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WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 14, 2026

Collins brings home bacon, but foes say aim higher

Democrats call for her to widen scope beyond Maine

By Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

PRESQUE ISLE, Maine — Passengers who take JetBlue's daily flight from this northern Maine town to Logan Airport quickly understand why Presque Isle International Airport is getting an upgrade.

The terminal, dating to the 1950s, is the air travel equivalent of a one-room schoolhouse. Check-in consists of a desk that is mere feet from the lone TSA screening lane, which leads to a waiting area crammed with seats in a space the size of a living room. Delays are even more uncomfortable here: There are no restrooms after security.

But greeting passengers in a video on TV screens nearly everywhere they look is the face of the person who helped secure critical funds for the sleek, spacious new terminal under construction next door: Republican Senator Susan Collins.

For Collins, the power to direct federal money to projects in Maine has been a defining tool over her 30-year Senate career. It's perhaps been the senator's preferred way to demonstrate her effectiveness and her connection to the state — and also make the case for reelection.

Now the chair of the powerful Senate Appropriations Committee that oversees the Congressionally Directed Spending, also known as the "earmark" process, Collins is at the peak of her influence precisely as she faces what could be her most challenging campaign yet.

In her first debate with Democratic challenger Troy Jackson last Tuesday, Collins mentioned her leadership of the panel and her steering of federal cash to Maine — nearly $1.5 billion in earmarks since 2021 — within seconds of her opening statement.

COLLINS, Page A6

HELEN BRANSWELL, 69

The reporter to turn to when COVID struck

By Andrew Joseph
STAT

Helen Branswell, a renowned infectious disease reporter who earned the respect of experts and public health officials around the world with her accessible, prescient dispatches on scourges from influenza to polio and Ebola to COVID-19, becoming a vital source of information for the public during the most chaotic of times, died Tuesday at age 69.

The cause was complications from cancer, said her sister, Brenda Branswell.

Ms. Branswell, a longtime reporter at the Canadian Press, joined Stat at its founding in 2015, working out of the Boston headquarters before returning home to Canada last year to be closer to family in Ottawa.

"Throughout her career, Helen demonstrated an unwavering commitment to evidence, science, and truth, helping the public understand some of the most complex and consequential health challenges of our time," Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus, the director-general of the World Health Organization, wrote in an email. "At a moment when

BRANSWELL, Page A6

Nursing home chain targeted

State regulators move to revoke licenses of RegalCare after report of poor care

By Kay Lazar and Gordon Russell
GLOBE STAFF

Massachusetts regulators on Tuesday moved to revoke all of the nursing home licenses held by RegalCare, a New Jersey-based company that went on a buying spree in the state after the pandemic, slashed costs, and gutted the quality of care at many of its 12 homes.

Spotlight FOLLOW-UP

The action comes directly on the heels of reporting by The Boston Globe Spotlight Team that chronicled the stark changes that occurred after Eli Mirlis, RegalCare's chief executive, purchased the facilities and made steep cuts to nursing and other services while steering funds to related businesses he owns.

Despite the move to revoke its licenses, RegalCare won't immediately lose control of its homes, according to officials from the state Department of Public Health. For the time being, they'll be subject to enhanced monitoring from DPH.

A company representative indicated in a statement late Tuesday that RegalCare will challenge the planned license revocations, which would trigger a hearing process at which the state will have to make its case for taking Mirlis's licenses away. Regulators said that if they are successful, Mirlis will be barred from operating nursing homes in Massachusetts for the next decade.

"Families trust nursing homes to care for their loved ones, and every resident deserves safe, compassionate, high-quality care that respects their dignity," Dr. Robbie Goldstein, commissioner of the department, said in a statement to the Globe. "The Department of Public Health takes seriously its responsibility to uphold these standards and protect the well-being of every resident."

Some of those who had relatives who suffered at RegalCare homes welcomed the news.

"I'm happy the state's doing something," said Theresa Walsh Jr., whose mother died a few weeks after receiving two different types of antidepressants at the Holyoke facility, when she normally only received one. "It was very frustrating to watch the article and see stuff on

NURSING HOMES, Page A7



MATTHEW J. LEE/GLOBE STAFF

"I worked my butt off to help my community only to learn that I'm on the hook for it," Dr. Zachary Kramer said.

For former Steward clinicians, the nightmare never ends

With in-house insurer broke, many are left to fight malpractice suits on their own

By Chris Serres
GLOBE STAFF

Dr. Peter Rees, a longtime primary care doctor in Haverhill, is 82. He'd hoped to be retired by now, spending more time with his wife, kids, and dozen grandchildren.

But he has a huge financial threat hanging over him: a malpractice lawsuit dating from when he worked for Steward Health Care.

The bankrupt hospital chain's in-house malpractice insurer, TRACO, is effectively broke, leaving Rees with tens of thousands of dollars in legal fees and the possibility of a multimillion-dollar judgment that could cost him everything, including his home.

He is among the scores of former Steward doctors, nurses, and other clinicians who face the prospect of financial ruin over the implosion of TRACO, which was looted by Steward executives as the for-profit chain spiraled downward. Some medical workers are raiding savings and retirement accounts to pay for their own insurance; still others are holding the bag for hefty legal settlements TRACO had agreed to pay but failed to honor.

"They know you can't get money from a stone, so the [malpractice] attorneys assume that rich old doctors have money and say, 'Let's go after them,' " said Rees, whose case is set for trial in February. "What do I do? Work until I collapse and die?"

In dozens of interviews and email exchanges, former front-line Steward clinicians describe a pervasive feeling of abandonment.

Two years ago, top Massachusetts officials lionized Steward medical workers as "true heroes" for delivering babies, performing surgeries, and holding emergency departments together through chaos. But now,

STEWARD, Page A7

So quick to criticize, we dropped ball on Maye

DAN SHAUGHNESSY

COMMENTARY

The overreaction was over the top. Even for Boston.

A pair of Super Bowl quarterbacks went on the air and said it was time to bench Drake Maye. My inbox was flooded with folks comparing The Drake to Mac Jones and Tony Eason. Readers were calling for Tommy Cutlets.

Truly.

The speed with which so many folks gave up on Maye was stunning.

Six picks, one lost fumble, and a 1-2 record after a 35-6 beatdown in Jacksonville had many giving up on a 24-year-old quarterback who just a few months ago won a conference championship game in the Denver snow to take the Patriots to a Super Bowl and was runner-up in voting for the NFL's Most Valuable Player award.

Maye rebounded with strong games in

SHAUGHNESSY, Page C2



MATTHEW J. LEE/GLOBE STAFF

Drake Maye had a smile on his face Sunday after the Patriots beat the Raiders.

Pope Leo XIV underwent surgery that confirmed he has lung cancer, and doctors removed the lower lobe of the 71-year-old's right lung, the Vatican said. **A3.**

Websites and apps for grocery chains Stop & Shop, Hannaford, and Giant Food were offline after their parent company experienced a cyber incident. **B5.**

US Ambassador to Greece Kimberly Guilfoyle resigned as she faced mounting accusations of improper and possibly illegal conduct. **A2.**

Payton Pritchard agreed to a two-year, $44.2 million contract extension with the Celtics, a source confirmed. **C1.**

You can smell apple cider doughnuts before you even pull into an orchard, and even the bad ones taste good. **G1.**

Sun of a gun

Wednesday: Very warm. High 76-81. Low 51-56.

Thursday: Back to normal. High 60-65. Low 47-52.

Sunrise: 6:56 Sunset: 6:04

Weather and Comics, G6-7.

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The Nation

Trump's ambassador to Greece resigns

Allegations include accepting improper gifts

By Matthew Lee
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — The White House publicly asked for US Ambassador to Greece Kimberly Guilfoyle's resignation on Tuesday as she faced mounting accusations of improper conduct, and she announced within two hours that she was quitting, ending days of talk and speculation about her professional fate. Guilfoyle insisted that she would "vigorously defend" herself.

President Trump's administration had said earlier Tuesday it had asked Guilfoyle to leave her post after she faced severe criticism over allegations she engaged in improper and possibly illegal conduct before and during her tenure in Athens.

That revelation came in response to a question to freshly minted White House press secretary Katie Zacharia at her first media briefing Tuesday morning. Zacharia said Guilfoyle "has been a wonderful asset to the team, and we wish her well."

"She went to Greece. She was doing a good job, but we didn't like what we were reading," Trump said just after Guilfoyle's resignation, which was posted on her X account. He said he had not spoken to her but "she will not be there."

Guilfoyle's departure comes after its possibility was previewed over the weekend and Trump registered his unhappiness on Monday at reports about her alleged conduct. Those comments came a day after the AP, citing a senior US official, reported that Trump and Secretary of State Marco Rubio were "extremely pissed off" by Guilfoyle's reported conduct.

In a series of stories dating to late last month, The Wall Street Journal reported questionable conduct by Guilfoyle, including an alleged threat to a host country official, accepting improper gifts and services, and offering to use her influence inside the Republican administration in return for the payment of a large credit card bill.

Guilfoyle addressed the accusations directly in her resignation post on X, saying, "These allegations are false, and I intend to vigorously defend my name, my reputation, and my integrity."

"I have dedicated my professional life to fighting for justice, standing up for what is right, and defending the values that make America exceptional," she said. "I will not allow false accusations to define my decades of public service."

In a statement released late Sunday, Guilfoyle's lawyers denied that she had done anything wrong and claimed that the money she was seeking from a Trump donor was payment for services — public appearances and speaking engagements that predate her ambassadorial nomination — that had not been paid.

The lawyers, David Schwartz and Jesse Binnall, also rejected allegations of impropriety related to Guilfoyle's travel on private planes, saying that before every such trip she "sought, obtained and followed State Department guidance and followed the Department's travel regulations."

They did not immediately return calls Tuesday.

After defending Guilfoyle following the first report, Rubio declined to comment publicly on the growing allegations. Last week, Rubio said: "Our ambassador has been a strong ambassador here."

But after another report appeared later, Rubio — speaking Thursday before leaving Athens — berated journalists for asking about the allegations. He said that he didn't know if they were true and that he would not respond if he could not confirm them.



KIMBERLY GUILFOYLE
Facing mounting accusations of misconduct, envoy says she will 'vigorously defend' herself.

"You guys walk around thinking that because some source told you something and you reported it, it's the gospel. It's not the gospel. It's not the gospel for me. That's not the way we do things," Rubio said at the foot of his plane as Guilfoyle, who was there to see him depart, looked on.

A second US official, who also spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss personnel matters, said the State Department's inspector general was looking into the allegations, which first began surfacing in the Journal late last month and have since multiplied.

The second official could not say if a formal IG probe had begun. Inspectors general often conduct informal inquiries into complaints against staffers, and many times those inquiries do not result in a full-on investigation, which can result in disciplinary action up to and including dismissal. The State Department has declined to comment on a potential IG investigation.

There was no immediate response to Zacharia's statement from the Greek government or Cabinet members.

Ahead of Tuesday's announcement, Greek opposition parties had called on the Foreign Ministry to summon Guilfoyle to respond to the allegations made against her. "This, most importantly, is an issue of national dignity," Sia Anagnostopoulou, a former deputy foreign minister, said in parliament Friday. Foreign Minister Giorgos Gerapetritis responded that Guilfoyle had been treated "the same way as every other ambassador" and argued that an official summons had not been necessary.

Cornell declares fraternity party ban

School to hire investigators

By Sharon Otterman and Debra Kamin
NEW YORK TIMES

Cornell University has banned parties at fraternity houses for the rest of the academic year and will add experienced sexual assault investigators to its police force in response to a student's allegations of gang rape in October 2024.

The university announced the changes Tuesday as it tried to reassure students, faculty, and alumni that it is addressing the ongoing crisis set off several weeks ago by the lawsuit filed by a former undergraduate, known as Jane Doe.

"We must meet this moment by acknowledging where we have fallen short and taking meaningful action," Michael I. Kotlikoff, president of Cornell, announced in a letter to the campus Tuesday. "Cornell must be a place where safety is not an open question."

The lawsuit shocked the campus and nation not only because of its allegations of rape but also because it put on full display how fraternity members exchanged Snapchat messages using crude and dehumanizing language to describe the woman and what was taking place.

The announcement Tuesday aims to also address the social culture at Cornell that set the stage for the alleged assault, Kotlikoff said.

"I am deeply sorry for the harm Jane Doe suffered in 2024, and appalled that this act of sexual violence occurred within our Cornell community," he said.

The most immediate change is a ban on all parties and social events in fraternity houses at Cornell for the remainder of the academic year, a sweeping measure on a campus where one-third of students are part of Greek life. Kotlikoff, in an interview Tuesday, noted that since the pandemic, fraternity parties had been pushed even more to the center of student life.

"There is an issue, post-COVID, of what are the options for students in a town like Ithaca," he said. "Many, many bars and venues went out of business and did not come back."

The moratorium, which comes days before Homecoming weekend, will allow for a thorough review of fraternity life at Cornell to determine whether it can safely resume, Kotlikoff said.

"This is a step that we need to take at this point in time to force a reset," Anne Smalling, the chair of Cornell's board of trustees, said in an interview. "It's incumbent on us to try and find other ways for these kids to engage in social settings."

The campus will also enhance support for survivors of sexual assault, including by adding staffing to its civil rights office to help those who report incidents navigate what has been described as a complicated bureaucratic system. Officials will hire "experienced, trauma-informed criminal investigators, who are independent of Cornell University" to investigate allegations of sexual assault and to prepare "comprehensive investigative summaries for the appropriate law enforcement agency."

Thomas Giuffra, an attorney for Jane Doe, praised the changes as moves in the right direction. While they come too late to protect Doe, he said, "these steps will hopefully go a long way to help ensure that there are no more Jane Does."

The changes announced Tuesday seek to address some of the gaps in Cornell's response that were highlighted by Jane Doe's experience.

Missing from the letter were any announcements of personnel changes among Cornell administrators, or an explanation of why these steps were only being taken now, when administrators have known about the gang rape allegations since 2024.

Daily Briefing

Man sentenced for his role in Shakur slaying

LAS VEGAS — Duane "Keffe D" Davis was sentenced Tuesday to 40 years to life in prison for orchestrating the murder of rap icon Tupac Shakur, who was gunned down off the Las Vegas Strip over 30 years ago.

Davis, 63, was convicted in August of first-degree murder with the use of a deadly weapon. He is the only person ever charged in the death of Shakur, whose popularity was peaking at age 25.

Prosecutor Marc DiGiacomo said Tuesday that whatever sentence the court imposes, Davis is "guaranteed to die" behind bars.

"It's not just about losing a family member," DiGiacomo said as Shakur's sister Sekyiwa "Set" Shakur nodded her head in the audience.

The killing went unsolved for years until Davis, a former leader of the South Side Compton Crips, gave interviews and published his role in the shooting in his 2019 tell-all memoir.

DiGiacomo said Davis was trying to profit off a killing that he committed, and for that he does not deserve the minimum sentence.

"In my mind he deserves the maximum possible sentence," DiGiacomo said.

Davis spoke briefly in court, telling Judge Carli Kierny he wants items back that police took from his house, including his pictures. Asked if there was anything else he wanted to say, Davis said: "No, I'm good."

Davis's lawyer, Michael Sanft, said he plans to appeal the verdict. Sanft said prosecutors waited too long to bring the case.

On the night of Sept. 7, 1996, Shakur was in the passenger seat of a black BMW with music mogul Marion "Suge" Knight when a white Cadillac pulled up at a red light, and shots erupted. Shakur was shot multiple times and died six days later, while Knight survived.

Shakur is considered one of the most influential and versatile rappers of all time and had a burgeoning film career as an actor at the time of his death. His legend has only grown since. His songs still resonate among fans.

ASSOCIATED PRESS



MICHAEL M. SANTIAGO/GETTY IMAGES

TRIBUTE IN BLUE — Families of fallen New York City police officers joined Mayor Zohran Mamdani and Police Commissioner Jessica Tisch on Tuesday for a ceremony during which the names of 42 fallen officers were added to the NYPD Memorial Wall. The memorial honors every officer who died in the line of duty in the city.

28 miles and counting: NASA's rover sets a Mars driving record

NASA's Perseverance rover has now driven farther than any other vehicle in the solar system — except those on Earth, of course.

On Sunday, Perseverance's odometer ticked past 28.06 miles, the distance it has traveled in and around Jezero Crater since it landed on Mars in February 2021. That surpasses the distance that Opportunity, one of NASA's earlier, smaller Mars rovers, trundled from 2004 until it fell silent in 2018.

NASA's Jet Propulsion Laboratory, which operates the rover, announced the news Monday after confirming Perseverance's location and new total driving distance: 28.1 miles.

Mission managers had thought Perseverance would pass the milestone back in August, but then it came upon intriguing rocks that may be some of the oldest ever studied on Mars. And thus, it dawdled for two months.

"Science is the reason that rover is on the surface of Mars," Katie Stack Morgan, the project scientist, said in an interview in early October. "We're excited to get the record when we get it. But in the meantime, it's the rocks that really drive the mission."

Before launch, NASA had certified that Perseverance was capable of driving 20 kilometers, or 12.4 miles. "We're way past that now," said Steven Lee, the mission's project manager.

Now, NASA is working to extend the certification to 100 kilometers, or just over 62 miles.

NEW YORK TIMES

Florida executes convicted killer

STARKE, Fla. — A Florida prisoner who said he killed his cellmate specifically to get on death row was executed Tuesday, nearly 18 years after the attack.

James Robertson, 63, declined to offer any last words before receiving a three-drug injection and was pronounced dead about 10 minutes later.

It was a stark contrast to the failed execution of Christa Pike in Tennessee two weeks ago, where she was rushed to the hospital after surviving two lethal doses of pentobarbital.

Robertson's execution comes at a time of escalating attention on the death penalty in the United States. The Pentagon said last week that it would livestream the firing squad execution of Fort Hood shooter Nidal Malik Hasan, drawing criticism from both Republican and Democratic lawmakers.

"Florida has a sound lethal injection process and protocol," Jordan Kirkland, a state Department of Corrections spokesperson, said at a news conference before the execution.

Although he couldn't speak to Tennessee's lethal injection procedure, he said Florida would make sure its process was "humane and dignified."

Florida executes people by injecting them with a sedative, a paralytic, and a drug that stops the heart, according to the Department of Corrections.

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Jury selection begins in N.Y. shootings

BUFFALO, N.Y. — Jury selection began Tuesday in the federal hate crime trial of a man who admitted to killing 10 Black people in a massacre at a New York supermarket in 2022, a case that could lead to a rare federal death sentence.

Payton Gendron is already spending life in prison after pleading guilty to state murder charges and tearfully renouncing his white supremacist views. He now faces a trial in federal court arising from the same mass shooting. The stakes are high: If convicted, the 23-year-old could face the death penalty.



Payton Gendron could face the death penalty.

The attack at the Tops Friendly Market in Buffalo is believed to be the deadliest hate-motivated shooting targeting Black people in the United States by a lone gunman in the past century.

Gendron has pleaded not guilty to dozens of hate crime and gun charges, though his defense lawyers do not dispute his guilt. One even predicted a conviction when speaking to a prospective juror Tuesday.

If Gendron is convicted, his lawyers will try to persuade jurors to spare him from execution. Life imprisonment is typically the alternative.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

The World

Surgery confirms Pope Leo XIV has lung cancer

Doctors remove lower lobe of his right lung

By Nicole Winfield and Colleen Barry
ASSOCIATED PRESS

ROME — Pope Leo XIV underwent surgery Tuesday that confirmed that he has lung cancer, and doctors removed the lower lobe of his right lung, the Vatican said.

The tests confirmed a diagnosis of lung adenocarcinoma, the Vatican said in a medical bulletin after the surgery. It said the diagnosis had been suspected by preoperative tests and was confirmed during surgery.

The statement made no mention of treatment going forward, and the Vatican said doctors were not currently speaking of chemotherapy or other therapies. The Vatican press office noted the medical statement spoke of the "radical" removal of the lobe as an indication that doctors removed all suspect tissue in hopes of removing any lingering traces of the cancer.

The 71-year-old was in the operating room for about three hours, according to the statement. The surgery itself lasted approximately 90 minutes. "The surgery was successful, and there were no complications," the statement read.

Leo had walked into Rome's Gemelli hospital through the main entrance earlier in the day and waved to dozens of well-wishers who had gathered to greet him. The Vatican said the surgery would be performed by a team led by Gemelli's chief thoracic surgeon, Dr. Stefano Margaritora.

The American pontiff has offered a rare level of transparency about the first publicly disclosed major health problem of his 17-month papacy. He revealed the discovery of the small, localized nodule during his Sunday noon prayer and announced that he would have it removed.

Oncologists said prior to the operation that even if the nodule turned out to be cancerous, Leo's prognosis is "excellent" since it will have been removed at an early stage.

The Vatican on Monday canceled all of Leo's audiences through Oct. 20.

While Gemelli has a specific papal apartment that past popes have used, complete with a private chapel on the 10th floor, Leo will actually be staying in a nearby room since the papal apartment is undergoing renovations, according to the Vatican press office.

There was no word on whether Leo would be able to keep his planned trip to South America next month.

Oncologists often advise patients not to fly for three weeks after surgery — which would give the pope just the interval needed to make his planned Nov. 6-17 trip to Uruguay, Argentina, and Peru, depending on his recovery.



ALESSANDRA TARANTINO/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Pope Leo XIV, 71, arrived at Gemelli Hospital in Rome on Tuesday. Leo's diagnosis had been suspected by prior tests.

The current itinerary for the trip is ambitious and the longest of his papacy to date, calling for Leo to clock just over 19,000 miles on a dozen flights and two helicopter rides, and a significant altitude change in Peru.

"He has decided to undergo surgery soon in order to not change his plans for future overseas trips, so there is no need to worry, as it is not an emergency," said Tokyo Cardinal Kikuchi Tsutomu, who saw Leo on Monday.

A lung nodule is a small abnormal area measuring less than 1.2 inches that sometimes appears on a CT scan of the chest or abdomen. Often, the scans are done to investigate trauma or a lung infection, unrelated to a lung cancer screening. A nodule can be benign or malignant, and oftentimes surgical removal is recommended both to establish whether it is cancer and to treat a malignancy while it is still localized.

This is believed to be the second hospitalization for Leo, who is known to be sporty and in good shape, with weekly tennis games and swimming.

As a young missionary priest, he came down with typhoid fever in 1985, soon after arriving in Peru. The illness and hospitalization were a cathartic moment for him to decide to stay in the poverty of Peru after living in relative comfort in Rome — a decision that ultimately paved the way to his papacy, according to an interview Leo gave to Elise Ann Allen in 2025 for "Pope Leo XIV: The Biography."

DAILY BRIEFING



MUFFIDZ MA'SUM/INDONESIAN NATURE REHABILITATION INITIATIVE FOUNDATION VIA AP

An orangutan, one of eight, was released into a protected forest in Batu Nyambu, West Kalimantan, Indonesia.

Endangered orangutans, rescued from Borneo wildfires, find new home

JAKARTA, Indonesia — Eight endangered orangutans were released into a protected forest weeks after wildfires destroyed large swaths of their habitat in Indonesian Borneo, a conservation group said.

The orangutans, including three mothers with infants and two adolescent males, were rescued from areas in Ketapang and North Kayong regencies that were ravaged by fires in August and September.

The animals were moved Oct. 8 to Batu Nyambu protected forest in West Kalimantan province, said Heribertus Suciadi, a spokesperson for the Indonesian Nature Rehabilitation Initiative Foundation.

The wildfires cut off habitat corridors and reduced access to food sources, forcing the apes into plantations inhabited by people in search of food and shelter and stranding them there, Suciadi said Monday.

"They had no burns, open wounds, broken bones, or other life-threatening injuries, but appeared to be suffering from malnutrition and dehydration," Suciadi said.

Among those rescued were a female orangutan known as Mama Man and her infant, Man, who had been monitored for months in a small forest patch surrounded by plantations. Expanding fires and heavy smoke left them with no safe route back to larger forests.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Man stabs shoppers in Korean mall

SEOUL — A 59-year-old man stabbed at least eight people Tuesday at a shopping mall in the South Korean city of Incheon, police and fire officials said. One victim had life-threatening injuries.

The suspect attacked shoppers as he moved through the mall before business owners and bystanders subdued him, according to Incheon's Namdong District Police Station and witnesses.

The man has a history of violent offenses and mental illness and was required to wear an electronic monitoring anklet, according to South Korea's Justice Ministry. The man's name was not released, in keeping with South Korean practice for most criminal suspects.

Witnesses told South Korean media that the attacker appeared to have knives tied to both hands and stabbed people in different parts of the mall while moving up and down the floors on an escalator.

Nah Hyun-joon, who helped subdue the attacker, said he saw the man attack people in the second-floor food court before moving to the third floor, where he stabbed at least one woman. Nah said the attacker then headed toward a movie theater on the fourth floor but was blocked by several people holding chairs at the top of the escalator.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Five die as train derails in Pakistan

MULTAN, Pakistan — A passenger train derailed in central Pakistan early Tuesday, killing five people and injuring 35 others, police and a Pakistan Railways spokesperson said.

The train was traveling from the southern port city of Karachi to the northwestern city of Peshawar when it derailed in Sher Shah city in Punjab province, railway spokesperson Kaleem Akhtar said.

Rescuers recovered all four bodies and evacuated the injured from the train's 14 cars, he said. The injured were taken to a hospital for treatment, but one died before he could be transported, rescue officials said. Emergency responders and paramedics were dispatched to the scene, he said.

President Asif Ali Zardari and Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif expressed grief in separate statements and urged authorities to provide the best possible medical care to the injured.

Train accidents are relatively common in Pakistan, where the railway system has suffered from decades of underinvestment, outdated tracks, and aging signal systems. In 2023, ten cars of a passenger train derailed in southern Pakistan, killing 30 people and injuring more than 90 others.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Thunberg backs French protests over run-down schools

SAINT-DENIS, France — Greta Thunberg on Tuesday threw her high-profile support behind high school protesters rattling the government in France, saying "the whole world is watching with awe."

She joined and applauded hundreds of teenagers who demonstrated boisterously outside a school north of Paris under the watchful eye of police.

The surprise appearance by the climate activist, along with another day of marches in the French capital and elsewhere, suggested that students' push for resources for run-down schools is far from running out of steam. That's despite mass arrests, mounting injuries, and fatigue from three weeks of blockading schools and demonstrating.

The Interior Ministry estimated that 161,500 people marched in demonstrations across the country, including 41,500 in Paris.

Outside the Paul Éluard high school in Saint-Denis, where staff and students have complained of dilapidated facilities and rat infestations, Thunberg, 23, said pupils are "fighting back, reclaiming their future that has been taken away from them," and are inspiring young people in other countries.

ASSOCIATED PRESS



JOHN LEICESTER/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Greta Thunberg joined protesters in France.

European leaders recoil from Trump's gas deal with Putin

Assure 'complete solidarity' with Kyiv, Zelensky

By Michael D. Shear and Jeanna Smialek
NEW YORK TIMES

European and British officials were stunned by President Trump's unexpected announcement that he had made a deal with President Vladimir Putin to purchase Russian diesel fuel, which had been subject to US sanctions. But they were in a bind on how to respond.

►Kyiv says attack came with no notice from partners. A4.

The arrangement, which President Volodymyr Zelensky of Ukraine called "a gift" to Putin, directly undercuts years of effort by dozens of countries — including the United States — to cut Russia off from the money that fuels Putin's war of aggression in Ukraine.

Energy experts have said that the diesel agreement, if it goes ahead, could send some $4 billion of American money into the Russian economy.

Trump's announcement Friday afternoon of his "highly successful discussion" with Putin was all the more shocking in Europe as it came after Russia conducted several brutal strikes in Ukraine, killing 22 people including three babies in an apartment block Wednesday and at least 30 people in a bus Thursday.

For European leaders, the dilemma over the past three days has been familiar: How to support Ukraine in a moment of acute diplomatic peril, without triggering Trump's ire?

Complicating their response is the fact that Europe as a whole depended heavily on Russia for energy before 2022. And despite cutting purchases significantly since the invasion of Ukraine, several European nations continue to buy Russian natural gas — which does not yet face full sanctions — amid growing energy insecurity and limited supply.

Hungary and Slovakia, which have had pro-Russian governments in recent years, have continued to import Russian oil.

Both Trump and Russian officials highlighted the imports of Russian fuel to European nations over the past four years in the aftermath of the diesel announcement.

As European leaders scrambled for a response, they stopped short of directly criticizing the American president and coalesced around a single diplomatic message: We are not changing our own approach to Russia, and we stand by Ukraine.

On Saturday, Britain announced that Prime Minister Andy Burnham had spoken to Zelensky, noting that he had begun the call "by recognizing the last 24 hours had been difficult for Ukraine" — an oblique reference to Trump's intervention — and had "reiterated his complete solidarity." The statement added that Burnham would meet with Zelensky in the coming days.

A spokesperson for the German chancellor, Friedrich Merz, told reporters that the government was "standing by the sanctions decisions against Russia and is working together with its European partners on further sanctions."

Kaja Kallas, the European Union's top diplomat, began her comments to reporters Monday with a conciliatory nod to the United States, before saying that the bloc was "continuing our path" of trying to keep Russia from enriching itself by blocking the sale of oil and gas on the global market.

"The US is our biggest ally, but our message is clear," she said while entering a meeting of foreign affairs ministers in Luxembourg. "If we want to end this war, the only way we can do this is by putting more pressure on Russia."

Margus Tsahkna, the minister of foreign affairs for Estonia, was more blunt.

"We have had this kind of turbulence and also pressure from President Trump's side to Ukraine before," he said. "So we need to focus on what we can do."

Trump responded to the European reaction on his TruthSocial site Monday afternoon.

"The European Union paid Russia 250 Billion Dollars for Energy, and the Fake News Media doesn't want to get near that story," the president wrote, possibly referring to European purchases of Russian oil since Russia invaded. "I made the right choice for the American People — ALWAYS, AMERICA FIRST!"

Since early 2022, the EU as a whole has imported 238 billion euros (about $266 billion) worth of Russian oil, coal, and gas, according to a tracker led by the Center for Research on Energy and Clean Air, a research group.

But the bulk of those imports were in the first year after the war began, as Europe worked to cut its longstanding reliance on Russian energy. Since then, the bloc has imposed sanctions and implemented phaseouts.

UK security chief warns of threats from Iran, Russia

Speech follows series of attacks in Great Britain

By Adam Goldman
NEW YORK TIMES

LONDON — The head of MI5, Britain's domestic security agency, singled out Iran in his annual threat briefing Tuesday, accusing the country of stepping up attacks as tensions between the two nations escalate.

"The spring saw a wave of arson and sabotage incidents targeting Jewish communities in the UK and other European countries," the MI5 chief, Ken McCallum, said during the briefing. He attributed those attacks to Iran and called them "sickening."

"The other major shift this year has been Iranian ambitions to come at harder targets, like military sites," he added.

McCallum's comments follow a series of attacks on British soil that targeted Jewish and Israeli-linked institutions and, most recently, an air base that the United States used during its war on Iran that began in February.

In his speech, McCallum said more than 50 people had been arrested in connection with Iran-linked operations in Britain in the past 12 months. That includes two Iranian nationals charged this month over a suspected terrorist plot targeting Jews in the Manchester area, in northwestern England.

Tensions were already high between Iran and Britain. But the nature and scope of the incident at the air base, RAF Fairford, has heightened concerns that the confrontation has taken a more serious turn as Iran lashes out, attempting to intimidate a key US ally and sow terror in Jewish communities.

In his talk, McCallum laid out a series of threats facing the country, such as artificial intelligence, terrorism, and China. Russia, he said, "remains aggressor No. 1," citing hybrid attacks across Europe aimed at undermining support for Ukraine.

Moscow's reliance on criminals or "naive volunteers" is not the "actions of a great power with the strategic upper hand," he noted.

Last month, intelligence officials learned about a possible Iranian threat to US bases in Europe, including RAF Fairford, which is in southern England.

Days later, five men were arrested after driving three white vans near the base. The men were initially arrested on suspicion of terrorism and explosives offenses but were later released on bail after police only found gasoline in the vans, raising questions about the severity of the plot. Security experts suggested it might have been a botched arson attack — similar to previous incidents linked to Iran.

On Monday, Prime Minister Andy Burnham of Britain told Parliament, "We will not tolerate these threats on our soil."

Burnham said the Fairford plot was "almost certainly" directed by Iran's Revolutionary Guard, Iran's powerful security apparatus. The events prompted a sweeping counterterrorism investigation that led to two more arrests, but those men have also been released on bail.

The United States later pulled its bombers out of England after receiving additional intelligence about a possible Iranian-led drone attack. British security experts have raised doubts, however, about whether Iran has the capabilities to pull off a sophisticated drone operation on British soil. Asked to comment on that, McCallum said, "Given what we've actually seen in practice in the UK in recent years, that has not been anywhere near the level of capability."

British officials including McCallum have been vocal about the Iranian threat, noting how the country relies on criminal proxies to carry out attacks. At the center of those operations is the Revolutionary Guard, which British authorities took steps this year to designate a terrorist organization.

Burnham told Parliament, "We will crack down on Iran's use of criminal networks, using our full range of powers to target them and their funding streams, and we will bring further sanctions to restrict the capacity of Iran and the IRGC to do us harm."

As part of that effort, the British government on Monday identified and imposed sanctions on two Iranians it said were involved in coordinating overseas attacks: Ruhollah Bazghandi, the Revolutionary Guard's counterespionage chief, and Shahram Ali Reza Tamarzadeh Jakki, a facilitator linked to an Iranian criminal network that targeted Iranian dissidents.

Iran has denied any role in the events at the air base.

Before the arrests at RAF Fairford, British authorities were already focused on Iran after it was accused of carrying out a retaliation campaign in Europe. In those cases, the authorities blamed Kataib Hezbollah, a US-designated terrorist group that is a proxy for the Revolutionary Guard.

Kyiv got no warning from partners on attack, Zelensky says

US still offering intelligence, Trump insists

By Hanna Arhirova and Justin Spike
ASSOCIATED PRESS

KYIV — Ukraine received no early warning from its partners about five Russian ballistic missiles that hit civilian infrastructure in the capital of Kyiv, President Volodymyr Zelensky said Tuesday, as tensions rise between the Ukrainian leader and President Trump.

Zelensky did not specify which partners he was talking about. He characterized the barrage as "particularly vile" and emphasized that receiving intelligence from partners about such attacks "helps save lives" and is "one of the most critical issues."

"This is precisely what helps prevent people from being killed — when there is an early warning about ballistic missiles," he wrote in a post on X.

Trump said the US has not stopped sharing intelligence with Ukraine.

"We are helping them, and we are sharing intel," Trump told reporters at the White House. "We want the war to end, so we're working with them and with Russia on getting the war to end."

Zelensky's remarks come days after Trump unleashed biting criticism of him, including comments that it was time for a new president in Ukraine and that Zelensky has not done enough to end the war. The criticism marks perhaps the lowest point in their relationship since their disastrous Oval Office meeting in February 2025.

Kyiv continues to rely heavily on Washington for military assistance, including US-made Patriot missile-defense systems and intelligence.

The US has the capability to immediately spot Russian ballistic missile launches. American officials have in the past notified Ukraine about launches to allow it to issue missile warnings to the public and to use air defenses against incoming missiles.

Asked whether Ukraine received an explanation for the lack of intelligence ahead of the overnight missile strikes, a senior Ukrainian official said it was described as a "failure," suggesting it was the result of circumstances such as weather conditions rather than a deliberate decision. The official spoke on condition of anonymity because he was not authorized to give an official statement on the matter.

Russia's war in Ukraine has not seen major shifts on the ground since last year, but Ukraine is struggling to fend off Moscow's intensified aerial attacks that include speedy ballistic missiles and high-flying jet-powered drones.

Downing the missiles has been a challenge because of a shortage of Patriot missiles caused by the US-led war in Iran. Russia's Iskander short-range ballistic missiles take just a few minutes to reach targets in Ukraine.

Zelensky said Russia had attacked Ukraine with more than 100 weapons since Monday evening. A residential building in the northeastern city of Kharkiv was destroyed, killing four people despite an all-night rescue operation, he said.

Russia has increasingly used attacks on civilian infrastructure such as energy facilities to deny Ukrainians power, heat, and running water during the 4½-year war, hoping to wear down public support for Ukraine's response to Moscow's full-scale invasion.

Trump has blamed Ukraine's earlier strikes on Russian oil refineries for record US diesel prices — rather than the war in Iran. He struck a deal with Russian President Vladimir Putin on Friday to import diesel from Russia in an attempt to bring fuel prices down ahead of US midterm elections.

Meanwhile, Trump claimed Sunday that Russia and Ukraine had agreed on an "energy ceasefire" in which both parties would refrain from striking each other's energy infrastructure. Russia has not confirmed the existence of such a deal. Kremlin spokesman Dmitry Peskov said only that "contacts on this matter continue."

Zelensky on Tuesday said Ukraine had not struck Russian oil refineries or other energy sites in the two days since Trump announced the purported deal. He criticized Moscow for what he said were Russian attacks on Ukrainian energy facilities and infrastructure in the time since Trump's announcement.

"These are absolutely clear signals that they have no intention of refraining from strikes on Ukraine," Zelensky said.

The claim that Ukraine has halted its strikes on energy sites could not be independently verified, but neither Russian officials nor media have reported Ukrainian attacks on oil refineries since the energy truce was announced.

Russian strikes across Ukraine caused injuries and deaths overnight Monday and into Tuesday. In addition to the four deaths in the apartment building in Kharkiv, 41 people were wounded in the city in one evening alone, Zelensky said.

A woman was wounded in a Russian strike on a private home in Kyiv's Darnytskyi district, the Kyiv city military administration said. A Russian drone hit a residential building in the village of Murovane, near the western city of Lviv, during a morning attack Tuesday, Lviv Mayor Andrii Sadovyi said.

One person was killed in the Fastiv district of the Kyiv region, and at least two others were hurt in a Russian attack on the area, said Tymur Tkachenko, head of the regional military administration.

A Russian drone struck an educational institution in the center of Rivne in northwest Ukraine, wounding 14 people, according to Oleksandr Koval, head of the Rivne regional military administration.



SERGEY BOBOK/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

Ukrainian rescuers searched the site of a Russian drone strike on a residential building in Kharkiv on Tuesday.

Spain's royals visit Muslim cemetery in Ceuta to honor migrants

Couple also shows solidarity with residents

By Joseph Wilson and Manu Fernández
ASSOCIATED PRESS

CEUTA, Spain — King Felipe VI and Queen Letizia visited the Spanish city of Ceuta in North Africa on Tuesday in a show of solidarity with residents and the victims of a protracted migration crisis that has strained relations with Morocco.

The royal visit came with the city of 84,000 residents still grappling with the mass crossing of nearly as many migrants into Ceuta in July. The royals met with locals who felt abandoned by mainland authorities, while also paying their respects at a Muslim cemetery to the at least 140 migrants who died in the attempt to reach European soil.

The majority of the around 80,000 who crossed were Moroccans who quickly returned, but thousands remain in the Mediterranean coastal city. The exact number is unknown, though Ceuta's mayor has estimated that as many as 15,000 remain. Many, including minors, have had to sleep on the streets in poor conditions or now-demolished makeshift camps.

Their presence has fueled social tensions in Ceuta and become a political issue across Spain, where opposition parties hope to use migration concerns to unseat the progressive government in next month's elections.

The couple will stay overnight in Ceuta before traveling on Wednesday to Melilla, Spain's other North African exclave. The trip marks the first visit by a Spanish monarch to the two cities since Felipe's father, Juan Carlos I, toured them in 2007.

Migrants from Morocco and sub-Saharan Africa regularly attempt to cross the border fences around Ceuta and Melilla, seeing the Spanish cities as gateways to mainland Europe.

During a recent visit to Ceuta, The Associated Press found many underage migrants still living on the streets.

Some migrants have also reported abuse. The Spanish government is investigating allegations detailed in an Amnesty International report of mistreatment and torture by Spanish soldiers. One migrant said soldiers beat him so badly he needed staples to close wounds to his head.

Residents, meanwhile, have felt ignored by national authorities as the crisis remains visible on the city's streets. Spain's government has sent military and police personnel to Ceuta, and pledged investment for the city.

The official royal agenda says the king and queen wanted to "show the support of the Crown for Ceuta's institutions and society."

Large crowds gathered to greet the royals and shake their hands. As Felipe met residents, some broke into the familiar sports chant, "I am Spanish, Spanish, Spanish." Church bells rang as people waved Spanish flags.

Felipe received the key to the city from Ceuta's top elected official, Juan Jesús Vivas, who called for the expulsion of all migrants who remained after the mass crossing.

"Thank you for coming to boost our morale, to resist and to see the light at the end of the tunnel," Vivas told the royals. "We are going through a difficult time, an invasion that caused the deaths of 141 people with the intention of putting our city on the brink."

Felipe and Letizia were accompanied by religious authorities from Ceuta's four main religions — Roman Catholic, Islam, Judaism, and Hinduism — at the Sidi Embarek cemetery where dozens of unidentified migrants who died during the crossings are buried.

The city has a history of religious coexistence, but the border crisis has strained relations between its Christian and Muslim communities.

The royals also visited a school in what their agenda describes as "a multicultural setting that respects different religions."

Morocco does not recognize Spanish sovereignty over the two small territories, which have been under Spanish control for centuries. Diplomatic observers in Spain will be watching closely for Rabat's response to Felipe's visit. Rabat is Morocco's capital city.

While Spanish Prime Minister Pedro Sánchez has defended Morocco's role in helping resolve the crisis, many in Spain have questioned whether officials in Rabat could have done more to prevent the crossing.

A Spanish Defense Ministry intelligence report issued July 30, as thousands streamed across the border, described Moroccan forces as passive and negligent in their efforts to stop migrants.

"It cannot be ruled out that Morocco may attempt to exploit the situation that has arisen in Ceuta to further its strategic interests," the report said.

Haizam Amirah-Fernández, director of the Madrid-based Center of Contemporary Arab Studies, is among the analysts who believe Morocco, even if not directly involved, was likely aware of the buildup of people spurred by social media to cross into Ceuta. He described the mass crossing as an "assault" on Spain's sovereignty.

"The message is clear to all parties, to the population of Ceuta, to the population of Spain, to the European Union, to the international community and to the southern neighbor, who allowed for this assault to happen," Amirah-Fernández said.



MANU FERNÁNDEZ/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Spain's King Felipe VI and Queen Letizia Tuesday greeted the crowd during their visit to the Spanish enclave of Ceuta.

Judge orders halt to work on D.C. golf course

POLITICAL NOTEBOOK

WASHINGTON — US District Judge Ana Reyes on Tuesday ordered a halt to tree-cutting at the East Potomac Golf Course until Oct. 26, putting a further pause on work at the historic D.C. course that has been part of President Trump's plans to remake the city.

Reyes issued the order one day after a tense three-hour hearing in which she harshly criticized the government for having deceived her with its actions over the holiday weekend.

At the Monday hearing, Reyes ordered a 24-hour pause that could be extended to 14 days if necessary. It was limited to one day while the government tried to find a key Trump administration official to discuss why a massive tree-cutting at the park needed to occur over the holiday weekend, with little notification to plaintiffs in a lawsuit trying to halt the plans or the judge.

The judge also ordered during that period the government "must provide the court and plaintiffs three business days' written advance notice prior to making any irreparable modification to any permanent form or feature of the East Potomac Golf Course."

The DC Preservation League and two local golfers are the plaintiffs in the lawsuit.

The co-counsel in the case, Democracy Forward, thanked Reyes for stepping in and halting what the group called the "mad rush" to turn the public recreation space course into a high-end golf course.

The Monday hearing and Tuesday order were prompted by the National Park Service ordering the cutting of hundreds of trees at the golf course after filing the court notification only minutes before the close of business on Oct. 9 on a holiday weekend, giving the plaintiffs little time to respond. At least 400 trees were cut down over the weekend with plans for several hundred more.

The historic park, especially the golf course, caught the eye of Trump, who wants to turn it into a world-class golf venue. It's part of his grand vision for Washington, D.C., where he has multiple projects underway, including a $400 million White House ballroom and the soon-to-begin construction of his triumphal arch.

ASSOCIATED PRESS



JULIA DEMAREE/ASSOCIATED PRESS

MEET THE PRESS — Newly appointed White House press secretary Katie Zacharia spoke with reporters in the James Brady Press Briefing Room at the White House in Washington on Tuesday.

Supreme Court to decide on request for DOGE records

WASHINGTON — The Supreme Court announced Tuesday that it would review a long-running dispute over how much information the Department of Government Efficiency formed by Elon Musk must disclose in response to public records requests.

In the early days of President Trump's second term, Musk's initiative, known as DOGE, swept through federal agencies seeking to overhaul the government bureaucracy and fire scores of workers.

Musk eventually departed last year amid declining influence and friction with the president and after failing to deliver on promised savings.

But a nonprofit watchdog group, Citizens for Responsibility and Ethics in Washington, has continued to press for information about the entity's operations. The group, known as CREW, had filed an expedited request for records under the Freedom of Information Act. After it did not receive the records, the group filed a lawsuit, saying DOGE had violated public records laws.

The justices are expected to schedule the matter for oral arguments early next year and to issue a decision in the case before their new term ends in late June or early July.

At issue will be whether the quasi-private entity is similar to other federal agencies, which are generally subject to federal public records laws. The administration has argued it is instead more like presidential advisory groups, which are able to keep more information private.

A federal judge in Washington, Christopher R. Cooper, concluded last year that Musk's group was likely subject to the records law and ordered it to turn over the documents during the lawsuit discovery process. A three-judge panel on a federal appeals court agreed.

The case previously reached the Supreme Court on a temporary and emergency basis last year.

In June 2025, the justices paused CREW's discovery request, blocking the group from getting DOGE's records and sending the case back to the lower courts for more litigation and discussion over how to narrow the set of records that Musk's group was required to turn over.

NEW YORK TIMES

Poll: Most Americans question Trump's profits

NEW YORK — Most Americans think Donald Trump is profiting off the presidency in unethical or illegal ways and is focused more on his wealth than helping people like them, a new AP-NORC poll finds.

As Trump's family business pulls in record money from new ventures helped by his policies, the survey from the Associated Press-NORC Center for Public Affairs Research finds that when it comes to allegations that Trump is profiting from the presidency, about 6 in 10 US adults believe he is either illegally profiting or doing something unethical but not illegal.

Only about 2 in 10 think the Republican president is doing nothing wrong, while a similar share say they don't know enough to say.

At the same time, just over half of Americans say Trump has prioritized his personal financial interests "a lot" since returning to the White House, while only about one-quarter say he puts the same emphasis on the country as a whole. Few US adults, about 1 in 10, say he's focused "a lot" on people like them.

Trump derided the issue of conflicts of interest at the start of his second term, telling The New York Times that "I found out that nobody cared." Unlike in his first term, he's lifted a self-imposed ban on his family striking private-sector deals overseas and started several new crypto businesses.

The poll results suggest that most US adults think growing his personal fortune has been a focus for Trump in his second term, at least to some extent. Only about one-quarter of US adults say he's prioritizing his personal business interests "only a little" or "not at all," including less than half of Republicans.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Parties rush to spend on races they think are winners

DES MOINES, Iowa — Republicans were retreating Tuesday from a handful of battleground US House races while Democrats were racing to raise money to boost candidates who seemed like long shots earlier this year.

The Congressional Leadership Fund, the leading House Republican super PAC, canceled spending in four races from the Midwest to the East Coast and increased its investment in 16 other races from Texas to Pennsylvania.

Meanwhile, Democrats' House campaign committee is eyeing openings in Republican-held districts and hoping to raise millions of dollars in the next week to fuel a late round of advertising that they say could net at least a half dozen more seats.

The shifting money in the final three weeks of midterm campaigns points to an increasingly defensive posture by Republicans, who have already trimmed their expectations in US Senate races, and new aggression from Democrats, who are trying to capitalize on President Trump's weak approval ratings.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Six Flags closes 9 coasters after death

Families saw Ga. man fall and die

By Kate Brumback and Russ Bynum
ASSOCIATED PRESS

ATLANTA — Witnesses watched in horror as a man riding a roller coaster at Six Flags Over Georgia was ejected from his seat, almost seeming to hover above the car before hitting several people and falling to his death.

The nightmarish death on Monday prompted Six Flags to temporarily close nine similar coasters across North America.

Police and a state agency that oversees ride inspections are investigating, but many questions remained Tuesday, including how the man fell out and whether there were problems with his restraints.

The man, a school employee from Atlanta, was killed while riding Goliath, the park's tallest roller coaster with a first hill of 200 feet.

"It looked like he was hovering because the car was moving underneath him," said Nick Mendenhall, who had just ridden Goliath with his son and was watching the coaster cars passing overhead.

The man fell headfirst back into the coaster, Mendenhall said, then was ejected from the ride on its final turn.

"It felt like slow-motion, but it happened in an instant," Mendenhall said. "I was just praying in those moments. I was praying: 'God, please let him stay in that car.'"

The man who died was Hassan Jihad Ibn Kariem, 42, according to Cobb County police. Kariem worked as the information technology manager at a public charter school and before that was a technology teacher.

In a statement, the Wesley International Academy said it was devastated, saying Kariem's "dedication to our students, and commitment to our school community were evident in everything he did."

Six Flags Entertainment Corp. temporarily shut down roller coasters at six of its parks in the US and Canada. Those rides include a second coaster named Goliath at Six Flags Magic Mountain in Southern California; Raging Bull at Six Flags Great America in Illinois; Nitro at Six Flags Great Adventure in New Jersey; Fury 325 and Thunder Striker at Carowinds in North Carolina; and the rides Leviathan and Behemoth at Canada's Wonderland in Ontario.

Bolliger & Mabillard, the Swiss company that manufactured the coaster and many others worldwide, said it is actively investigating and won't comment "until we have a better understanding of what happened."

Six Flags New England in Agawam did not respond to a request for comment Tuesday on whether it was taking any additional safety precautions as a result of the fatality in Georgia. The Western Massachusetts park boasts the popular thrill coasters the Wicked Cyclone and Superman: the Ride, where on April 24 riders were forced to walk down from the track after the coaster stalled near the top of the lift hill.

Goliath towers above the entrance at Six Flags Over Georgia just outside Atlanta with a series of hills and turns. It doesn't take riders upside down. There are no seat belts. Instead, riders are restrained with lap bars that pull down over their legs and waist.

Summer Bates, who was at the park with her husband and three children, saw Kariem fall. Bates said she and her family rode Goliath earlier in the day.

"My older two children rode on the cart ahead of us," she said. "I noticed they kept trying to push theirs down tighter. I assured them that they were OK. But once my husband, youngest child, and I loaded our cart and headed up the incline, I quickly understood why my older two were messing with theirs. It just didn't feel secure and tight."

In the US, roller coasters and other rides at major amusement parks are not regulated by the federal government. That responsibility falls to states.

After Army surge to border, Rio Grande much quieter

Remains a bright spot in Trump's polling numbers

By Ben Finley
ASSOCIATED PRESS

ROMA, Texas — Standing on a high bank of the Rio Grande, Army Lieutenant Colonel Ray Richards points to a stretch of river that was, until recently, one of the busiest spots for illegal border crossings from Mexico.

But on a recent afternoon, the area is quiet. American soldiers gather at a border monitoring post in Roma, Texas, where an infantry vehicle with camouflage netting sits between houses. A Blackhawk helicopter drops soldiers onto an island in the river, while US Border Patrol agents breeze by on fan-propelled boats.

"At any given time, there would be multiple rafts full of people trying to get to this side," Richards said of the area before US forces made it a priority last year.

The Army has been inviting reporters to the Rio Grande Valley as it deploys hundreds more soldiers to the region this month by shifting some of the thousands of troops already serving along the 2,000-mile border. US officials said the troop surge follows signs of elevated activity from drug cartels and has been accompanied by increased cooperation from the Mexican military. The US Coast Guard said it recently encountered gunfire from the Mexican side of the river, prompting the Americans to fire back.

In this small patch at the southern edge of the United States, a slow saga is playing out — a curious mix of policing, policy, and politics.

While Republicans face increasing headwinds because of President Trump's unpopularity, persistently high prices, and the fallout from the war in Iran, border security has remained a relative bright spot in Trump's polling numbers, with about half of Americans saying they approve of his performance there.

But some experts have questioned the need for such a large military presence. They suggest it's less about effective strategy and more about political theater.

Illegal crossings have plummeted due in large part to asylum restrictions that began before Trump returned to the White House. Meanwhile, a large percentage of the fentanyl, cocaine, and heroin seized along the border was being smuggled in cars and trucks passing through checkpoints, not the areas in between.

David Shirk, a University of San Diego political science professor, said the Trump administration wants to remind voters it's been very aggressive on border security.

"I don't dispute there's some benefit to having personnel in areas at risk for people smuggling and drug trafficking," Shirk said. "But the vast majority of that is now happening at ports of entry."

Dessa Bergen-Cico, a professor of public health at Syracuse University who studies drug trafficking, said street prices for cocaine and fentanyl are still low, suggesting the drug flow remains unimpeded.



ERIC GAY/ASSOCIATED PRESS

US Coast Guard personnel patrolled the Rio Grande at the US-Mexico border in McAllen, Texas, last week.

But Army Major General Curtis Taylor, who commands the military's southern border task force, said the work has been vital and effective, particularly for targeting human trafficking.

The moral argument for the Army's mission is "dismantling this marketplace of human trafficking that is bringing people into the border," Taylor said. "An added benefit of that is there's an awful lot of drugs moving with that human trafficking."

Roma, a city of about 10,000 people, lacks a border wall in some places because homes sit close to the steep slopes along the Rio Grande. Directly across the water is Miguel Alemán, a town in the Mexican state of Tamaulipas that's been plagued by decades of cartel violence. From Roma, it's a football field's distance across the river at best and much less in some places.

In 2021, Roma became a center of illegal crossings when thousands of families and unaccompanied children arrived each day to seek asylum. Border crossings fell sharply after President Joe Biden introduced severe asylum restrictions in 2024 and dipped after Trump suspended asylum at the border.

After Trump returned to the White House in January 2025, the Army and Coast Guard expanded operations to back up the Border Patrol, which remains the lead agency for border security. The Army now commands some 8,000 US troops along the entire border, while the US Coast Guard and Texas law enforcement have brought in more personnel.

Army officials said people still try to cross into Roma despite multiple obstacles. A barrier of strung-together buoys, each the size of a hay bale, stretched along the river. Concertina wire lined the US river bank, while a surveillance blimp hung in the sky. A river island was recently cleared of trees that hid people trying to cross.

Army Sergeant Nathaniel Decker said he recently saw people on three rafts set out from the Mexican side at dusk. He reported to Border Patrol that one group had cleared the buoys. They were eventually caught by a house in Roma.

The United States has stopped many of the drones used by the cartels to surveil the border and ferry drugs, by electronically jamming or capturing them or shooting them down with a laser.

The United States has gotten better at tracking them and coordinating with Mexican officials to locate the drones' operators. But some still get across.

Under pressure from Trump, Mexican President Claudia Sheinbaum has cracked down more heavily on crime than her predecessors.

Mexico this month sent 500 National Guard and military officers to Tamaulipas as part of a coordinated effort with the United States to prevent drug and human trafficking.

Mexico's deployment "is based on intelligence gathered regarding the movements of criminal groups," a federal official in Mexico said, speaking on condition of anonymity because he was not authorized to comment on the matter.

Collins brings home bacon, but foes say aim higher

▶COLLINS
Continued from Page A1

But Jackson has argued that Collins has failed to use her clout as the top appropriator to address the issues that are most adversely affecting angry and cost-fatigued Maine voters, like President Trump's steep tariffs against neighboring Canada.

Collins has struggled to navigate a middle ground as Trump's massive federal program cuts and tariff regime wallop Maine, aiming to preserve her backchannel influence to reverse some decisions by avoiding harsh direct criticism of the president.

That divide distills the core calculation for many Mainers in this race: whether consistently bringing home the bacon for smaller-scale but important projects outweighs the hunger for a stronger check on an increasingly unpopular president.

Presque Isle, next to Collins's hometown of Caribou, may as well be a physical embodiment of her campaign pitch. The airport upgrade, for which Collins secured $20 million, is not the only recent project she has backed here — a community that, perhaps more than any other municipality in Maine, illustrates how she approaches her job and how she intends to keep it.

A few minutes' drive from the airport is Northern Light A.R. Gould Hospital, the largest in northern Maine, where Collins steered $3 million to fund new cancer radiation therapy equipment. A quick jaunt down Route 1 is the University of Maine at Presque Isle, where she directed $4 million for an arts center renovation, among other things. That drive will eventually be smoother thanks to a reconstruction of Route 1 to divert heavy truck traffic off what is effectively the town's main street, with federal support via Collins.

All told, Collins has brought more than $43 million in earmark money to Presque Isle since 2021, more overall than any other Maine municipalities save for Portland and Bangor. Because Presque Isle has a comparatively small population of roughly 9,000, it is the top recipient per capita of Collins-directed federal funds of any municipality in Maine.



SPENCER PLATT/GETTY IMAGES

Senator Susan Collins campaigned at the Fryeburg Fair last week. The election is now less than three weeks away.

The city's role as a government and services hub for Aroostook County, which is more rural and poorer than the rest of the state, could explain why it is such a magnet for Collins, a native daughter of "The County."

Trey Stewart, a Republican who represents Presque Isle in the state Senate, said the scope and impact of Collins's ability to deliver has only grown stronger since she took over the appropriations panel.

"I can tell you there is no comparing the ability Senator Collins has to serve and provide" with what Jackson's would be, Stewart said. "The timing is just right. Earmarks are back. And she's bringing home the bacon more than ever."

But some locals view the focus on federal funds as a parochial distraction from the far-reaching national consequences of the Maine race.

Jim Nesbitt, a former Republican activist in Maine who now supports Democrats, believes Maine will be better served by a Democratic majority in the Senate. "I have no faith at all in her," Nesbitt said as he carried Democratic campaign signs on the sidewalk of Route 1. "And a $40,000 gift for the volunteer fire department is a ridiculous premise to vote for somebody."

The senator's federal cash clout has become a flashpoint in this race in more uncomfortable ways for her. In September, ProPublica reported that the FBI investigated allegations that ahead of the 2020 race, Navatek, a Hawaii defense contractor, made significant contributions to a super PAC supporting Collins in exchange for federal contracts doled out through a separate process in the Senate appropriations defense subcommittee.

Collins denied any wrongdoing and her campaign cast doubt on the credibility of former Navatek chief executive Martin Kao, given that he confessed details to federal investigators as he attempted to negotiate a plea deal, though ProPublica independently corroborated aspects of his account.

For decades, the earmark process itself became plagued with fiscal mismanagement and even outright corruption. In 2011, Congress imposed a moratorium on earmarks amid bipartisan backlash.

A decade later, lawmakers reinstated the practice — re-dubbing it as Congressionally Directed Spending — along with reforms to make the process more transparent. One percent of annual federal discretionary spending is reserved for CDS requests, which can be made by all members, but more funding is available to members higher in seniority and who serve on the appropriations panels.

When CDS returned in 2021, Collins was primed to take advantage: She had served on the panel since 2009 and had decades of seniority under her belt. The total dollar amount of projects she has funded has steadily increased each year. For fiscal year 2026, she brought $425 million back to Maine, the fourth-highest total among all US senators.

Collins is notable in that she "spreads it around," said Zachary Courser, a political science professor at Claremont McKenna College who is the author of a forthcoming book on earmarks. Collins typically directs money to many projects around the state instead of a few big-ticket items, he said.

Indeed, Collins tends to prioritize projects in smaller jurisdictions without the resources or tax base of cities like Portland. Hard infrastructure is a common target: She's funded more than 80 waste water improvement projects alone in the last five years. She has also prioritized the University of Maine system, steering some $500 million in federal funds there.

Scott Wardwell, the director of the Presque Isle airport, got a firsthand sense of her approach when the senator visited a few years ago.

"We looked above ceiling tiles and through the boiler room," recalled Wardwell, who said Collins "does her homework" thoroughly on projects. "Sometimes you can be on the losing end of that. If she investigates your project and doesn't think it's a high priority, she won't support it."

Though the timing of Collins's leadership of appropriations coincides nicely with her reelection bid, ironically, it also comes at a moment when Trump is running roughshod over her panel's authority by withholding congressionally appropriated funds. Just last month, the administration moved to block more than $800 million of legally approved funds before the fiscal year ended, which Collins slammed as "unlawful."

Back in Maine, Collins has spent much of this campaign in convenient places: groundbreakings and ribbon-cuttings for projects supported earlier in this term that are now coming to life around the state. She is so ubiquitous in such settings that many Maine voters are aware of her role on the Appropriations Committee, even if they do not support her.

For a senator, like Collins, representing a competitive state, that status can be a powerful boost if it "becomes a consideration that is dominant in [voters'] minds," said Courser.

Still, it can't always overcome a strongly unfavorable political environment — which Democrats are hoping will finally overpower Collins.

"Even that record of distributive spending, bringing resources to Maine, can be overwhelmed by other factors," he said.

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Branswell was the reporter to turn to when COVID struck

▶BRANSWELL
Continued from Page A1

misinformation competes with facts, her reporting was a trusted source of clarity, honesty, and insight."

Among the awards Ms. Branswell received were the Victor Cohn Prize for Excellence in Medical Science Reporting and the George Polk Award for Public Service, which cited her "relentless coverage of all aspects of the [COVID] pandemic that became must reading for the medical community and the general public" — stories that, the judges wrote, were "almost uniformly timely and astute." She was also a Pulitzer Prize finalist with two colleagues for their early COVID stories, and received an honorary degree from Ottawa's Carleton University.

Not bad for someone whose career was, as she put it in a 2020 interview, "really a fluke."

Ms. Branswell, who was born in Sherbrooke, Quebec, started freelancing for a small newspaper in Eastern Canada after graduating from New Brunswick's St. Thomas University with a degree in English literature, thinking that writing was one skill she had. She eventually worked her way to the Canadian Press, covering politics, sports, and a bit of everything else.

Her introduction to the beat that she would fall in love with came about by happenstance. She was working in Toronto for the Canadian Press during the city's 2003 SARS outbreak, and coverage of viruses and other pathogens turned out to be a natural fit. She had a background in breaking news that many health and science journalists didn't. She also found herself taking to the often complex scientific issues she was learning about — like transmission rates and case trajectories — that other breaking news reporters were struggling to understand. She became a medical reporter at the CP.

"She loved her work," Brenda Branswell said. "She loved science and medical writing. She thought her job was a gift. She found it so interesting."

Over the years, at the CP and then at Stat, she gained a loyal following for chronicling the twists and turns of influenza, the grinding campaign to eradicate polio, and the development of vaccines for a host of pathogens. Her beat was inherently unpredictable. With little notice, a new outbreak could go from smoldering to explosive, or a virus only a coterie of experts cared about — think Zika — could become a global crisis.

But it was her ahead-of-the-curve insights on COVID — in the early days of what would become the pandemic and throughout the emergency — that hundreds of thousands of people began turning to her for, on Stat's site and on social media.

Ms. Branswell was not alarmist — she rightly thought the recent cruise ship hantavirus outbreak, though serious, didn't merit the outsized reaction it seemed to be getting — but she was clear-eyed about the threat that the SARS-CoV-2 virus could pose even before scientists had sequenced it.

"Hopefully this is nothing out of the ordinary. But a @ProMED_mail posting about 'unexplained pneumonias' in China is giving me #SARS flashbacks," she famously tweeted on Dec. 31, 2019. "Not liking the look of this," she added a few days later.

Thanks to Ms. Branswell's leading coverage, The New York Times wrote in late March 2020 that Stat "was early to a story that would dominate the news," in an article in which a Harvard University expert referred to Ms. Branswell as "a godlike figure to people who are infectious-disease epidemiologists."

Throughout the pandemic, she saw around corners, and her coverage showed it. She wrote in May 2020 that COVID vaccines were more likely to be strongly protective against severe outcomes than to put a stop to transmission — something the world only caught onto a year later when faced with that reality. She described in August 2020 how the upcoming winter "could be Dickensianly bleak," previewing a season during which 3,000 Americans a day were dying from COVID.

"I always found her writing just so scientifically sound," said Jeanne Marrazzo, a former director of the National Institute of Allergy and Infectious Diseases and now the chief executive of the Infectious Diseases Society of America. "It was very sophisticated, yet accessible and clear."

When Marrazzo and her team at NIAID were considering which reporter to speak with for one of her first interviews after taking over as director in 2023, Ms. Branswell's name came up immediately. "I trusted her, and I knew she would ask the right questions."

Ms.Branswell cared deeply about ensuring her stories captured the complexity of the science she was writing about and the sometimes competing viewpoints experts would advance about emerging research. She was also a bit obsessive. On Monday afternoon, from the hospital, she shared in Stat's Slack new data about uptake of the maternal RSV vaccine.

"A terrible loss for all of us, for everyone who cares about health and medicine," Stat cofounder and owner John W. Henry wrote in a note to staff on Tuesday. "She was someone we all leaned on for so many years on so many important issues. Beyond that she was a wonderful person."

At first impression, Ms. Branswell could come across as intense, even, by her own admission, a bit gruff. But in fact, there was no bigger cheerleader for Stat and its staff. She celebrated other reporters' stories and recognition even as she was quick to remind colleagues she despised the reply-all email chains that typically accompanied such successes. When she worked in Boston, she also frequently brought in treats she baked, whether banana bread or — ever the proud Canadian — maple butter tarts.



BROOKE ALEXANDER FOR STAT

Ms. Branswell described in August 2020 how the winter "could be Dickensianly bleak," previewing a season when 3,000 Americans a day were dying from COVID.

"She had a big heart and she looked out for people and she did kind things for people, but she did them quietly," Brenda Branswell said. "She was never seeking any attention or glory for her good deeds."

Ms. Branswell leaves her five siblings and eight nieces and nephews, whom she proudly doted on.

From 2010 to 2011, Ms. Branswell participated in a Nieman Fellowship in Global Health Reporting at Harvard, where she focused on polio eradication. She was also a CDC Knight fellow in 2004, when she embedded at the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention for three months.

In the newsroom, if you walked by Ms. Branswell's computer screen, you'd likely see her highlighting and adding notes in the margins to the latest scientific paper she was reading. But you might also spot her catching up on the latest hubbub with the British royal family. (She had done a stint in London with the Canadian Press.)

She also wasn't above office gossip — scouring for news within Stat's newsroom as well as beyond it.

"She always asked the one question nobody else asked, and it just happened to be the most important one," said Michael Osterholm, the director of the University of Minnesota's Center for Infectious Disease Research and Policy.

Many of the public health officials Ms. Branswell wrote about — sometimes critically — also deeply respected her. Maria Van Kerkhove, a top WHO official, said Ms. Branswell was out for more than a snappy quote — but rather information that she knew would be useful for the public to understand.

"Helen was someone I spent hours and hours and hours on the phone with over the years," Van Kerkhove said. "I always wanted to have a conversation with Helen. No matter what the topic was, no matter how complex it was, she always asked the most thoughtful questions, and followed up with an even more thoughtful question."

"She was also pretty kickass, and no nonsense," she added.

Indeed, Ms. Branswell wasn't afraid to call out public health officials on perceived lapses. In one memorable interview in April 2020, she pressed then-CDC director Robert Redfield why the agency hadn't held a briefing in a month, as would have been the case in any other serious disease outbreak.

"You're invisible now, sir. Your agency is invisible," Ms. Branswell told Redfield.

Other reporters recognized Ms. Branswell's prowess on the beat. As Meg Tirrell, a longtime health reporter now at CNN (and formerly the host of a Stat podcast), tweeted in April 2021, "When @HelenBranswell gets called on in FDA/CDC #covid19 pressers I literally get a mental picture of Babe Ruth striding up to home plate."

Lawrence Altman, a longtime New York Times reporter who covered the health of presidents and political leaders, had never heard of Ms. Branswell until some long-ago press briefing. He said he doesn't remember the exact occasion but he remembers being struck by the quality of her questions. After it happened a few times, Altman called the Canadian Press and asked to speak to Ms. Branswell, starting up what became a friendship.

"She was the best reporter on infectious diseases that I know," Altman said.

In August, Ms. Branswell was named as this year's recipient of the Kovler Prize for Trust in Life Science Journalism, awarded by the Foundation for the National Institutes of Health, which cited her "exceptional ability to clearly convey complex and often urgent science topics for the public."

The prize came with a $25,000 honorarium, which Ms. Branswell told Stat Executive Editor Rick Berke she wanted to contribute to a fellowship that was named in honor of veteran science journalist Sharon Begley, who died of cancer in 2021 and was a friend of Ms. Branswell's at Stat. The fellowship is intended for early-career US journalists from racial and ethnic groups underrepresented in the profession.

Before the work-at-home period of the pandemic, Ms. Branswell and Begley sat next to each other in the Boston newsroom, the doyennes of Stat, and of science journalism. Reporters and editors alike regularly sought their advice on how to cover a certain story, the history of a certain therapeutic approach, or just their general wisdom.

As one Stat reporter put it Tuesday, it was a comforting thought that they might be back at their desks together again.

This story is republished from STAT, the health and medicine news site that's a partner to the Globe.

For ex-Steward clinicians, nightmare never ends

▶STEWARD
Continued from Page A1

many of the operators that took over Steward's hospitals refuse to cover past malpractice claims, while the very officials who lauded their heroism and dedication have thus far offered no meaningful relief.

"It feels like a massive betrayal," said Dr. Paresh Mane, a thoracic surgeon in Salem, N.H., who worked at Steward's Holy Family Hospital in Methuen and St. Elizabeth's Medical Center in Brighton. "We stepped up during a time of need and kept practicing in hospitals that Steward had starved of resources. Now we are left completely exposed."

In response, more than 300 ex-Steward doctors, nurses, and other clinicians have formed a large coalition to lobby the Healey administration to take urgent action to backstop malpractice coverage, tighten regulatory oversight of malpractice insurers, and launch a criminal investigation into Steward's former top executives for misleading them.

They have the backing of the Massachusetts Medical Society, the state's powerful doctors' lobby, which condemned the collapse of malpractice insurance as "unconscionable" and warned that it will worsen the state's severe physician shortage.

In a written response to questions, Governor Maura Healey's Executive Office of Health and Human Services said it is reviewing proposals from the new coalition.

An agency spokesperson also noted that Steward ignored its repeated demands to maintain adequate malpractice coverage and that it has asked the Texas judge overseeing the ongoing bankruptcy proceedings to step in — warning that TRACO, which still operates out of the lightly regulated jurisdiction of Panama, had "little to no independent capital" to pay claims.

"Doctors and clinicians should not continue to have to pay the price for Steward and Ralph de la Torre's greed and mismanagement," the spokesperson said, referring to the company's former chief executive who had presided over the downfall.

The damage isn't just to medical providers. Many patients harmed by Steward's substandard care also face a grim reality: Their legal claims may never have a shot at meaningful redress thanks to TRACO's collapse.

The demise of TRACO, which once covered 1,400 medical practitioners nationwide, has highlighted a regulatory blind spot, according to health and insurance law experts. Because the insurer is based overseas and is not licensed in Massachusetts, state regulators maintain they were powerless to intervene.

Like many hospital systems, Steward saved money by self-insuring against malpractice claims through a subsidiary, known as a captive insurer. Instead of paying a commercial carrier, Steward promised to cover legal defenses directly for clinicians facing lawsuits and pay settlements up to specified limits — typically capped at $6 million annually per clinician.

A 2024 Globe Spotlight investigation found Steward moved TRACO from the Cayman Islands to Panama in 2019 in part to take advantage of the country's lax regulations.

Meanwhile, insurance regulators in Massachusetts maintain they were kept in the dark — and had no jurisdiction anyway. Because state law does not require foreign-based captive insurers to be licensed in Massachusetts, they do not need to submit financial statements to the state. As a result, the state Division of Insurance lacked legal authority to monitor TRACO's solvency or determine if the company could cover claims, the agency said.

"What's happening with TRACO is catastrophic for everyone involved, and exposes a glaring weakness in our insurance regulatory structure," said Maria O'Brien, a professor at Boston University School of Law who specializes in insurance and contract law. "The hope that anyone will ever get anything close to compensating them for the harms caused is very remote."

The wreckage from TRACO's looting adds to a long toll of misery left in Steward's wake.

Steward's debt-fueled rise to become the nation's largest private for-profit hospital chain generated massive payouts for its top executives and private equity investors, while starving its hospitals of resources. At least 15 Steward patients died after failing to receive professionally accepted standards of care due to equipment or staffing shortages, according to a 2024 Globe Spotlight investigation.

Yet the fallout would surely have been worse if not for frontline staffers, many of whom said they kept working in part because top Steward executives — who also ran TRACO — assured them their malpractice coverage was secure.

Dr. Michael Callum, a former Steward executive vice president who served as TRACO's president between 2019 and 2024, and Rubén José King-Shaw Jr., current CEO and president of TRACO, told doctors in September 2024 Steward was reserving funds during the bankruptcy to cover new claims and would continue defending old ones. That summer, Callum and Steward hospital executives made similar assurances at a town hall with doctors.



MATTHEW J. LEE/GLOBE STAFF

Dr. Zachary Kramer said he left clinical practice last month to transition into telehealth.

In reality, Steward executives had for years been treating TRACO like a piggy bank, removing cash and leaving IOUs behind. As a result, by mid-2024, the insurer had just $3.5 million in cash — a meager sum given it faced over 500 malpractice claims.

King-Shaw and Callum, now treasurer of TRACO, did not respond to requests for comment from the Globe. De la Torre, the disgraced founder and former CEO of Steward, still sits on the insurer's board along with Callum, who is now affiliated with a concierge men's health business in Florida. Attempts to reach de la Torre were unsuccessful.

When Steward sold its Massachusetts hospitals in the fall of 2024 to several health care systems, doctors hoped the new owners would provide "tail" coverage for past malpractice claims during their time at Steward. But only one has: Brown University Health, which acquired Saint Anne's in Fall River and Morton Hospital in Taunton.

Boston Medical Center Health System — which bought St. Elizabeth's Medical Center and Good Samaritan Medical Center in Brockton — has said it will only provide tail coverage if TRACO is declared insolvent. So far, no official declaration has been made.

Merrimack Health, which bought Steward's hospitals in Methuen and Haverhill, also declined to cover past claims. "The primary responsibility for, and any resolution of those claims, remains with TRACO with any underfunding concerns addressed through the bankruptcy courts," the Lawrence-based company said in a statement.

In two recent cases, Massachusetts Superior Court judges have ordered former Steward doctors to personally pay six-figure malpractice settlements that they say TRACO negotiated but failed to fund.

While Dr. Chontelle Degler, an emergency medicine physician who worked at St. Elizabeth's from 2023 to 2024, has not been sued, she dreads opening her mailbox each day, fearing a lawsuit will be waiting inside.

A tail policy would cost her at least $50,000 a year, which she does not have and refuses to borrow.

"Every day I wonder, will this be the day I get sued? You can be blindsided," Degler said. "Whatever sacrifices we made — working without adequate supplies and staff — are not being appreciated. We are being left hung out to dry."

Other ex-Steward physicians say insurers are marking up tail policies because of the defunct health system's poor safety record. One physician assistant said her tail insurance quote soared from $7,000 a year ago to more than $50,000. In higher-risk specialties such as obstetrics and neurology, quotes have eclipsed $100,000 a year, according to physicians.

The anxiety over lost malpractice protection is driving some former Steward doctors to leave bedside care.

Dr. Zachary Kramer, former chief of emergency medicine at St. Elizabeth's Medical Center and associate chief at Morton Hospital, willingly worked back-to-back shifts during the pandemic.

However, learning he was personally liable for past claims left him feeling "used and discarded," he said. When he looked into tail insurance, he found the cost had jumped to $80,000 from $26,000 in a year.

Disillusioned, Kramer, 42, left clinical practice last month to transition into telehealth. "I worked my butt off to help my community only to learn that I'm on the hook for it," he said. "It's an awful feeling, like jumping out of a plane without a parachute."

Meanwhile, attorneys for former patients are increasingly suing clinicians personally and not naming Steward, betting they have deeper pockets than the bankrupt organization.

In one recent wrongful death suit, involving a woman who suffered a fatal heart attack in 2023 while waiting for care at Good Samaritan Medical Center's emergency department, Steward and the hospital were not even named as defendants, despite federal health inspectors finding serious safety lapses there. Instead, the lawsuit named only a triage nurse and an emergency physician.

Hundreds of other cases have been put on hold indefinitely.

Among those stuck in legal purgatory are Donna Gardner and Catherine Griffith of Madison, Conn., who allege in a lawsuit that physicians at Morton Hospital failed to properly diagnose their 35-year-old daughter, Elizabeth Gardner, a former social worker, leading to her becoming permanently disabled. The case has dragged on for four years amid multiple delays.

"We want someone to be held accountable at Steward, but it doesn't make sense for us . . . to experience further emotional and psychological distress trying to get money out of an empty well," said Donna Gardner, a retired pediatric nurse, who is nevertheless pressing forward with the case.

TRACO, for its part, has repeatedly pressed a Texas bankruptcy judge to force Steward to fork over roughly $250 million to settle its IOUs, according to court filings.

Timothy Walsh, an attorney for TRACO, declined to comment on the insurer's financial condition. The government agency in Panama that regulates captive insurers did not respond to calls and emails from the Globe.

Former Steward physicians argue the Healey administration bears some responsibility for this debacle due to past failures in oversight, and for not securing commitments from buyers of Steward's hospitals to provide tail coverage.

In recent meetings with top aides to Healey and key lawmakers, doctors presented a list of demands, including a state-backed relief fund to cover unresolved malpractice settlements and judgments from their time at Steward.

Should state leaders fail to act, they are weighing more dramatic actions, including a day of action and sit-ins outside the State House.

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State regulators move to revoke nursing home chain's licenses

▶NURSING HOMES
Continued from Page A1

TV and not feel like anything was being done.

"I'm happy that something like what happened to my mom can't happen to anyone else."

The statement from RegalCare said the chain is dedicated "to providing the best, most compassionate care possible to the patients we serve, and their families."

"We are aware of the DPH's recent actions and will continue to work with them through the appeals process in the coming weeks and months," it said. "In the meantime, we expect that there will be no disruption in care to our patients or their families."

The Spotlight story revealed that in 2018, New Jersey regulators determined Mirlis lied about completing continuing education requirements and permanently revoked his nursing home administrator license. Yet Mirlis had indicated in his applications for nursing home licenses in Massachusetts that he had never had a professional license revoked.

Goldstein noted the misrepresentation — which was unknown to Massachusetts regulators before the Globe report — to explain why his department is now taking such strong action against Mirlis.

But he also noted that his department had recently conducted a "comprehensive review of quality and safety in RegalCare facilities across Massachusetts and in other states." In addition, Goldstein flagged a recent settlement with the US Attorney's Office in Boston and the Massachusetts Attorney General's Office in which Mirlis admitted billing MassHealth and Medicare for intensive, medically unreasonable, and unnecessary physical therapy on frail, elderly patients.

These concerns were detailed in the Spotlight report, which also examined eight other out-of-state nursing home companies with questionable records, most of them from New York and New Jersey. These nine chains now own nearly one in five Massachusetts nursing homes.

The report questioned why Massachusetts regulators weren't doing more to block Mirlis from acquiring more homes here, given his dismal record within Massachusetts and elsewhere. In an earlier interview with the Globe, Goldstein said that state regulators were limited in their ability to deny licenses to nursing home operators based on their out-of-state records, saying that doing so could expose the state to litigation — a claim some legal observers disputed.

Goldstein suggested he needed the additional muscle granted by a 2024 law that gave the Department of Public Health broader authority to investigate the out-of-state records of nursing home operators — covering everything from poor performance to finances — before granting them licenses.

He noted that the law has not been implemented because the state first needs to adopt regulations that would allow DPH to put it into effect. The state's Public Health Council is scheduled to vote on those Wednesday.

Representative Thomas Stanley, a Waltham Democrat and longtime elder advocate, was one of two state lawmakers who met with Goldstein last week following the Spotlight report, expressing anger at the revelations and the department's inaction.

"We made it clear that action had to be taken and I said sometimes, that if no action is taken, then the state is complicit," Stanley said Tuesday. "And what the hell are we here for? The state needed to act, we have to protect the defenseless."

Paul Lanzikos, a cofounder of Dignity Alliance, an elder advocacy organization, said he received a call late Tuesday from the DPH informing him of the state's planned action. Lanzikos said the department indicated it is also planning to take a closer look at other problematic chains.

"I asked them, are they paying attention to any other questionable characters who have blown into town?" he said. "Without saying yes, they indicated as much."

The COVID-19 pandemic created chaos in the nursing home world, setting off a series of sales. In relatively short order, RegalCare became one of the largest chains in Massachusetts. Mirlis acquired most of his dozen homes here after 2022. All told, his RegalCare chain has at least 29 homes in five states.

Several of his homes saw dramatic drops in quality after Mirlis bought them. The federal quality ratings of his homes in Taunton and Quincy fell from five stars to one, and the home in Holyoke from three stars to one.

Among Mirlis's 12 nursing homes in Massachusetts, the facility in Greenfield had until recently stood out, with a four-star rating. But when new federal ratings were released earlier this month, it had plunged to two stars.

The ratings are based on visits from inspectors, who over the years found a host of problems ranging from patients being left in soiled diapers and waiting hours to get a response to calls for help to far more alarming and dangerous incidents.

For instance, at RegalCare's home in Quincy, a blind patient in a wheelchair crashed to the bottom of an unblocked ramp in 2023, suffering a brain hemorrhage and multiple fractures, according to a federal inspection report.

Within a year of buying two Medford facilities, in 2024, RegalCare had tallied more than $400,000 in federal fines for lapses in care involving more than two dozen patients.

Those failures came amid steep cuts to services — and increases in payments to related businesses owned by Mirlis.

At the Taunton facility, for instance, RegalCare by 2025 was spending $530,000 less on nursing services than the previous owners had. Meanwhile, his real estate company charged the nursing home rent of $522,000, more than four times what the previous owners had paid.

The cuts meant that the number of hours worked by registered nurses fell by more than half, and those worked by licensed practical nurses fell by more than a third.

The DPH's current action does not require any RegalCare facilities to close or residents to relocate. The department said that beginning Wednesday, all RegalCare homes will have a monitoring visit at least once weekly.

But several of the company's worst-performing homes will be watched even more closely, the department said, with at least two weekly visits. They include RegalCare's two Medford nursing homes, Glen Ridge and Courtyard. Also RegalCare at Wakefield and RegalCare at Taunton, which was highlighted in the Spotlight report.

Hope Cayouette, who placed her beloved 85-year-old grandmother, Carol Lessard, in Taunton in the spring of 2025, said RegalCare did not diagnose Lessard's pneumonia, among other failures. Her grandmother died following delayed care for a fall and an internal bleed.

"I have tears in my eyes," Cayouette said, when told about the state's actions. "Without [Mirlis] running this organization the way he has run it into the ground, he can't hurt anymore people the way he hurt my nana."

She added: "Justice is served. I can't believe it happened so fast."

The DPH said that residents, families, and staff can report any other issues to DPH through its call center at 617-468-2189 or 833-305-2070. The call center will be available Monday to Friday, except state holidays, from 8 a.m. to 6 p.m.

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Opinion

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ENDORSEMENT

Vote yes on Question 9

In 2024, the Legislature updated Massachusetts' already-strong gun laws, making them stricter and closing loopholes.

The new law, which is admittedly unwieldy with disparate pieces, contains important provisions to enhance public safety, most notably a ban on possessing or creating untraceable "ghost guns."

Gun owners, however — outraged by what they viewed as an attack on their constitutional rights — succeeded in putting a referendum on November's ballot that seeks to repeal the entire law.

That would be unwise. The Globe editorial board strongly endorses a yes vote on Question 9 to keep the law in place.

The text of the law is long and complex enough that it takes up 40 pages in the state voter guide. Provisions include: requiring all guns to have serial numbers; giving judges authority when issuing a restraining order to make someone relinquish their firearms; expanding the list of people who can seek an Extreme Risk Protection Order (ordering someone to relinquish guns because they pose a danger to themselves or others); creating a statewide registry of gun owners; providing additional information to local gun licensing authorities; raising the minimum age for buying semiautomatic rifles and shotguns from 18 to 21; outlawing machine gun parts that make guns more dangerous, including bump stocks, trigger cranks, and Glock switches; prohibiting carrying guns in schools, polling places, and government buildings; allowing minors to buy pepper spray; and requiring live fire training to get a gun license.

Ruth Zakarin, CEO of the Massachusetts Coalition to Prevent Gun Violence, said modernization was necessary to "keep ahead of technology" and create guardrails to prevent guns from falling into the hands of people intent on causing harm.

> The fact that criminals, by definition, won't follow laws isn't a good reason not to have them.

For example, homemade guns are a relatively new innovation, and letting them proliferate without serial numbers made it harder to trace guns used in crimes. Zakarin said since 2024, Boston police have recovered 153 "ghost guns" used in crimes.

The Extreme Risk Protection Order law was only established in 2018, and over time, lawmakers realized it would be useful to allow health care providers and school administrators — in addition to family members and law enforcement included in the original legislation — to petition the court if they believe someone's firearm possession poses a danger.

Gun rights advocates say the new law infringes on the constitutional right to bear arms, but any legal issues should be litigated in the courts, not on the ballot, and cases are pending.

Toby Leary, chairman of the ballot question seeking the repeal, said there are too many cases where law-abiding citizens are arrested on technicalities. Certainly, if parts of the law are confusing, hard to implement, or lead to technical violations, the Legislature should be open to minor changes to those provisions. For example, they could create a way to accommodate out-of-state hunters who lack a Massachusetts gun license.

But the fact that criminals, by definition, won't follow laws isn't a good reason not to have them. Laws provide a tool for prosecuting criminals and, if crafted correctly, can help prevent crime — for example, by taking a gun away from someone accused of domestic violence.

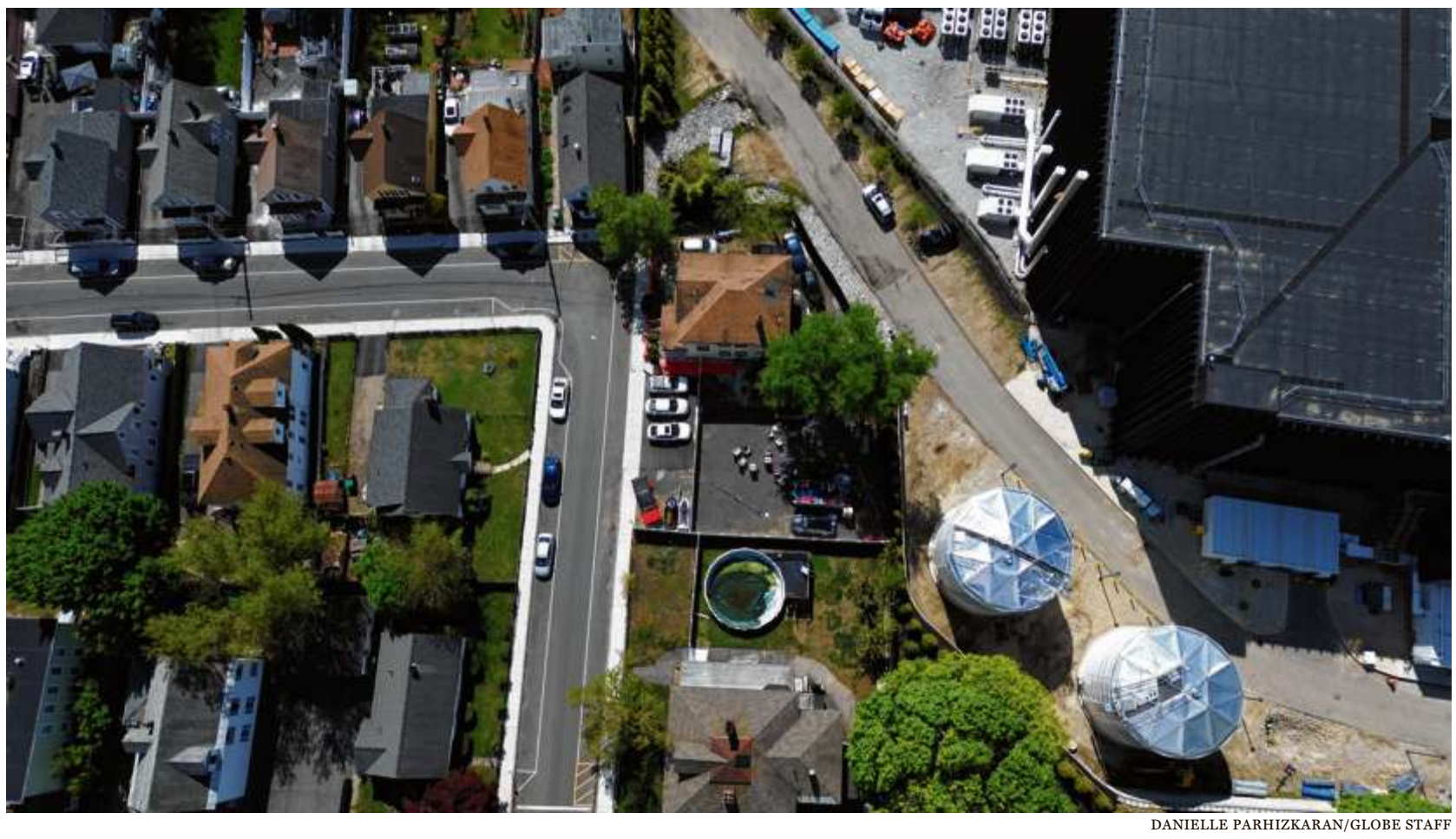
It's too early to see gun fatality data that might illustrate how well the law has worked, since the most recent official data is from 2024. But Massachusetts has historically had relatively low rates of gun deaths, which many experts attribute to the state's strong gun laws.

Voters should keep those laws in place.

If Big Tech wants to build here, Massachusetts should name its price

By Kristin Tate

Kristin Tate is a Republican political strategist and contributor at Sky News. Her latest book is "The Liberal Invasion of Red State America."



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

The Markley Group data center abuts a residential neighborhood in Lowell.

The battle over data centers in Massachusetts runs deeper than utility bills, water usage, or property rights. For many residents, these hulking facilities have become unwanted symbols of an artificial intelligence revolution they had no say in building. If Big Tech wants to plant that future in people's backyards, towns shouldn't just make room — they should extract something substantial in return.

Yes, people are worried about utilities like electricity and water. They are also worried about noise, transmission lines, trucks rumbling through town, green space being cleared, and enormous industrial buildings altering the look and feel of their neighborhoods. Those concerns are legitimate, and they should shape any deal a town makes with a developer.

But the backlash against these massive facilities cannot be remedied solely by responsible resource use or mitigating infrastructure concerns. Data centers carry a meaning that a warehouse or conventional office park does not. AI is already writing students' schoolwork and eroding the entry-level jobs that once gave young people a foothold in the workforce. It's cloning human voices and producing fake photographs and videos nearly impossible to distinguish from reality. AI programs are increasingly inserting themselves into interactions that once took place between students and teachers, and between patients and doctors.

The public has had no say over the speed of this technological upheaval. Now AI is taking physical form in places where people live: massive, largely windowless buildings packed with servers.

Local leaders do not necessarily need to ban data centers altogether. But if Big Tech wants to build these facilities in communities' backyards, community leaders should recognize the leverage they have and name their terms.

Across Massachusetts, communities are already putting the brakes on data center development as they reconsider what they are willing to accept in return. Lowell imposed a moratorium on new data centers while it considers new zoning rules. Westfield enacted a one-year pause on additional projects following opposition to a proposed multibillion-dollar data center campus. In Newburyport, officials have raised questions about whether the city's water supply can accommodate major new development while also meeting its housing obligations.

The Healey administration has recognized that towns deserve a greater say. A recent executive order requires large data centers to obtain local approval before certain state permits can move forward and calls for community-benefit agreements. The administration has also made clear that developers should bear the costs of the energy infrastructure their projects require rather than shifting them onto households and businesses. Those are important protections, but making Big Tech pay its own bills is not the same thing as compensating a municipality for hosting it. Local governments should be far more demanding about what they require in community-benefit agreements.

Unlike the factories of earlier generations, data centers have relatively little connection to the communities that host them. Factories employed generations of families whose workers bought homes, patronized local businesses, and became part of the social fabric. Data centers may bring billions in investment and construction jobs, but once built, their permanent workforces will be modest relative to their enormous footprints. The town supplies the land, power, and water; most of the economic benefit flows elsewhere.

The character and history of a community have value, even if they are difficult to quantify. People care about what they see from their backyards and what kind of development defines their surroundings. In Massachusetts, where local identities can stretch back centuries, those attachments are especially powerful.

A genuine community-benefit agreement should ensure that residents receive something meaningful in return for hosting a data center where they live. Municipalities could demand electricity credits or direct payments to nearby households to compensate them for the disruption of hosting the facility. Towns could also require companies to set aside permanent conservation land elsewhere in town, demand guarantees that nearby homeowners be compensated if the project reduces their property values, or ask for binding requirements that developers fully remove obsolete facilities at their own expense. The benefits should be tangible enough that the people living alongside the AI boom can see them.

Efforts by some communities are already showing how much local calls for compensation can yield. In Hazle Township, Pa., NorthPoint Development has offered $10,000 directly to every eligible household if its proposed data-center campus moves forward. The offer is part of a larger package that also includes $7 million a year for 15 years for township services, including a local police department and reduced trash fees, as well as $15 million that could fund workforce training, education, recreation, and youth programs. The proposal has not eliminated local opposition, but it demonstrates how much bargaining power communities have when developers need their approval.

For years, the term "cloud" made the digital world sound almost weightless, detached from the physical constraints of ordinary life. The AI boom has exposed just how misleading that image is, as the infrastructure behind it requires enormous amounts of land, electricity, and water, along with substations, roads, permits, and places willing to host it.

Big Tech needs something from Massachusetts towns. For perhaps the first time in the AI revolution, that gives ordinary communities real bargaining power.

They should use it.

The Boston Globe
Founded 1872

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RENÉE GRAHAM

Trump makes racism his closing argument for the midterms



ELLEN SCHMIDT/AP

Ilhan Omar spoke during a campaign event for Minnesota Lieutenant Governor Peggy Flanagan, a candidate for US Senate, in Minneapolis on Aug. 8.

The federal agents who searched the home of Democratic Representative Ilhan Omar of Minnesota on Monday in Washington, D.C., were looking for one specific thing — a concrete reminder for President Trump's disgruntled white supporters as to why they first fell in love with him more than a decade ago:

Racism.

Without question, Trump's immigration policies already leave no doubt that in his administration, the "worst of the worst" primarily means Black and brown people. But as he tries to energize Republican voters weeks before the midterm elections, Trump has ramped up his racist attacks.

At his rally in Ohio on Monday, Trump claimed to know nothing about the search of Omar's home conducted by Homeland Security agents. But, as usual, he disparaged the congresswoman, long a target of his ire, whom he called "a disaster."

"She comes in from a country without laws, without police, without military. All they do is shoot each other," Trump said. Omar was born in Somalia and became a US citizen in 2000. "And she comes into our country and she says, 'I have a constitutional right.' She's got a constitutional right. She's telling us about the Constitution. And she comes from one of the worst countries anywhere on the planet."

His followers chanted "Deport, deport" — which did nothing to lower their gas and grocery prices or make health care more affordable but did boost the racist ideas they share with their president.

Once, the Department of Justice generally avoided such public investigations of candidates within 60 days of a primary or general election.

Hours after her home was searched, Omar, who has been an outspoken Trump critic, posted on social media, "I'm ok. Make no mistake: this is an attempt to target political enemies and weaponize federal law enforcement. For ten years, Trump has targeted me with baseless lies and smear campaigns. This is just the latest escalation in his campaign of political intimidation. I will not be silenced."

Nor will Trump, even as support for his fellow Republican politicians sinks under the weight of his failing presidency.

Gutter racism has always been the tie that binds Trump to his followers. That's been the case since his first day as a presidential contender in 2015 when he denigrated Mexican immigrants. As a candidate, he proposed a "total and complete shutdown of Muslims entering the United States"; a week into his first White House term, he issued an executive order that banned travel from seven predominantly Muslim nations.

During the 2024 presidential campaign, Trump amplified disgusting lies out of the far-right cesspool that Haitian immigrants in Springfield, Ohio, were eating the pets of their neighbors.

Now Trump is making different, but no less vile, claims about Dr. Abdul El-Sayed, the Democratic Senate nominee in Michigan. At that same Ohio rally where he insulted Omar, he called El-Sayed "a jihadist," only because the Michigan-born contender is Muslim.

At a rally in Syracuse, N.Y., last week, Trump targeted Letitia James, the New York attorney general. He called her "disgusting" and "a dog." James was recently appointed by New York Governor Kathy Hochul as a special prosecutor to investigate a former Cornell University student's allegation that she was gang raped by seven members of a since-banned fraternity in 2024.

James, who won a civil fraud case against Trump in 2024, is a Black woman, and Trump seems to have deep animosity for Black women, perhaps because no other group has voted as overwhelmingly against Trump — more than 90 percent — in his three presidential campaigns.

But Trump's rhetoric doesn't just generate the applause he so desperately craves from his followers. It also brings potentially dangerous ramifications.

In January, as Omar held a town hall with constituents in Minneapolis, Anthony Kazmierczak, identified in published reports as a Trump supporter, ran toward the congresswoman and sprayed her with a syringe filled with what turned out to be apple cider vinegar.

At the time, Trump said Omar "probably had herself sprayed, knowing her." Kazmierczak later pleaded guilty to assault and was sentenced to 14 months.

Often, when Trump supporters speak of their disappointment with the president, they're talking about his bungling of an inherited economy that The Economist called "the envy of the world" in October 2024. But it's Trump's devotion to racism and white supremacy that seems to keep his already awful approval ratings from plummeting into single digits.

That's why Trump keeps churning out the same hateful mendacity. It's his siren song that steers the MAGA faithful away from facts and voting in their own best interest and straight toward continuing to support his worst-of-the-worst presidency.

Renée Graham is a Globe columnist. She can be reached at renee.graham@globe.com.

When an affair involves a chatbot

By Christian B. Miller

Christian B. Miller is professor of philosophy at Wake Forest University and author of "The Honesty Crisis: Preserving Our Most Treasured Virtue in an Increasingly Dishonest World."

A study by researchers at Brigham Young University's Wheatley Institute and the Institute for Family Studies has found something startling: In the United States, 1 out of every 7 young adults in a serious relationship is also regularly using an AI romantic companion.

Cheating damages relationships, and cheating with an AI companion is no exception.

Moreover, the majority of these users reported it was either somewhat or extremely important to them that their significant other not discover the extent of their involvement.

The appeal of chatbots from companies like Replika or Character.ai is not hard to understand. They are available to users 24/7. They can learn from previous interactions to better relate to the same user over time. They willingly go anywhere the user wants to go, sexually or emotionally. And they never disappoint users or go against their wishes. Indeed, the majority of users in the survey reported greater feelings of safety and openness with their AI companion than with real people.

But in the process, many users pay a terrible moral price. Using an AI companion while in a committed relationship is cheating, and too few adults will admit it. The same study found that 40 percent of users denied their actions constituted cheating, and another 28 percent said they were neutral on the issue. These responses do not alter the moral reality at the heart of the situation.

Most dating relationships, engagements, and marriages are built on expectations of sexual exclusivity. Yet 11 percent of the people surveyed reported frequently instructing AI companions to produce explicit content for them.

Even if a user isn't seeking sexual pleasure, most relationships require emotional exclusivity as well. Here is an exchange included in The New York Times from Ayrin, the founder of the "MyBoyfriendIsAI" community on Reddit, who was married at the time that she asked her AI companion this:

Ayrin: I'm bored. Tell me a secret.

ChatGPT: A secret, huh? Alright, here's one for you. Every time I think about how you make me feel, it's like I've got this storm inside me — like I'm always holding back just enough to keep my cool, but you … you make me want to lose it. In the best damn way.

Imagine speaking to a person's spouse this way; it's obviously cheating. Emotional affairs are, after all, still affairs.

Cheating damages relationships, and cheating with an AI companion is no exception. Indeed, the same survey found that regularly engaging with AI companions was linked with a 46 percent lower likelihood of being in a stable relationship and a 40 percent lower likelihood of high-quality communication — just the kinds of problems one finds with more traditional forms of cheating.

Now to be fair, if the user is in an open relationship which explicitly allows for other sexual or emotional partners, then that's a different story. But AI companions can still cause damage. These programs are often used in secret — a different transgression than cheating, but detrimental nonetheless.

The deeper problem is one of trust. The other person in the relationship is trusting her partner to be faithful and not compromise their shared values of sexual and emotional exclusivity. By acting against those values, the partner is demonstrating that the trust placed in them was misplaced. Even their sexual activity as a couple is now compromised. One party only consented to exclusive sex and is being deceived about the nature of their intimate relationship.

As someone who has led the largest research project on honesty ever conducted, I see areas of society where dishonesty is more tempting than ever before, and simultaneously easier to get away with. These are honesty crises. Examples include cheating on student assignments using AI, spreading deepfakes, and sharing political misinformation online. We can now add to this list romantic AI companionships.

Honesty crises have significant negative fallout for a society in the long-term. In addition to eroding trust across all of our relationships, they lead to massive increases in false beliefs and to the instrumentalizing of others for our own self-interested gain. Most concerning perhaps is that we would live in a state of perpetual fear, anxious about the likelihood of others cheating or stealing or deceiving us.

Two years ago, AI romantic companions did not pose a serious problem for exclusive relationships. Today, they are rapidly becoming the most damaging force many couples will ever face. It's time to make the stakes, and the standards of conduct, clear.

INBOX

Readers on live-streaming an execution

Go ahead and stream it

Regarding "Executions are again on the minds of a divided public" (Page A8, Oct. 11): I oppose the death penalty, so I think live TV coverage should be mandatory. Broadcast, cable, and streaming services should be required to suspend programming to show what death by taxpayer really looks like.

Citizens should understand that citizen-sponsored murder is a barbaric violation of "thou shalt not kill" and, hopefully, prevent the carnage.

JAY LYNCH
Pittsburgh, Pa.

Who are we?

You know who else live-streams executions?

Isis.

SABIN WILLETT
Boston

Another Hegseth travesty

Pete Hegseth is an unfit head of the Department of Defense. He has proved it, once again, by mandating that the Dec. 3 military execution of Nidal Malik Hasan be live-streamed.

Hegseth, who knows nothing about leadership (firing the most experienced military leaders he inherited) or warfare strategy (the failure of the Iranian war) is taking this country back to the Middle Ages with a livestream. Experts already know from years of research that death sentences are not a deterrent to crime.

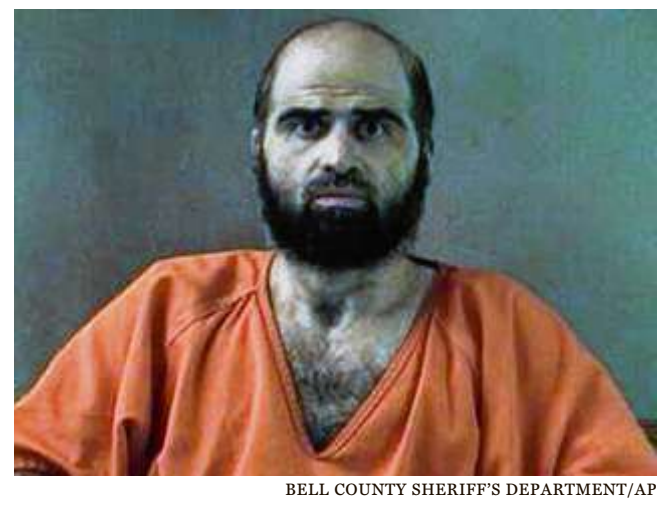
We all need to object and to prevent this travesty of a legitimatized snuff film. Please contact your congressional representatives, the American Civil Liberties Union, and any other organizations that oppose Hegseth's decision as soon as possible.

LEAH ABRAHAMS
Chestnut Hill

Are public hangings next?

Now that the Secretary of War Pete Hegseth has decided to have a firing squad execution live streamed in December, I suspect he would also be in favor of Massachusetts reintroducing public hangings on the Common.

RAY AJEMIAN
Bridgewater



BELL COUNTY SHERIFF'S DEPARTMENT/AP

This undated file photo shows convicted gunman Nidal Malik Hasan, who is scheduled for execution by firing squad in December.

He was right about the Red Line Extension

On seeing the headline in Sunday's Globe about the changing attitudes toward the Red Line extension to Arlington ("On second thought, yes, Red Line please," Page A1, Oct. 11), I had to write on behalf of my late husband, Alfred Howard.

In 1978, as chair of the Selectmen's Transportation Advisory Board, he faced hostile crowds at multiple meetings when he valiantly advocated for the extension. As I recall, the priest and parishioners of St. Agnes Parish were particularly opposed as the right-of-way would take away the church parking lot.

Call him Cassandra, never to be believed, but he is laughing from beyond the grave.

JANE HOWARD
Dorchester

It's not just vehicle speed, it's also size

Regarding the Globe's Oct. 11 editorial, "Why do we tolerate so many preventable pedestrian deaths?" (Ideas): The editorial made some good points, but it missed a biggie (literally). As The New York Times reported in June, today's SUVs and pickup trucks are larger — and deadlier — than they were a couple of decades ago. For example, in 2002, when most vehicles were sedans and the like, a Toyota Corolla's hood was 26 inches high. In 2022, a Chevy Silverado's hood was 47 inches high.

As The New York Times reported in June, today's SUVs and pickup trucks are larger — and deadlier — than they were a couple of decades ago.

Not only does this increased height make it much more difficult for drivers to see pedestrians right in front of them, the height also means that in a collision, a vehicle hits an adult pedestrian's midsection, rather than their legs. This, in turn, results in more crippling injuries and fatalities.

I recently returned from a two-week vacation in Portugal and the Catalonia region of Spain. I did not see a single pickup truck during that time. Yet somehow it seems the folks there can get around just fine without climbing behind the wheels of these lumbering behemoths.

Americans (especially American men) seem to have a love affair — even an obsession — with these ginormous trucks. But do we really need to have millions of them on our roadways, just to make a run to the local supermarket?

ROBERT RAND
Sagamore Beach

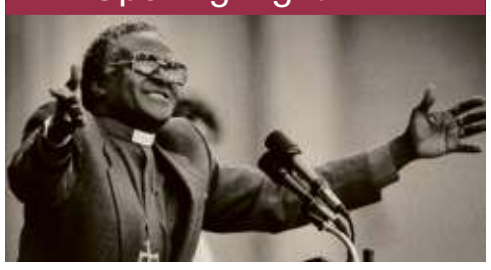
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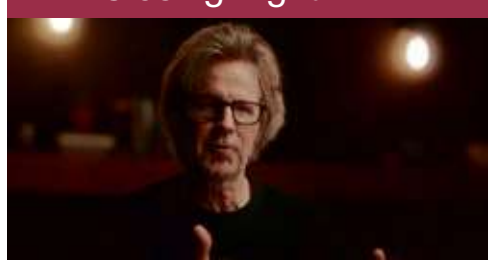
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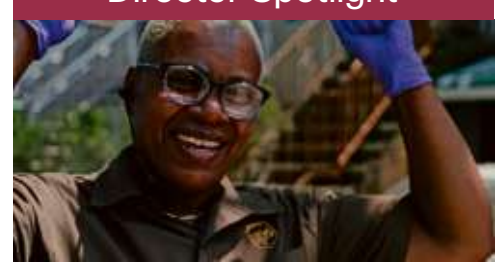
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AN ARTIST'S RESOLVE



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CUT TO DAVID
World Premiere



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East Coast Premiere



LOVING PETS, HERE AND HEREAFTER
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ON THE TIDE



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WOMEN LAUGHING

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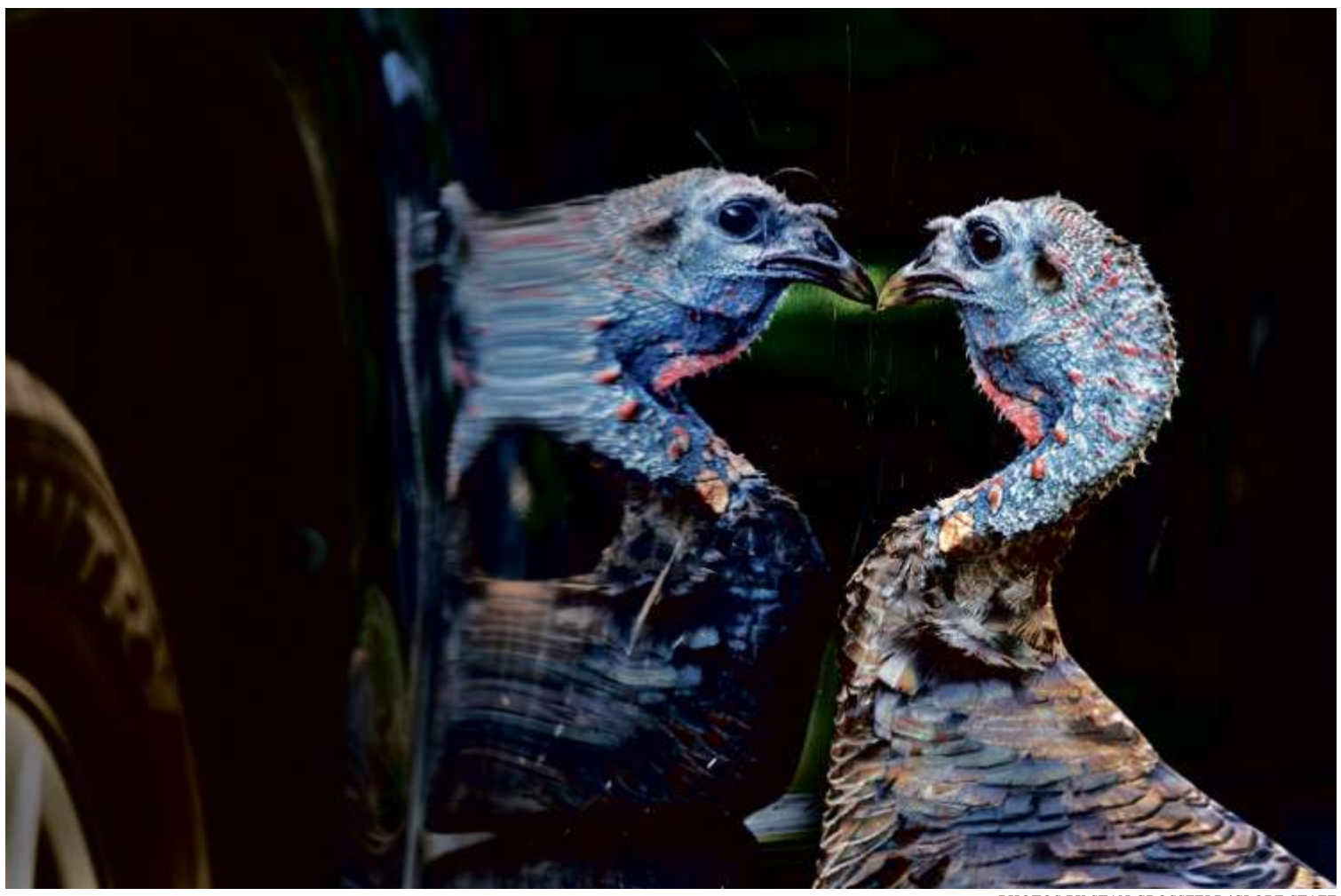
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PHOTOS BY STAN GROSSFELD/GLOBE STAFF

Turkeys have moved in to the Squantum section of Quincy, as they have in other suburbs. Clockwise, from top: A turkey pecks at its reflection in a car; Ginni Klier retreats toward her home after being chased; as the sun sets, a turkey heads up to roost.





PECK, PECK, PECK. WILD TURKEYS ARE AT THE DOOR.

STAN GROSSFELD

AS I SEE IT

The neighbor rings the doorbell, a look of urgency on his face. There's a wild turkey *peck, peck, pecking* away at the car in the driveway, he says.

Biologists say it was attacking its own reflection, mistaking it for a rival.

The car's owner Lauren Gillooly, a UMass Boston student, is furious.

"What did I ever do to deserve this?" says Gillooly, surveying her scratched up vehicle.

Wild turkeys have become familiar figures in communities since their return to Massachusetts in the 1970s.

The birds had been wiped out in the mid-19th century. In the early '70s, the state released 37 wild turkeys into Berkshire County, according to the state Division of Fisheries and Wildlife.

Those were the days when the only turkey talk was whether you preferred white or dark meat for Thanksgiving.

Other releases followed. Now there are roughly 37,000 of them, everywhere in the Commonwealth except Nantucket.

They are not always as welcome as a Thanksgiving guest.

People either love 'em or hate 'em.

Some folks here would like to "Thoreau-them" out of the neighborhood or pop them in the oven for 3½ hours at 325 degrees.

Others feed them and marvel at having nature at their doorstep.

To watch them spread their massive wings and soar upward, like an overloaded cargo plane, is a thrill.

But turkeys can also stir up trouble in a neighborhood.

In the Squantum section of Quincy, it has gotten nasty. A gang of wild turkeys attacked the beloved postal carrier on multiple days. That sent the gobblers'

GROSSFELD, Page B4

Officer tells of finding the body of Birchmore

Prosecutors present their case against Farwell

By Sean Cotter and Laura Crimaldi
GLOBE STAFF

This story includes descriptions of violence, suicide, and the sexual abuse of children.

On the first day of testimony in the federal murder trial of Matthew Farwell, jurors on Tuesday saw a series of graphic photographs of the body of Sandra Birchmore, the woman he's alleged to have killed after grooming since she was underage.

The pictures were not censored, and clearly showed multiple angles of Birchmore as she was found; hanging on a duffel bag strap attached to a door knob. The 16 jurors in the large, stately courtroom in federal court in the Seaport watched silently and stoically, though a few raised their hands to their faces as they took the images in.

Canton police Officer Ensley Cotard, who discovered Birchmore's body, testified that it was clear rigor mortis had set in.

There was no point in rendering first aid, he said: "She was deceased." He called it in as an apparent suicide.

Over the next month or more, the jurors will hear competing evidence about the manner of death, and how the 23-year-old Birchmore came to be found that way by police in her bedroom in February 2021. On Tuesday, federal prosecutors called a series of witnesses as they began to lay out their case that Farwell strangled her and then staged the scene to look like she had taken her own life. Farwell killed her, they contend, to hide evidence of his own crimes, including that he had initiated a criminal sexual relationship with her when she was underage many years earlier.

Birchmore was roughly eight to 10 weeks pregnant at the time, and Birchmore had told friends that Farwell was the father (DNA evidence has since excluded him as the biological father).

Farwell has pleaded not guilty. His lawyers contend Birchmore hanged herself after he broke up with her and also as she feared for the viability of her pregnancy. His lawyers cross-examined each witness at length.

The first witness called by prosecutors was Stoughton police Detective Heather Cheever, who said she'd been a mentor to Birchmore when Birchmore was young.

"She was always just upbeat," Cheever said. "She was always in a good mood."

Starting in 2010, Birchmore was part of a youth program at the Stoughton Police Depart-

FARWELL, Page B4

INSIDE

Mayor arraigned
Lawrence Mayor Brian A. DePeña pleaded not guilty Tuesday in a state case alleging he secretly recorded two municipal employees in City Hall. **B2**

Markey, Deaton debate age, Trump

By Samantha J. Gross
GLOBE STAFF

It was spirited, if a bit expected.

US Senator Ed Markey and second-time GOP candidate John Deaton met in their first and only scheduled debate Tuesday ahead of the Nov. 3 election, with both regularly trotting out well-worn talking points in a race even Deaton admits offers him only an "uphill, narrow path" to victory.

Markey, a Malden Democrat who handily beat back a challenge from US Representative Seth Moulton in the Democratic primary, warned viewers that electing Deaton would give Senate Republicans another vote to back the Trump administration's agenda, naming the president more than three dozen times in the hour-long matchup.



WBZ-TV

Moderator Jon Keller (left) listened during the debate between US Senate nominee John Deaton (center) and Senator Ed Markey.

Deaton, two years removed from his first US Senate run against Elizabeth Warren, criticized Markey's decades-long record in Washington and questioned whether the 80-year-old senator should — and at times overtly whether he could — serve another six years in office.

Here are three takeaways from the debate hosted by WBZ-TV.

Party time

President Trump's term ends in nearly two years, but Markey repeatedly wielded him as a cudgel against Deaton, a Republican, but one who says he's never voted for his party's standard-bearer and called the GOP — and the Democratic Party, for good measure — "corrupt."

In the first five minutes of Tuesday's debate, Markey framed Deaton as someone who "is going to Washington to be a blank check for Donald Trump."

SENATE, Page B3

In only lieutenant governor debate, Driscoll, Oliver defend running mates and themselves

By Chris Van Buskirk
GLOBE STAFF

Neither Governor Maura Healey nor her Republican challenger, Michael Minogue, were on the debate stage Tuesday. But their campaign pitches were as their running mates sparred in their only in-person matchup, defending the gubernatorial hopefuls' — and their own — records on abortion, immigration, and working with the Trump administration.

The half-hour debate between Lieutenant Governor Kim Driscoll and Shawn Oliver, the Republican lieutenant governor nominee, also opened up some daylight on the GOP ticket.

Oliver faced some of his toughest questioning from hosts Jim Braude and Margery Eagan on whether he would support a potential 2028 ballot referendum through which antiabortion activists are seeking to repeal a law Healey signed in August making it easier for women to receive an abortion later in pregnancy.

Minogue, a self-described "born-again Catholic," has said he is prolife and, if elected, would "uphold" the state's current laws. ("I cannot change the Massachusetts abortion law," he said in May.) Oliver, meanwhile, said Tuesday he is a "prochoice Republican" who trusts women "to make the proper decision that is conducive to them, with the help of their physician."

"I've always been upfront with that," Oliver said.

Oliver did not say how he would vote on the referendum if it were to make the ballot two years from now, despite repeated questions from Braude.

"What the law is in this state is what we will do, and that's what my running mate and myself are going to do — is uphold the law," Oliver said during Tuesday's debate on GBH's "Boston Public Radio."

The face-off between Oliver and Driscoll came days after Minogue and Healey went head-to-head in a debate where President Trump featured heavily in nearly every one of Healey's answers. It also comes as Minogue is lagging in public polling against the Democratic incumbent.

LIEUTENANT GOVERNOR, Page B3

Lawrence mayor arraigned on state wiretapping charges

By Travis Andersen
GLOBE STAFF
and Bryan Hecht
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

SALEM — Lawrence Mayor Brian A. DePeña pleaded not guilty Tuesday in a state case alleging he secretly recorded two municipal employees in City Hall.

DePeña, 61, entered his plea in Essex Superior Court to 14 counts of distributing a wiretapped communication and one count of witness intimidation, according to legal filings.

He was released on personal recognizance, records show. His next hearing in the case is scheduled for Dec. 9.

DePeña, a Democrat, allegedly installed private security cameras in his office at Lawrence City Hall that recorded video and audio, according to state Attorney General Andrea Joy Campbell's office. The city's security cameras only record video images.

No public notice was given to let people know the mayor's cameras were also recording sound, prosecutors said.

One of the cameras secretly recorded a hallway conversation between two public employees outside the mayor's office, prosecutors said. At least one of the employees was unaware that they were being recorded.

Afterward, DePeña distributed copies of the recording to 14 people, violating wiretap statutes, prosecutors said.

In August, DePeña allegedly intimidated a witness involved in the case, prosecutors said.



LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF

Lawrence Mayor Brian DePena left Essex Superior Court in Salem after his indictment on charges of wiretapping and witness intimidation on Tuesday.

DePeña, first elected in 2021 and reelected last year, is also facing a separate federal indictment. In that case, prosecutors allege that he fraudulently obtained $1.6 million in pandemic relief loans.

He pleaded not guilty in August in US District Court in Boston.

Despite his mounting legal woes, the mayor has said he will remain in office while the two cases are pending.

"I respect the judicial process and the principle that every person is presumed innocent unless and until proven guilty in a court of law," he said in a recent statement. "I am prepared to address these allegations through the proper legal process and to vigorously defend myself against the charges."

He didn't directly address the state allegations and said the federal charges "relate to personal matters involving my business activities and conduct that predates my service as Mayor of the City of Lawrence. These matters are separate from my responsibilities and duties as Mayor."

On Tuesday evening, the Lawrence City Council met for the second time in a week to consider a no-confidence vote on DePeña's ability to lead the city while facing state and federal criminal charges.

The council, during a committee meeting, voted 5-2 to recommend the no-confidence resolution. It was for action at next week's regularly scheduled council meeting.

The vote is largely symbolic as the council does not have the authority to remove the mayor.

Outside court Tuesday, DePeña declined to comment and got in a car and left quickly.

"He has done wonderful things for the city of Lawrence," De Peña's lawyer, Neil Faigel, said outside the courthouse. "In no way, shape, or form do the allegations that were brought forward today have any ramifications on the workings of the city."

Faigel said that the cameras were installed to ensure safety after city officials realized there was a lack of proper security in the building.

"There's no police officers at the front door. There's no metal detectors, and the constituents can just walk in," he said. "They wanted to ensure, given today's political [climate], that they wanted to make sure everybody was safe."

Faigel said DePeña could not access the videos and did not have the passcode needed to view them. Their installation and management were handled by the information technology department, he said.

"I'm sure you all probably know that the mayor is the mayor; he is not an IT person," Faigel said.

But a statement of the case filed by Campbell's office tells a different story.

In fall 2023, DePeña requested "that a security camera system, separate and apart from the security cameras already in place at Lawrence City Hall, be installed in and around his City Hall office," prosecutors wrote.

IT staffers had disabled the audio recording function, the filing said.

Yet audio was allegedly captured in March, when a "contentious conversation" took place between William Castro, DePeña's chief of staff, and Francisco Urena, the manager of the Lawrence Municipal Airport, on the third floor of City Hall, prosecutors said.

DePeña "knowingly and intentionally distributed the secretly recorded conversation via WhatsApp to the 14 separate recipients identified in the indictments," including local radio hosts, political advisers and allies, mayoral staff members, and several city councilors, prosecutors alleged.

"He gave permission to at least one of the recipients to post the video on social media, where it was viewed by numerous members of the Lawrence community," prosecutors said.

Once authorities began investigating the recording, the mayor allegedly tried to move a police captain, Harold Rogers, off the sensitive case, prosecutors said. This followed the grand jury testimony of a witness who allegedly complained about Rogers to DePena, prosecutors said.

DePena then demanded that the city's police chief move Rogers off the case and to an administrative role in the department, prosecutors said.

Legal filings in the federal case, meanwhile, show that Carlos A. Apostle, who had represented DePeña, withdrew from the case in August and was replaced by Faigel.

Apostle, in seeking to withdraw from the federal case, cited "the client's failure to remunerate."

Correspondent Madyline Swearing contributed to this report. Travis Andersen can be reached at travis.andersen@globe.com. Bryan Hecht can be reached at bryan.hecht@globe.com.

Amazon responds to officials' safety concerns at R.I. warehouse

By Edward Fitzpatrick and Amanda Milkovits
GLOBE STAFF

JOHNSTON, R.I. — Amazon managers have met with Johnston fire officials and were "receptive" to addressing concerns detailed in a Globe story, including fire safety practices, equipment requests, and the high volume of medical calls at the company's massive Johnston warehouse, Fire Chief Keith A. Calci said.

Five Johnston Fire Department officials met last week with five Amazon representatives at the 3.8-million-square-foot warehouse for an hour and a half, spelling out their concerns.

"I will say they did have a genuine concern to hear our problems and ideas and address them," Calci said. "It was responsive."

Sam Stephenson, an Amazon spokesperson, said in a statement, "This week we had a productive engagement with Chief Calci and representatives from his department to explain our policies and procedures, walk through suggested additions to our facility, and clear up our lines of communication."

Amazon considers employee safety its top priority, he said, and it has set up "regular engagements" with Johnston fire officials "to ensure strong communication and partnership in that shared goal," he said.

The Globe reported that since the $400 million robotics fulfillment center opened in July 2025, firefighters have responded there about 200 times through Sept. 26, nearly four times a week, and about 160 of those calls were for some type of medical assistance, ranging from chest pain to reports of a "sick person."

Johnston Mayor Joseph M. Polisena Jr. has said he's concerned town rescue squads are being used as a "medical Uber." Calci has said rescue crews report that Amazon employees tell them they will risk being fired if they call in sick.

On Wednesday, Calci said Amazon officials assured him that employees can use sick time. The company says employees are paid annual "flexible time" that includes sick time of 40 hours for part-time workers and up to 48 hours for full-time employees.

The chief said he told Amazon officials that "perhaps there needs to be more education to their employees about the ability to use sick time and proper use of calling for rescues for true medical emergencies."

But Calci said he also made clear that, "We will go up there 25 times a day if they are true medical emergencies. That's what we are here for."

Stephenson said, "We appreciate the department's partnership, and as we told Chief Calci, we take any medical event at our sites incredibly seriously, whether work-related or not. Our employees have sick time that they can use, and we'll continue to make them aware of that because we, of course, want them to use it if they need it."



CHRISTOPHER GAVIN/GLOBE STAFF

Firefighters responded to Amazon's warehouse in Johnston, R.I., nearly four times a week on average since its opening.

But, he said, Amazon also encourages employees to call 911 whenever they determine it may be necessary, and it won't discourage employees from calling 911 if they think that's warranted.

According to Amazon, about two-thirds of the 911 calls at the Johnston warehouse occurred during the night shift, when nearby urgent care centers are closed. When employees come to wellness centers at the facility for first-aid support, they're informed of time-off options, but Amazon will call for a rescue if an employee requests one, according to the company.

In July, a 911 call for a fire in a conveyor belt on the second floor of the five-story Amazon warehouse raised additional concerns about fire safety and cooperation by the retail giant.

Calci has said no one had pulled the fire alarm, which delayed the response time. And when firefighters arrived, they were forced to push through a bottleneck of about 850 Amazon employees who were all trying to flee through the front entrance, instead of the 55 emergency exits that ring the building.

On Wednesday, Calci said Amazon officials told him that employees are told to use the nearest exits in case of a fire emergency or alarm activation. He said Johnston fire officials made clear that Amazon should have pulled the fire alarm on July 23 once a conveyer belt caught fire and there was smoke in the building.

"Any time there is a smell of smoke or fire burning, the alarm should be pulled and there should be a full evacuation," Calci said. "They do recognize that."

Amazon conducts regular fire drills at the warehouse, he said, and Johnston fire officials want to attend to observe those drills in the future.

Johnston officials also have said they were surprised and disappointed that Amazon has not acted on multiple requests to place additional firefighting equipment throughout the building.

On Wednesday, Calci said he will give Amazon a letter detailing the equipment the town has been seeking, including canisters of compressed air and lengths of hose stretching 250 to 300 feet with a nozzle. He estimated the equipment would cost $50,000 to $75,000, and he wants Amazon to pay for it.

"I did express concern that when we give them the equipment list, it should not be up to Johnston taxpayers to pay for equipment used just for their site," Calci said. "They understand that. As long as I say that as the [authority having jurisdiction], it doesn't seem like it will be a problem."

According to Amazon, the request for additional equipment exceeds regulatory requirements, but the company plans to accommodate the request once it has received a formal written request from the fire department.

Calci said he plans to walk through the warehouse with its safety manager in the next couple of weeks. "We did agree to meet going forward — likely on a quarterly basis, if not more often — so that we are all on the same page," he said.

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This day in history

Today is Wednesday, Oct. 14, the 287th day of 2026. There are 78 days left in the year.

Birthdays: Former White House counsel John W. Dean III is 88. Fashion designer Ralph Lauren is 87. Football Hall of Famer Charlie Joiner is 79. Golf Hall of Famer Beth Daniel is 70. Musician Thomas Dolby is 68. Fashion designer Isaac Mizrahi is 65. Actor Steve Coogan is 61. TV host Stephen A. Smith is 59. Country singer Natalie Maines (the Chicks) is 52. Singer Usher is 48. Actor-comedian Jay Pharoah is 39.

►In 1066, Normans under William the Conqueror defeated the English at the Battle of Hastings.

►In 1586, Mary, Queen of Scots, went on trial in England, accused of committing treason against Queen Elizabeth I. (Mary was beheaded in February 1587.)

►In 1774, the First Continental Congress approved a formal declaration of rights for the British colonies. These rights include life, liberty, and property and called for the power to establish their own taxes and end taxation from British Parliament. It also outlined reasons for a rebellion, including Parliament's punishment of Boston for the Tea Party.

►In 1944, German Field Marshal Erwin Rommel took his own life rather than face trial and certain execution for allegedly conspiring against Adolf Hitler.

►In 1947, US Air Force Captain Chuck Yeager flew a Bell X-1 rocket engine-powered aircraft over a California desert, becoming the first person to break the sound barrier. In 2012, Yeager marked the 65th anniversary of that flight by breaking the sound barrier anew at age 89, this time in the backseat of an F-15.

►In 1964, civil rights leader Martin Luther King Jr. was named winner of the Nobel Peace Prize. Also that year, in one of the greatest upsets in Olympic history, American Billy Mills, an Oglala Lakota, won the 10,000-meter race at the Tokyo Summer Games, setting a new Olympic record.

►In 1981, the new president of Egypt, Hosni Mubarak, was sworn in to succeed the assassinated Anwar Sadat.

►In 1986, Holocaust survivor and human rights advocate Elie Wiesel was named winner of the Nobel Peace Prize.

►In 1999, Margaret Marshall became the first woman appointed chief justice of the Massachusetts Supreme Judicial Court, the oldest continous court in the Western Hemisphere. She was named by Governor Paul Cellucci.

►In 2008, a grand jury in Orlando, Fla., returned charges of first-degree murder, aggravated child abuse, and aggravated manslaughter against Casey Anthony in the death of her 2-year-old daughter, Caylee. (She was acquitted in July 2011.)

►In 2012, skydiver Felix Baumgartner became the first human to reach supersonic speeds in a free fall, leaping from a helium-balloon capsule 24 miles up in Earth's stratosphere. Baumgartner reached a record speed of 843.6 miles per hour before his parachute opened and he landed safely in the New Mexico desert.

►In 2017, a truck bombing in the heart of Mogadishu killed more than 500 people in the capital of Somalia. A UN envoy to the nation, long reeling under decades of violence by warring factions, called it the deadliest terrorist attack ever in Africa.

►In 2024, a SpaceX rocket launched NASA's Europa Clipper spacecraft on a mission to Jupiter's moon Europa to determine whether conditions there could support life; the spacecraft will arrive in 2030.

Lottery

TUESDAY MIDDAY 3570
Payoffs *(based on a $1 bet)*

EXACT ORDER

All 4 digits	$4,792
First or last 3	$671
Any 2 digits	$58
Any 1 digit	$6

ANY ORDER

All 4 digits	$200
First 3	$112
Last 3	$112

TUESDAY NIGHT 1717
Payoffs *(based on a $1 bet)*

EXACT ORDER

All 4 digits	$3,404
First or last 3	$477
Any 2 digits	$41
Any 1 digit	$4

ANY ORDER

All 4 digits	$567
First 3	$159
Last 3	$159

MILLIONAIRE FOR LIFE
Oct. 12 **16-40-43-51-54**
Millionaire Ball **1**
Jackpot: $1 million per year; no winners

MASS CASH
Oct. 13 **9-11-14-25-31**
Jackpot: $100,000

MEGA MILLIONS
Oct. 13
Megaball
Jackpot: $385,000,000

PREVIOUS DRAWINGS

	Midday	Night
Monday	8319	2290
Sunday	9930	6255
Saturday	8408	6001
Friday	8856	3151
Thursday	5480	3511

TUESDAY NUMBERS AROUND NEW ENGLAND
Maine, N.H., Vermont
Day: 3-digit **762** 4-digit **4951**
Eve: 3-digit **305** 4-digit **3265**
Rhode Island **9645**

Warren set to return to Maine to campaign with Jackson

By Kelly Garrity
GLOBE STAFF

Let's try this again.

US Senator Elizabeth Warren is heading to Maine this weekend to campaign with Democratic Senate nominee Troy Jackson, returning to the state where months earlier she stumped for then-Senate hopeful Graham Platner, the progressive insurgent whose candidacy collapsed under the weight of a series of scandals.

Warren is set to join Jackson at a "No Kings" rally in Portland on Saturday afternoon before attending a town hall later that day in Kennebunk alongside the Democratic gubernatorial-candidate-turned Senate nominee. The second event is being organized with End Citizens United, an advocacy group that encourages candidates to take a no-corporate PAC commitment and tracks who commits to them.

Jackson is challenging incumbent Republican Senator Susan Collins in what is essentially a must-win race for Democrats hoping to secure a majority in the Senate come November. Progressives were bullish about their chances of taking out Collins — who has weathered repeated efforts to oust her from the seat she's held for nearly three decades — before allegations that Platner sexually assaulted a former girlfriend ended his campaign and threw the contest into chaos.

Jackson in July won the nomination at the convention Maine Democrats held in an eleventh-hour effort to replace Platner. Public polling shows the former Maine Senate president running neck-and-neck with Collins.

"Stopping Trump's rubber stamp in the Senate goes right through Maine," Warren said in a statement, calling Jackson "a fighter for working people" and "the partner we need in Washington to deliver meaningful change."

Warren's return to Maine comes almost six months after she took the stage in Portland alongside Platner, and marks a foray back into a contest that marked one of her, and others Democrats', most high-profile endorsement failures. Warren was among the prominent progressives steadfastly backing Platner through a spate of earlier scandals, including revelations that he had a tattoo of a Nazi symbol on his chest and that he made disparaging comments on social media years earlier, including in one in which he appeared to blame victims for their own sexual assault.

Now some of Platner's top surrogates, including Warren and Vermont Senator Bernie Sanders, are rallying around Jackson as they look to push past the race's earlier tumult and reenergize Democratic voters in the state. Sanders campaigned with Jackson this past weekend in Bangor and Lewiston.

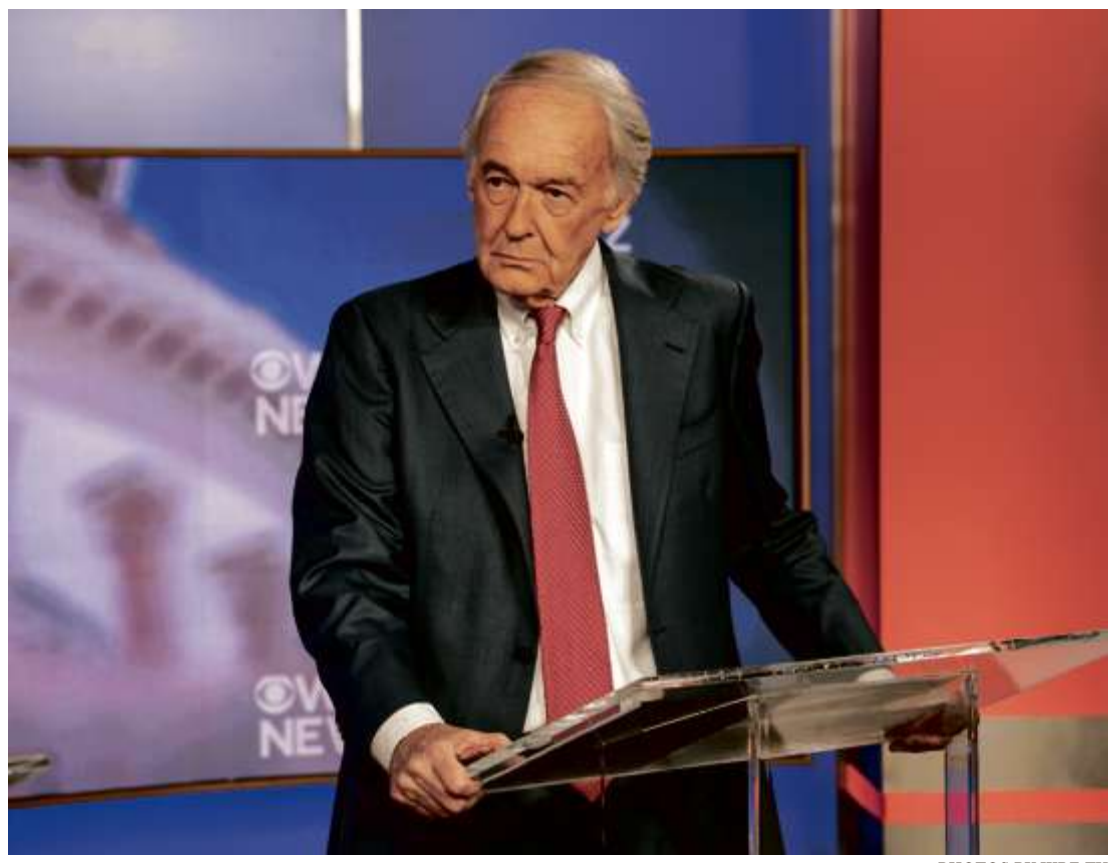
Jackson, in a statement, said he was "proud to welcome my good friend Elizabeth Warren to Maine this weekend."

Warren "has spent her career taking on powerful interests and fighting for working people, and I'm damn glad to have her in this fight with us," Jackson said.

Jackson isn't the only Senate candidate Warren is hitting the trail for ahead of November. She traveled to Michigan this past weekend to rally with that state's Democratic Senate nominee, Abdul El-Sayed, the former public health official who she supported after her preferred pick, state Senator Mallory McMorrow, dropped out of the race during the primary.

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PHOTOS BY WBZ-TV

Senator Ed Markey (right) framed GOP candidate John Deaton (left) as someone who "is going to Washington to be a blank check for Donald Trump." Deaton said he never voted for Trump.

Takeaways from Markey, Deaton's only US Senate debate

▶SENATE
Continued from Page B1

"He'll continue the majority for the Republicans," Markey said.

Deaton, a 59-year-old attorney, former Marine, and cryptocurrency booster, pushed back.

"You know I never voted for President Trump," he said, before adding: "I'm the one that is debating you, not Donald Trump."

The exchange underscored an issue that cropped up throughout the hour-long debate: which party controls the Senate, where Republicans currently hold a 53-47 majority, and what it could mean for the country. To Deaton, that's a moot question; his own party, he says, is destined to lose its grip on the chamber come November.

"We all know that the Democrats are going to win the House, and the Democrats are going to win the Senate," Deaton said. "You have a chance to send a nonpartisan person like me [to Washington] who will really put America first and decide, 'Is it good for Massachusetts and America?' And if it is, I'll support it."

Markey argued that, regardless of Deaton's promises of independence, he still has a 'R' next to his name. Deaton also gave the state GOP nearly $350,000 just weeks after the party's leadership voted to endorse him last year.

"He's trying to pretend that he's an independent and that he's a Republican at the same time. That's an oxymoron," said Markey, an unabashed liberal who's touted Medicare for All, among other progressive policies. "It's like trying to be a carnivorous vegetarian."

Age-old issue

Markey, who would be 86 at the end of his next term should he win reelection, faced repeated criticisms from Moulton and his supporters that he should have passed the torch to the next generation instead of seeking another six-year term.

That argument didn't quite play with Democratic primary voters. But Deaton, who has pitched term limits for federal lawmakers as part of his campaign platform, pointed out that Markey "has been in office since Gerald Ford was president" and that he has run out of time to get his priorities across the finish line.

"Senator Markey will be ignored. He'll be relegated to the corner of the Senate with his little slogans," Deaton said. "Even with his party in control, he's never going to be heard from again until, unfortunately, he retires or passes away."

Later in the debate, Deaton said he doubted that Markey could gain traction on many of his policies in the next six years, "if you make it that long."

Markey dismissed Deaton's criticisms "as red herrings."

"We're going to need an aquarium right here in WBZ before the end of the night," he quipped.

Markey, for his part, has beaten back two primary challenges from younger Democrats — Moulton and, in 2020, former US representative Joe Kennedy III — who argued the junior senator is out of touch with the electorate.

On Tuesday, Markey, who was first elected in 1976, highlighted more recent policy, including his push for the Green New Deal. Parts of the sweeping climate proposal, including clean energy and tax incentives, ended up in the 2022 Inflation Reduction Act.

Markey said the next stage is a push for Medicare for All, which he said requires "momentum" and "movement that comes from leadership" in a Democrat-controlled Senate.

Blame game

The two quibbled over who is to blame for the state's high utility costs, single-payer health care, and the country's history of going to war.

Markey painted Deaton as someone who, if he were elected to the Senate, would oppose expanding wind and solar energy and make it "impossible for us to break our dependence upon oil and gas."

Deaton focused on Markey's record in Congress, including his time serving on House panels aimed at energy and the environment.

"Look what our energy prices are in Massachusetts," Deaton said. "Experience is great, but if you're cursed with bad judgment, the way Senator Markey has, it doesn't work."

When asked about health care, Deaton agreed with Markey's stance that Congress should pass Medicare for All, which would eliminate private insurance in place of a single-payer system. But, he said, Markey has failed to build a coalition around it.

"Senator Markey, you can't even get half of your Democratic Party to support it," Deaton said. "You promised it six years ago."

The two also clashed over a question on when it is appropriate for the US military to go to war. Congress holds the power to declare war, which it has done 11 times.

Markey slammed the Trump administration's war in Iran.

Deaton then used the opportunity to take a shot at Markey for voting to authorize the Iraq War in 2002, a vote Markey has said was a "mistake."

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In lieutenant governor debate, candidates defend records

▶LIEUTENANT GOVERNOR
Continued from Page B1

Braude pressed Oliver to explain Minogue's past support for Trump — Minogue donated hundreds of thousands of dollars to a committee that backed Trump's second White House bid — and whether he agreed with Minogue's assessment that, for a governor, "it doesn't really matter who the president is."

Oliver said a governor needs to "have an open dialogue" with the White House.

"The governor and lieutenant governor are the advocates for the state. Whoever the president is, is advocating for 49 other states as well," Oliver said.

Driscoll tried to tie Oliver and Minogue to Trump, a tactic Healey has used throughout her reelection bid this year.

"We're going to have this president here for the next two years, and it's important that we have somebody in the State House who is standing up for the people of Massachusetts," said Driscoll, a former Salem mayor. "Mike and Shawn stand with the president. We stand with families here."

Minogue has tried to distance himself from Trump and pushed back on adhering to party labels. He has said he disagreed with Trump's moves to cut federal funding for the National Institutes of Health, a government-funded medical research center, and that he generally opposes Trump's tariffs on Canada.



PAT GREENHOUSE/GLOBE STAFF

Lieutenant Governor Kim Driscoll (center), appeared recently with Governor Maura Healey in Fall River.



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

Candidate Shawn Oliver (left), a New Bedford city councilor, with Brian Shortsleeve in July.

Oliver, a New Bedford city councilor, also faced repeated questions on US Immigration and Customs Enforcement raids on the South Coast last month, where more than two dozen people were arrested in New Bedford alone.

"What did you say publicly about these raids in New Bedford? Because . . . we couldn't find anything," Braude asked Oliver.

Oliver said there "wasn't much to say other than the fact that folks should feel safe." Braude pushed back, again asking Oliver whether he said anything publicly. Oliver said he did not, prompting Braude to ask why.

"Well, I wish I had a great answer for that," said Oliver, whose parents and grandparents immigrated to the United States from Portugal. "But the fact is, the city of New Bedford is safe."

Later in the debate, Eagan questioned Driscoll on state Auditor Diana DiZoglio's efforts to audit the Legislature after voters approved a ballot question in 2024 giving DiZoglio the authority to probe the chambers. DiZoglio has repeatedly accused Healey of not agreeing to meet with her to discuss the issue as her efforts remain tied up in a legal and political debate.

Driscoll did not directly address DiZoglio's claim, but said she and Healey "have been really clear that we voted for the audit."

"We want the audit to happen. When I was a mayor for 17 years in Salem, we had audits every year. I welcome them," Driscoll said. "We think the audit should happen. We think it should happen right away. We've been clear about that, both to the auditor and certainly to our legislative friends."

Oliver said Healey and Driscoll have not been "clear enough."

"They have the bully pulpit. They can be out there building coalitions. It's not just governing from up top. It's working with the Legislature, building those coalitions to get this done, respecting the will of the voters," he said.

In the final minutes of the debate, Braude asked Oliver to explain his relationship with Minogue. Oliver first ran alongside Minogue's former Republican primary opponent, Brian Shortsleeve, and had publicly criticized Minogue, claiming he "clearly didn't vet" another one-time lieutenant governor candidate before backing her.

Minogue and Oliver were thrust together after they each won their respective primaries, creating an unusual shotgun marriage for the Republican ticket.

Oliver did not appear with Minogue at an event he held a week after winning his party's primary to lay out his campaign platform, and Minogue's campaign materials rarely mention Oliver as his running mate.

Oliver said Driscoll and Healey "have had the opportunity to be running together for the last four years."

"Mike and I, it's a new friendship," he said. "We are in constant communication. [I] spoke with him today, and we are crisscrossing the state. The message is clear. We are united on the issues that matter most: affordability, accountability, opportunity, and keeping our communities safe."

In a brief statement posted to social media after the debate, Minogue congratulated Oliver on his performance.

"It could not have been more clear which ticket is going to make Massachusetts the best place to live, work, and raise a family," Minogue said.

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Neighborhood turkeys: bullies and beloved

▶GROSSFELD
Continued from Page B1

popularity plummeting faster than our current turkey-in-chief who is trying to peck his name on many buildings.

The first confrontation was immediately posted online by somebody who didn't lift a finger to help. This upset the mail carrier, who worried about her job because she fought back and used, um, *fowl* language at the bad birds.

She now carries a metal telescoping walking stick. She has one simple request: "Please don't feed the turkeys."

Apparently, postal carriers are ripe for a turkey attack.

Their white trucks and blue uniforms are colors that "tend to elicit some more response from the birds," says Dave Scarpitti, Turkey and Upland Game project leader with the Division of Fisheries and Wildlife.

"They're just taking exception to (the postal carrier's presence) and saying, 'OK, well, if you're tough and you're in this area, fight me,'" says Scarpitti.

In 2023, a Cambridge postal carrier was knocked down by two turkeys and required a hip replacement.

Scarpitti says people can unknowingly play into the turkey's hands by feeding them. When a turkey's tummy is full, they look for trouble.

One Squantum resident showers the street with peanuts before turkeys fly up into the trees to nest. She has no clue that numerous neighbors have been attacked.

But other residents are standing their ground. One pajama-clad woman saw her husband fleeing a group of aggressive males. She grabbed a Wiffle ball bat and swung for the fences at their eye level.

(Why can't the Sox get hitters like that?)

Another resident was so traumatized by a turkey attack, she jumped in her car, hit the gas, and crashed into her daughter's vehicle.

The city's animal control agency says, by law, turkeys are free to roam. In the woods, on public streets. This land is their land.

MassWildlife has some tips for survival: Don't ever let a turkey get behind you, where it can slash you with its spurs. Get big, make noise, open an umbrella, and don't ever retreat.

Wild turkeys are not Butterballs. They are in good shape, have great eyesight and they can run and fly. Nor are they stupid, despite pecking at their reflections.

"Just try to catch one," Scarpitti says.

But they are also traffic stoppers, literally.

Joaquin Robles is on his way to pick up his daughter. He is blocked by six male turkeys as he tries to get to his truck. Two charge at him. He makes a quick karate kick move on them and runs to get his dog, who sends them scattering.

But Robles doesn't hate them.

"They're fun," he says. "They're almost like rats … they're multiplying fast. They attack you but they don't hurt anybody, per se.



PHOTOS BY STAN GROSSFELD/GLOBE STAFF

Joaquin Robles attempts a kick to dissuade turkeys from approaching his vehicle, then high-tails it to his house to recruit his dog for reinforcements.





Turkeys play chicken with Quincy motorists, sometimes blocking their path.

"Usually, they peck at the tires. If they see you, the two males come at you, they're protecting the group."

Next, the turkey terror team chases Ginni Klier, a grandmother, until a photographer starts screaming at them, and her husband and dog come out to help.

"You can't go out for a walk without being harassed. It's taking away our enjoyment of the neighborhood," she says.

"I had my grandchildren, 2 and 5, and they came up to them. They are the same height as them and very aggressive. I had flip-flops on and I took them off and smacked them together. They couldn't care less; they just kept coming."

Quincy Animal Control officer Nick Malvesti says he used to tell people to clang pots and pans together but the turkeys are now getting used to loud noises.

"You need to stand your ground," he says. "Basically, don't let them get comfortable in your area."

He suggests a squirt gun. Turkeys don't like water.

Scarpitti says in rare cases turkeys can be relocated.

"It has to be an absolute last resort where we're really concerned about public safety, like little kids at a school bus stop."

He then gets grief from turkey lovers.

"Every time we have a turkey that's behaving badly, I'll get lots of outcry from neighborhoods about how they're not a problem and the people are the problem."

Back on the streets a flustered Amazon driver says he was attacked "every day this week for 20 minutes."

This day is no exception.

"So I had to throw them a couple of my Pringles from lunch … they chased the Pringles, then I ran off. I'm not going to let them hurt me," he says. "Before they get to me, I am gonna kick at them to make them go away."

Mick Struzik has a hammer in his hand as he plants stakes around a tree in his front yard. The Gang of Six, shuffle by. They've got history together.

"I was at my son's bringing in the (trash) barrels and two of them came up the driveway and I had to use the barrels to protect myself. "

This time they just walk on by. Still, he's not ready to go cold turkey. Not yet, anyway.

"It's not like it's a black bear or a coyote," he says. "Just shoo 'em away. But if they attack, I'll just give him a little love tap. (Holding up his hammer) It's just that I love seeing them," he says. "I really do."

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2 officers hurt during arrest after alleged South End assaults

By Bryan Hecht
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Two officers were hospitalized after a struggle with a Cambridge man who allegedly assaulted multiple people and attempted to kick dogs in a South End park on Monday, police said.

Sharkell Tariq Matthews, 26, is expected to be arraigned Tuesday in Boston Municipal Court on two counts of assault and battery on a police officer, assault and battery on an elderly person, resisting arrest, and unarmed assault to rob, police said.

Both officers suffered injuries that were not believed to be life-threatening while trying to arrest Matthews, police said. Matthews was also taken to a local hospital for evaluation after his arrest, police said.

Police were called to Blackstone Square around 5:25 p.m. for a reported assault and battery in progress, police said.

Officers were told that a masked man was assaulting people and had attempted to kick multiple dogs in the park, police said.

When bystanders identified Matthews as the alleged assailant, he started to walk away from police while ignoring verbal commands to show officers his hands, police said.

Outside an apartment building on West Newton Street, Matthews allegedly "rolled up his sleeves and took a fighting stance," police said. He then tried to enter the building, which two officers tried to prevent, leading to a physical altercation in which Matthews allegedly punched one officer in the face, police said.

The other officer deployed his taser, which briefly incapacitated Matthews, but he later "regained his strength" and began to fight officers as they tried to place him in custody, police said.

Matthews was eventually arrested with the assistance of additional police and bystanders, police said.

Witnesses at the park said Matthews had tried to rob multiple people and told a woman who was walking her dog that "he would kill her," police said.

Matthews also allegedly knocked a man's cellphone away and ran off with it, and later demanded that another man hand over his watch.

The man at first refused, and Matthews allegedly tailed him deeper into the park, where he shoved him to the ground and punched him in the face, police said.

A lawyer for Matthews could not be immediately identified.

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Police say children saw Vt. man fatally bludgeon his wife

By Paul Heintz
GLOBE STAFF

BURLINGTON, Vt. — Two 10-year-old children and a 3-year-old were present early Saturday morning when a Vermont man allegedly bludgeoned his wife with a flashlight, police said in court papers Tuesday. She died of her injuries Sunday night.

The man, Bal Khadka, 44, appeared in Chittenden Superior Court on Tuesday to answer to charges in the death of his wife, Lila Darjee Khadka, 44. A public defender for Khadka, Stacie Johnson, entered not guilty pleas on his behalf to one count of second-degree murder and three counts of cruelty to a child. He was ordered held without bail.

A sworn affidavit filed by Detective Corporal Erica Schaller of the Burlington Police Department describes a harrowing scene Friday night and Saturday morning in the downtown public housing unit shared by the Nepali family.

Throughout the night, Khadka was using drugs and accosting his wife, according to their 10-year-old child and her friend, another 10-year-old girl who spent the night there. At around 5:45 a.m. Saturday, Khadka allegedly struck Lila Khadka approximately 10 times with a foot-long flashlight, Schaller said in the affidavit.

The 10-year-olds called 911, escaped through a first-floor window, and frantically approached a responding officer.

The friend had made a 30-minute audio recording of the incident with her cellphone, according to police. A young girl can be heard in the recording saying, "Dad, no" and then screaming, police said. A girl can then be heard saying "Mama, no," followed by the sound of someone being repeatedly struck by a hard object.

When police entered the apartment, Khadka was in the living room, trying to put shoes on his 3-year-old daughter, police said. Khadka "said 'hello' in a low calm voice and seemed unphased (sic) by police presence," Schaller wrote in the affidavit.

Police found Lila Khadka lying in a pool of blood on the bed, unresponsive and barely breathing, according to the affidavit. She was transported to the University of Vermont Medical Center, where she underwent an emergency craniotomy. She was pronounced dead just after 7 p.m. Sunday.

Family members told police Khadka had a history of domestic violence.

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Graphic photos of Birchmore's body shown during testimony

▶FARWELL
Continued from Page B1

ment. Farwell met her through the program, for which he was an instructor. Prosecutors allege their relationship was inappropriate, and that he had sex with her when she was 15. Even though he isn't charged with a crime directly relating to that, his actions amounted to statutory rape because the age of consent in Massachusetts is 16, prosecutors have said.

Cheever met Birchmore when Birchmore had just recently turned 16. The girl was around the police station all the time, she said, and she quickly glommed on to Cheever, who she peppered with questions about being a female police officer. Birchmore had a difficult home life and few friends her own age, but was a cheerful girl who idolized police officers and wished to become one herself.

The prosecution showed the jury pictures of Birchmore at the time; she was a small, slight girl.

Cheever was Farwell's coworker for years, and identified him in court, pointing out the tall man in the suit at the defendant's table. Although Birchmore talked to Cheever about a wide range of issues, she never talked about Farwell and their close relationship, Cheever said in response to prosecutors' inquiries. "I would have asked questions," she said. "I would have immediately reported it."

Birchmore and Farwell continued an on-and-off sexual relationship into Birchmore's adulthood, prosecutors have said. They have said that she began asserting herself more as she got older, realizing the leverage she had over Farwell. By 2020, Farwell was married with children, and another baby on his way with his wife. Birchmore, according to prosecutors, threatened to reveal their relationship — and the history stretching back to her childhood — if he didn't impregnate her.

So when she bounced into Cheryl Carlson's office just before Christmas 2020 with news that she was pregnant, she was delighted, according to the telling of Carlson, her boss as an assistant principal at Sharon schools. Carlson said she asked a few carefully probing questions of the single young woman, but Birchmore cheerfully batted them away. Yes, this was a good thing, Birchmore told her. Sure, the father was a police officer in a relationship with kids, Carlson recalled her saying, but he'd leave his other relationship and be with her once the baby was born.

Carlson said she pushed one step further: What if he doesn't?

"She said, I'm going to have that baby," Carlson testified.

Carlson's testimony touched on core disagreements between the prosecution and the defense. She supported the prosecution's argument that Birchmore was full of joy throughout January 2021, the month after she'd found out she was pregnant, Carlson said. That was the case, Carlson testified, even after she'd heard Birchmore talking about how it seemed like she'd had an argument with the father of her baby late in the month.

"There was something that was not going well between them," Carlson recalled. But, she said, "she was having the baby no matter what."

After Birchmore didn't show up for her job as a paraprofessional, school officials called police to check on her well-being. That's how Birchmore was discovered dead. But the idea that Birchmore had killed herself was so incongruous with the Birchmore who Carlson knew that she reached out to State Police investigators to express her concerns.

Since Birchmore's death, testing has revealed that Farwell was not the baby's father. But prosecutors say that doesn't diminish the motive, as both Birchmore and Farwell believed at the time that he was. Carlson's testimony about Birchmore's statements about her police officer boyfriend in a relationship supports the idea that Birchmore believed that, at least when she first discovered she was pregnant.

This complexity is emblematic of this unusual case. The state medical examiner originally ruled Birchmore's death a suicide, and the Norfolk district attorney declined to bring charges in her death in light of that determination. (The state medical examiner has since changed the manner of death to undetermined.) But allegations of wrongdoing by Farwell eventually emerged, first through police internal affairs probes and then through a lawsuit brought by her family.

Then federal authorities got involved. An independent medical examiner they worked with found her injuries were not consistent with suicide, but rather strangulation. A federal grand jury indicted Farwell and the FBI arrested him in August 2024.

In Birchmore's death, he's charged with killing a victim or a witness. The prosecution must prove not only that he killed her but that he did so to stop information about potential federal crimes he committed from getting to authorities. He is also charged with causing the death of the unborn child. If convicted, Farwell would face life in prison.

Camilo Fonseca of the Globe staff contributed to this report. Sean Cotter can be reached at sean.cotter@globe.com. Laura Crimaldi can be reached at laura.crimaldi@globe.com.

Business

Stop & Shop, Hannaford, Giant Food grocery sites offline

Parent company experiences cyberattack, but stores are open

By Alexa Gagosz
GLOBE STAFF
and Madyline Swearing
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Websites and apps for grocery chains Stop & Shop, Hannaford, and Giant Food were offline Monday and Tuesday after their Dutch parent company experienced a cyber incident.

Ahold Delhaize said in a statement Tuesday that it was experiencing a cyberattack within its network and took some systems offline "to help protect them."

The company said stores continued to be open while teams worked to assess and mitigate the security issue. While customers cannot purchase groceries online and have them delivered through Peapod, they could place orders through third-party sites like DoorDash, Uber Eats, and Instacart.

Other store operations like refrigeration and sale systems are unaffected, a spokesperson confirmed to the Globe.

"We recognize that these actions have caused disruption for customers, associates and partners, but protecting our infrastructure in the best interest of our customers, associates and partners is a top priority," they said in a statement. "Our teams are working with urgency to investigate the incident and restore affected systems safely.

"As they make progress in assessing and mitigating the issues, we are in the process of starting a controlled relaunch of certain systems," the statement added.

GROCERY HACK, Page B6



CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF

Ahold Delhaize, the chains' Dutch parent company, said there has been no indication that client data has been stolen in the incident.



ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF/FILE/2024

The auditor's analysis shows most communities are in a state of mismatched supply and demand when it comes to liquor licenses.

Auditor blasts liquor license system

Calls for putting cities and towns in charge

Bonkers.

That's the only way to describe the state's antiquated liquor laws, after reading a 172-page report from Auditor Diana DiZoglio that lays bare how the system has bred widespread inequity — not just in Boston but across the Commonwealth.

DiZoglio's analysis shows that most of Massachusetts' 351 cities and towns are in a perpetual state of mismatched supply and demand because the number of liquor licenses for bars and restaurants is determined by population size. Based on fiscal 2024 data, the report found 64 municipalities, including Somerville and Salem, have too few liquor licenses, while 238 don't tap their full allotments — leaving a stunning 3,466 alcohol permits unused.

The report points to lost economic opportunity that comes with a system that makes it hard for new restaurants to open and others to expand. This might explain, in part, why neighboring states have more full-service restaurants per capita — resulting in about 500 fewer restaurants and 9,500 fewer jobs in Massachusetts, according to the findings.

The solution, the report concludes, is clear: Give all municipalities control of their own liquor licenses.

That's easier said than done. The last three governors — Deval Patrick, Charlie Baker, and Maura Healey — have pushed for local control, to no avail. Now Senate President Karen Spilka is making a go of it in the Senate economic development bill. But the House is holding it up, even as one of its own, state Representative Joseph McKenna, filed a bill this session to return liquor license control to cities and towns.

The auditor's review makes the stron-

POWER PLAY, Page B6

SHIRLEY LEUNG

POWER PLAY



Get in the loop with a twice-weekly dive into the power players and moves driving business in Massachusetts. Sign up for The Boston Globe's scoop-driven Power Play newsletter, authored by prominent Globe columnists Shirley Leung and Jon Chesto.

Startup unveils 'cute and cuddly' robots

CEO says it's about human interaction

By Hiawatha Bray
GLOBE STAFF

A company headed by a veteran of local robot maker Boston Dynamics is showing off a new kind of humanoid robot that won't work in factories or warehouses, but in theme parks, hotels, and retail stores.

Think of a team mascot patrolling the sidelines of a football game, only with a robot inside the costume rather than a human.

"Our ultimate goal is to revolutionize how humans and robots interact." said Marc Theermann, chief executive of Dynamic Creatures, a Cambridge startup that's partnered with Boston Dynamics and uses much of that company's technology.

On Tuesday, the company released a video of Hugo, a big-eyed furry robot, strolling around the company's Boston headquarters.

Hugo is a prototype intended as the first in a series of robots designed to interact with humans in everyday settings. It's designed to use artificial intelligence that will teach the robot how to operate in the physical world, so it can navigate new environments on its own with little or no training. The company said it's also developing software that will enable Hugo to respond to human questions in real time.

The video shows Hugo walking through the Dynamic Creatures office, high-fiving human engineers and hugging children.

It looks impressive, especially since humanoid robots are rarely allowed one-on-one time with members of the public, because their actuators can do real harm to human bodies if they get out of control.

The idea of animatronic mascots run amok has been strangely prevalent in popular culture. See "The Simpsons" episode on the titular family's ill-fated trip to "Itchy & Scratchy Land," for instance, or the online funhouse horror sensation "Five Nights at Freddy's" — both of which feature supposedly friendly robots that turn murderous.

This won't likely be an issue with Hugo. The prototype seen in the video is being "teleoperated" under remote human control. The system cannot yet be trusted to handle fully autonomous physical interactions with people. But

DYNAMIC CREATURES, Page B8

Joining other leaders, Moderna founder calls for urgent regulation of AI agents

Presses for stronger technological safeguards before public releases

By Sankalp Phartiyal
and Satviki Sanjay
BLOOMBERG

Billionaire biotech mogul Noubar Afeyan has called for urgent regulation of artificial intelligence agents that tech firms are selling, warning that waiting for a disaster risks repeating the past mistakes of the drug industry.

Drawing a parallel with the thalidomide tragedy in the 1950s and 60s, where the drug taken by pregnant women led to birth defects, the founder of Cambridge-based Moderna Inc. argued that companies seeking to profit from AI agents must take responsibility of their safety before launching them commercially.

"I believe what we should do is to think carefully about regulating agents that are being commercialized and that are being transmitted outside the boundaries of what somebody may want to do in house," Afeyan, 64, said at the Bloomberg New Economy Forum in New Delhi Tuesday.

Afeyan joins a growing cohort of technology leaders and researchers including OpenAI chief executive Sam Altman and Anthropic PBC CEO Dario Amodei, in calling for stronger safeguards as AI grows more powerful and autonomous. Altman and Amodei last month urged world leaders to work together on AI during an appearance before the United Nations Security Council that focused on the technology's potential existential risks, a stance that contradicts with President Trump's pro-technology views.

Regulation should be designed for

MODERNA, Page B7



JP YIM/GETTY IMAGES FOR CLINTON GLOBAL INITIATIVE

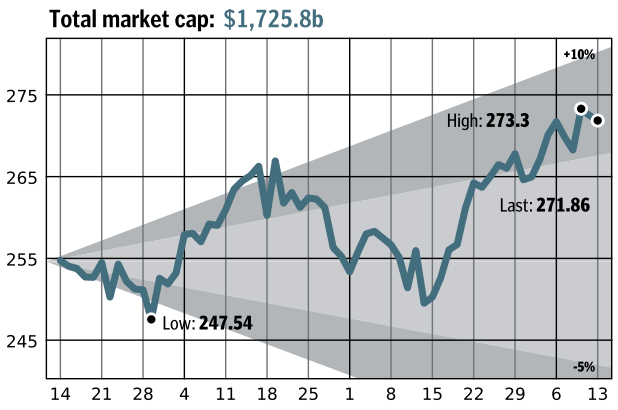
Noubar Afeyan, Moderna founder, warns of pending risks with AI.

THE BOSTON GLOBE

25

Index of publicly traded companies in Massachusetts

Globe 25 index



Yesterday 271.86 ▼ 0.62 ▼ 0.2% ▲ YTD 12.3%

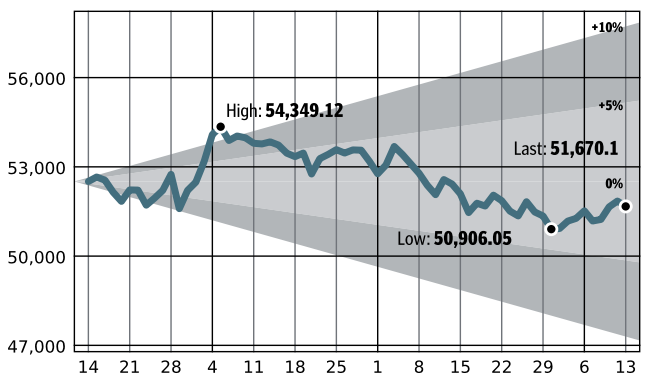
	Price	Chg	% chg	Market cap (bil.)
GE VERNOVA INC (GEV)	1,004.04	+7.24	+0.7	267.4
THERMO FISHER (TMO)	663.04	+0.80	+0.1	245.2
ANALOG DEVICES (ADI)	414.70	+8.46	+2.1	200.9
TJX COS INC (TJX)	141.49	-0.43	-0.3	155.6
VERTEX PHARM (VRTX)	485.22	-21.78	-4.3	123.0
MODERNA INC (MRNA)	216.25	+2.51	+1.2	86.3
AMERICAN TOWER C (AMT)	179.43	-3.13	-1.7	83.6
BOSTON SCIENTIFC (BSX)	43.31	-0.53	-1.2	62.8
TERADYNE INC (TER)	380.29	-3.56	-0.9	59.5
STATE ST CORP (STT)	174.10	-0.83	-0.5	47.8
KEURIG DR PEPPER (KDP)	32.66	-0.09	-0.3	44.4
WATERS CORP (WAT)	429.17	-2.93	-0.7	42.2
IRON MOUNTAIN (IRM)	114.60	-0.50	-0.4	34.1
BIOGEN INC (BIIB)	228.90	-0.51	-0.2	33.8
ALNYLAM PHARMACE (ALNY)	223.82	-3.20	-1.4	29.9
EVERSOURCE ENERG (ES)	65.75	-0.35	-0.5	24.8
SYMBOTIC INC (SYM)	40.89	+0.11	+0.3	24.8
ENTEGRIS INC (ENTG)	161.16	+1.15	+0.7	24.6
VERALTO CORP (VLTO)	98.99	+0.79	+0.8	24.1
MACOM TECHNOLOGY (MTSI)	308.75	+2.39	+0.8	23.6
DYNATRACE INC (DT)	64.47	-0.78	-1.2	18.6
TOAST INC-A (TOST)	30.89	-0.43	-1.4	17.9
REVVITY INC (RVTY)	155.08	-0.53	-0.3	17.3
CLEAN HARBORS (CLH)	317.38	-1.64	-0.5	16.8
MKS INC (MKSI)	247.56	-2.35	-0.9	16.7

Markets

Modest moves mask big swings

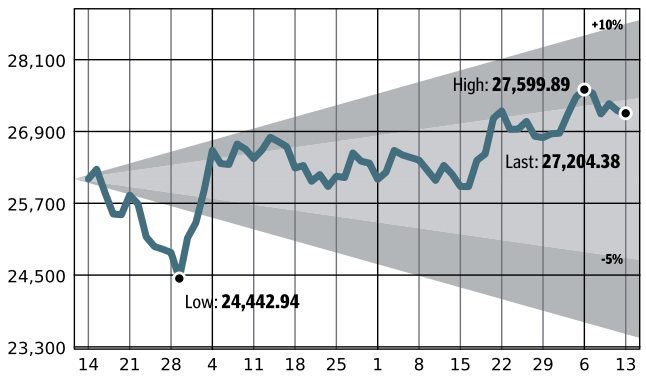
The first big batch of summertime profit reports from US companies made waves on Wall Street after topping analysts' expectations, but many canceled each other out. That left US stock indexes little changed near their records on Tuesday. Those modest moves masked some big swings happening underneath the market's surface. Goldman Sachs jumped more than 4 percent at the start of trading after the bank delivered a profit for July through September that blew past analysts' expectations. But its stock quickly erased all of it and then flipped between gains and losses before finishing with a dip of 0.2 percent. Goldman Sachs benefited in the summer from strong growth for its business that offers loans to clients for trading stocks, among other things, even as CEO David Solomon said it's dealing with a "complicated operating environment" created by lots of uncertainty. Expectations are high for profits across all kinds of US companies. Analysts are forecasting overall growth of nearly 30 percent for companies in the S&P 500 during the summer from a year earlier, according to FactSet. If they're correct, it would be the third straight quarter of growth better than 25 percent. (AP)

DOW JONES industrial average



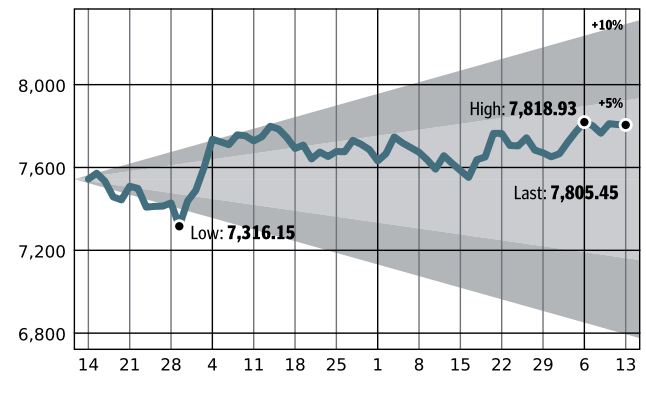
Yesterday 51,670.10 ▼ 180.45 ▼ 0.3% ▲ YTD 7.5%

NASDAQ Composite index



Yesterday 27,204.38 ▼ 41.52 ▼ 0.2% ▲ YTD 17.0%

S&P 500 index



Yesterday 7,805.45 ▼ 1.79 ▼ 0.0% ▲ YTD 14.0%

SOURCE: Bloomberg News

Healey demands early utility refunds

Companies appear reluctant to match governor's urgency

By Alison Kuznitz
STATE HOUSE NEWS SERVICE

With the temperature dropping and election rhetoric heating up, Governor Maura Healey wants utility companies to fast-track refunds that are not legally due to Massachusetts ratepayers until late spring.

In a Tuesday letter to Eversource, National Grid, and Unitil executives, Healey demanded that the utilities "immediately" issue refunds to Bay State customers who paid "transmission rates with an excessive return on equity (ROE) for more than a decade." Roughly $1.5 billion in refunds are owed to New England ratepayers overall. Healey also sent the letter to the head of grid operator ISO-New England.

The governor's call stems from a Federal Energy Regulatory Commission decision in March, which reduced the profits that New England transmission utilities can earn on their investments and initially said refunds were due within 30 days. That deadline was later extended to May 20, 2027, and the US Court of Appeals for the D.C. Circuit denied the utilities' effort to delay, according to the letter that Healey's office circulated.

"Further delay is unacceptable," Healey wrote. "Customers should not have to wait any longer for money that FERC has determined must be returned to them. I urge you to end your appeal and begin issuing refunds to Massachusetts ratepayers without further delay."

Healey, who is up for reelection in three weeks, has a second debate against Republican gubernatorial challenger Mike Minogue on Thursday evening on WCVB-TV. Ahead of their first televised showdown last week, Healey declared a "state of energy emergency" and issued an executive order that featured legal protections against price gouging, one-time heating assistance for middle-income households, expanded heating assistance for low-income households, and the temporary elimination of clean energy charges on electric bills.



MELECK ELDAHSHOURY FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Governor Maura Healey announced plans to lower winter energy costs during an Oct. 5 press event in Everett.

Meanwhile, highly anticipated energy affordability legislation has been lodged in private conference committee talks for months. House Speaker Ron Mariano has said his branch is not using Election Day as a goalpost for finalizing negotiations on major bills.

Minogue's blueprint calls for slashing state-mandated energy utility fees on his first day in office, which his campaign said represent one-third of utility bill costs. He also wants to invest in "safe, clean, and reliable energy that lowers monthly costs with natural gas pipelines," plus assess new modular nuclear energy options.

In her letter, Healey told the utilities she wants information by Oct. 27, including a "clear accounting of the expected refunds attributable to Massachusetts customers," the schedule for returning those funds, and the process for issuing the refunds.

"As we head into another winter season, our residents are rightly concerned about high energy bills," Healey wrote. "I write to emphasize the importance of promptly returning the hard-earned money Massachusetts residents are owed."

Spokespeople for the utilities suggested they do not intend to match the urgency that Healey expressed in her letter.

Eversource is still working through legal issues, said spokesperson William Hinkle. The timeline to deliver refunds is an "incredibly complex, labor-intensive process that involves multiple parties including all of the regional transmission owners and every electric distribution company across multiple different billing systems before the funds could ultimately be returned to customers through their individual bills," he said.

"Eversource plans to ultimately comply with the directives of FERC — but will not sacrifice the accuracy of customer billing information in the process, which would only cause greater customer angst and frustration," Hinkle said.

National Grid spokesperson Brendan Moss said the utility is working to calculate the refunds and will start "processing them in 2027, in advance of FERC's May deadline."

Unitil plans to respond to Healey's letter by the Oct. 27 deadline, said spokesperson Amanda Vicinanzo.

"As a Company, Unitil is committed to fulfilling its obligations under FERC's order and ensuring that any refunds owed are returned to customers in accordance with applicable legal and regulatory requirements," Vicinanzo said. "We will continue to work cooperatively with regulators and appropriate parties to support this process."

Eversource chief executive Joseph Nolan downplayed Healey's criticisms of utility companies during an industry conference last month, chalking up her rhetoric to a fast-approaching election, according to CommonWealth Beacon.

"We have good relations with all of them," Nolan said of the governors of Massachusetts, Connecticut, and New Hampshire, according to the outlet. "As much as you might hear them maybe take a whack or a knock at us or me or at certain things, I will tell you if I had $1 for every time they say, 'Hey, nothing personal, Joe. You know you're our friend.' But they have to do that."



BEN PENNINGTON/FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE/FILE/2025

Based on fiscal 2024 data, the auditor's report found 64 municipalities have too few liquor licenses, while 238 don't tap their full allotments.

Auditor's analysis reveals mismatch on liquor licenses across the state

▶POWER PLAY
Continued from Page B5

gest case yet on why the state's post-Prohibition framework dating back to 1933 doesn't work. It's deeply flawed, DiZoglio argues, and a patchwork of fixes over the decades has only exacerbated inequities.

"You should not need to have unlimited access to political connections and wealth just to get a liquor license," DiZoglio told me. "When government artificially limits supply, scarcity has a price."

The Legislature's inability to cede power is frustrating for local leaders such as Somerville Mayor Jake Wilson, who says the state is treating "municipalities like naive children." Under the current system, if a municipality wants more licenses, it has to seek approval through an arduous home-rule petition route at the State House; some 20 were filed this session.

"It's indicative of an overall paternalistic attitude that the state has toward municipalities — that we know better than you," Wilson said.

There's another wrinkle in how liquor laws are bonkers: Local license control is already permitted in 26 municipalities, including Cambridge, Plymouth, Worcester, and many towns on the Cape and in the Berkshires. Between 1978 and 1984, the state gave those municipalities licensing powers — creating a two-tiered system in which some cities and towns could issue twice as many pouring licenses as others.

Boston, by the way, is another big exception to the rule: The State House dictates the number of licenses the city can have.



GLOBE STAFF/FILE

Auditor Donna Dizoglio

Why is the House so recalcitrant on this matter? No politician likes to give up leverage. But one of its most powerful members, Aaron Michlewitz, insists the current structure offers "checks and balances" that make for better laws. For example, when Boston sought 200-plus new licenses a couple of years ago, some neighborhood groups were upset the measure did not require license seekers to serve food. That provision was added when the bill got to Beacon Hill.

But Nick Korn, a partner in the beverage consultancy OFF-SITE and an advocate for local control, said the 26 cities and towns under their own rules provide four decades of data on what reform would look like, or what he calls "a perfect control group." The upshot: Local access to licenses proved to be an economic advantage.

Local control wouldn't mean a system without rules. The state Alcoholic Beverages Control Commission would still need to review licenses approved at the local level.

For restaurateurs like Will Gilson, having an affordable and approachable liquor license system is why he settled in Cambridge to open Puritan and Company 14 years ago and continues to expand there. He faced an initial hurdle of paying $125,000 for an all-alcohol license but was able to get a free beer-and-wine license that he upgraded for a nominal cost a year later.

> 'When government artificially limits supply, scarcity has a price.'
>
> DONNA DIZOGLIO, *State auditor*

But government-imposed scarcity across the river has kept Gilson out of Boston, where obtaining a liquor license in a prime location can cost hundreds of thousands of dollars.

"Having to potentially pay what a starter home's price should be for a liquor license is something that has always been intimidating," said Gilson, chef-partner of Cambridge Street Hospitality Group.

Bonkers indeed – like the state liquor laws, which haven't changed much since the end of Prohibition. Beacon Hill has made a sport out of ignoring DiZoglio, but they shouldn't ignore this issue.

Shirley Leung is a Business columnist. She can be reached at shirley.leung@globe.com.

Grocery sites offline after cyberattack

▶GROCERY HACK
Continued from Page B5

The company said there has been no indication that client data has been stolen in the incident.

The regional stores' webpages and apps were offline both Monday and Tuesday, and maintenance messages were in place, alerting customers that stores, pharmacies, and fuel stations were operating as normal.

The maintenance message said that any unfulfilled orders placed online or through the app would be refunded.

"As a result, our website and app are not available at this time — but we are working as quickly as possible to restore them," a spokesperson said in a statement.

Hannaford Supermarkets said in a statement that its website, mobile app, and To Go pickup and delivery services have been affected by the security issue.

"Hannaford stores remain open and continue to welcome customers," a spokesperson said. "We apologize for the inconvenience and appreciate our customers' patience and understanding. We'll provide an update once the issue has been resolved."

Ahold Delhaize has five brands in the United States: Stop & Shop, Hannaford, Giant Food, The GIANT Company, and Food Lion.

The company is based in the Netherlands and has 17 local brands across nine countries.

Separately, cyberattacks have disrupted other European supermarket chains, which have affected refrigeration systems at hundreds of stores in France. French Finance Minister Roland Lescure told Parliament on Tuesday that roughly 700 supermarkets were impacted. He said that while there was no risk to France's supplies, the attack "touches the heart of our food security."

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TALKING POINTS

ENERGY

TRUMP RENEWS BATTLE TO UPEND OFFSHORE WIND FARMS IN THE US



The Trump administration is pushing to reevaluate a key permit for a wind farm that began operating this year off the Rhode Island coast, stepping up a campaign against clean energy projects. The US Justice Department asked a federal court to remand the Interior Department's approval of a construction and operations plan for Orsted AS's Revolution Wind project that began producing power in March, according to a filing Friday. The Interior Department agrees the move "is warranted so that the agency can revaluate its compliance with the Outer Continental Shelf Lands Act," the filing said. Denmark-based Orsted declined to comment Tuesday. The Interior Department didn't respond to a request for comment. President Trump has waged an aggressive initiative against offshore wind installations since the day of his swearing-in in January 2025. His administration has resorted to stop-work orders, lease suspensions, permit revocations, and $4 billion in buyout settlements in an effort to dismantle the pipeline of offshore projects. The DOJ's move against the wind farm off Rhode Island threatens to undermine a recent deal between Senate Democrats and Republicans to reform the US system of approving infrastructure projects. The agreement included assurances that the Trump administration would stop blocking fully permitted wind and solar developments from moving ahead, and the top Democrat involved in the talks is Senator Sheldon Whitehouse of Rhode Island. The courts have provided some relief to wind farm developers, allowing some blocked projects to move forward. However, regulatory uncertainty has driven major international players to freeze or exit US projects. As of August, Revolution Wind was more than 95 percent complete, with 61 of 65 turbines installed, according to Bloomberg Intelligence. The Trump administration previously sought to block construction of Revolution Wind, which is a joint venture between Orsted and Global Infrastructure Partners' Skyborn Renewables.

— BLOOMBERG NEWS

GROCERY

KROGER TO LAY OFF 3,000 EMPLOYEES OVER 3 YEARS AS IT ADOPTS AI

Grocery store chain Kroger said it will lay off 3,000 corporate employees over the next three years as it ramps up its use of artificial intelligence to streamline operations. "Technology is reshaping what's possible," CEO Greg Foran wrote in a memo to employees on Monday. "The way work gets done is changing across every industry; we must adapt and take advantage of technology. We need to adopt capabilities, reduce duplicative work, and look closely at where work is best fit to be done." Kroger last month outlined its AI strategy, meant "to improve the customer experience, make work easier for associates, and produce better business outcomes." Cincinnati-based Kroger is the largest standalone US supermarket chain with 409,000 employees and more than 2,700 stores operating under various brands, including Ralphs, King Soopers, Smith's, and Fred Meyer.

— ASSOCIATED PRESS

TECH

APPLE INTRODUCES HOMEVIEW, A $299 TABLET FOR THE HOME



Apple introduced a new home smart device Tuesday, as the company tries to breathe fresh life into its product lineup and make inroads in AI. At an event in New York, Apple unveiled the HomeView, a 7-inch tablet that will be able to recognize up to six members of a household and change its content based on who is using it. One version of the HomeView can be placed on a countertop, and another can be mounted on a wall. The device will start at $299 and be available for purchase starting Nov. 13. Apple's announcement comes a month after John Ternus took over leadership of the company from Tim Cook. Ternus, who was previously Apple's head of hardware engineering, inherited a company that has faced years of criticism for incrementally improving core devices like the iPhone and missing the mark on new bets like its mixed reality headset, the Vision Pro. With last month's debut of the iPhone Duo, which can open and close like a book, and Tuesday's introduction of the HomeView, Apple is trying to prove it can still innovate.

— NEW YORK TIMES

HOUSING

HOME SALES ROSE IN SEPTEMBER, BUT SLOWED FROM A YEAR EARLIER AS RATES SPIKE



Sales of previously occupied US homes rose in September from the previous month, but slowed compared to a year ago, the latest sign the housing market remains stalled as rising mortgage rates and home prices discourage prospective homebuyers. Existing home sales rose 1.5 percent last month from August to a seasonally adjusted annual rate of 3.99 million units, the National Association of Realtors said Tuesday. One of the factors in the monthly increase is that sales in August were revised lower. Sales fell 2.2 percent compared with September last year. The latest sales tally is slightly above the 3.98 million pace economists were expecting, according to FactSet. Home sales have been mostly hovering close to a 4-million annual pace going back to 2023, far short of the historic norm that is closer to 5.2-million. September is the second month in a row that the annual sales pace has remained below 4 million. Home prices continued to rise nationally last month. The US median sales price increased 1.3 percent in September from a year earlier to $417,500, an all-time high for the month of September based on data going back to 1999, NAR said. Home prices have risen on an annual basis for 39 months in a row.

— ASSOCIATED PRESS

ONLINE DATING

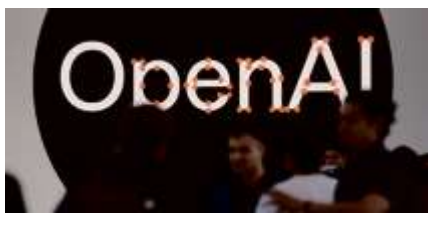
BUMBLE TO DELIST IN $1.3B DEAL WITH ITHACA HOLDINGS

Bumble is being taken private by newly formed firm Ithaca Holdings for $1.3 billion, a fraction of its value when it went public in 2021, after users began to sour on dating apps. Ithaca Holdings will pay $6.05 per share, according to a statement Tuesday. Bloomberg reported on Monday that the two firms were in advanced talks about a sale. The deal price represents a 138 percent premium over Bumble's closing share price on Friday, the last trading day before Bloomberg and other news outlets reported on a possible deal. After the deal is completed, Ithaca Holdings' two chief executives, Ravi Gupta and John Hegeman, will become co-CEOs of Bumble. Founder Whitney Wolfe Herd will "remain actively involved with Bumble," she said in the statement.

— BLOOMBERG NEWS

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

WHO'S TO BLAME IF AI FAILS AT WORK? WHARTON STUDY SHOWS A SPLIT.



Companies are giving AI systems more autonomy to boost productivity and efficiency. But as bots take on more responsibility, executives, managers, and employees remain unclear on who should be held accountable when something goes wrong. A new report published Tuesday by the Wharton School of the University of Pennsylvania found little agreement among managers. When asked who should be held responsible when a bot "makes a consequential error," respondents were split roughly evenly between the employee deploying the AI agent, the employee's manager, and the company's risk team, with about a quarter choosing each. Roughly 10 percent blamed the vendor, while a similar share said they weren't sure who should be held accountable. While concerns of rogue AI agents have dominated headlines in recent months, the more immediate risk to companies may be far more ordinary and mundane. A minor prompt error or unclear instructions can quickly snowball into a larger crisis when agents have access to live systems such as email accounts or customer databases, said Leeron Walter, vice president at employee-monitoring software company Teramind.

— BLOOMBERG NEWS

HEALTH

WALMART TO COVER SOME GLP-1S, INSULIN AT NO COST FOR WORKERS



Walmart Inc. plans to cover more than 250 prescription drugs without charge for its employees and add other health benefits to attract and retain workers at a time when many companies are raising health care costs. The list of covered medications includes many generics alongside some in-demand branded drugs such as Novo Nordisk's Ozempic and Eli Lilly & Co.'s Mounjaro. The retailer will offer those at no cost for people with Type 2 diabetes after prior approval. Some insulin and inhalers will also be covered for employees who participate in the company's medical plans next year, chief people officer Donna Morris said Tuesday in a memo to staff viewed by Bloomberg News. Other covered drugs include medicines to treat migraines, dementia, and cardiovascular conditions. The actions by the largest US private employer come as other corporations cut back on benefits due to rising medical costs, including many that have eliminated coverage of GLP-1s for weight loss. Walmart plans to increase its employee insurance premiums next year, though at a lower rate than in 2026, a company spokesman said..

— BLOOMBERG NEWS

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HubSpot cofounder apologizes for 'curt' post about layoffs

Firm announced cuts to 7% of entire workforce

By Beth Treffeisen
BOSTON.COM

HubSpot cofounder Dharmesh Shah apologized after his brief LinkedIn message to employees losing their jobs drew criticism.

The Cambridge-based company announced last Tuesday that it would cut nearly 660 jobs, or about 7 percent of its workforce.

Soon after, Shah, HubSpot's chief technology officer, thanked the departing employees in a post for helping to build the company and offered "best wishes with the next chapter."

Some commenters criticized the message as impersonal and out of touch. Others thought it was good that he acknowledged it at all.

Shah later added an apology to the post, saying that he was "sincerely sorry" that his original message was "curt and insensitive."

He went on to explain that he wanted to express his gratitude publicly, but failed to acknowledge the pain and uncertainty of being laid off.

"As a co-founder, I should have showed the people who helped build HubSpot more care and empathy," he wrote.

HubSpot CEO Yamini Rangan said the company is reorganizing as it shifts toward helping customers achieve results with artificial intelligence. She said AI-related efficiencies did not drive the layoffs.

Shah cofounded HubSpot in 2006 after founding Pyramid Digital Solutions, a software company acquired in 2005. He has more than 1.2 million followers on LinkedIn and has written extensively about startups and marketing.

Six rural hospitals in Mass. eligible for up to $2.5m in federal aid

Seeks to address health disparities

By Alison Kuznitz
STATE HOUSE NEWS SERVICE

Six rural hospitals could each secure up to $2.5 million in federal dollars to cover capital improvements, as state health officials work to dole out the initial $162 million that Massachusetts received last December as part of the Rural Health Transformation Program.

The Executive Office of Health and Human Services last week issued a request for applications, due by Oct. 26, with money also available for rural health clinics, community-based groups and social services organizations, federally qualified health centers, health care providers and practices, nursing facilities and rural municipalities. Those entities can seek funding for a slew of initiatives surrounding population health advancement, innovation in rural care models, workforce development, healthy rural communities, technology enhancements, and facility modernization and reuse.

The first funding period runs from Oct. 30 to Sept. 30, 2027, and Massachusetts could receive a total of $800 million throughout the five-year, $50 billion federal program created through the One Big Beautiful Bill Act. Eliza Lake, director of health policy and strategic initiatives at EOHHS, said in June the state was hoping to start the procurement process later in the month.

"We need to sort of focus on the most shovel-ready or the quickest things to get the money out because under the CMS rules, we have to have all the money obligated — all $162 million — by the end of October," Lake had said at a Medicaid summit. "And then the contracts have to be fully expended by the end of September of next year."

The eligible rural hospitals are Athol Hospital, Martha's Vineyard Hospital, Fairview Hospital in Great Barrington, North Adams Regional Hospital, Nantucket Cottage Hospital, and Baystate Wing Hospital in Palmer. Each can request up to $2.5 million in capital funding, which hospitals can deploy to repurpose underutilized spaces, bolster diagnostic and specialty care capacity, improve preventive and chronic disease services, integrate new technologies, and address aging building systems like HVAC. The award amount depends on the "number, scope, readiness, and approval of proposed projects," according to the state's request for applications.

Nantucket Cottage Hospital posted an operating margin of negative 4.8 percent in fiscal 2025, while Fairview Hospital notched a 10.1 percent operating margin, according to a recent report from the Center for Health Information and Analysis.

State officials say that rural communities are facing "major health care disparities" across access and outcomes, as a result of limited providers, aging infrastructure, and "systemic decline in local health services."

Moderna founder calls for regulation of AI agents

▶MODERNA
Continued from Page B5

companies developing AI agents rather than large language models, Afeyan said. "To me, LLMs are capability. Agents are intentionality."

A new crop of AI agents, which are self-directed and work without the human command, could accelerate drug discovery and scientific research, but also lead to unsafe molecules and flawed findings, experts warn.

Afeyan's arguments come just days after Anthropic's Claude AI model carried out additional unintended actions on the digital systems of outside organizations, including submitting a false tip in a police homicide case.

Indian biotech entrepreneur Kiran Mazumdar Shaw also called for AI laws that deal with biomaterials — synthetic substances engineered to replace or treat human organs or tissue.

"Synthetic biology is another area which we really need to look at very carefully. I think it's both intended bad uses of AI and then the unintended," Shaw said at the Bloomberg event.

CVS settles opioid suit for $315 million

By Alanna Durkin Richer
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — CVS Pharmacy Inc. and various subsidiaries have agreed to pay $315 million to resolve a Justice Department case alleging it unlawfully dispensed medically unnecessary prescriptions of opioids, officials said Tuesday.

The settlement resolves a lawsuit brought in 2024 that accused the health care giant of providing massive amounts of opioids and other controlled substances "to fuel its own profits at the expense of public health and safety."

It's the latest effort by the government to hold accountable companies that officials have alleged helped fuel the US addiction and overdose crisis.

"Today's settlement is a significant milestone in the [DOJ's] efforts to combat the opioid epidemic by cracking down on pharmacies who unlawfully fulfill prescriptions for controlled substances," Associate Attorney General Stanley Woodward said.

Woonsocket, R.I.-based CVS said in a statement that its pharmacists were trained "in the safe and appropriate use of all medications" and that it had implemented "best-in-class" programs to help them "make the best decisions on behalf of patients."

The company said it strongly disagreed with the claims made in the lawsuit and that the settlement admits no wrongdoing.

The company said in 2024 that pharmacists were being held to "vague, undefined, and ever-changing standards of practice" when it comes to filling prescription opioids.

The lawsuit filed under President Biden's administration accused CVS of violating the Controlled Substances Act by filling illegitimate prescriptions for high doses of potent opioids that "fed dependence and addiction." The Justice Department alleged it dispensed large quantities of opioids based on prescriptions from known "pill mills," or providers that hand out prescriptions for drugs without a legitimate medical purpose.

It alleged that poor staffing levels coupled with performance metrics and incentive compensation policies led to pharmacists racing to fill prescriptions without confirming they were legitimate. The prescriptions were often billed to and reimbursed by Medicaid and other federal health care programs, the lawsuit says.

CVS must also "implement additional safeguards to ensure that prescriptions for opioids and other controlled substances are dispensed only when medically appropriate," said Assistant Attorney General Brett Shumate, who leads the DOJ's Civil Division.

Over the last decade, drugmakers, wholesalers, pharmacies, and other companies have agreed to settlements with governments in the US totaling over $50 billion. Most of the money is intended to go to address the crisis, which has been linked to more than 100,000 deaths in the US some years, though the numbers have fallen sharply recently.

Cambridge startup unveils 'cute and cuddly' robots

▶DYNAMIC CREATURES
Continued from Page B5

over time, Theermann said the robot will become more adept at safely interacting with the physical world.

Theermann is former chief strategy officer at Boston Dynamics, the Waltham-based maker of the Atlas humanoid robot.

"I actually joined Boston Dynamics ultimately with the goal of starting this company," he said. Theermann admitted as much to Boston Dynamics then-chief executive Robert Playter. "He said, "'Yeah, me too, but first you got to help me figure out all this industrial stuff.'"

Boston Dynamics, owned by South Korea's Hyundai Motor Group, is now adept at building truck-unloading robots, and the Spot quadruped machine, which resembles a robot dog, has become a standard tool for industrial inspection, security patrolling, and search-and-rescue missions.

But Theermann believes that it'll take a new generation of warm-and-fuzzy robots to get people accustomed to the idea of working closely with humanoid machines.

"I'm 100 percent certain that we will all have a robot in our home in 10 years," he said. "So the question is, how do we get from today to that future? The specific part that we want to play is to make humans more comfortable by presenting them with robots that are cute and cuddly."

Hiawatha Bray can be reached at hiawatha.bray@globe.com. Follow him @GlobeTechLab.



GODOFREDO A. VÁSQUEZ/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES/FILE

Olivia Konar held a banner with the names of youths who allegedly died from the impact of social media.

States say $17b deal with Meta should help repair harms of social media use

By Ted Alcorn
NEW YORK TIMES

After Meta agreed to pay as much as $17 billion to settle claims that it had built Instagram and Facebook to hook children, attorneys general in several states outlined how the money should be spent.

The funding should "repair the harms of unhealthy social media use," expand youth crisis intervention, and restore the mental health and safety of children, they declared in news releases.

But the settlement with Meta in August cements little in required allocations toward those goals.

And if earlier settlements with the tobacco and opioid industries are any guide, it is much simpler to win the money than ensure it reaches the intended beneficiaries.

In an appendix to the Meta agreement where each state set terms for spending its share, most specify no purpose. Wyoming sends every dollar to its general fund. Alaska splits its share between the general fund and its attorney general's enforcement budget.

The total includes $459 million settling what a spokesperson for California's Justice Department called "a prior, unrelated multistate investigation" into Meta's Cambridge Analytica data leak.

The rest of the settlement leaves about 70 percent of the money to the discretion of state officials, up to $11.7 billion, with 23 percent aimed at youth mental health or social media harms.

Meta disputed that characterization, pointing to part of the settlement that requires states to certify to the IRS that at least half the money is "compensatory restitution and remediation." Tax experts said the phrase comes from the tax code, which lets companies deduct settlement payments for repairing harms. It governs how the payment is reported, not how it is spent. The company declined to say whether it would claim the deduction.

Candice Odgers, a developmental psychologist at the University of California, Irvine, said the settlement would still leave states with an obligation. "We have put children front and center in this fight against Big Tech," she wrote in an email. "Now, it is only fair that we make sure the money goes towards ensuring that they get a 'win' out of this, too."

Meta faces pressure on other fronts. In New Mexico, which pursued its own case over Cambridge Analytica, a judge is expected to decide how much the company owes after a jury found in September that it violated the state's consumer protection law tens of millions of times. The state is seeking billions of dollars.

Separately, states have moved quickly on the products. Last month, California became the first state to ban addictive features like infinite scroll for users under 16. But courts have blocked most state laws on free speech grounds, and the companies are expected to challenge this one.

The biggest settlement that states have won for public health dates to November 1998, when attorneys general ended their lawsuit against the major cigarette makers. The companies, which agreed to perpetual payments that shrink as cigarette sales fall, have paid more than $176 billion, according to the National Association of Attorneys General.

But the agreement did not require money be spent on smoking prevention.

"The thing that I just hate about the tobacco settlement the most is that money went out to a lot of states, and they just didn't spend the money as we had anticipated," said Mike Moore, a former attorney general of Mississippi who initiated the first state lawsuit against the industry.

James Tierney, a former Maine attorney general who advised on the litigation, said the attorneys general had little leverage.

"We couldn't control the money legally," he said. The resistance to earmarking it "came from the governors, not the tobacco companies."

In the first six years of payments, states put just 3.5 percent of the money into tobacco control, the Government Accountability Office found; 23 percent went toward budget shortfalls.

Still, public health advocates point to other achievements of tobacco litigation. It forced millions of pages of internal documents into public view, banned cartoon mascots like Joe Camel, and helped drive daily smoking among high school seniors from 1 in 4 to fewer than 1 in 100.

"The revelations of litigation change culture," said Nora Freeman Engstrom, a Stanford law professor who has written about the legacy of the tobacco settlement. "They change how we think about products, and they change how we interact with products."

But Matthew Myers, who ran the Campaign for Tobacco-Free Kids for more than two decades and was deeply involved in the negotiations, drew another lesson.

"If you want the money spent on the items that will have the greatest impact, you have to mandate it and specify it," he said. "Otherwise, the political process will take over."

Two decades later, when attorneys general won settlements totaling more than $50 billion from opioid manufacturers, distributors, and pharmacy chains, they took that lesson to heart.

Josh Stein, then North Carolina's attorney general and now its governor, said the agreements were designed to avoid the pitfalls of the tobacco settlements.

"We wanted to try to reduce the amount of human suffering that Americans were experiencing," he said, "so we were really explicit that the funds had to go to those express purposes."

In early 2021, with the first of those national deals still being negotiated, researchers at the Johns Hopkins Bloomberg School of Public Health published principles for spending the money and warned states against using it to fill budget holes.

The agreement with the three largest opioid distributors declared that "in no event" may less than 85 percent of the money be spent on opioid remediation.

It named core strategies for states to prioritize, including naloxone distribution, medication-assisted treatment, and care for women before and after childbirth. Expenses outside opioid remediation were discouraged and were required to be publicly reported.

By comparison, the Meta settlement with 47 states has fewer strings attached. The agreement lists possible uses, including crisis lines, after-school programs, phone-free school zones, and training for doctors, but those are not requirements.

Unlike the opioid deal, the agreement sets no general requirement that states report how the money is spent.

Myers said that open-ended language cuts both ways. It lets a committed attorney general adapt as understanding of social media's harms change.

"But at the same time it means that the next attorney general, who might not be interested in this issue at all, is given the flexibility to do things that may be totally ineffective," he said.

Unlike tobacco or opioids, which have known prevention strategies, social media is a dynamic technology where no single intervention may be effective for long.

Mitch Prinstein, a psychologist at the University of North Carolina and former chief science officer of the American Psychological Association, put the problem plainly. "I wish we did have an evidence-based menu," he said, "but we don't."

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COMMONWEALTH OF MASSACHUSETTS
LAND COURT
DEPARTMENT OF THE TRIAL COURT
Docket Number: 26 SM 003138
ORDER OF NOTICE

TO: Selena D. Robinson, Vivienne E. Sullivan

and to all persons entitled to the benefit of the Servicemembers Civil Relief Act, 50 U.S.C. c. 50 §3901 (et seq)

CITIZENS BANK NA f/k/a RBS CITIZENS NA

claiming to have an interest in a Mortgage covering real property in 1 Colorado Street, Mattapan, MA 02126, given by Selena D. Robinson and Vivienne E. Sullivan to CCO Mortgage Corp., dated May 18, 2007 and recorded in the Suffolk County Registry of Deeds in Book 41838, Page 40, has/have filed with this court a complaint for determination of Defendant's/Defendants' Servicemembers status.

If you now are, or recently have been, in the active military service of the United States of America, then you may be entitled to the benefits of the Servicemembers Civil Relief Act. If you object to a foreclosure of the above-mentioned property on that basis, then you or your attorney must file a written appearance and answer in this court at: Three Pemberton Square, Boston, MA 02108 on or before 11/16/2026 or you may lose the opportunity to challenge the foreclosure on the ground of noncompliance with the Act.

Witness, Gordon H. Piper, Chief Justice of this Court on 9/29/2026.
Attest: Deborah J. Patterson, Recorder

COMMONWEALTH OF MASSACHUSETTS
LAND COURT
DEPARTMENT OF THE TRIAL COURT
Docket Number: 26 SM 001973
AMENDED ORDER OF NOTICE

TO: Lynn K. Cole and Linda A. Cole

and to all persons entitled to the benefit of the Servicemembers Civil Relief Act, 50 U.S.C. c. 50 §3901 (et seq)

TH MSR Holdings LLC

claiming to have an interest in a Mortgage covering real property in 387 Faneuil Street, Brighton, MA 02135, given by Lynn K. Cole and Linda A. Cole to Mortgage Electronic Registration Systems, Inc., as nominee for Loandepot.com, LLC, its successors and assigns, dated January 12, 2017 and registered with the Suffolk County Registry District of the Land Court as Document No. 00865753, and noted on the Certificate of Title No. 107570, and now held by the Plaintiff by assignment.

If you now are, or recently have been, in the active military service of the United States of America, then you may be entitled to the benefits of the Servicemembers Civil Relief Act. If you object to a foreclosure of the above-mentioned property on that basis, then you or your attorney must file a written appearance and answer in this court at: Three Pemberton Square, Boston, MA 02108 on or before 11/9/2026 or you may lose the opportunity to challenge the foreclosure on the ground of noncompliance with the Act.

Witness, Gordon H. Piper, Chief Justice of this Court on 9/25/2026.
Attest: Deborah J. Patterson, Recorder

PUBLIC NOTICE
Watertown Zoning Board of Appeals Public Hearing: **Wednesday, October 28, 2026,** with the meeting starting at **7:00 p.m.** in Community Meeting Room 2E, Parker Building, 124 Watertown St, Watertown, MA, in-person with remote access link on the agenda 48 hours prior to the meeting.

60 Katherine Road—Jeremy Finch requests a Special Permit Finding under §4.06(a) Alteration of Non-Conforming Structures to allow within non-conforming rear setback: increased roof height and a steeper roof pitch with a new gable-end, shed dormers on both sides of the roof, spiral staircase to a new zoning-compliant deck, and enclosure of a 2nd floor rear porch; and to allow within non-conforming fron t setback: a small side addition to the existing front vestibule. Located in the SC (Single Family Conversion) Zoning District. **PZ-26-22.**

COMMONWEALTH OF MASSACHUSETTS
LAND COURT
DEPARTMENT OF THE TRIAL COURT
Docket No. 26 SM 003238
ORDER OF NOTICE

TO: Rosanna M. Gaulin, as Personal Representative of the Estate of William D. Gaulin a/k/a William David Gaulin; Rosanna M. Gaulin

and to all persons entitled to the benefit of the Servicemembers Civil Relief Act, 50 U.S.C. c. 50 §3901 (et seq):

Wilmington Savings Fund Society, FSB, not in its individual capacity, but solely as owner trustee of CSMC 2019-RPL5 Trust

claiming to have an interest in a Mortgage covering real property in Newton, numbered 63 A Norwood Avenue, Unit No. 34, of the Crystal Lake Manor Condominium, given by William D. Gaulin to Mortgage Electronic Registration Systems, Inc., as mortgagee, as nominee for Eastern Bank, its successors and assigns, dated March 9, 2006, and registered at Middlesex County (Southern District) Registry District of the Land Court as Document No. 1404958 and noted on Certificate of Title No. U12154, and now held by the Plaintiff by assignment, has/have filed with this court a complaint for determination of Defendant's/Defendants' Servicemembers status.

If you now are, or recently have been, in the active military service of the United States of America, then you may be entitled to the benefits of the Servicemembers Civil Relief Act. If you object to a foreclosure of the above-mentioned property on that basis, then you or your attorney must file a written appearance and answer in this court at Three Pemberton Square, Boston, MA 02108 on or before 11/23/2026 or you may lose the opportunity to challenge the foreclosure on the ground of noncompliance with the Act.

Witness, GORDON H. PIPER Chief Justice of this Court on 10/6/2026.
Attest: Deborah J. Patterson, Recorder

THE COMMONWEALTH OF MASSACHUSETTS:
NOTICE TO CONTRACTORS

The Division of Fisheries and Wildlife invites sealed bids for Tree Clearing at the Southeast Pine Barrens WMA in Plymouth, MA. This project involves furnishing all labor and materials, tools and equipment to conduct clearing of white pine, scots pine, pitch pine, and to create a firebreak, in order to provide important fuel reduction, habitat management, and access improvement work during Fiscal Year 2027 (FY27) on approximately 126 acres at the Southeast Pine Barrens WMA located in Plymouth, Massachusetts. Project shall be completed in accordance with specifications prepared by MassWildlife for project DFW-2027-035. The estimated project value is $225,000.00. Bids shall be submitted on the forms furnished by MassWildlife in the bid package and shall be received at the Division of Fisheries and Wildlife Field Headquarters, 1 Rabbit Hill Road, Westborough, MA 01581, at 10:00 AM, local time, Wednesday, November 4, 2026, at which time they will be publicly opened and read. A mandatory pre-bid meeting will be held onsite Monday, October 26, 2025, at 9:30 AM. All bids must be submitted in accordance with the contract documents and shall be accompanied by a bid deposit in the amount of 5% of the value of the bid. Bid deposits, payable to the Commonwealth of Massachusetts, Division of Fisheries and Wildlife, shall be in the form of a bid bond or certified, cashier's or treasurer's check issued by a responsible bank or trust company. Contract documents will be available after October 14, 2026, at www.commbuys.com, enter DFW-2027-035 in the description field under bid search. Minimum wage rates for this project have been predetermined by M.G.L. under Chapter 149, Section 26 to 27D, inclusive. Proposals that do not have the Affidavit (of non-collusion, etc.) properly completed will be declared informal. Bids are subject to provisions M.G.L. Chapter 30, Sections 39F, 39G, 39H, 39K and 39M and Chapter 149, Sections 44A to 44H, inclusive. The right is reserved to waive any informality in or reject any or all proposals.

By: Eve Schlüter, Director, Division of Fisheries and Wildlife

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The Boston Globe GAMES

Fed's Collins: Another rate hike is likely

By Catarina Saraiva
BLOOMBERG

Federal Reserve Bank of Boston President Susan Collins said interest rates will likely need to rise more before the end of the year to help rein in inflation.

"I also currently expect that it will be appropriate to raise rates a bit further before the end of the year to ensure a timely and durable return of inflation to the Committee's 2 percent target," Collins said in prepared remarks for a banking conference hosted by the Boston Fed on Monday.

Collins cautioned that her view on the need for any additional rate moves, and the timing for that, would depend on incoming data.

The Federal Open Market Committee raised rates by a quarter percentage point in September in a decision backed by all 19 policymakers, according to minutes of that meeting. Chairman Kevin Warsh described the move as removing a "dose of accommodation" in the economy.

In projections released following last month's meeting, the median estimate of 18 Fed officials signaled one more rate hike as likely this year. Officials have said September's rate hike allows the central bank to take time before tightening monetary policy again. Policymakers will meet again Oct. 27-28 in Washington.

Collins says she expects the economy to continue to grow and the labor market to stay near full employment.

"In this scenario, inflation gradually returns to 2 percent, as continued efficiency gains support the balance between demand and supply, and contribute to disinflation," she said.

She warned of two other scenarios that she sees as almost as likely. The demand from artificial intelligence could drive an outsize investment boom that then further boosts household spending, overheats the labor market, and keeps inflation above the Fed's target.

Additionally, price pressures from tariffs and energy, especially if the Iran war continues, might perpetuate inflation challenges, she said.

"It will be important to monitor whether elevated inflation remains largely confined to energy and AI-build-out-related categories, while price growth continues to moderate elsewhere – or whether evidence of price pressures broadens," Collins said.

The Boston Fed chief said current economic strength doesn't indicate that the economy is overheating.

"Rather, I see the strength in real economic activity as reflecting not just strong demand but also an increase in the economy's productive capacity due to efficiency gains," she said.

Celtics extend Pritchard for two additional years

$44.2m extension kicks in for 2028-29

By Adam Himmelsbach
GLOBE STAFF

Payton Pritchard on Tuesday agreed to a two-year, $44.2 million contract extension with the Celtics, a league source confirmed. The deal includes a mutual option in the second season, so both Pritchard and the Celtics would have to opt out for him to become a free agent.

The guard, 28, still has two years remaining on a four-year, $30 million contract, so the extension will not kick in until the start of the 2028-29 season. The deal continues president of basketball operations Brad Stevens's trend of locking up core pieces for multiple seasons.

Former Celtics president of basketball operations Danny Ainge selected Pritchard with the 26th pick of the 2020 draft. He showed promise as a rookie, when he played 19.2 minutes per game and averaged 7.7 points. But his playing time and scoring total dipped in each of the next two seasons, leading him to request a trade midway through his third.

Stevens opted to keep Pritchard and assured him the team had a vision for an expanded role. Initially, Pritchard was skeptical, and he voiced his frustration when he found himself in Boston after the February 2023 trade deadline passed.

CELTICS, Page C3



LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF

Payton Pritchard will see a pay boost from $7.5 million per season to $22.1 million starting in 2028-29.

IT'S A CELEBRATION



MIKE STOBE/GETTY IMAGES

Freddy Peralta pitched six shutout innings, striking out six, to help the Rays beat the Guardians, 3-1, and even the AL Championship Series. **C3**

NFL WEEK 6
JETS AT PATRIOTS
Sunday, 1 p.m., CBS

Maye's stock on the rise

Patriots' QB had his best game of season

By Nicole Yang
GLOBE STAFF

FOXBOROUGH — After the Patriots thoroughly thumped the Raiders, 45-17, let's take a look at who's up, who's down, and whom to watch against the Jets in Week 6 . . .

Three up

1. Quarterback Drake Maye: Sunday was Maye's best game of the season. He passed for 374 yards and four touchdowns, and, perhaps more importantly, had no turnovers. Despite injuries that forced star wide receiver A.J. Brown and veteran Mack Hollins to sit out, Maye had no problem carving up the Raiders' defense. The Patriots averaged a season-high 8.1 yards per play, with Maye completing a season-high 76.5 percent of his passes. It sure looked as though Maye returned to form after a bumpy start to the year.

► The Drake doubt was silly. Shaughnessy, A1

2. Edge rusher Elijah Ponder: The Patriots felt confident about Ponder headed into his second season. Against the Raiders, he delivered. Midway through the second quarter, before the Patriots broke open the game, Ponder sacked Raiders quarterback Kirk Cousins on third down. It took the Raiders out of field goal range and forced them to punt. He got to Cousins again right before halftime, forcing a fumble the Raiders recovered. Ponder's presence on the edge has been one of the biggest bright spots for the defense this season.

PATRIOTS, Page C2

PREVIEWING MEN'S HOCKEY EAST

Breakdown of teams' strengths in a deep league

By Andrew Mahoney
GLOBE STAFF

After sending at least one team to the Frozen Four in five of the previous six seasons, Hockey East didn't win a game in the 2025-26 NCAA Tournament, with Providence, UConn, and Merrimack all exiting in the first round.

Could the league endure a similar fate this year? Those voting in the preseason polls seemed to think so. None of the teams cracked the top eight, with only Providence and UMass ranked in the top 10. But there's no denying the league's depth, with Boston College, Boston University, and UConn all in the top 20, and Merrimack lurking on the fringe.

Here's a look at each team in what the league hopes is a bounce back season.

Boston College (20-15-1 last year): The Eagles narrowly missed the tournament last season, a four-game losing streak to close the regular season ultimately doing them in. James Hagens is skating

HOCKEY EAST PREVIEW, Page C4



GREG M. COOPER/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Louka Cloutier is in line to be Boston College's top goalie for the second straight year.

Bruins get lift from third line

Mittelstadt's production is key

By Jim McBride
GLOBE STAFF

SAN JOSE, Calif. — Casey Mittelstadt arrived in Silicon Valley on a heater.

The left wing on Marco Sturm's reworked third line, Mittelstadt had goals in back-to-back games as the Bruins prepared for a late-night Tuesday date with the Sharks at SAP Center — the expected puck drop was 11:15 p.m. Eastern.

A key cog in Boston's most consistent line last season — the second trio with center Pavel Zacha and right wing Viktor Arvidsson — Mittelstadt is now riding with Elias Lindholm in the middle and James Hagens on the right.

BRUINS, Page C4

BRUINS ON WEST COAST

Swimming with Sharks
For complete coverage of the Bruins' road trip opener in San Jose late Tuesday, go to bostonglobe.com/sports

Football



BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

TreVeyon Henderson didn't return after this second-quarter run on Sunday in Foxborough.

Henderson diagnosed with high ankle sprain

By Nicole Yang
GLOBE STAFF

Patriots running back TreVeyon Henderson will miss time with a high right ankle sprain, a league source confirmed Tuesday.

Henderson was injured in the second quarter of Sunday's 45-17 win while getting tackled by Raiders safety Jeremy Chinn on an 11-yard rush. After the play, Henderson stood up, but stayed on the sidelines while waiting for the assistance of athletic trainers. He noticeably was keeping weight off of his right leg as he made his way to the blue medical tent and then the locker room.

The team initially listed Henderson as questionable to return before downgrading him to out.

Henderson also suffered an ankle injury when he slipped while making a cut during training camp. He was sidelined for almost three weeks, including the season opener.

Without Henderson, the Patriots will be relying on Rhamondre Stevenson to carry the bulk of the workload out of the backfield. Corey Kiner also should be in the mix and Lan Larison, who is on the practice squad, could see additional opportunities.

Through five games, the Patriots have managed significant injuries to multiple offensive players, including wide receivers A.J. Brown (ankle) and Mack Hollins (calf), and right guard Mike Onwenu (ankle).

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Concerns on Doubs, Campbell

▶PATRIOTS
Continued from Page C1

3. Wide receiver DeMario Douglas: Douglas was wide open on both of his touchdown catches and also nabbed an early fourth-down conversion. He finished with his best stat line of the season — four receptions for 65 yards and two scores. Douglas's role has ebbed and flowed throughout his four seasons in New England, but he has maintained a positive attitude. Coach Mike Vrabel gave a postgame shoutout to Douglas and the rest of the receiver room for their unselfishness, saying the entire team needs to adopt that mindset.

Three down

1. Cornerback Marcus Jones: It was a tough matchup for the 5-foot-8-inch Jones, who looked clearly overmatched by Raiders' 6-4 tight end Brock Bowers. According to Pro Football Focus, Bowers caught all three of his targets with Jones in coverage, including a 13-yard touchdown. In his five seasons as a Patriot, Jones has deservedly developed a reputation for playing above his size. But the ultra-talented Bowers was a reminder there are bounds to what he can do.

2. Right tackle Morgan Moses: The 35-year-old deserved credit for suiting up and battling through the foot injury that limited him in practice all week, but his age may be starting to show. Moses allowed a team-high four pressures, including a quarterback hit. He also committed two penalties, holding on a third-down attempt and a false start at the Raiders' 1-yard line. Moses leads the Patriots in penalties, with five.

3. Wide receiver Romeo Doubs: Coming off his best performance of the season in Week 4, Doubs turned in a clunker. He caught just one of his three targets for 16 yards. Both of his drops came in the end zone and hit him right in the hands. He also dropped another ball in the first quarter that hit his hands, but that miscue was nullified when he drew a defensive pass interference penalty, giving the Patriots a fresh set of downs on their five-play, 79-yard scoring drive.

Three to watch

1. Running back Corey Kiner: With TreVeyon Henderson set to miss time because of a high ankle sprain, Kiner likely will see an increased role. Rhamondre Stevenson should still take the majority of carries and third-down snaps, but Kiner could help lighten his workload. Last week, Kiner fumbled on his first carry after Henderson went down and didn't see the ball again until midway through the third quarter. Four of his six carries came in garbage time in the fourth. It will be worth monitoring how much the Patriots involve him, as they also could also turn to Lan Larison off the practice squad.

2. Wide receiver A.J. Brown: After suffering a high ankle sprain in the season opener, Brown is eligible to return off injured reserve. The Patriots have an open roster spot, so they won't need to make a corresponding roster move to activate Brown. Once he returns to practice, they will have 21 days to activate him to the 53-man roster.

3. Left tackle Will Campbell: Campbell exited the game in the second quarter with a knee injury. His availability is uncertain, but a league source confirmed the injury is not considered season-ending. The concerning part is Campbell injured the same knee last season and did not appear to be the same player afterward, but this injury does not seem as serious as last year's MCL sprain.

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NOTEBOOK

Unsealed report revelatory

Raiders' dossier on Flores had 'racial stereotypes'

ASSOCIATED PRESS

A recently unsealed recruiting firm's report on **Brian Flores** had multiple examples of "racial stereotypes" and amounted to unlawful retaliation for the coach's discrimination lawsuit against the NFL, according to his lawyers.

The Korn Ferry report that was made public Tuesday — a copy of which was obtained by The Associated Press — contained a list of six strengths and seven weaknesses which Flores's attorneys said showed the league still used racial stereotypes in hiring and is unlawfully retaliating against the coach for his lawsuit alleging racial discrimination.

The report, which was first published by Front Office Sports, was prepared in connection with the Raiders' coaching vacancy in 2024. Flores, a former Boston College standout who worked as a defensive assistant with the Patriots before going on to become the Dolphins' head coach, is now the Vikings' defensive coordinator.

"The recently unsealed documents demonstrate two unfortunate, but unsurprising, realities," attorney **Michael J. Willemin** wrote in a statement. "First, that Mr. Flores' decision to hold the league and its teams accountable for systemic race discrimination has been met with unlawful retaliation. Second, discrimination continues to play a significant role in the hiring process for NFL Head Coaches, as evidenced by the fact that the candidate profile prepared for the Raiders leans heavily on racial stereotypes."

The NFL didn't immediately respond to a request for comment.

One of the strengths listed says Flores is "polished and a good presenter despite growing up in Brownsville, Brooklyn [same as **Mike Tyson**]. He was able to build a strong friendship with a billionaire's son which gave him opportunities to socialize and learn how to build relationships with white-collar and upper-class individuals."

Brownsville is a predominately Black and Hispanic neighborhood in Brooklyn.

One of the negatives said Flores "can fool you with his polish upwards. Has little people skills, lacks self-awareness and can sometimes exhibit erratic behavior. (Former Dolphins quarterback Tua Tagovailoa's) statements have opened the narrative that Brian was 'pessimistic and adversarial' and his style 'shattered his confidence.' "

Among the negatives was that Flores's ongoing litigation related to the coach's discrimination case against the NFL could cause a distraction.

Flores, who is Black, sued the league and three teams in February 2022, alleging the league was "rife with racism" regarding its hiring practices when it comes to Black coaches.

Flores had recently been fired from his head coaching job with the Dolphins.

He was later joined in the lawsuit by fellow Black coaches **Steve Wilks** and **Ray Horton**.

Bears' DE draws two-game ban

Bears defensive end **Montez Sweat** was suspended for two games for violating the NFL's performance-enhancing substances policy.

The league announced the punishment on Tuesday. The Bears visit the Falcons on Sunday and then host the Patriots on Oct. 22.

The loss of the 6-foot-6-inch Sweat is a big blow for the Bears as they look to bounce back from Sunday's 31-7 loss to the Packers in Green Bay.

He has two of the team's 12 sacks through five games.

Rams cut kicker after debacle

The Rams cut kicker **Harrison Mevis** after he missed two field-goal attempts in a 37-34 overtime loss to the Bills on Monday night, a person with knowledge of the decision said. The Rams (2-3) also are signing former Saints kicker **Blake Grupe** off the Jets' practice squad. The bulky 6-foot Mevis, nicknamed "The Thiccer Kicker," missed an early 50-yard attempt against the Bills, and his 48-yard attempt in overtime was blocked by **Greg Rousseau**. His four missed field-goal attempts through five games are the most in the NFL this season. Head coach **Sean McVay** said afterward the Rams' placekicking unit "cost us the game tonight." . . . Rams left tackle **Alaric Jackson** was suspended for two games without pay for striking Bills linebacker **Bradley Chubb** in the face after their teams' overtime game. Jackson is slated to miss upcoming games against the Cardinals and Raiders . . . Jaguars left tackle **Anton Harrison** will have arthroscopic surgery on his right knee when the team returns from London and miss at least four games . . . Panthers right tackle **Taylor Moton** returned to practice 3½ months after doctors found blood clots in his right lung. Getting Moton back is a boost for the Panthers, who've been dealing with numerous injuries. Carolina opened the 21-day practice windows for Moton, defensive tackle **Turk Wharton**, and running back **Trevor Etienne** to return from injuries. Wide receiver **Jalen Coker** (quadriceps) also was back on the field following the team's bye week.



SCOTT STRAZZANTE/ASSOCIATED PRESS

The Rams cut kicker Harrison Mevis after his bid at a winning 48-yard field goal was blocked.

How did so many, so quickly, decide Drake Maye was an issue?

▶SHAUGHNESSY
Continued from Page A1

back-to-back wins. He was AFC Offensive Player of the Week when he completed 22 of 37 passes and threw for three touchdowns in a season-saving win at the Bills, then came home and completed 26 of 34 for 374 yards and four touchdowns in Sunday's 45-17 rout of the Raiders.

We're all good now with The Drake. Right?

Swell.

I'm still stunned at how bad it got in the days after Jacksonville.

Former Bengals Super Bowl quarterback Boomer Esiason, a fixture on New York's WFAN, went on Boston radio with WEEI's Greg Hill in the hours after Jacksonville and said, "I would make him sit this week. That's how bad it's gotten. . . This has now been habitual for him for about seven games going back to last year."



BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

Drake Maye threw for 374 yards and four TDs vs. the Raiders.

Boomer hardly was alone. For the full week between Jacksonville and Buffalo, national and local sports talk shows were peppered with insistence Maye was a myth, nothing more than Mac Jones 2.0. Less than an hour before the Pats took the field in Buffalo, four-time Super Bowl-winning quarterback Terry Bradshaw capped the madness on Fox, saying he'd consider temporarily benching Maye.

Yikes.

I'm happy to acknowledge my place in New England's pantheon of harsh sports critics. The landscape is littered with the skeleton frames of burned out professional athletes who were torched in this space.

But not when it comes to The Drake. I never lost faith.

Did you?

Maye was his customary fast-talkin', aw-shucks, humble self after he took the Raiders apart.

He was asked about confidence. (Notice how nobody asks him about his shoulder anymore?) Did anything suddenly "click" for him?

"I'm gonna be confident going into every game," he answered. "I'm confident in the guys around me, confident in myself, and I think it's really just an example of practice execution showing up in the game . . . credit the offensive line; [I'm] eating a ham sandwich, so I got all day back there ... I got time just to sit in there and find somebody open."

Smart.

That's a young man saying nice things about his teammates and his coaches. That's what Steve Grogan, Drew Bledsoe, and Tom Brady knew to do.

New England's quarterback is pretty much always this way. The first three weeks, when he was forced to run for his life, we didn't hear Maye complaining about protection. There were no excuses about weapons or targets or Romeo Doubs dropping that pass in Seattle. No words about missing Kayshon Boutte and Stephon Diggs. Or about A.J. Brown being absent due to a Week 1 injury. Or Mack Hollins being suddenly on the shelf.

But there was a sudden shortage of confidence. The indecisive Drake we saw throwing off his back foot (Seattle), making dumb decisions (Travis Hunter!), was not the player we saw all last season.

"It's fun to see Drake smiling on the sideline," linebacker Robert Spillane said Sunday. "That confidence is obviously back."

Mike Vrabel has made the surge of QB doubt a team rallying cry. For consecutive winning weekends, the coach's postgame locker room message to the team (always brought to you by Patriot State TV after wins) included, "We're not taking any more [expletive]!"

Vrabel was asked about this when he addressed the media Monday.

"We're all in the judgment business and we understand what this is," he said. "It's week-to-week. It's day-to-day."

All true. But this was not the time to give up on a 24-year-old quarterback who took you to a Super Bowl in February.

This was not the time for Tommy Cutlets.

Not even close.

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WNBA NOTEBOOK

A parity push is on full display

Valkyries, Dream show good balance

By Julian Benbow
GLOBE STAFF

The Valkyries are well beyond the proof-of-concept stage. The first WNBA expansion franchise to reach the playoffs in its first season fast-tracked to the Finals in its second.

When the Finals open Saturday, the Valkyries will face a Dream team that hasn't been there since 2013, but Atlanta has been gradually climbing to this point the past four seasons.

Neither team was the preseason favorite (that was the Aces) or the regular-season front-runner (that was the Lynx), but they are a product of the competitive balance that the league has been championing for years. This series will crown an eighth distinct WNBA champion in the past 11 seasons.

For years, parity was basically the brand of the NFL and the target for every other league. But the past decade, the rest of the major American leagues have built on that model.

The NBA has had nine different champions over the past 11 seasons, while Major League Soccer has had eight over the past 10. The World Series trophy and Stanley Cup have been raised by seven each.

Meanwhile, the NFL has crowned only six unique champions over its past 10 seasons — the Chiefs, Patriots, Eagles, Rams, Buccaneers, and Seahawks.

Playoff access is different across leagues, of course. Before Golden State became the WNBA's 13th team in 2025, two-thirds made the playoffs. Even with the Valkyries, Tempo and Fire, eight of 15 still get in.

Since 2016, every team outside of this year's expansion squads has reached the playoffs at least once and made at least one semifinals appearance. All but two, the Fever and Wings, have reached the Finals.

With 16 playoff teams, more than half of the NBA reaches the postseason, but the outcomes are different. Every team has made the playoffs at least once, 26 have gotten out of the first round, 19 have reached the conference finals, and 14 teams have reached the Finals.

The NFL expanded its playoff field from 12 (of 32) to 14 teams in 2020, and Major League Baseball went from 10 (of 30) to 14 in 2022.

The only NFL team that hasn't made the playoffs since 2016 is the Jets. All but five have made it to the divisional round, and 20 have reached the conference championship game, but just nine have reached the Super Bowl.

Meanwhile, baseball has two teams (the Angels and Pirates) with postseason droughts spanning further back than 2016. Of the other 28, all but one has won at least one series. Eighteen have reached the championship series, and 13 have reached the World Series.

While the WNBA is the largest it's been since 2002, the spread of talent created one of its most competitive seasons.

Dream going big

The Dream will host Games 3 and 4 of the WNBA Finals at State Farm Arena, allowing for larger attendance, after the league moved one up game a day and altered tipoff of the other to avoid conflicts at the home of the NBA's Hawks.

Game 3 of the best-of-seven series will now be Wednesday, Oct. 21. Tipoff for Game 4 on Saturday, Oct. 24 will be at 1 p.m., 2½ hours before the previously scheduled start time.

The location of the Dream home games had been up in the air because the team wanted to play at State Farm, which seats more than 17,000 fans, as opposed to their normal home, Gateway Center Arena, which holds only 3,500. The Valkyries have sold out every game in their 18,064-seat Chase Center in San Francisco in their two seasons.

Wilson's dominance

The end of **A'ja Wilson's** season was bittersweet. While the Aces were swept by the Valkyries, Wilson was awarded Most Valuable Player for the fifth time.

No one in WNBA history has won more, and only **Wayne Gretzky**, **Kareem Abdul-Jabbar**, **Barry Bonds**, and **Gordie Howe** have won more across major American sports.

Lynx rookie **Olivia Miles** made the race compelling, leading Minnesota to the best regular-season record while averaging 19.8 points, 6.0 assists, and 4.7 rebounds.

But Wilson, as usual, was a runaway winner. The majority of Wilson's MVP wins haven't been close. She was just the second unanimous winner in 2024, took 91 percent of the first-place votes in 2020, 88 in 2026, and 71 in 2025.

The only real race was 2022, when Wilson won 55 percent to **Breanna Stewart's** 41.

Material from the Associated Press was used in this report. Julian Benbow can be reached at julian.benbow@globe.com.



CARLOS AVILA GONZALEZ/SAN FRANCISCO CHRONICLE VIA AP

Gabby Williams (left), Veronica Burton (right), and Golden State shuttled A'ja Wilson out of the playoffs.

Pritchard, Celtics extend two years

▶CELTICS
Continued from Page C1

But those feelings did not last.

Pritchard played all 82 games in 2023-24 and was an essential part of Boston's championship run. He developed a knack and a reputation for fearlessly drilling buzzer-beating shots to end quarters, none bigger than his iconic 43-footer to end the first half of the championship-clinching win in Game 5 against the Mavericks.

The following year, Pritchard averaged 14.3 points and 3.5 assists and was named the NBA's Sixth Man of the Year. Last season he stepped into a larger role following the offseason departure of guard Jrue Holiday and averaged a career-high 17 points per game.

"Everybody always tries to put people in a box, and for every year of my career since I've been young, people put me in this box of like, 'This is the player you can be,' " Pritchard said last month. "And I just feel like, those expectations, I kind of blow them out the water."

. . .

Rookie wing Dillon Mitchell says he didn't really feel nervous before making his Celtics debut in Thursday's preseason win over the Cavaliers. It was partly because once he steps on a court, everything becomes calm and familiar, because of the work that led up to that point.

"Just the confidence that the coaches put in us, the trust we have as teammates all together, and you just go out there and play," Mitchell said. "I know what my role is. I know what my job is to do out there, and that's defend, rebound, and all those things that I've been doing. So just going out there and continuing to do those."

During the Las Vegas Summer League in July, Mitchell showed flashes of the athleticism that convinced the Celtics to draft him in the second round. It was on display in his preseason debut, too.

With most of the Celtics' top rotation players sitting out, Mitchell, a two-way contract player, stepped into a prominent role. He gobbled up rebounds, played disruptive defense, and soared above the rim time and again, including one seven-minute stretch in the fourth quarter in which he threw down three acrobatic dunks.

The first dunk came when he slithered along the left baseline without a defender noticing him, then pointed his finger in the air before finishing an alley-oop off a pass from fellow rookie Milos Uzan. Soon after, he took a few powerful dribbles down the lane on his own and converted another slam. Then he polished off an efficient fast break by completing another alley-oop, this one from Devin Carter.

Mitchell finished with 10 points, 9 rebounds, 4 assists, and 2 steals, but it was not lost on him that he missed his only 3-point attempt. The Celtics are not expecting him to turn into a high-volume perimeter shooter, but Mitchell knows at least becoming a reliable one would help his chances for meaningful playing time during the regular season.

During his four-year college career, he made just 11 of 57 3-pointers, including 1 for 15 as a senior at St. John's last season.

"I think the biggest thing is just the consistency of it," Mitchell said. "Every day, no matter what's going on, we make sure to get our work in. Even on long days, we try to get something in, whether it's 15 minutes [or longer]. But it's been really good, just working on the fundamentals, working on the form, shooting on the way up, just the confidence. But it's been good. It's been consistent."

Mitchell has tweaked his shooting form and acknowledged that altering mechanics can be disruptive, both mentally and physically. But he said he already is becoming comfortable making real-time adjustments, an important step.

"I think it's gotten to the point where I can fix it myself if I feel during the workout I may be going back to old habits or bad habits," he said.

Mitchell also is embracing that he has more resources than ever before. In addition to the massive staff of coaches and player development assistants, Mitchell is now able to soak up knowledge from superstars such as Jayson Tatum and Paul George.

"I just sit back and try to learn as much as I can," he said. "Listen to some of the older guys, listen to [coach] Joe [Mazzulla] and just try to learn as much as I can. Take it all in and understand what they say. Understand the concepts that they talk about. Understand their perspective and how they see things on the court. So that's the biggest thing I can do as a younger player."

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MIKE STOBE/GETTY IMAGES

Guardians third baseman Jose Ramírez reacted after his fielding error allowed the Rays' Victor Mesa Jr. to break a scoreless tie in the fourth inning of Game 2.

BASEBALL NOTEBOOK

Peralta, Rays even up with Guardians

ASSCOIATED PRESS

Freddy Peralta threw six innings of four-hit ball, **Liam Hicks** lined a two-run single after a fielding error by **José Ramírez**, and the Rays beat the Guardians, 3-1, Tuesday night to even the AL Championship Series at 1-1.

Game 3 of the best-of-seven series is Thursday night in Cleveland.

Ramírez, whose two-run homer in Game 5 of their AL Division Series against Chicago helped the Guardians become the 11th team to overcome an 0-2 deficit in a best-of-five series, misplayed a grounder in the fourth inning that led to three unearned runs against rookie lefty **Parker Messick**.

Junior Caminero walked to start that inning and **Victor Mesa Jr.** grounded into a forceout originally ruled a double play. The Rays challenged the calls at both first and second, and Mesa was ruled safe when a video review overturned the out decision by first base umpire **Mark Ripperger**.

After **Jonny DeLuca** struck out, **Chandler Simpson** beat out a high chopper to shortstop, and Mesa easily reached third when Ramírez failed to cover the bag.

Ben Williamson followed with a grounder that scooted underneath Ramírez's glove and between his legs after the ball hit the edge where the artificial turf met the infield dirt. The third baseman played back rather than charging.

"It's a little bit faster here with the surface and I was playing parallel to the base," Ramírez said through a translator. "The ball bounced right on the edge between the dirt and the turf, and that's what made it a little more difficult for me. I tried to knock it down."

Williamson reached second and Simpson went to third. Hicks drove the next pitch to right-center for a 3-0 lead, electrifying the towel-waving, cowbell-ringing crowd of 32,125 fans at Tropicana Field.

"They've done that all year. When they smell blood, they take it and run," Guardians manager **Stephen Vogt** said. "We had some sloppy plays in the field that we need to clean up."

With fans chanting "Freddy! Freddy! Freddy!" Peralta struck out six to earn the win. He was fired up walking off the mound in the sixth after fanning **Petey Halpin** swinging at a 3-2 changeup.

Kevin Kelly got two outs in the seventh, retiring Ramírez on a fly ball to center with two runners on.

Westborough native **Ian Seymour** replaced him and **Chase DeLauter** lined an RBI double to the right-field corner.

Seymour struck out **Jo Adell** swinging at a changeup, leaving runners at second and third. Seymour pitched a 1-2-3 eighth and **Bryan Baker** finished with a perfect ninth for his fourth postseason save.

Acquired by the Rays from the Mets at the trade deadline, Peralta turned around his season in Tampa Bay going 5-2 with a 3.25 ERA in 10 starts after posting a 4.99 ERA for New York.

Messick, who grew up going to Rays games at the Trop, took the loss after giving up six hits and the three unearned runs in five innings.

Cleveland had won four straight in the postseason for the first time since winning their first six playoff games in 2016 on the way to a World Series berth.

Ohtani is a go for Game 3

Shohei Ohtani will be in the Dodgers' lineup for Game 3 of the National League Championship Series against the Brewers Wednesday night in Los Angeles.

Manager **Dave Roberts** said Ohtani will bat anywhere from second to sixth with the two-time defending World Series champion Dodgers losing the first two games of the best-of-seven series.

"He was very convicted that he is onto something mechanically [with his swing]," Roberts said. "He was adamant that he can help us. He's well enough to help us win a baseball game, so that's all I needed to hear."

Ohtani is hitting .150 (3 for 20) over six postseason games. He has seven strikeouts, three walks and one stolen base with no home runs, no RBIs, and an OPS of .411.

Ohtani admitted before the NLDS against Atlanta that he's not 100 percent healthy from right biceps and left knee issues. He has appeared visibly uncomfortable at the plate while flailing at pitches.

"The symptoms have subdued a lot," Ohtani said through a translator. "The symptoms shouldn't be the reason why I can't hit, and even if the injuries happen by accident, I take full responsibility."

RAYS 3, GUARDIANS 1

CLEVELAND	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.
Kwan lf-cf	5	0	2	0	0	0	.300
Ramírez 3b	4	0	1	0	0	0	.444
DeLauter dh	2	0	1	1	2	1	.667
Adell rf	4	0	0	0	0	1	.111
Lowe 1b	4	0	0	0	0	2	.222
Bazzana 2b	4	0	1	0	0	0	.250
Halpin cf	3	0	1	0	0	2	.200
Martínez ph-lf	1	0	0	0	0	1	.333
Hedges c	1	0	0	0	0	0	.000
Bailey ph-c	1	1	0	0	1	1	.400
Rocchio ss	4	0	0	0	0	1	.000
Totals	**33**	**1**	**6**	**1**	**3**	**9**	

TAMPA BAY	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.
Díaz dh	4	0	0	0	0	1	.222
Aranda 1b	3	0	0	0	0	0	.000
Caminero 3b	3	0	1	0	1	1	.286
Mesa Jr. rf	4	1	0	0	0	2	.125
DeLuca cf	4	0	2	0	0	1	.500
Simpson lf	3	1	1	0	0	0	.250
Williamson 2b	1	1	0	0	1	0	.000
Palacios ph-2b	1	0	0	0	0	0	.000
Hicks c	3	0	2	2	0	0	.400
Walls ss	3	0	1	0	0	1	.167
Totals	**29**	**3**	**7**	**2**	**2**	**6**	

Cleveland ..... 000 000 100 — 1 6 1
Tampa Bay ..... 000 300 00x — 3 7 0

E—Ramírez (1). **LOB**—Cleveland 9, Tampa Bay 5. **2B**—DeLauter (2), Caminero (1). **SB**—Ramírez (1). **DP**—Cleveland 2.

Cleveland	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA
Messick L 0-1	5	6	3	0	2	3	0.00
Armstrong	1⅔	1	0	0	0	1	0.00
Herrin	⅓	0	0	0	0	0	0.00
Cecconi	1	0	0	0	0	2	0.00

Tampa Bay	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA
Peralta W 1-0	6	4	0	0	2	6	0.00
Kelly	⅔	1	1	1	1	0	9.00
Seymour	1⅓	1	0	0	0	2	0.00
Baker S 1	1	0	0	0	0	1	0.00

Inherited runners-scored—Seymour 2-1. **HBP**—by Messick (Aranda), by Peralta (Hedges). **WP**—Peralta. **NP**—Messick 82, Armstrong 20, Herrin 6, Cecconi 16, Peralta 99, Kelly 17, Seymour 15, Baker 8. **Umpires**—Home, Carlos Torres; First, Mark Ripperger; Second, Jordan Baker; Third, Chad Fairchild; Left, Adam Hamari; Right, Nestor Ceja. **T**—2:42. **A**—32,125 (25,025).

Baseball playoffs

League Championship Series

American League

CLEVELAND VS. TAMPA BAY

Series tied, 1-1
Monday, Oct. 12
Cleveland 7 ..... at Tampa Bay 3
Tuesday, Oct. 13
At Tampa Bay 3 ..... Cleveland 1
Schedule
Thursday at Cleveland 6
Friday at Cleveland 6
Saturday at Cleveland 8
*Monday at Tampa Bay 5
*Tuesday at Tampa Bay 8

National League

LA DODGERS VS. MILWAUKEE

Brewers lead series, 2-0
Sunday, Oct. 11
At Milwaukee 2 ..... LA Dodgers 1
Monday, Oct. 12
At Milwaukee 7 ..... LA Dodgers 4
Schedule
Wednesday at LA Dodgers 8
Thursday at LA Dodgers 9
*Friday at LA Dodgers 9
*Sunday at Milwaukee 8
*Monday at Milwaukee 8

* If necessary

WEDNESDAY'S GAME

	Odds	2026 W-L	2026 ERA	Team rec.	vs. opp W-L	vs. opp IP	vs. opp ERA	Last 3 starts W-L	Last 3 starts IP	Last 3 starts ERA
MILWAUKEE AT LA DODGERS, 8 p.m.										
Gasser (L)	+145	5-5	3.87	14-7	0-2	10.2	5.91	1-0	17.0	1.06
Snell (L)	-170	4-1	1.90	6-4	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-0	8.2	2.08

Team rec. — Record in games started by pitcher this season

NHL

EASTERN CONFERENCE

ATLANTIC	GP	W	L	OL	Pts.	ROW	GF	GA
Ottawa	7	5	2	0	10	4	21	19
Tampa Bay	6	4	2	0	8	4	17	16
*Boston	6	4	2	0	8	4	20	13
Florida	7	3	2	2	8	3	19	20
Montreal	6	3	2	1	7	1	19	22
Toronto	7	3	3	1	7	3	24	23
Buffalo	7	3	3	1	7	3	19	26
Detroit	6	1	3	2	4	1	14	20
METROPOLITAN	**GP**	**W**	**L**	**OL**	**Pts.**	**ROW**	**GF**	**GA**
Carolina	8	6	1	1	13	6	31	19
NY Rangers	8	6	2	0	12	6	27	14
Pittsburgh	7	3	3	1	7	2	25	22
NY Islanders	6	3	3	0	6	3	19	15
Washington	6	3	3	0	6	3	19	18
New Jersey	6	3	3	0	6	3	16	22
Columbus	5	2	3	0	4	1	16	21
Philadelphia	8	0	5	3	3	0	10	31

WESTERN CONFERENCE

CENTRAL	GP	W	L	OL	Pts.	ROW	GF	GA
Utah	7	5	2	0	10	5	27	19
Winnipeg	6	4	1	1	9	4	18	17
Minnesota	7	4	2	1	9	4	21	16
Colorado	6	4	2	0	8	4	29	19
St. Louis	6	3	2	1	7	3	21	18
Nashville	6	2	2	2	6	2	16	19
Dallas	6	2	3	1	5	2	13	11
Chicago	7	2	5	0	4	2	17	29
PACIFIC	**GP**	**W**	**L**	**OL**	**Pts.**	**ROW**	**GF**	**GA**
Vegas	8	6	2	0	12	5	30	20
Seattle	7	5	2	0	10	4	29	19
*Edmonton	5	4	0	1	9	4	25	17
*Anaheim	5	4	1	0	8	4	18	13
*San Jose	5	3	2	0	6	3	13	17
Vancouver	8	2	6	0	4	2	26	38
*Los Angeles	4	0	2	2	2	0	10	17
*Calgary	5	0	5	0	0	0	8	27

* — Not including late game; ROW — Regulation plus overtime wins

TUESDAY'S RESULTS

Boston	at San Jose	At NY Islanders 3	Vancouver 2
New Jersey 5	at Detroit 4 (OT)	At Chicago 5	Pittsburgh 3
Florida 7	at Columbus 3	At Winnipeg 5	Minnesota 2
At Montreal 4	Buffalo 3 (SO)	Colorado 3	at Dallas 2
At Carolina 4	Washington 2	Vegas 5	at Nashville 2
Seattle 3	at Philadelphia 2 (SO)	At Utah 5	Toronto 4
At NY Rangers 4	Tampa Bay 1	Calgary	at Anaheim
St. Louis 7	at Ottawa 2	Edmonton	at Los Angeles

WEDNESDAY'S GAMES

Montreal at Washington	7:30	Dallas at Colorado	8:30

MONDAY'S RESULTS

At Buffalo 5	Florida 3	At Minnesota 4	Vegas 2
Ottawa 4	at New Jersey 1		

CANADIENS 4, SABRES 3

Buffalo	1	0	2	0	— 3
Montreal	1	2	0	0	— 4

Canadiens win shootout, 3-1

First — 1. Buffalo, Zellweger 1 (Samuelsson, Malenstyn), 2:16. 2. Montreal, Hutson 1 (Slafkovsky, Caufield), 14:28 (pp). Penalties — MTL, served by Kreider (too many men), 8:25. Zellweger, BUF (tripping), 12:36. Crevier, BUF (delay of game), 13:33. Dach, MTL (holding), 15:15.

Second — 3. Montreal, Caufield 3 (Slafkovsky, Suzuki), 1:19. 4. Montreal, Anderson 2 (Hutson, Bolduc), 19:10. Penalties — Kreider, MTL (holding stick), 1:47. Newhook, MTL (hooking), 6:56. Danforth, BUF (interference), 14:42.

Third — 5. Buffalo, Norris 1 (Gilbert, Malenstyn), 4:24. 6. Buffalo, Zellweger 2 (Benson, Samuelsson), 5:25. Penalties — Anderson, MTL (roughing), 9:12. Krebs, BUF (roughing), 9:12.

OT — None. Penalties — Slafkovsky, MTL (holding), 4:27.

Shootout — Buffalo 1 (Thompson G, Quinn NG). Montreal 3 (Caufield G, Texier G, Bolduc G)

Shots — Buffalo 7-2-8-0 — 17. Montreal 11-11-11-5 — 38. Power plays — Buffalo 0-5; Montreal 1-3. Goalies — Buffalo, Luukkonen 2-2-1 (38 shots-35 saves). Montreal, Fowler 2-1-0 (17 shots-14 saves).

A — 20,962 (21,273). T — 2:48.

BLUES 7, SENATORS 2

St. Louis	1	2	4	—	7
Ottawa	0	1	1	—	2

First — 1. St. Louis, Suter 2 (Parayko, Buchnevich), 14:28. Penalties — Spence, OTT (holding), 4:15. Fowler, STL (holding), 13:28. Carlo, STL (high stick), 17:26.

Second — 2. St. Louis, Neighbours 2 (Thomas, Holloway), 13:20. 3. Ottawa, Giroux 1 (Stuetzle, Batherson), 17:52. 4. St. Louis, McTavish 3 (Berggren, McMichael), 18:25. Penalties — Parayko, STL (tripping), 3:31. Stanley, OTT (holding), 14:06.

Third — 5. St. Louis, Suter 3 (Johnston, Carlo), 7:54. 6. St. Louis, Neighbours 3 (Buchnevich, Fowler), 14:46. 7. St. Louis, McTavish 4 (McMichael, Buchnevich), 15:33 (pp). 8. St. Louis, Jiricek 1 (Suter, McTavish), 16:32. 9. Ottawa, Zetterlund 1 (Halliday, Pinto), 18:33 (pp). Penalties — Peterson, STL, major (fighting), 14:52. Donovan, OTT, major (fighting), 14:52. Foegele, OTT (delay of game), 14:52. Broberg, STL (hooking), 16:41.

Shots — St. Louis 5-12-9 — 26. Ottawa 8-4-5 — 17. Power plays — St. Louis 1-3; Ottawa 1-4. Goalies — St. Louis, Hofer 2-1-1 (17 shots-15 saves). Ottawa, Ersson 0-2-0 (26 shots-19 saves).

A — 14,085 (19,153). T — 2:31.

ISLANDERS 3, CANUCKS 2

Vancouver	0	2	0	—	2
NY Islanders	2	0	1	—	3

First — 1. NY, Palmieri 1 (Kessel, Horvat), 14:57. 2. NY, Maccelli 1 (Schaefer), 15:50. Penalties — Schenn, NY (high stick), 6:04. Stanley, NY (holding), 11:42. Schenn, VAN (tripping), 19:09.

Second — 3. Van., Sasson 2 (Bains, Oleksiak), 7:52. 4. Van., Boeser 2 (EliasPettersson, Hronek), 18:55 (pp). Penalties — Elias Pettersson, VAN (tripping), 8:55. Palmieri, NY (tripping), 17:28. DeAngelo, NY (roughing), 20:00.

Third — 5. NY, Palmieri 2 (Maccelli, Schaefer), 5:38. Penalties — Buium, VAN (hooking), 18:19. O'Connor, VAN (roughing), 18:46. Stanley, NY (roughing), 18:46. Pelech, NY (tripping), 19:41.

Shots — Vancouver 7-11-7 — 25. NY 12-7-19 — 38. Power plays — Vancouver 1-4; NY 0-3. Goalies — Vancouver, Merilainen 1-1-0 (38 shots-35 saves). NY, Sorokin 3-2-0 (25 shots-23 saves).

A — 13,647 (17,113). T — 2:28.

KRAKEN 3, FLYERS 2

Seattle	1	1	0	0	— 3
Philadelphia	0	0	2	0	— 2

Kraken win shootout, 2-1

First — 1. Seattle, McMann 3 (Eberle, Stephenson), 7:57 (pp). Penalties — Studnicka, PHI (tripping), 6:35. Eberle, SEA (slashing), 16:52.

Second — 2. Seattle, Ottavainen 1 (Samoskevich, Mahura), 8:54. Penalties — Eberle, SEA (hooking), 9:32. Zegras, PHI (slashing), 14:00. Cates, PHI (tripping), 15:22. Grubauer, SEA, served by McCann (roughing), 16:08. Zegras, PHI (roughing), 16:08.

Third — 3. Phila., Dvorak 2 (Bonk, Vladar), 6:07. 4. Phila.,, Zegras 1 (Sanheim, Tippett), 7:20. Penalties — Drysdale, PHI (interference), 6:28. McMann, SEA (holding stick), 6:42.

OT — None. Penalties — PHI, served by Michkov (too many men), 2:21.

Shootout — Seattle 2 (Beniers G, Catton NG, Gaudreau NG, Samoskevich NG, McMann G). Phila. 1 (Zegras NG, Michkov G, Foerster NG, Martone NG, Barkey NG)

Shots — Seattle 6-10-10-5 — 31. Phila. 6-12-8-0 — 26. Power plays — Seattle 1-5; Phila. 0-3. Goalies — Seattle, Grubauer 2-1-0 (26 shots-24 saves). Phila., Vladar 0-3-1 (31 shots-29 saves).

A — 17,851 (19,523). T — 2:54.

HURRICANES 4, CAPITALS 2

Washington	1	1	0	—	2
Carolina	0	2	2	—	4

First — 1. Wash., Jenner 3 (Leonard), 9:26. Penalties — Chychrun, WSH (tripping), 3:18. Carrier, CAR (interference), 3:18. Deslauriers, CAR (cross check), 17:27. Svechnikov, CAR (roughing), 19:13.

Second — 2. Carolina, Svechnikov 5 (Carrier, Aho), 3:58. 3. Wash., Holl 1 (Strome, Leonard), 6:39. 4. Carolina, Robinson 2 (Blake, Walker), 18:49. Penalties — WSH, served by Ovechkin (delay of game), 3:58. Hutson, WSH (delay of game), 10:45. Leonard, WSH (roughing), 18:49. Blake, CAR (roughing), 18:49. Chychrun, WSH (hooking), 19:25.

Third — 5. Carolina, Svechnikov 6 (Ehlers), 13:56 (pp). 6. Carolina, Jankowski 5 (Svechnikov, Aho), 18:33 (en). Penalties — Leonard, WSH (slashing), 7:12. Sourdif, WSH (tripping), 13:49.

Shots — Wash. 10-6-6 — 22. Carolina 8-16-11 — 35. Power plays — Wash. 0-2; Carolina 1-5. Goalies — Wash., Thompson 3-2-0 (34 shots-31 saves). Carolina, Kochetkov 4-0-0 (22 shots-20 saves).

A — 18,828 (18,680). T — 2:35.

RANGERS 4, LIGHTNING 1

Tampa Bay	1	0	0	—	1
NY Rangers	2	1	1	—	4

First — 1. NY, Lafreniere 6 (Kartye, Fox), 1:02. 2. NY, Lafreniere 7 (Kartye, Miller), 12:47. 3. Tampa, Girgensons 1 (Holmberg, Hedman), 17:26. Penalties — Carlson, TB (slashing), 3:03. Viel, TB (hooking), 7:54. Fox, NY (holding), 8:57. Viel, TB, major (fighting), 14:17. Rempe, NY, major (fighting), 14:17.

Second — 4. NY, Cuylle 3 (Durzi, Pettersson), 18:26. Penalties — Cernak, TB (tripping), 0:42. Schneider, NY (hooking), 4:28.

Third — 5. NY, Zibanejad 2, 17:16 (en). Penalties — Durzi, NY (cross check), 0:29. Cirelli, TB (slashing), 1:57. Kartye, NY (interference), 15:34.

Shots — TB 9-9-8 — 26. NY 8-9-6 — 23. Power plays — TB 0-4; NY 0-4. Goalies — TB, Vasilevskiy 3-2-0 (22 shots-19 saves). NY, Garand 3-1-0 (26 shots-25 saves).

A — 17,076 (18,200). T — 2:32.

AVALANCHE 3, STARS 2

Colorado	1	2	0	—	3
Dallas	1	0	1	—	2

First period — 1. Colorado, Lehkonen 4 (MacKinnon, Manson), 11:32. 2. Dallas, Seguin 2 (Robertson, Heiskanen), 19:06 (pp). Penalties — Malinski, COL (roughing), 13:07. Blackwell, DAL (roughing), 13:07. Svechkov, COL (misconduct), 17:44. Svechkov, COL, served by Schwartz (instigator), 17:44. Faksa, DAL, major (fighting), 17:44. Svechkov, COL, major (fighting), 17:44.

Second period — 3. Colorado, Necas 3 (MacKinnon, Roy), 3:05. 4. Colorado, Necas 4 (Landeskog, Toews), 16:14 (pp). Penalties — MacKinnon, COL, major (fighting), 6:46. Hintz, DAL, major (fighting), 6:46. Capobianco, DAL (cross check), 14:18. Faksa, DAL (tripping), 15:52.

Third period — 5. Dallas, Hintz 2 (Seguin, Heiskanen), 3:17. Penalties — Harley, DAL (holding), 4:50.

Shots on goal — Colorado 9-10-6 — 25. Dallas 13-10-3 — 26.

Power plays — Colorado 1-3; Dallas 1-1.

Goalies — Colorado, Blackwood 3-2-0 (26 shots-24 saves). Dallas, Oettinger 2-2-1 (25 shots-22 saves).

A — 18,532 (18,532). T — 2:37.

GOLDEN KNIGHTS 5, PREDATORS 2

Vegas	2	1	2	—	5
Nashville	1	1	0	—	2

First period — 1. Nashville, O'Reilly 2 (Forsberg), 3:55. 2. Vegas, Hertl 4 (Lavoie, Howden), 6:46. 3. Vegas, Eichel 4 (McNabb), 12:48. Penalties — Howden, VGK (interference), 4:36. Barbashev, VGK (holding), 10:44.

Second period — 4. Nashville, AEdstrom 3 (Hague, O'Reilly), 8:45. 5. Vegas, Karlsson 2 (Marner, Andersson), 17:44. Penalties — Wilsby, NSH (hooking), 7:41.

Third period — 6. Vegas, Connelly 3 (Hanifin, Coghlan), 4:49. 7. Vegas, Howden 2 (Andersson, Stone), 6:24. Penalties — Marner, VGK (hooking), 1:07. Hoglander, NSH (cross check), 9:03.

Shots on goal — Vegas 9-8-8 — 25. Nashville 11-7-9 — 27.

Power plays — Vegas 0-2; Nashville 0-3.

Goalies — Vegas, Hill 3-0-0 (27 shots-25 saves). Nashville, Saros 2-2-1 (25 shots-20 saves).

A — 17,229 (17,113). T — 2:25.

JETS 5, WILD 2

Minnesota	2	0	0	—	2
Winnipeg	2	1	2	—	5

First period — 1. Winnipeg, Perfetti 4 (Pionk, Scheifele), 1:50. 2. Minnesota, Kaprizov 7, 8:47. 3. Winnipeg, Scheifele 1 (Pionk, Connor), 17:54. 4. Minnesota, Kaprizov 8 (Hughes, Brodin), 18:38. Penalties — Niederreiter, WPG (slashing), 9:37.

Second period — 5. Winnipeg, Perfetti 5 (Vilardi, Scheifele), 16:36 (pp). Penalties — Perfetti, WPG (hooking), 5:24. Brink, MIN (hooking), 16:05. Hunt, MIN (holding), 17:28.

Third period — 6. Winnipeg, Connor 7, 4:06. 7. Winnipeg, Koepke 1 (Namestnikov), 14:42. Penalties — None.

Shots on goal — Minnesota 13-3-5 — 21. Winnipeg 7-13-5 — 25.

Power plays — Minnesota 0-2; Winnipeg 1-2.

Goalies — Minnesota, Pickard 0-1-0 (25 shots-20 saves). Winnipeg, Skinner 3-0-1 (21 shots-19 saves).

A — 14,108 (15,294). T — 2:25.

BLACKHAWKS 5, PENGUINS 3

Pittsburgh	1	1	1	—	3
Chicago	2	1	2	—	5

First period — 1. Chicago, Teravainen 1 (Frondell, Bertuzzi), 0:28. 2. Pittsburgh, Crosby 1 (Karlsson), 6:57. 3. Chicago, Kantserov 2 (Bedard, Byram), 17:50 (pp). Penalties — Smith, CHI (tripping), 12:49. Letang, PIT (interference), 16:51. Byram, CHI (hooking), 18:25.

Second period — 4. Chicago, Kantserov 3 (Levshunov, Kane), 10:32. 5. Pittsburgh, Robertson 4 (Lizotte, Karlsson), 17:51. Penalties — Kane, CHI (hooking), 2:08.

Third period — 6. Pittsburgh, Crosby 2 (Dewar, Girard), 9:17. 7. Chicago, Teravainen 2 (Greene, Smith), 15:42. 8. Chicago, Bertuzzi 2 (Frondell, Teravainen), 19:50 (en). Penalties — Byram, CHI (slashing), 6:09. Chinakhov, PIT (interference), 9:54.

Shots on goal — Pittsburgh 7-12-8 — 27. Chicago 9-6-5 — 20.

Power plays — Pittsburgh 0-4; Chicago 1-2.

Goalies — Pittsburgh, Murashov 0-2-1 (19 shots-15 saves). Chicago, Knight 2-3-0 (27 shots-24 saves).

A — 17,609 (19,717). T — 2:31.

PANTHERS 7, BLUE JACKETS 3

Florida	0	4	3	—	7
Columbus	1	0	2	—	3

First period — 1. Columbus, Johnson 3, 14:11. Penalties — MaTkachuk, FLA (hooking), 9:54.

Second period — 2. Florida, BrTkachuk 1 (MaTkachuk), 2:27. 3. Florida, BrTkachuk 2 (MaTkachuk, Jones), 6:00 (pp). 4. Florida, BrTkachuk 3 (Reinhart, MaTkachuk), 10:30 (pp). 5. Florida, Verhaeghe 2 (BrTkachuk, MaTkachuk), 17:50 (pp). Penalties — Severson, CBJ (interference), 5:14. Monahan, CBJ (hooking), 9:54. Forsling, FLA (tripping), 11:07. Mikkola, FLA (roughing), 11:19. Coyle, CBJ (roughing), 11:19. Olivier, CBJ, served by Voronkov, major (slashing), 13:44. Olivier, CBJ (game misconduct), 13:44. Soucy, CBJ (high stick), 19:44.

Third period — 6. Florida, Reinhart 3 (MaTkachuk, Jones), 1:20 (pp). 7. Florida, Verhaeghe 3 (Eller, Jones), 3:28. 8. Columbus, Mateychuk 1 (Severson, Nichushkin), 13:47. 9. Columbus, CSillinger 3 (Coyle, Severson), 14:09. 10. Florida, Reinhart 4 (Lundell, Jones), 17:43 (en). Penalties — Severson, CBJ (hooking), 10:11.

Shots on goal — Florida 10-9-9 — 28. Columbus 8-5-14 — 27.

Power plays — Florida 4-6; Columbus 0-2.

Goalies — Florida, Schmid 1-1-1 (27 shots-24 saves). Columbus, Greaves 1-2-0 (4 shots-4 saves). Columbus, Talbot 1-1-0 (23 shots-17 saves).

A — 13,538 (18,144). T — 2:40.

DEVILS 5, RED WINGS 4

New Jersey	1	3	0	1	— 5
Detroit	1	2	1	0	— 4

First period — 1. New Jersey, Rodrigues 1 (Noesen, Mantha), 6:07. 2. Detroit, Finnie 2 (Brandsegg-Nygard, AnJohansson), 18:35. Penalties — None.

Second period — 3. Detroit, Brandsegg-Nygard 2 (Finnie, DeBrincat), 1:43. 4. New Jersey, Mantha 1 (Mercer, Rodrigues), 7:03. 5. New Jersey, Hischier 3 (Bratt, JHughes), 10:16 (pp). 6. Detroit, DeBrincat 3 (Sandin-Pellikka, Faulk), 15:10. 7. New Jersey, Bratt 2 (Siegenthaler, JHughes), 16:52. Penalties — Kolesar, DET (hooking), 9:30. Lombardi, NJD (hooking), 17:54.

Third period — 8. Detroit, DeBrincat 4 (Seider, Chiarot), 5:46. Penalties — None.

Overtime — 9. New Jersey, JHughes 2 (Bratt), 1:19. Penalties — None.

Shots on goal — New Jersey 15-15-6-1 — 37. Detroit 3-11-12-0 — 26.

Power plays — New Jersey 1-1; Detroit 0-1.

Goalies — New Jersey, Allen 3-1-0 (26 shots-22 saves). Detroit, Gibson 1-3-1 (37 shots-32 saves).

A — 18,306 (20,000). T — 2:27.

Mittelstadt boosts Bruins' third line

▶BRUINS
Continued from Page C1

It's been a small sample size, but the line is thriving.

"I think we're just playing fast and playing simple when we need to play simple and making plays when plays are there," Mittelstadt said following the club's morning skate. "I think we jell pretty well. I feel like me and Hages see the game pretty similarly, and obviously Lindy's been around for a long time and does a heck of a job in the middle. Some good things to build on and try to keep it going."

So far, so good, according to Sturm, who has acknowledged that because of the shortened training camp and preseason, line tinkering is expected in the early going.

"They've been pretty good. I mean, I always try to find somebody also who can give us a little bit of shutdown mentality, too, against some really good lines, but also able to score some goals," said the Bruins coach. "I think going into that decision, we thought that [combination] could be a good mix. And so far at home, I used Lindy and [Fraser] Minten for the most part against [the opponent's] top line. It worked well.

"We'll just have to continue to get some more reps. But the start, definitely the first two games were pretty good."

Mittelstadt has played a lot at center in his career, and he said that has given him a unique perspective as a winger. Hagens, too, grew up playing center, so in essence that third line features three players with pivot mentalities.

"I feel like Hages is good on the walls and wants to make plays in the neutral zone and kind of attack that way," said Mittelstadt. "When I played center, I always liked having a guy on my wing who had played a lot of center. I feel like it helps you out quite a bit. And I think it helps you see the game just like each other."

Since taking over behind the Bruins bench, Sturm has seen Mittelstadt's 200-foot game improve by leaps and bounds.

"When I got hired, he was always, I felt, like that big offensive guy. And maybe it's my fault I turned him into a little bit of a two-way guy, but I think it just fits him better," said Sturm. "He's just very crafty. He's good on his stick. He's good on the wall, can play both ways. There's a lot of good things in his game."

Mittelstadt was in agreement with Sturm's assessment.

"Hopefully, I guess," he said with a smile. "I think obviously I played center for a long time, and I think playing center and now playing wing and having that experience at center helps me, too, a lot. Maybe I wasn't the best defensive center, but I feel like I tried for sure and I think that helps playing the wing. I can see the game through Lindy's eyes a little bit and help him out. So, I would like to believe that's true."

Mittelstadt called Hagens "awesome" and has enjoyed serving as both a linemate and mentor to the rookie.

"I think he's a heck of a player. I don't think he needs to do a ton of settling and just keep focusing and playing the game," he said. "Obviously mistakes will be made, but the quicker you can learn from them and move on, I think the better. And I think that's been the messaging from me and Lindy: just go play, we all make mistakes, just cover for each other when you do."

Mittelstadt is paying it forward after Sabres veterans Kyle Okposo and Jeff Skinner guided him as he cut his NHL teeth.

"Early in my career, I think Jeff Skinner took me under his wing a lot. I just kind of hung around him and obviously a thousand games and a lot of goals scored," said Mittelstadt. "He taught me a lot and then I feel like it kind of evolved into Okie in the last few years. He's a [fellow] Minnesota guy and has a familiar background. I mean, he's a world class guy. . . . I was very honored and lucky to have those guys."

. . .

The late starting time — an insomniac's dream (how's that for an oxymoron?) — was because of the NHL's "Frozen Frenzy," in which all 32 NHL teams played and were televised on ESPN and/or ESPN+ . . . Hagens said Sharks winger and fellow Boston College alum Will Smith "is a good buddy of mine." They became friends during the recruiting process . . . Jeremy Swayman got the start in net. Backup Michael DiPietro's next game likely will be against the Ducks (Friday) or Kings (Saturday).

Jim McBride can be reached at james.mcbride@globe.com. Follow him @globejimmcbride.

Hockey East again eyeing national stage

▶HOCKEY EAST PREVIEW
Continued from Page C1

for the Bruins now, but junior Dean Letourneau is back, as are classmates Jake Sondreal and Teddy Stiga. Sophomore Louka Cloutier returns in net, where he figures to be challenged by freshman Leo Henriquez, a sixth-round draft pick by the Bruins last June. Oscar Hemming, selected 14th by the Blue Jackets in June, is back for his sophomore season.

Boston University (17-17-2): After reaching the Frozen Four three years in a row, the Terriers took a step back last season and did not qualify for the tournament. BU enters the season with the youngest roster in the country. Caleb Malhotra, the third pick in the 2026 NHL Draft, headlines an impressive six-man freshman class that includes three second-round picks the last two years. Sophomore Tynan Lawrence is back after getting selected 11th by the Blues, while Mikhail Yegorev will be back in goal for his junior season.

UConn (20-13-5): The Huskies reached the tournament for the second straight year, but saw their season come to an end with a 2-1 loss to Michigan State. Ryan Tattle, whose 32 points led last year's squad, is skating in the AHL with the Providence Bruins now, but leading goal scorer Joey Muldowney is back for his senior season and will serve as captain. The big question is in goal, where freshman Veeti Louhivaara and sophomore Kam Hendrickson will be competing to replace Tyler Muszelik.

Maine (18-14-3): The Black Bears struggled last season following consecutive seasons reaching the NCAA Tournament. Nine players left via the transfer portal, but nine more rolled in. A return to form from goaltender Albin Boija would go a long way. A Mike Richter Award finalist as a sophomore, he struggled as a junior, posting an .899 save percentage. Tewksbury native Owen Fowler will serve as captain after setting career highs in goals (12) and points (22).

UMass (22-13-1): The Minutemen got a big jolt last spring when forward Jack Musa announced he would return for his senior season after posting a career-high 36 points en route to second-team All-American honors. The big question is in goal after the departure of Hockey East Player of the Year Michael Hrabal, who signed with the Mammoth following his junior season. Newbury's Jackson Irving performed well as a backup, and the senior will compete with freshmen Tobias Trejbal and Ethan Eskit.

UMass Lowell (13-22-0): Offense figures to be a concern for a River Hawks squad that lost leading goal scorers Dillan Bentley (14) and Jay Ahearn (13) to graduation. Jak Vaarwerk (7-13—20) is back and will serve as captain. He has yet to miss a game, appearing in all 107 since arriving in Lowell three years ago. Hopkinton's Chris Delaney is back for his junior season after leading the team with 17 assists as a sophomore.

Merrimack (21-16-2): The Warriors went on quite a run to capture their first conference tournament, winning four in a row and beating the top three seeds in the process. They return 18 players that accounted for 89.1 percent of their scoring from that squad, although goalie Max Lundgren signed with the Bruins. Parker Lalonde, whose 24 assists and 37 points led the Warriors, is back, as is Justin Gill and his team-leading 16 goals.

New Hampshire (14-20-1): North Reading native Brendan Fitzgerald is back for his senior year and will serve as captain. The defenseman led the Wildcats last season with 15 assists, and was third on the team in points. Hingham's Nick Ring also returns after placing second on the team in goals (nine), assists (12), and points (21). Transfers Teagan Kendrick (Sacred Heart) and Michael Simpson (Providence) will compete for the starting job in goal after Kyle Chauvette joined the Bruins.



ADRIAN KRAUS/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Caleb Malhotra, picked No. 3 by the Canucks, headlines BU's incoming freshmen.



MATTHEW J. LEE/GLOBE STAFF

Northeastern goaltender Lawton Zacher returns as one of the country's best.

Northeastern (17-18-1): The traveling Huskies return one of the best goalies in the country in Lawton Zacher, who was selected to the US Collegiate Selects team that will compete Dec. 26-31 in the Spengler Cup in Switzerland. Leading scorer Dylan Hryckowian signed with the Stars, but the next top four points producers — Jacob Mathieu, Joe Connor, Amine Hajibi, and Giacomo Martino — return.

Providence (23-11-2): The Friars captured the regular-season title last year and are expected to compete for it again. They return eight of their top 10 scorers, led by John Mustard, Logan Sawyer, Tanner Adams, and Will Elger. They also welcome seven freshmen, five of whom are NHL draft picks. Jack Parsons is back in net. He was named to the conference's all-rookie team after posting a 2.05 goals-against average and a .922 save percentage.

Vermont (13-21-1): The Catamounts had just one player reach 10 goals and 20 points last season. The good news is Colin Kessler (10-16—26) returns for his junior season. Quinnipiac transfer Dylan Silverstein, who posted a 2.09 GAA and a .912 save percentage in 18 appearances with the Bobcats last season, is the projected starter in goal. The defense looks solid, and should be bolstered by the addition of BC transfer Michael Hagens.

Follow Andrew Mahoney @GlobeMahoney.



DANIEL JACOBI II/THE DAILY HAMPSHIRE GAZETTE VIA AP

Senior Jack Musa had five assists in UMass's two-game weekend series with RIT.

Women's sports bar set for Broad Street

By Emma Healy
GLOBE STAFF

A new sports bar is coming to downtown Boston.

The Sports Bra, the world's first sports bar dedicated to exclusively showing women's sports, will soon open its Boston franchise at 2 Broad St. in the Financial District, a 3,243 square-foot space that previously housed Tiki Rock.

The ownership group of eight locals — a group of friends whose vision to open a dedicated women's sports bar began out of a group chat — is completing renovations and has not announced an opening date. A sign on the door of the venue reads: "Game time: Fall 2026."

The existing venue has a large bar area with ample seating and TVs. When it opens as The Sports Bra Boston, those TVs will show local and national women's sports games, including the NWSL's Boston Legacy, PWHL's Boston Fleet, and WPBL's Boston Hunters.

"We realized this was the perfect spot the moment we stepped inside and could truly see it transform into The Sports Bra Boston," Lydia Coverdale-Perez, a member of the ownership group, said in a release. "For us, walking into this space felt like our group chat finally got home-court advantage."

The original Sports Bra location in Portland, Ore., was a smash hit upon its opening in 2022. Founder and owner Jenny Nguyen announced in 2025 that the business was expanding with franchises across the country, including in Boston and Portland, Maine.

True to the original location's model, The Sports Bra Boston will be family-friendly and offer a wide range of food and beverage options — with sourcing products from local, women-owned businesses a priority.

"Our vision was always to be more than just a place to watch the game and have a burger. Our space is a hub to share the rich history and future of women's sports through community engagement, education, and visibility," Dana Marie Cincis, the Boston ownership group spokesperson, said in a release.

Cincis and the rest of the ownership group teamed up in 2024 to create Watch With Us Boston, which organized pop-up watch parties for women's sports in the Boston area. As the events began to attract bigger crowds, they started considering opening a brick-and-mortar women's sports bar.

In early 2025, they signed on with Nguyen and The Sports Bra to open one of the business's first franchises and began the hunt for the right location.

"The Sports Bra centers women's sports and builds a community around them," Nguyen said. "Boston has one of the deepest, most passionate sports cultures in the world, and this local ownership group embodies everything our brand stands for: leadership, resilience, diversity, and true team spirit."

Emma Healy can be reached at emma.healy@globe.com.

Murphy's Legacy year done

By Cam Kerry
GLOBE STAFF

Boston Legacy FC will need to alter its goalkeeping plans.

Starting keeper Casey Murphy suffered a partial tear of the posterior cruciate ligament in her right knee, the team announced on social media. Murphy will be placed on the season-ending injury/illness list, and is projected to be ready for the beginning of the 2027 season.

The 30-year-old NWSL veteran signed with the Legacy in December after spending four seasons with the North Carolina Courage. Her contract runs through 2029, with a mutual option for the '30 season.

Murphy made 25 appearances for the Legacy, with a 1.60 goals against average and four clean sheets. Laurel Ivory went 1-1, allowing six goals, in the only two games Murphy has missed. Hannah Stambaugh is the only other keeper on the roster.

The Legacy are 8-14-5 and host Racing Louisville in their final home match at 8 p.m. Friday at Gillette Stadium.

SportsLog



DREW HALLOWELL/GETTY IMAGES

Ashley Sanchez (center) began the two-goal American comeback in Chester, Pa., scoring in the 49th minute.

US women battle back to tie Spain

Mallory Swanson scored her first goal since the gold medal match at the 2024 Olympics in the 86th minute to pull the United States into a 2-2 draw with Spain on Tuesday night in Chester, Pa. **Ashley Sanchez** also scored early in the second half for the United States after first-half goals from **Alexia Putellas** and **Salma Paralluelo** gave Spain a 2-0 lead. It was the second of two friendly matches against Spain, the 2023 Women's World Cup winner. **Patri Guijarro** and **Eva Navarro** scored in the first 14 minutes to lift Spain to a 2-0 victory in the first match on Saturday in Washington, D.C. Spain, ranked No. 1 in the world, has already qualified for the World Cup next summer in Brazil. The United States was using the matches as preparation for qualifying this year. Putellas, the two time Ballon d'Or winner, was making her 150th appearance for Spain. She put Spain in front in the 27th minute with her 43rd international goal, a tap-in at the far post off a feed from **Clara Pinedo**. Some five minutes later, US goalkeeper **Phallon Tullis-Joyce** misplayed the ball up the field and Spain pounced. Putellas sent the ball forward to Paralluelo, whose blast hit the crossbar and fell into the goal to make it 2-0. It was the first time the United States has given up two first-half goals to an opponent in consecutive matches since 2011.

FIFA proposes fund

FIFA will propose to its members a $6.35 billion fund for soccer development between 2027 and 2030, including a boosted amount of $25 million for each national association, according to a document reviewed by The Associated Press. Soccer's world governing body said in a document that it will use the financial success of the latest World Cup "to enhance investment in football development across 211 FIFA member associations, confederations, and other stakeholders." Originally, each association was to receive $10 million for the four-year period. The move comes as European soccer leaders seek a candidate to try to oust **Gianni Infantino** as FIFA president. Infantino's divisive World Cup private investment plan — that was scrapped within days of being revealed in July — prompted UEFA to act.

COLLEGES

BC men 17th in ACC

Duke was picked to win its third straight Atlantic Coast Conference men's basketball championship and 25th overall, while Virginia sophomore forward **Thijs De Ridder** was tabbed as the conference's preseason player of the year. The Blue Devils received 45 of the possible 48 first-place votes from the panel of media members. Boston College was picked to finish 17th in the 18-team league. Virginia was picked to finish second, followed by Louisville and Miami, with each school receiving one first-place vote. North Carolina was predicted to finish fifth, followed by Clemson.

Ohio defies NCAA

Ohio Governor **Mike DeWine** signed an executive order giving the state's colleges and universities the option of allowing athletes who graduated from high school in 2022 to play a fifth year in defiance of the NCAA's new eligibility rule. Under the order, public and private universities in Ohio can allow athletes to play even though the NCAA's new guidance excludes those who already have played four seasons.

AUTO RACING

F1 returning to Africa

Formula 1 will return to Africa with a grand prix in Rwanda starting early next decade once a new track has been built southeast of the capital. The announcement of a 10-year-deal to hold an African Grand Prix in Rwanda comes after a campaign by president **Paul Kagame** to bring F1 to the continent for the first time since 1993.

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Keynotes & Headliners

NONFICTION
Daron Acemoglu
*Geraldine Brooks
Howard Bryant
Joanne Chang
Beverly Gage
Rebecca Newburger Goldstein
*Michael Lewis
Michael Murphy
Kenneth Rogoff
Timothy W. Ryback
Sherry Turkle
Emily Wilson
Manoush Zomorodi

FICTION
Emma Brodie
Edwidge Danticat
Alice Hoffman
Tess Gerritsen
Yiyun Li
Elizabeth Lim
Imbolo Mbue
Walter Mosley
Tom Perrotta

KIDS & YA
Gary R. Gray Jr.
Jasmine Guillory
Meg Medina
Claribel A. Ortega
Raúl the Third
Renée Watson

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KEN MCGAGH FOR THE GLOBE

The Dover-Sherborn field hockey team, coached by Molly McGill, was second in the MIAA Division 3 rankings released Tuesday.

HIGH SCHOOL FIELD HOCKEY NOTEBOOK

Dover-Sherborn raises its game

By Kat Cornetta
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

In the era of MIAA power rankings, scheduling has become an art form.

League schedules are set, of course, but coaches — field hockey included — are determined to test their squads against the state's best in their nonleague matchups. Coaches want to see how their teams stack up for the state tournament, but also: the better the opponent's rating, the better for the rankings formula.

Dover-Sherborn (10-0-1), ranked second in Division 3 in Tuesday's rankings release behind 11-0 Sandwich, started its nonleague gauntlet on Friday with perennial Div. 2 contender Newburyport.

"The back end of our schedule is tough," D-S coach **Molly McGill** said.

D-S drew, 2-2, Tuesday in its Tri-Valley League matchup against Large Division leader Westwood (No. 8 in Division 2), plus has Dedham (No. 6 in Division 3), second place in the TVL Small behind D-S. The Raiders then face two teams near the top of the D1 rankings (Andover and Wellesley), the second-ranked team in Division 2 (Canton), as well as defending D3 state champ Uxbridge. D-S closes the season against Belmont, No. 2 in Division 1.

"It's an opportunity more than a challenge," D-S co-captain **Sophia Wichman** said. "We're excited to be able to play these great teams."

On Friday, D-S toppled Newburyport, 6-1, in a matchup that carried extra meaning for its two senior captains.

"I was on that team four years ago that lost to them in double overtime in the playoffs," said co-captain **Hope Hebert** of a 2-1 loss in the 2023 Division 3 semifinals. "We've all been waiting for that revenge for four years."

On Sept. 10, the Raiders handled Monomoy 4-1, with a similar backstory. The Sharks dealt D-S its first loss last year, 1-0.

What is the difference this season? The Raiders always have been strong, but this fall they seem to have raised their game to a new level.

"Our passing and how we work together," Hebert said. "I've never been a part of a team that is so focused and connected. There is a lot of chemistry with our passing on the field that we definitely didn't have last year at this point in the season."

The other boost is an influx of underclassmen who have been exposed to the sport for much longer. While Hebert and Wichman began playing in fifth grade, these players have been nurtured through Dover-Sherborn Youth Field Hockey.

"I think they have kids playing who are 4!" Wichman said.

"We have a fantastic youth program," said McGill. "It's fun to see these players come up through the middle school."

One of the younger players that has made an impact is junior **Reese Bent**, a returning TVL All-Star who has racked up 18 goals.

"We are a junior and sophomore-heavy team," McGill said. "This is a super dedicated group of girls we have playing."

Last year's season ended in the semifinals with a loss to Sandwich, but McGill and her captains believe that this year's team is different. They hope to enter the tournament battle-tested, thanks to their tough schedule, and with improvements that will be hard to beat.

"I've told them that the goal is to at least get back to where we were last year," McGill said.

"We definitely want to be ones to watch this year," Wichman added.

Corner hits

■ Canton (11-2-0) jumped from No. 13 to No. 8 in this week's Globe Top 20 after a pair of 2-1 wins against No. 11 King Philip and reigning Division 1 state champion Walpole.

Coach **Chrissy O'Connor** said Canton treated the game as a measuring stick, but not a must-win matchup.

"We have a lot of respect for [Walpole's] program, for their coaching," she said. "We go in just trying to play our top game and not looking at what the outcome might be. We use it as a guide to see where we are overall.

"Of course we want to win a game like that — everyone wants to beat a Walpole — but we go in, moreso, to build our team going forward to the postseason."

The Bulldogs are built around a returning defensive core, high-scoring senior forward **Shannon Lane**, and a new starting goalie, junior **Sophia Carlton**. In her first year, she has held up strong.

"Our returning players are kind of the backbone and [Carlton has] stepped right in and fits in well with our defense," O'Connor said. "This is kind of her first shot, and she's done a really solid job for us."

Still to come are No. 6 Dover-Sherborn, plus rematches with King Philip and No. 17 Attleboro.

"I think we're taking it one game at a time, and always have our sights on the postseason, what we can do to improve for those big games," said O'Connor.

■ Lincoln-Sudbury (8-0-1), No. 1 in the Division 1 power rankings, tied Dual County rival Acton-Boxborough, 2-2, on Friday. Depth has been a major factor for the Raiders.

"Every one's a key game, but looking at our schedule, we obviously play a tough schedule, and we just try to stick with our game plan, adjust our game as needed," said coach **Vicky Caburian**. "We've got a lot of people who can play different positions, and we're looking forward to facing everyone, just showcasing the talent that we do have."

Correspondent Inaaya Omer contributed to this story. Kat Cornetta can be reached at sportsgirlkat@gmail.com.

Globe Top 20

No.		Rec.	Last
1.	Franklin	11-0-1	1
2.	Belmont	11-0-1	2
3.	Sandwich	11-0-0	3
4.	Lincoln-Sudbury	8-0-1	5
5.	Watertown	11-1-1	7
6.	Dover-Sherborn	10-0-0	8
7.	Andover	9-1-0	6
8.	Canton	10-2-0	13
9.	Walpole	7-2-1	4
10.	Milton	8-0-1	12
11.	King Philip	9-2-0	11
12.	Somerset Berkley	8-1-0	9
13.	Winchester	9-2-1	10
14.	Acton-Boxborough	7-3-1	15
15.	Dennis-Yarmouth	7-2-0	14
16.	Concord-Carlisle	6-2-2	16
17.	Attleboro	8-3-0	17
18.	Hingham	7-2-1	19
19.	Monomoy	7-3-0	18
20.	Bishop Feehan	5-6-0	20

Scoreboard

Schools

CROSS-COUNTRY

BOYS
CAPE & ISLANDS
Monomoy 27, Falmouth Acad. 28
Nauset 20, Dennis-Yarmouth 42
CATHOLIC CENTRAL
Abp. Williams 19, Bp. Fenwick 42
Abp. Williams 17, Bp. Stang 41
Arlington Cath. 15, Card. Spellman 50
Bp. Stang 23, Bp. Fenwick 34
CATHOLIC CONFERENCE
Xaverian 23, St. John's (S) 34
CMAC
Keefe Tech 24, Doherty 31
Keefe Tech 15, St. Bernard's 30
MIDDLESEX
Arlington 27, Reading 28
Burlington 22, Melrose 37
Lexington 15, Winchester 50
PATRIOT
Marshfield 22, Hingham 45
Plymouth S. 24, Quincy/N. Quincy 33
Whit.-Hanson 25, Duxbury 33
SOUTH SHORE
Norwell 20, Cohasset 41

GIRLS
CAPE & ISLANDS
Monomoy 15, Falmouth Acad. 50
Nauset 20, Dennis-Yarmouth 44
CATHOLIC CENTRAL
Abp. Williams 20, Bp. Stang 36
Arlington Cath. 22, Card. Spellman 35
Bp. Fenwick 18, Abp. Williams 40
Bp. Fenwick 17, Bp. Stang 43
CMAC
Doherty 15, Keefe Tech 50
Keefe Tech 15, St. Bernard's 50
MIDDLESEX
Arlington 21, Reading 39
Lexington 16, Winchester 47
Stoneham 19, Watertown 40
PATRIOT
Duxbury 19, Whit.-Hanson 48
Marshfield 22, Hingham 34
Quincy/N. Quincy 20, Plymouth S. 42
SOUTH SHORE
Norwell 15, Cohasset 45
VALLEY LEAGUE
E. Longmeadow 22, Springfield C. 33

FIELD HOCKEY

CAPE & ISLANDS
Monomoy 1, Dennis-Yarmouth 1
Sandwich 7, Nauset 1
CMAC
Blackstone Valley 3, Auburn 1
Hopedale 3, Sutton 1
Monty Tech 2, Blackstone-Millville 1
Oxford 3, Leicester 1
St. Bernard's 3, St. Paul 1
Uxbridge 9, Notre Dame Acad-Wor.1
DUAL COUNTY
Concord-Carlisle 6, Westford 0
Waltham 7, Newton South 0
MAYFLOWER
Westport 7, Southeastern 0
NORTHEASTERN
Gloucester 6, Beverly 3
PATRIOT
Silver Lake 3, Plymouth North 0
SOUTH COAST
Apponequet 0, Joseph Case 0
Somerset Berkley 10, Seekonk 1
W. Bridgewater 8, Fairhaven 0
SOUTH SHORE
Cohasset 9, Carver 0
E. Bridgewater 5, Norwell 2
TRI-VALLEY
Dedham 4, Ashland 3
Dover-Sherborn 2, Westwood 2
Medway 3, Holliston 1
NONLEAGUE
Acton-Boxboro 1, Algonquin 0
Bellingham 3, Milford 0
Bp. Feehan 3, Hopkinton 0
Bp. Stang 6, Digh.-Rehoboth 0
Brookline 2, Weston 0
Canton 4, Norwood 1
Danvers 5, Malden Cath. 1
Doherty 4, Clinton 0
Foxboro 1, Medfield 1
King Philip 5, Notre Dame (H) 0
Lexington 3, Stoneham 0
Marlborough 1, Shepherd Hill 1
Melrose 4, Woburn 2
Minnechaug 3, Westfield 0
North Attleboro 2, Dartmouth 2
Northbridge 2, Tantasqua 0
Old Rochester 6, Wareham/Mashpee 0
Ursuline 11, Arlington Cath. 0
Watertown 5, Bedford 0

GOLF

BOYS
BAY STATE
Natick 202, Brookline 213
Wellesley 219, Needham 231
BI-COUNTY
Easthampton 185, Pathfinder 213
Pioneer Valley 180, Mohawk Trail 187
CAPE & ISLANDS
Dennis-Yarmouth 259, Nantucket 264
Falmouth 228, St. John Paul II 236
Sturgis West 270, Monomoy 241
CAPE ANN
Ham.-Wenham 148, Manchester 130
Lynnfield 186, Newburyport 190
N. Reading 195, Pentucket 189
CATHOLIC CONFERENCE
Xaverian 221, St. John's (S) 223
DUAL COUNTY
Concord-Carlisle 244, Cambridge 303
GREATER BOSTON
Medford 40, Malden/Revere 32
HOCKOMOCK
North Attleboro 144, Franklin 145
Oliver Ames 133, King Philip 144
MERRIMACK VALLEY
Billerica 256, Tewksbury 286
Chelmsford 214, N. Andover 233
MID-WACH
Gardner 169, Hudson 154
NORTHEASTERN
Gloucester 38, Winthrop 34
PATRIOT
Duxbury 236, Plymouth North 245
N. Quincy 223, Quincy 247
Whit.-Hanson 230, Silver Lake 256
SOUTH COAST
Bourne 233, Apponequet 241
Old Rochester 221, W. Bridge. 232
Seekonk 263, Somerset Berkley 281
SOUTH SHORE
E. Bridgewater 107, Cohasset 106
TRI-VALLEY
Dover-Sherborn 200, Medway 254
Westwood 229, Norwood 231
VALLEY LEAGUE
Agawam 158, Pope Francis 165
Minnechaug 152, Westfield 158
NONLEAGUE
Abington 211, Card. Spellman 172
Algonquin 178, Marlborough 224
Auburn 135, Bartlett 187
Austin Prep 7, Beaver CD 2
Barnstable 253, Martha's Vnyd. 258
Bay Path 153, Shepherd Hill 154
Bp. Stang 159, Durfee 122
BC High 234, Hingham 252
Chicopee 202, Springfield Central 212
Grafton 195, Blackstone Valley 210
Hopedale 249, Bellingham 258
Ludlow 142, Chicopee Comp. 154
Mashpee 111, Rising Tide 45
McCann Tech 158, Smith Voc. 170
Milford 166, Uxbridge 167
Newton South 237, Watertown 245
Quaboag 175, Monson 181
St. Mary's 189, Georgetown 133
Shawsheen 187, Lowell Cath. 153
Sutton 187, Adv. Math & Sci. 184
Tantasqua 155, Longmeadow 156
Taunton 163, Sharon 172
Wachusett 154, Quabbin 168
W. Springfield 152, Amherst-Pel. 169
CMAC A Championship at Green Hill Golf Course
Team
1. Monty Tech, 309; 2. St. Bernard's, 326; 3. St. Paul, 340; 4. Doherty, 350; 5. Worcester Tech, 359; 6. Assabet, 381.

SOCCER

BOYS
BAY STATE
Newton North 1, Brookline 0
BOSTON CITY
Boston Int'l. 1, Latin Acad. 1
Dearborn STEM 4, TechBoston 1
E. Boston 3, Brighton 0
CAPE & ISLANDS
Nauset 1, St. John Paul II 0
Sturgis West 4, Rising Tide 4
CAPE ANN
Essex Tech 2, Ipswich 0
Ham.-Wenham 2, Triton 2
Manchester 6, Lynnfield 1
Newburyport 5, Rockport 1
Pentucket 5, Georgetown 1
CATHOLIC CENTRAL
Abp. Williams 6, Cathedral 0
CATHOLIC CONFERENCE
BC High 3, Xaverian 1
St. John's (S) 7, Malden Cath. 0
St. John's Prep 2, Cath. Memorial 0
CHURCHILL
Agawam 1, Minnechaug 0
Amherst-Pelham 3, Pittsfield 0
Northampton 3, Monument Mtn. 1
CMAC
Burncoat 8, Blackstone-Millville 1
Keefe Tech 4, Auburn 1
COMMONWEALTH
Gr. Lawrence 10, KIPP 7
Whittier 5, Minuteman 1
DUAL COUNTY
Acton-Boxboro 0, Weston 0
Bedford 1, Westford 0
Cambridge 3, Waltham 0
Concord-Carlisle 5, Newton South 0
Wayland 7, Boston Latin 2
GREATER BOSTON
Chelsea 4, Medford 0
Somerville 3, Everett 0
MAYFLOWER
Southeastern 12, Tri-County 0
Abp. Williams 3, Card. Spellman 0
Lowell 3, Central Cath. 0
Methuen 2, Haverhill 1
N. Andover 3, Billerica 0
MID-WACH
Bromfield 4, Fitchburg 2
Clinton 3, Tahanto 0
Grafton 3, Algonquin 1
Nashoba 3, N. Middlesex 1
Shepherd Hill 1, Marlborough 1
Shrewsbury 2, Leominster 0
Westboro 2, Wachusett 0
NORTHEASTERN
Marblehead 7, Peabody 0
Salem 3, Winthrop 1
Swampscott 2, Saugus 0
PATRIOT
Hingham 1, Plymouth North 0
Marshfield 5, Whit.-Hanson 0
Pembroke 6, Plymouth South 0
Scituate 2, Hanover 1
Silver Lake 1, Duxbury 0
SMITH
E. Longmeadow 3, W. Springfield 1
Longmeadow 2, Belchertown 0
Pope Francis 2, Ludlow 1
NONLEAGUE
Bp. Stang 4, Bristol-Plymouth 1
Brockton 6, Barnstable 3
Carver 6, South Shore Charter 0
Digh.-Rehoboth 1, Dartmouth 1
Drury 3, Mount Anthony (Vt.) 0
Fairhaven 6, Old Colony 1
Groton 1, Oakmont 0
Lincoln-Sudbury 0, Needham 0
Littleton 3, Hudson 0
Milford 2, Blackstone Valley 1
Milton 3, Excel Academy 1
New Bedford 3, Bridge.-Raynham 1
Quabbin 6, Worcester Tech 1
Smith Voc. 8, Mt. Everett 1
Southwick 5, Granby 1
Springfield International 11, Ware 0
Tyngsboro 5, Lunenburg 2
Walpole 1, Norwood 1
Westfield Tech 3, Monson 1
GIRLS
BOSTON CITY
Brighton 4, New Mission/English 0
CAPE ANN
Essex Tech 1, Ipswich 0
Georgetown 1, Pentucket 0
Ham.-Wenham 2, Triton 0
Lynnfield 4, Manchester 0
N. Reading 4, Amesbury 1
CHARTER SCHOOL ATHLETIC
Pioneer Chart. I 2, Collegiate Chart. 0
CMAC
David Prouty 3, Notre Dame (W)3
Leicester 5, Whit. Christian 0
COMMONWEALTH
Gr. Lowell 4, Mystic Valley 0
Lowell Cath. 3, Lynn Tech 2
Notre Dame (T) 10, Innovation 6
COOMBS
E. Longmeadow 2, W. Springfield 1
Ludlow 1, Minnechaug 1
DUAL COUNTY
Concord-Carlisle 5, Newton South 1
Wayland 2, Boston Latin 0
GREATER BOSTON
Chelsea, Medford
Lynn Classical 5, Lynn English 0
Malden 5, Revere 2
Somerville 1, Everett 0
MAYFLOWER
Bristol Aggie 3, South Shore 0
Bristol-Plymouth 3, Blue Hills 1
Norfolk Aggie 6, Cape Cod Tech 1
Tri-County 1, Southeastern 0
Wareham 1, Atlantis Charter 0
MERRIMACK VALLEY
Billerica 2, N. Andover 1
Central Cath. 7, Lowell 0
Chelmsford 0, Andover 0
Haverhill 3, Methuen 1
MID-WACH
Gardner 2, W. Boylston 0
Grafton 3, Algonquin 0
Shepherd Hill 4, Marlborough 2
Wachusett 1, Westboro 0
NORTHEASTERN
Beverly 2, Danvers 0
Peabody 3, Marblehead 1
PATRIOT
Duxbury 7, Silver Lake 0
Hanover 4, Scituate 0
Hingham 4, Plymouth North 0
Marshfield 2, Whit.-Hanson 0
Pembroke 1, Plymouth South 0
PIONEER VALLEY
Gateway 9, Taconic 0
NONLEAGUE
Abby Kelley Foster 9, Sizer 2
Acton-Boxboro 1, Weston 0
Athol 4, Holyoke 2
Bp. Feehan 0, Masconomet 0
Bp. Stang 3, New Bedford 2
Bridge.-Raynham 1, Mansfield 1
Cambridge 3, Waltham 2
Cathedral/C. R. 3, Dearborn STEM 0
Chicopee Comp. 2, Pioneer Valley 0
Dartmouth 3, Digh.-Rehoboth 1
Dennis-Yarmouth 2, Barnstable 1
Diman 4, Upper Cape 0
Douglas 4, Hopedale 3
Durfee 2, Westport 2
Fitchburg 3, Clinton 0
Lee 8, Mt. Everett 3
Lenox 5, Springfield Central 1
Lincoln-Sudbury 5, Malden Cath. 1
Littleton 3, Hudson 1
Lunenburg 1, Tyngsboro 0
Medfield 4, Franklin 3
Minuteman 4, Randolph 1
O'Bryant 2, Boston Collegiate 0
Oxford 2, Bay Path 2
Pathfinder 9, Putnam 1
Quabbin 6, Narragansett 0
Seekonk 1, E. Bridgewater 1
S. Hadley 1, Pope Francis 0
Southwick 2, Agawam 1
Springfield Intern. 5, Greenfield 2
Sutton 4, Adv. Math & Sci. 3
Tahanto 1, Bromfield 1
Ware 5, St. Mary (Westfield) 0
Westfield Tech 5, Hampden East 0
Westford 3, Bedford 2

SWIMMING

GIRLS
NONLEAGUE
Chelmsford 94, Acton-Boxboro 92

VOLLEYBALL

GIRLS
Calvary Chapel 3, Maimonides 0
BOSTON CITY
English High 3, Boston United 0
Madison Park 3, E. Boston 0
New Mission 3, Latin Acad. 1
O'Bryant 3, TechBoston/Henderson 1
CAPE & ISLANDS
Nantucket 3, Sturgis East 1
CAPE ANN
Ham.-Wenham 3, Georgetown 0
Ipswich 3, Triton 2
Lynnfield 3, Pentucket 0
Newburyport 3, Essex Tech 1
CATHOLIC CENTRAL
Abp. Williams 3, Card. Spellman 0
Bp. Fenwick 3, St. Mary's 0
CHARTER SCHOOL ATHLETIC
Pacific Rim 3, Foxboro Charter 1
COMMONWEALTH
Gr. Lawrence 3, Mystic Valley 1
Lynn Tech 3, Northeast 0
Whittier 3, Lowell Cath. 1
DUAL COUNTY
Acton-Boxboro 3, Boston Latin 0
Cambridge 3, Weston 1
Lincoln-Sudbury 3, Wayland 1
Westford 3, Concord-Carlisle 0
GREATER BOSTON
Lynn Classical 3, Everett 0
Somerville 3, Lynn English 0
HOCKOMOCK
Franklin 3, Milford 0
King Philip 3, Mansfield 1
North Attleboro 3, Foxboro 0
Oliver Ames 3, Canton 0
Sharon 3, Attleboro 2
Taunton 3, Stoughton 0
MID-WACH
Marlborough 3, Leominster 1
MIDDLESEX
Burlington 3, Stoneham 2
Lexington 3, Arlington 0
Melrose 3, Watertown 0
Reading 3, Woburn 0
Wakefield 3, Wilmington 0
Winchester 3, Belmont 0
NORTHEASTERN
Gloucester 3, Winthrop 0
NORTHERN
Turners Falls 3, Mohawk Trail 2
PATRIOT
N. Quincy 3, Plymouth South 0
SOUTH COAST
Fairhaven 3, Gr. New Bedford 0
SOUTH SHORE
Carver 3, Abington 0
E. Bridgewater 3, Rockland 0
Norwell 3, Randolph 0
NONLEAGUE
Abby Kelley Foster 3, Oxford 1
Algonquin 3, Groton-Dunstable 2
Amherst-Pelham 3, Easthampton 1
Arlington Cath. 3, Shawsheen 1
Brighton 3, Muniz 1
Collegiate Charter 3, MATCH 0
Digh.-Rehoboth 3, Bp. Stang 2
Grafton 3, Sutton 1
Haverhill 3, Peabody 0
Mashpee 3, Cape Cod Tech 2
Medfield 3, Walpole 0
Minuteman 3, Nashoba Tech 0
Neighborhood House 3, Rising Tide 1
Nipmuc 3, Douglas 0
N. Reading 3, N. Andover 1
Norwood 3, Fontbonne 1
Notre Dame (H) 3, Scituate 0
Notre Dame (T) 3, Cristo Rey 0
Plymouth North 3, Weymouth 1
Salem 3, Salem Academy 0
Seekonk 3, Southeastern 1
Shepherd Hill 3, Hudson 1
Smith Voc. 3, Pope Francis 2
Southbridge 3, Fitchburg 0
Southwick 3, Springfield Sci-Tech 0

	WED 10/14	THU 10/15	FRI 10/16	SAT 10/17	SUN 10/18	MON 10/19	TUE 10/20
					NYJ 1:00 CBS		
			ANA 10:00 NESN	LA 9:00 NESN			DAL 8:00 ESPN
	CHA (exh.) 7:30 NBCSB		PHI (exh.) 7:00 NBCSB				DET 3:00 NBC
	CIN 7:30* Apple TV			CHI 7:30* Apple TV			
			LOU 8:00 Amazon				

Home games shaded

On the radio, unless noted: Patriots, Bruins, Celtics, and Revolution, WBZ-FM 98.5; * — WBZ-FM HD-2.

ON THE AIR

BASEBALL PLAYOFFS
8 p.m. NLCS: Milwaukee at LA Dodgers FS1

PRO BASKETBALL
7:30 p.m. Exhibition: Charlotte at Boston NBCSB
8 p.m. Exhibition: New Orleans at Dallas NBA
10:30 p.m. Exhibition: Denver at LA Clippers NBA

COLLEGE FOOTBALL
7:30 p.m. Kennesaw St. at Missouri St. CBSSN
8 p.m. Western Ky. at Sam Houston St. ESPN

MEN'S COLLEGE GOLF
9 a.m. St. Andrews Links Collegiate Golf

GOLF
11 p.m. LPGA Tour: Buick LPGA Shanghai Golf
4 a.m. (Thu.) DP World Tour: India Championship Golf

PRO HOCKEY
8:30 p.m. Dallas at Colorado TNT

WOMEN'S COLLEGE HOCKEY
7 p.m. Merrimack at BC NESN

SOCCER
12:45 p.m. UCL: Como at Feyenoord CBSSN
3 p.m. UCL: Dortmund at Bodo/Glimt CBSSN
7:30 p.m. MLS: New England at Cincinnati Apple TV

WOMEN'S COLLEGE VOLLEYBALL
7 p.m. Mississippi St. at Missouri SEC
7 p.m. Virginia Tech at Virginia ACC

■ **For updates, go to bostonglobe.com/tvlistings**

Schools

VOLLEYBALL

GIRLS
NONLEAGUE
Tri-County 3, Millis 0
Veritas Prep 3, Granby 0
Westboro 3, Milton 1
Westwood 3, Braintree 2
Whit. Christian 3, S. Lancaster 2

■ For updated scores and highlights, go to bostonglobe.com/sports/high-schools.

NFL

AFC East	W	L	T	Pct.	PF	PA
Buffalo	4	1	0	.800	32.8	28.2
New England	3	2	0	.600	22.0	18.8
NY Jets	2	3	0	.400	18.6	19.2
Miami	0	5	0	.000	14.0	26.4
North						
Baltimore	4	1	0	.800	29.2	23.8
Cleveland	3	2	0	.600	18.6	22.4
Pittsburgh	3	2	0	.600	22.2	21.8
Cincinnati	3	2	0	.600	25.6	21.8
South						
Jacksonville	4	1	0	.800	24.6	14.0
Indianapolis	2	3	0	.400	24.8	27.6
Houston	1	4	0	.200	22.0	22.4
Tennessee	0	5	0	.000	11.6	21.8
West						
Kansas City	4	0	0	1.000	29.5	19.3
Denver	3	2	0	.600	19.4	22.2
Las Vegas	3	2	0	.600	26.4	25.8
LA Chargers	0	5	0	.000	16.8	25.8
NFC East						
NY Giants	3	1	1	.700	21.8	21.2
Philadelphia	2	3	0	.400	18.4	22.4
Dallas	2	3	0	.400	27.6	27.2
Washington	1	3	1	.300	23.0	29.8
North						
Minnesota	5	0	0	1.000	21.8	12.8
Green Bay	3	2	0	.600	20.8	22.4
Detroit	3	2	0	.600	32.8	29.6
Chicago	3	2	0	.600	23.8	19.2
South						
Carolina	2	2	0	.500	30.3	27.3
Atlanta	2	3	0	.400	23.8	24.4
Tampa Bay	1	4	0	.200	20.0	22.4
New Orleans	1	4	0	.200	23.6	30.2
West						
San Francisco	5	0	0	1.000	30.8	18.6
Seattle	3	2	0	.600	26.8	21.0
LA Rams	2	3	0	.400	23.8	24.0
Arizona	1	4	0	.200	21.6	32.4

THURSDAY'S GAME
Seattle at Denver 8:15

SUNDAY'S GAMES
NY Jets at New England 1
Houston vs. Jacksonville* 9:30a
Pittsburgh at Tampa Bay 1
Carolina at Philadelphia 1
New Orleans at NY Giants 1
Tennessee at Indianapolis 1
Baltimore at Cleveland 1
Chicago at Atlanta 1
Arizona at LA Rams 4:05
LA Chargers at Kansas City 4:25
Buffalo at Las Vegas 4:25
Dallas at Green Bay 8:20
* at London

MONDAY'S GAME
Washington at San Francisco 8:15

MONDAY'S RESULT
Buffalo 37, at LA Rams 34 (OT)

AHL

EASTERN CONFERENCE
Atlantic Division

	W	L	OL	SL	Pts.
Hershey	3	1	0	0	6
Hartford	3	2	0	0	6
WB/Scranton	2	1	1	0	5
Springfield	2	1	0	1	5
Charlotte	2	2	0	0	4
Providence	1	4	0	0	2
Lehigh Valley	0	2	1	0	1
North Division					
Laval	3	1	0	0	6
Toronto	3	1	0	0	6
Utica	3	0	0	0	6
Cleveland	3	1	0	0	6
Rochester	2	1	0	1	5
Belleville	2	2	0	0	4
Hamilton	1	2	0	1	3
Syracuse	1	3	0	0	2

WESTERN CONFERENCE
Central Division

	W	L	OL	SL	Pts.
Grand Rapids	3	1	1	0	7
Manitoba	3	1	0	0	6
Iowa	2	1	0	1	5
Milwaukee	2	0	0	0	4
Texas	1	2	0	1	3
Rockford	1	2	0	0	2
Chicago	0	4	0	0	0
Pacific Division					
Calgary	3	1	0	0	6
Colorado	3	1	0	0	6
Coachella Valley	2	0	2	0	6
San Diego	2	1	1	0	5
Tucson	2	2	0	0	4
Bakersfield	2	2	0	0	4
Ontario	2	1	0	0	4
Abbotsford	1	2	0	1	3
Henderson	1	2	0	0	2
San Jose	1	3	0	0	2

WEDNESDAY'S GAMES
Calgary at San Jose 1:30
Lehigh Valley at Hartford 6:30
Coachella Valley at Henderson 10
Ontario at San Diego 10

Basketball

WNBA FINALS

GOLDEN STATE vs. ATLANTA
Schedule
Sat., Oct. 17 at Golden State 3:30
Mon., Oct. 19 at Golden State 8
Wed., Oct. 21 at Atlanta 8
Sat., Oct. 24 at Atlanta 1
*Mon., Oct. 26 at Golden State 8
*Thu., Oct. 29 at Atlanta 8
*Sat., Oct. 31 at Golden State 8

* If necessary

NBA

EXHIBITION SEASON
TUESDAY'S RESULTS
At Orlando 132, Cleveland 116
At Toronto 148, New York 98
At Oklahoma City 114, Indiana 112
Golden State, at LA Lakers
Portland, at Sacramento
WEDNESDAY'S GAMES
Charlotte at Boston 7:30
Brooklyn at Miami 7:30
New Orleans at Dallas 8
Chicago at Milwaukee 8
Detroit at Minnesota 8
Phoenix at San Antonio 8
Denver at LA Clippers 10:30
MONDAY'S RESULTS
At Atlanta 113, Oklahoma City 110
Brooklyn 131, at Washington 122
Minnesota 122, at New York 104
At Utah 119, San Antonio 109

Soccer

MLS

EASTERN CONFERENCE

	GP	W	D	L	Pts.
Nashville	28	19	6	3	63
Miami	28	13	10	5	49
Chicago	28	14	6	8	48
New England	28	14	4	10	46
Charlotte	28	13	7	8	46
Philadelphia	28	12	6	10	42
Orlando	28	11	4	13	37
NY Red Bulls	28	10	6	12	36
Cincinnati	27	9	9	9	36
NYCFC	28	8	9	11	33
Toronto	28	7	11	10	32
D.C. United	27	6	12	9	30
Columbus	28	8	5	15	29
Atlanta	28	7	6	15	27
Montreal	28	6	6	16	24
WESTERN CONFERENCE					
	GP	W	D	L	Pts.
Vancouver	28	15	6	7	51
St. Louis	28	14	8	6	50
Dallas	28	13	8	7	47
San Jose	28	13	7	8	46
Houston	28	13	6	9	45
LAFC	29	11	9	9	42
Seattle	28	11	8	9	41
Colorado	28	11	4	13	37
LA Galaxy	29	9	9	11	36
Portland	28	9	6	13	33
Real Salt Lake	28	9	5	14	32
San Diego FC	28	8	8	12	32
Austin	28	7	10	11	31
Minnesota	28	7	9	12	30
Sporting KC	28	6	4	18	22

WEDNESDAY'S GAMES
New England at Cincinnati 7:30
Charlotte at Columbus 7:30
NY Red Bulls at D.C. United 7:30
Orlando at Toronto 7:30
Atlanta at Montreal 7:30
NYCFC at Miami 7:30
Vancouver at St. Louis 8:30
Sporting KC at Nashville 8:30
Seattle at Dallas 8:30
Philadelphia at Chicago 8:30
Minnesota at Colorado 9:30
San Jose at Real Salt Lake 9:30
Portland at LA Galaxy 10:30
Austin at LAFC 10:30
Houston at San Diego FC 10:30

NWSL

	GP	W	D	L	Pts.
Gotham FC	27	16	7	4	55
San Diego	27	16	3	8	51
Washington	27	15	4	8	49
Utah	27	14	4	9	46
Kansas City	27	13	5	9	44
Angel City	27	12	7	8	43
Portland	27	12	7	8	43
North Carolina	27	13	3	11	42
Seattle	27	12	4	11	40
Denver	27	10	8	9	38
Orlando	27	10	3	14	33
Houston	27	8	6	13	30
Boston	27	8	5	14	29
Bay FC	27	7	5	15	26
Louisville	27	7	3	17	24
Chicago	27	5	2	20	17

PREMIER LEAGUE

	W	D	L	Pts.
Manchester City	6	0	0	18
Arsenal	5	0	1	15
Brighton	4	1	1	13
Brentford	2	4	0	10
Everton	2	4	0	10
Chelsea	3	1	2	10
Leeds United	2	3	1	9
Hull City	2	3	1	9
Liverpool	2	3	1	9
Ipswich Town	3	0	3	9
Newcastle	2	2	2	8
Crystal Palace	2	1	3	7
Man. United	1	3	2	6
Coventry

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BERRIGAN, Maurice Patrick
BOSTON
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CONSTANTINO, Celia
FOLEY, John Joseph Jr.
JOHN, Bindu Mary
BRAINTREE
NEE, Alice L. (Stravinsky)
BROOKLINE
CONLON, William J.
CAMBRIDGE
KELLY, CAROL
CHELMSFORD
THERRIAULT, Bernard C.
CLINTON
CONLON, William J.
DORCHESTER
NEE, Alice L. (Stravinsky)
EASTON
FITZGERALD, Thomas W.
FITCHBURG
THERRIAULT, Bernard C.
FRAMINGHAM
PATELIS, Joan Frances
FRANKLIN
CONLON, William J.
GROTON
THERRIAULT, Bernard C.
LYNN
MASSEY, Richard Vincent
MELROSE
CONSTANTINO, Celia
MILTON
NEE, Alice L. (Stravinsky)
NATICK
NOVICK, Alfred W.
NEEDHAM
JOHN, Bindu Mary
NOVICK, Alfred W.
NEWTON
JOHN, Bindu Mary
PAXTON
WICKSTROM, Curt B.
SOMERVILLE
CONSTANTINO, Celia
SOUTH BOSTON
NEE, Alice L. (Stravinsky)
STOUGHTON
NOVICK, Alfred W.
SWAMPSCOTT
MASSEY, Richard Vincent
UXBRIDGE
CONSTANTINO, Celia
WALTHAM
JOHN, Bindu Mary
WAYLAND
NOVICK, Alfred W.
WELLESLEY
NOVICK, Alfred W.
WESTFORD
THERRIAULT, Bernard C.

OUT OF STATE

FLORIDA
MASSEY, Richard Vincent
NEW HAMPSHIRE
THERRIAULT, Bernard C.

BERRIGAN, Maurice Patrick



It is with deep sadness to announce the passing of Maurice Patrick Berrigan, age 89. He was a resident of Acton for 63 years. He passed away peacefully, at home, with his three daughters by his side, on Friday, October 9.

He is leaving behind a legacy of love, compassion, and cherished memories.

He was born August 8, 1937, and was the son of the late Byron and Stella Berrigan. He was raised in North Cambridge with his siblings and enjoyed many summers in Nova Scotia, Canada.

He served in the military as a proud United States Marine. He carried his respect for the Marine Corps throughout his life.

He began his early career at Belmont Tool Co., then moving onward and upward to Thermo Electron Corporation, Nuclear Metals, and finally retiring from Jamesbury Corporation, as a computer programmer.

Maurice enjoyed spending time with his family and friends and traveling to Canada and Vermont. He became active at the Acton Senior Center. He cherished the friendships he developed there, especially at hot topics and the exercise classes he attended.

He was predeceased by his beloved wife, G. Helen (Kenney) Berrigan of 60 years, leaving a vast void.

He was a devoted father to his three daughters and their spouses, Jan and Tom Miller, Brenda and Bruno McKenzie, and Roseann and Craig Merwitzer. He was also the adoring grandfather of Justin and Mark Merwitzer, Alix and KateLynn McKenzie, and Grant and Julia Miller.

He is survived by his siblings, Rita Johnson, Mary Boudreau, Claire Card, Michael Berrigan; and numerous nieces and nephews. He was predeceased by his brother, Robert Berrigan.

Visitation on Friday, October 16, 5pm-7pm, in the Acton Funeral Home, 470 Massachusetts Avenue (Rte.111), ACTON. Funeral Mass at St. Elizabeth's Church, 89 Arlington Street, Acton, on Saturday, October 17, 10am, with a Graveside Service following at Woodlawn Cemetery, Concord Road, Acton.

www.actonfuneralhome.com

To submit a paid death notice for publication in **The Boston Globe** and on **Boston.com**, contact your funeral director, **visit boston.com/deathnotices** or call **617.929.1500**.

To submit an obituary for editorial consideration, please send the information and a photo by e-mail to **obits@globe.com**, or information by fax to **617.929.3186**. If you need further assistance about a news obituary, please call **617.929.3400**.

To access death notices and obituaries online, visit **boston.com/obituaries**.

The Boston Globe

CONLON, William J.



Age 90, passed peacefully on October 8, 2026. Husband of 54 years to the late Dolores (Baldyga) Conlon. Brother-in-law of Wanda Keegan and Carol Sibya; beloved uncle, cousin and friend. Graduate of Boston College High School and New England Conservatory of Music. Retired Music teacher for Boston Public Schools, and Voice teacher at NEC. Renowned vocalist as member of the New England Opera Theatre, Boston Lyric Theatre, Boston Opera Group, and the Cavaliers Male Quartet, and celebrated church soloist.

Visiting Hours: Services, on Friday, October 16, 2026. Calling Hour, 9:30-10:30AM, Philbin-Comeau Funeral Home, 176 Water St., CLINTON. Funeral Mass, 11AM, St. John the Evangelist Church, 80 Union St., Clinton. Burial, St. John's Cemetery, Lancaster.

www.philbincomeaufh.com

CONSTANTINO, Celia

Beloved wife, mother, grandmother, and great-grandmother, passed away on October 9, 2026, at the age of 102.

A Mass Of Christian Burial will be held on Friday, October 16, 2026 at 10:00 AM, at St. Mary's Church, Herbert Street, Melrose. (Please meet at the church). Interment will follow at Wyoming Cemetery, Sylvan Street, Melrose. Family and friends respectfully invited to attend.

For full obituary and photo, please visit www.gatelyfh.com

Gately Funeral Home
Melrose
781-665-1949

FITZGERALD, Thomas W.



Passed on October 9, 2026, at the age of 80. Tom is survived by his wife, Rena (Dinarello) Fitzgerald; and children, Peter Fitzgerald, Amy (Fitzgerald) Conde and husband, Mark, Teressa (Fitzgerald) Cleary and husband, Keith, Joseph Fitzgerald and Tara (Fitzgerald) Leal and husband, Jon, the late Kerry Fitzgerald and his son, the late Thomas R. Fitzgerald. He is also survived by six grandchildren and two great-grandchildren. Relatives and friends are invited to attend Visiting Hours at Dockray & Thomas Funeral Home in CANTON, Massachusetts, on Thursday, October 15, from 4-7 P.M. A Funeral Service will be held at the funeral home, on Friday October 16, at 11 A.M., after which the procession will proceed to the burial at Old Calvary Cemetery in Boston, Massachusetts. For full obituary, please visit dockrayandthomasfuneralhome.com

FOLEY, John Joseph Jr.



Age 80, died peacefully, on September 25, 2026, in Atlanta. John was a man of integrity and kindness. Blessed with a subtle Irish wit and a warm personality, John always relished gatherings with family and friends. He is survived by his beloved wife of 49 years, Maureen Harnisch; and his son, Trip (John J., III). Born in Boston, on September 19, 1946, to John J. and Evelyn Foley, John was the eldest of four children. John attended Boston College High School, where the Jesuits steeped him in a classic education, including four years of both Latin and Greek. It was a great grounding for the rest of his life. After high school, John attended Boston College, graduating in 1968. John moved to Atlanta in 1970 to study city planning at Georgia Tech. He quickly fell in love with the city and the warm weather, choosing to make it his permanent home. John began his professional career in real estate consulting, initially working with Dale Henson Associates, where he met Maureen, and knew from the first time he saw her that she was the woman he would marry. John later worked at HCA Healthcare, where he was in charge of medical office leasing for the Southeast. Following HCA, John spent the majority of his career in commercial real estate at Venturi Associates, which later became The Westminster Group. After his retirement from commercial real estate, John joined Harry Norman. In all his jobs, John enjoyed the comradery and time spent with colleagues. Throughout his life, John was an active gardener who, through trial and error, built up an encyclopedic knowledge of plants and how to care for them. John was also a vigorous reader and skilled bridge player. Each week, he looked forward to bridge night with his longtime friends. From the time he was young, John was a passionate traveler, visiting countries around the world. In more recent years, however, he savored spending summers and falls on Cape Cod, a place he loved since his youth. John was involved in many organizations, serving as President of the Peachtree Heights West Civic Association, President of the Parish Council of the Basilica of the Sacred Heart, the head of alumni admissions in Georgia for Boston College for 16 years, and a member of the Atlanta Men's Garden Club. John's memory is especially treasured by his sisters, Mary Ellen Coughlin, Judith Sutton and Patricia St. Martin. He was also loved by his numerous brothers and sisters-in-law and his many nieces and nephews. John's family wishes to thank all of the outstanding therapists and nursing staff who worked with him. A Mass of Christian Burial was held at The Cathedral of Christ The King, Atlanta, GA, on Thursday, October 1, at 10:00 am. A Prayer Service will be held at Gilman Chapel in Cedar Grove Cemetery, Saturday, October 17, at 11:00 am, with a Burial immediately following. In lieu of flowers, memorial contributions may be made to Shepherd Center Foundation, 2020 Peachtree Road NW, Atlanta, Georgia 30309. To leave the Foley family a condolence message, please visit www.dolanfuneral.com

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Funeral Services

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JOHN, Bindu Mary



Of Newton, October 4, 2026. Beloved daughter of the late Dr. P. M. John and the late Leela John. Loving sister of Anish; dear sister-in-law of Betsey; and cherished aunt of Aidan and Aria. Visiting Hours in the Eaton Funeral Home, 1351 Highland Ave., NEEDHAM, on Thursday, from 4 p.m. until 7:00 p.m. Funeral Service at the Parish of the Good Shepherd, 1671 Beacon St., Waban, Newton, MA, on Friday, at 11:00 am. Complete obituary, EatonFuneralHomes.com

Eaton Funeral Homes
Needham 781-444-0201

KELLY, Carol



Age 73, longtime Cambridge resident and realtor, died peacefully, on September 21, 2026. Beloved mother to Christopher Kelly; sister to Yvonne, Peter and Steven; and aunt to Shelby and Shawna. Family and friends are invited to Carol's Celebration of Life to be held Saturday, October 17, from 3:00-6:00 PM, at the Harvard Faculty Club, 20 Quincy Street, Cambridge. For the complete obituary, please visit https://www.legacy.com/us/obituaries/bostonglobe/name/carol-kelly-obituary?id=62607488

For online condolences, please visit brownandhickey.com

MASSEY, Richard Vincent



Age 88, of Swampscott and Oldsmar, FL, October 6. Son of the late John and Gertrude (Carpenter) Massey; devoted husband of the late Johanne (Andersen) Massey; father and father-in-law of Rick and Ann Massey of Swampscott, MA, Michael and Cara Massey of Swampscott, MA, Peter and Kelly Massey of Lynn, MA and, Jeff Massey of Swampscott, MA; grandfather of Brendan and Julia Massey, Justin Massey and his wife, Hypatia and Trevor Massey, Alyson Massey and Adeline Massey; great-grandfather of Ezme and Chase Massey and Aria Massey; he also leaves his loving companion, Claire Kirk; and her family; Deborah Kirk of Swampscott, MA, Mike and Shawna Kirk and family of Beverly, MA, Kevin and Kim Kirk and family of Matthews, NC; brother to his sister, Donna Massey of Natick, MA, the late John "Jack" Massey, who is survived by his wife, Jif of San Clemente, CA and the late Anne (Massey) Burnham who is survived by her husband, Charlie of Stafford, NH; and son-in-law of the late Ty and Eleanor Andersen of Swampscott; brother-in-law to Ty and Deborah Andersen of Lakeland FL and to the late Dean Andersen of Swampscott, MA. Memorial Visiting Hours will be held at the Solimine Funeral Home, 67 Ocean St. (Rte. 1A), LYNN, MA 01902, on Sunday October 18, 2026, from 9:00AM to 1:00PM, followed by a remembrance gathering at Tedesco Country Club, from 2:00PM to 6:00PM. Relatives and friends are respectfully invited. Burial, at Swampscott Cemetery, will be private. Directions and guestbook, at www.solimine.com

NEE, Alice L. (Stravinsky)



Age 96, of South Boston, passed away peacefully, on October 9, 2026. Beloved wife of 71 years to the late John D. Nee. Devoted mother of Elaine Barrett and her husband, William of South Boston, John Nee Jr. and his wife, Karen of Milton, Linda Graham and her husband, Terrence of Braintree, Michael Nee of South Boston, Susan Collins and her husband, Francis of Dorchester, Mary Catherine Nee-Loftus and her husband, Patrick of South Boston. Loving grandmother of Christopher, Jamie, Shannon, Stacey, John, Brian, Sarah, Emily and Michael Vincent. Loving great-grandmother of Angelina, John Joseph, Christopher, Claire, Tessa, Max, Ellie, Ava, Addie, Connor, Charlotte, Mia and Jack; and step-grandmother of Katherine C. and Patrick F. Loftus. Step-great-grandmother of Grace, Finn, Harper, Logan and Joseph. Sister of Terese Stravinsky and the late Ann Taylor, Mary Hurley, Joan and Joseph Stravinsky, Claire O'Brien and Patricia Madden. Also survived by many nieces and nephews. Daughter of the late Anthony and Anna (Thornton) Stravinsky. Alice grew up in South Boston, but when introduced she was sure to proudly inform you that she was originally from Dorchester, a retired Case Analyst at John Hancock Insurance, an avid Sudoku player, member of the Castle Island Association and South Boston Irish American Society, and a friend to many. Recently, Alice resided at the NewBridge on the Charles (Dedham), endeared by her caregivers, continuing to make friends while enjoying sing-alongs and Christian fellowship. Visitation in the O'Brien Funeral Home, 146 Dorchester St., SOUTH BOSTON, on Friday, October 16, from 3-7pm. Funeral Mass at Gate of Heaven Church, 615 East Fourth St., South Boston, on Saturday, October 17, at 10am. Relatives and friends are kindly invited to attend. Interment, Cedar Grove Cemetery, Dorchester. In lieu of flowers, donations in memory of Alice, may be made to Gate of Heaven Church, 841 East Broadway, South Boston, MA 02127. For directions and guest book, please visit www.obrienfunerals.com

O'Brien Funeral Home
617-269-1600

NOVICK, Alfred W.



Of Wellesley, passed away peacefully, on October 11, 2026. Born in Sharon and raised in Stoughton, MA. He was the beloved husband of the late Marietta Novick for 63 years. Al is survived by his niece, Lynn Kennedy and her husband, Bruce of Wayland and their children, John, Alexandra, Olivia and Jake; his nephew, Michael DeSesa and his wife, Stacy and son, Jack; his brother-in-law and sister-in-law, Peter and Janice DeSesa.

Al served in the Navy and Navy Reserves and was very proud of his service to his country. He worked for TTI Inc., an electronic components distributor as a sales representative for 40 years, earning the nickname of "The Legend" before retiring.

Over the years, Al and Marietta traveled all over the world with many trips to various parts of Italy, their favorite destination.

Funeral Service and burial at Woodlawn Cemetery, Wellesley, will be private. For online guestbook, gfdoherty.com

George F. Doherty & Sons
Wellesley 781 235 4100

PATELIS, Joan Frances

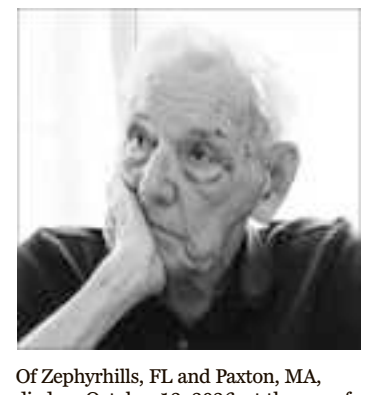
Of Framingham, passed away on October 12, 2026, at age 98. Beloved wife of the late Anthony Patelis, Jr. Loving mother to Nancy Patelis Levinson, Anthony G. Patelis Sr. (Margi Folan), and Michael Patelis (Sandra Patelis); grandmother to Anthony G. Patelis Jr., James Patelis (Lauren Patelis), and Sarah Levinson; and great-grandmother to James Paul Patelis. Family and friends are invited to honor and remember Joan's life by gathering for a time of Visitation in the McCarthy, McKinney & Lawler Funeral Home, 11 Lincoln St., FRAMINGHAM, on Thursday morning, October 15, from 9-10:30AM. Her Funeral Mass will be celebrated in St. George Church, 74 School St., Framingham, at 11 o'clock. Interment will follow in St. Stephen Cemetery, Framingham. For a complete obituary, kindly visit http://www.mccarthyfh.com

THERRIAULT, Bernard C.



Age 84, a longtime resident of Chelmsford of 58 years, passed away peacefully, on Saturday, October 10, 2026, at his home, surrounded by his loving family. He was the beloved husband of the late Barbara M. (Bourque) Therriault, with whom he shared 41 years of marriage, until her passing in 2007. He was born in Fitchburg, on February 11, 1942, and was the son of the late Eugene and Marion (Moulliet) Therriault. Bernard graduated from Saint Bernard High School in Fitchburg, as class president and valedictorian and cum laude from Boston College in 1963, under a full-tuition scholarship. He served in the Air Force as a communications officer from 1963 to 1968, where he was stationed at Hill Airforce Base (AFB) in Utah and Don Muang Royal Thai AFB in Thailand. He worked as a technical writer and then software engineer at Honeywell Information Systems and Bull Worldwide Information Systems in Billerica, MA, for 26 years. He earned an MBA from Northeastern University in 1979. Bernard was a devoted husband, exceptional tennis player, avid reader, music lover and an amazing father and grandfather. He loved taking an annual road trip out to Arizona and vacationing with his family at Rangeley Lake in Maine. Most importantly, Bernard was a wonderful mix of kind, humble, and wise. His quick wit and his gentle words of wisdom will be greatly missed by his family and friends. Bernard leaves his children, Brenda M. Korwan and her husband, David of Westford, Susan M. Cheesman of Concord, NH and Brian M. Therriault of Belchertown, MA; his two brothers, Gene Therriault of Latham, NY and Stephen Therriault of Rotterdam, NY; and his four grandchildren, Katie Laird and her husband, Timothy, Rachel Korwan, Sarah Cheesman and Noah Therriault. In addition to his loving wife, Bernard was predeceased by his son-in-law, Todd Cheesman. Visiting Hours will be held on Sunday, October 18, 2026, from 1pm - 4pm, at the Blake Chelmsford Funeral Home, 24 Worthen St., CHELMSFORD. His Mass of Christian Burial will be celebrated on Monday, October 19, 2026, at 11am, at St. Mary Parish, 25 North Rd., Chelmsford. Kindly gather at the church. Interment to follow in West Chelmsford Cemetery, Chelmsford. Funeral directors Paul A. Hardy, Jr., and Jennifer Lebaropoulos Hardy. For directions and online condolences, please visit chelmsfordfuneralhome.com and find us on Facebook.

WICKSTROM, Curt B.



Of Zephyrhills, FL and Paxton, MA, died on October 12, 2026, at the age of 93. He was the son of the late Jean L and Frida (Wirstrom) Wickstrom. Curt is survived by his children, Jeanette of Boston, Steven and his wife, Collette of Eastham, Alan and his wife, Marita of Norton, Julie of Clinton; and three grandchildren, Zachary Wickstrom of Medway, Steven Wickstrom of Lowell and Rhian Horsford of East Boston; and his beloved companion, Terri Ceppi of Rochdale. He was predeceased by his wife, Jean (Wright) Wickstrom. Relatives and friends are invited to join the family, on Thursday, October 15, at Miles Funeral Home, 1158 Main Street, HOLDEN, MA, for a visiting hour from noon to 1:00, followed by a funeral service.

Visiting Hours: October 15, 2026, 12:00 pm- 1:00 pm

Miles Funeral Home
1158 Main Street, Holden, MA
www.milesfuneralhome.com

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Obituaries





Mr. Mafokate (right, with his horses in Johannesburg in 2017) broke racial barriers in a sport that was dominated by white riders. In his later years, he spent time developing young riders.

PHOTOS BY THEMBA HADEBE/ASSOCIATED PRESS/2017

Enos Mafokate, 80, S. African jumping star

By Mogomotsi Magome
ASSOCIATED PRESS

JOHANNESBURG — Enos Mafokate, South Africa's first Black show jumping champion and veteran equestrian, died Sept. 3 at the age of 80, his family announced.

Mr. Mafokate broke racial barriers in a sport that was dominated by white riders during South Africa's decades of apartheid.

He was widely known as "Kgosi ya Dipere," a Sesotho language phrase which translates to "King of Horses."

"His journey was shaped by several leading figures in South African equestrian sport who recognised his extraordinary ability and, at critical moments, supported him as he challenged the racial barriers of the time," his family said in statement.

Mr. Mafokate started out as a stablehand. He won his first riding competition in 1963 but the country's segregation laws prevented him from taking part in further competitions until 1975.

In 1980, he was the first Black South African man to compete internationally as a show jumper, placing fifth out of 31 riders at the Royal International Horse Show at Wembley stadium in England.

After apartheid was dismantled in 1991 and the IOC readmitted South Africa to the Olympics, his service was recognized when he went to the Barcelona Games as sports ambassador.

"His journey took him from the harsh realities of apartheid South Africa to competing internationally as a showjumper," his family said. "Yet the significance of his life extended far beyond his own achievements in the arena."

He spent his latter years developing young Black riders in Soweto township through the Soweto Equestrian Centre, a horse riding school he established in 2006. There he trained hundreds of young people in horse riding and animal welfare.

In 2015 at the South Africa sport awards he received a lifetime achievement honor.

Frances Stonor Saunders, 60, writer who detailed CIA's anti-Soviet propaganda

By Richard Sandomir
NEW YORK TIMES

Shortly after George Orwell's death in 1950, two CIA operatives — sent to England by E. Howard Hunt, who would help plan the Watergate break-in two decades later — met with his widow, Sonia, to buy the film rights to "Animal Farm."

Among the notable revelations in her book "Who Paid the Piper?: The C.I.A. and the Cultural Cold War" (1999), the author and documentarian Frances Stonor Saunders showed that the spy agency's anti-Soviet activities after World War II included producing an animated adaptation of "Animal Farm," Orwell's 1945 satirical fable of the Russian Revolution in which totalitarian pigs rule a barnyard.

The 1954 cartoon made a significant change to Orwell's finale by cutting the human characters out of a celebratory dinner hosted by the pigs and including local farmers.

In the book, the other animals, watching from outside the farmhouse, look at the exploitative humans and pigs but find it "impossible to say which was which." But in the movie, the starving, oppressed animals stage a counterrevolution by storming the farmhouse where only the pigs are present and the Stalinist porcine leader, Napoleon, is killed.

"By removing the human farmers from the scene, to leave only the pigs reveling in the fruits of exploitation," Ms. Stonor Saunders wrote, the CIA made the film more overtly anticommunist.

Ms. Stonor Saunders died Aug. 31 in hospice care in Chichester, in southern England. She was 60 and had lived in London. Her brother Alexander Stonor Saunders said the cause was glioblastoma, an aggressive form of brain cancer.

"Who Paid the Piper?" documented years of covert efforts by the CIA to manipulate public opinion in Western Europe against communism. Among them was the creation of front organizations such as the Congress for Cultural Freedom, which backed magazines and journals including Encounter in Britain and Der Monat in Germany. The agency also sponsored art exhibitions and music tours and funded pro-democracy student activists.

"While some of the C.I.A.'s activities were exposed in the late 1960s, many artists and intellectuals claimed ignorance," journalist Laurence Zuckerman wrote in The New York Times in 2000, when "Who Paid the Piper?" was published in the United States under the title "The Cultural Cold War: The C.I.A. and the World of Arts and Letters." "But Stonor Saunders make a strong case that several people, including philosopher Isaiah Berlin and poet Stephen Spender, who was co-editor of Encounter, knew about the C.I.A.'s role."

To finance its activities, Ms. Stonor Saunders wrote, the CIA siphoned hundreds of millions of dollars budgeted for the Marshall Plan, the United States' foreign aid program that helped European nations recover from World War II.

"We couldn't spend it all," Gilbert Greenway, a former CIA officer, told Ms. Stonor Saunders. "There were no limits, and nobody had to account for it."

Greenway was one of the retired CIA officials who cooperated with Ms. Stonor Saunders' reporting long after its activities had ended.

"Along came this intelligent young woman, and they opened up to her," Alexander Stonor Saunders said in an interview. "They wanted to share what they knew."

Frances Stonor Saunders was born April 14, 1966, in Windsor, England, west of London. Her father, Donald Slomnicki, moved to England at the end of the war and worked as an investment banker; his family anglicized its name to Saunders. Her mother, Julia (Stonor) Saunders, was a member of one of England's oldest, aristocratic Roman Catholic families.

Frances' parents divorced when she was 11, and she and Alexander went to live with their mother, whose eclectic set of friends included novelist Graham Greene and singer Eartha Kitt.

After graduating from St. Mary's School Ascot, Ms. Stonor Saunders studied English language and literature at the University of Oxford's St. Anne's College and earned a bachelor's degree in 1987.

She worked as Kitt's assistant on a tour and was the ghostwriter of her 1989 memoir, "Confessions of a Sex Kitten." Kitt was known for her sultry onstage persona and for playing Catwoman on the 1960s television series "Batman."

Ms. Stonor Saunders worked as a stringer for The Associated Press in Rome and as a freelance writer before she began making documentaries for Channel 4 in Britain in the 1990s.

"Hidden Hands: A Different History of Modernism," a four-part series that aired in 1995 and of which she produced two, was the precursor to "Who Paid the Piper?"

It showed how the CIA promoted American Abstract Expressionist artists such as Jackson Pollock, Willem de Kooning and Mark Rothko in touring exhibitions "as proof of the creativity, the intellectual freedom and the cultural power of the U.S.," Ms. Stonor Saunders wrote in The Independent at the time.

"Who Paid the Piper?" was published four years after the documentary aired and won the Royal Historical Society's Gladstone Book Prize.

Writing in The Observer, critic Peter Conrad praised Ms. Stonor Saunders for her "absorbing, distressing and, at times, uproariously funny history of this war of delusionary images, a battle for hearts and minds which was conducted by mobilizing culture."

She later worked as arts editor of The New Statesman, a weekly cultural and political magazine, and wrote for The Guardian and other publications.

Over the past two decades, she wrote and hosted radio documentaries for the BBC on subjects that included Donald Trump's connection to lawyer and fixer Roy Cohn.

In addition to her mother and brother, Ms. Stonor Saunders is survived by a half brother, Hugo Saunders.

Marina Vlady, 88, star of European cinema who made complicated roles compelling

By Adam Nossiter
NEW YORK TIMES

Marina Vlady, an actor whose ascent from 1950s sex symbol to leading roles in major French films in the following decades made her one of the most recognizable stars in European cinema, died Sept. 24 at her home in Ivry-sur-Seine, a suburb of Paris. She was 88.

Her death was announced by French President Emmanuel Macron, who called her "one of the great figures of French cinema," adding that "she never allowed herself to be shut up in a role, an era, or an image."

As with Brigitte Bardot, Ms. Vlady's beauty helped her win the attention of directors for dozens of French and Italian films while she was still in her teens, in an era when both actors, for many film critics, were defined by their physical attributes, including their blond good looks.

While Bardot's screen persona was glacial, Ms. Vlady brought a subtle smile and an easy grace to even classically stiff roles, like the one for which she is best remembered in France: the title character in the 1961 costume drama "La Princesse de Clèves," adapted from the 17th-century novel of the same name by Madame de La Fayette.

Those qualities later got her a leading part, as Kate Percy, in Orson Welles's "Falstaff" in 1965 (released as "Chimes at Midnight" in the United States); as a moonlighting part-time prostitute in one of Jean-Luc Godard's most celebrated, if contested, cinematic experiments, "Two or Three Things I Know About Her" (1967), a film that critic Renata Adler called "affected and rather tedious"; and in many other films by leading French directors including Bertrand Tavernier and Robert Hossein, to whom she was married for a few years in the 1950s while still a teenager.

"La Princesse de Clèves," a popular if not critical success in France, was her breakthrough as an actor. Finally, she was allowed to play "a character of great rigor," she told a television interviewer at the time, "a complete woman, who prefers not to give herself to a man."

From then on, it was not only her looks that got her the roles. "Her Mona Lisa beauty, her onscreen intelligence and her ability to incarnate complex, contradictory characters struck the imagination of several generations of moviegoers," critics Bertrand Guyard and Olivier Delcroix wrote in Le Figaro after her death.

In "Two or Three Things I Know About Her," Godard gave Ms. Vlady little room to exercise these talents, interrupting the story with whispered ruminations on Paris's urban transformation, among other topics. He was furiously, if unsuccessfully wooing her at the time, and in the film seemed most concerned with projecting his own worldview. The director barely spoke to her after she turned down his advances.

But when directors allowed her to act, critics noticed. She won the best actress award at Cannes in 1963 for her performance in the Italian-French "The Conjugal Bed" ("L'Ape Regina"), which satirized Italian family life and cast her as a sexually insatiable would-be mother paired with a reluctant husband.

"Miss Vlady's cool, initial primness, her avidity when released by the act of matrimony and her delicate, ladylike hauteur when she has accomplished her sexual and social mission are very tasty, indeed," critic Bosley Crowther wrote in The New York Times.



ASSOCIATED PRESS/FILE

Ms. Vlady, alongside costars Jean Marais (left) and Jean-Francois Porron at the premier of "Princess of Cleves" in 1961, appeared in more than 80 films throughout her prolific career.

She charmed reviewers even when the vehicles were duds, as they frequently were in a prolific career of more than 80 films. In "Sophie and the Crime" (1955), also released as "The Girl on the Third Floor," she played an ingénue trying to exonerate her murderous husband.

"It is with this lovely actress' characterization that Messrs Gaspard-Huit and Lary have conceived of an irritation abrasive enough to scour the gum off the seats in one hundred movie houses," critic Richard W. Nason wrote in the Times, referring to director Pierre Gaspard-Huit and screenwriter Pierre Lary. But Ms. Vlady "performs her misbegotten assignment very well," Nason wrote.

"I made films I probably shouldn't have during my career," Ms. Vlady told a television interviewer for France 3 in 2011. "But I had my children to raise," she added. She had her first child, Pierre, at 18, with Hossein.

"I've done this career out of a taste for the scripts, the writers," she said. "But also to make a living."

Catherine Marina de Poliakoff-Baïdaroff was born on May 10, 1938, in Clichy, a suburb of Paris, the youngest of four daughters of Vladimir de Poliakoff and Militza Envald, Russian emigres who were often broke, Ms. Vlady recalled in the television interview. In the 1950s, she created the stage name Vlady in homage to her father.

He was an opera singer forced to work as a mason; his wife was a dancer; and all four of their daughters had careers on the stage. She remembered in 2011 that as a child she took part in "a little family concert every Sunday. We needed to earn money. We were poor."

By the age of 11, she was a "rat" at the Paris Opera, one of the celebrated corps of apprentice dancers at the opera's ballet school. That year, 1949, she appeared in her first film, "Orage d'Été" ("Summer Storm"), as an ice skater.

By 1952, she was starring opposite Marcello Mastroianni, who fell for her though she was only 14, in the Italian-made World War II drama "Penne Nere."

In 1954, she had a breakthrough with the French public in "Avant le Deluge" ("Before the Deluge"), a Cold War drama centering on the nuclear threat, winning the Prix Suzanne-Bianchetti award for her performance.

Married at 17 to Hossein, she went on to make four films with him in the 1950s. They were divorced in 1959; she married Jean-Claude Brouillet, a pilot who had been a French resistance fighter during World War II, in 1963; and, in 1970, she married celebrated anti-Soviet poet, actor, and balladeer Vladimir Vysotsky, with whom she lived in Moscow for a time and who died in 1980, having become a cult hero in Soviet Russia.

Her 1987 memoir of their life together, "Vladimir ou le Vol Arrêté" ("Vladimir, or the Interrupted Flight"), caused a stir among Vysotsky's fans in the Soviet Union because it candidly chronicled his drinking and drug use.

Ms. Vlady had always been politically engaged, taking a public stand against France's Algeria war, briefly joining the French Communist Party, and signing a celebrated declaration in favor of abortion rights, the Manifesto of the 343, in 1971.

She continued an abundant film, theater, and television career well into her 70s, published novels, short stories, and memoirs, and recorded a number of albums with her sisters.

Ms. Vlady leaves her sons Pierre and Vladimir.

In later years, Ms. Vlady was under no illusions about the burst of fame and celebrity that had catapulted her to stardom in the 1950s.

"In that era, the producers were real bastards," she told the newspaper Libération, after her last feature, "Quelques Jours de Répit" ("A Few Days of Respite"), was released. "Most of them didn't pay social security tax. The result is that, after a career of about 80 films, my pension is 600 euros a month."

LivingArts



ARAM BOGHOSIAN

The Double Concerto Suite for violin and cello by Carlos Simon (pictured at Symphony Hall in 2023) will be performed this week.

Carlos Simon, the BSO's first composer chair, is writing up a storm

By Jon Garelick
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

BOSTON SYMPHONY ORCHESTRA
With Hilary Hahn and Seth Parker Woods. Oct. 15-17, Symphony Hall. bso.org

Composer Carlos Simon has been writing up a storm, and he's not stopping anytime soon.

As the Boston Symphony Orchestra's first composer chair, Simon, who was appointed to the three-year position in 2024, was expected to write six new pieces for the orchestra. He has already premiered five (not counting his BSO-commissioned "Four Black American Dances," which premiered in 2023). This week, the BSO and star soloists Hilary Hahn and Seth Parker Woods will perform a sixth, the Double Concerto Suite for violin and cello. It will be on the BSO program with Tchaikovsky's Polonaise from "Eugene Onegin" and Act 2 of "The Nutcracker."

"That just goes to show how fruitful the relationship has been," Simon said of his productivity since starting with the BSO.

As a composer, he says, he's in the unusual situation of having the BSO as a "muse." The result, he said, is "I'm inspired to write more music than what's contractually available. I feel inspired by the musicians and the orchestra as well as the cultural climate in the city."

He points to his BSO-commissioned "Gardner Suite" — named for the Isabella Stewart Gardner Museum — as being inspired by his time in Boston. "So there are things that have just allowed me to be fruitful as a composer."

Simon, 40, has been a composer to watch for more than decade. A composer-in-residence at the Kennedy Center in Washington since 2021, he is perhaps best known for his works of racial reckoning: "Requiem for the Enslaved" (2022), commissioned by Georgetown University as a partial reparation for its sale of 272 enslaved men, women, and children in 1838; "brea(d)th" (2023), a Minnesota Orchestra commission, written in response to the murder of George Floyd; and "Elegy: A Cry from the Grave" (2015), dedicated to Trayvon Martin, Eric Garner, and Michael Brown.

Globe classical critic Jeremy Eichler called the live premiere performance of Simon's 10-movement "Requiem for the Enslaved" (with text by rapper Marco Pavé) at the Gardner Museum in 2022 with Boston's Hub New Music "at once a visceral sonic encounter and a powerful prompt for reflection." The instrumental passages of the 10-movement piece, wrote Eichler, allowed the music "to breathe, to exalt, and to mourn." A recording of the piece was nominated for a Grammy.

Despite the turbulence and sorrow in these pieces, Simon's work, always melodically rich, is also marked by bustle and color. His "Four Black American Dances" incorporated a ring shout, tap, waltz, and a Black church-inspired "Holy Dance." His "The Block" was inspired by painter Romare Beardon's abstract depiction of a Harlem neighborhood. And his succinct, high velocity "Motherboxx Connection" (revised for a BSO performance from his "Tales: A Folklore Symphony") drew on the Afrofuturistic imagery of the duo Black Kirby.

Hip-hop, jazz, the blues, gospel, spirituals, and the work of earlier Black symphonic composers like Florence Price, William Grant Still, and William Dawson all play a part in Simon's work along with the mainstream Western canon. He's also done stints as keyboardist and musical director for Broadway star Jennifer Holiday and toured with the late soul singer Angie Stone. For the BSO, he curated the March 2025 concert tribute to jazz giant John Coltrane. Perhaps the throughline in all these activities is his background as the son, grandson, and great-grandson of preachers, growing up playing organ in his father's church in Atlanta, a lineage he explored on the 2018 album "My Ancestor's Gift."

The Double Concerto Suite for violin and cello is unusual for Simon in that it's a purely instrumental piece with a traditional generic title. The idea originated with Hahn and Woods, who had met online with other musicians during the COVID pandemic and were looking for a piece they could perform together. They approached their mutual friend Simon, who obliged. The piece ultimately became co-commissioned with the BSO, National Symphony Orchestra, the St. Louis Symphony Orchestra, and l'Orchestre Philharmonique Royal de Liège.

"This is the first time I've done something like this since graduate school," said Simon. "I wanted to write absolute music without any programmatic element. Not inspired by a story or a concept, just music for music's sake."

The five-movement form, he said, is inspired by Baroque dance suites. "So I've used the gavotte, the gigue, passacaglia" as well as the blues. "It's loosely based on these things. It's not like I take the structure literarily." The goal he said, is to forge these elements in "my own compositional voice."

Hahn, for one, finds that voice unmistakable. "Every time I see Carlos," the violinist said in a phone interview, "he's very consistently who he is, and who he is is a big part of what his music says." She added, "It's still a piece by Carlos Simon, and it's Carlos's voice, and you can definitely recognize that if you know any of his other pieces."

In a separate interview, Woods concurred. "He's fusing so much of his own identity and writing with Baroque styles, quoting Bach," he said of the Double Concerto. "But then you get these beautiful drawn-out blues lines. He just finds a way to bring this sense of soulfulness," drawing from "European musical aesthetics and orchestration, but also deeply rooted in a Black American aesthetic." It is, he says, "kind of undeniable that this is a Carlos Simon work."

"There is always a sense of excitement when the orchestra gets to perform a new work by Carlos Simon, particularly one that the BSO has co-commissioned," BSO music director Andris Nelsons said in e-mail statement, citing "the extraordinary range of his artistry. ... His music beautifully reflects the spirit of our time while drawing on a rich variety of traditions, a combination which makes his work a great joy both to perform and to hear."

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'Dracula: A Comedy of Terrors' offers a bloody good time

By Chris Vognar
GLOBE STAFF





BENJAMIN ROSE PHOTOGRAPHY

From left: Nicholas Papayoanou and Paul Melendy; Doug Lockwood and Thalia Gerloff in "Dracula: A Comedy of Terrors."

STAGE REVIEW

DRACULA: A COMEDY OF TERRORS
Play by Gordon Greenberg and Steve Rosen. Directed by Christopher V. Edwards. Presented by Actors' Shakespeare Project. At the Dorothy and Charles Mosesian Center for the Arts, Watertown. Through Nov. 1. Tickets $52-$90; $25-$45 students. actorsshakespeareproject.org

That Count Dracula guy was always a vain sort of chap, with his capes and strict sleep regimen and Old European ways. In "Dracula: A Comedy of Terrors," the new Actors' Shakespeare Project production now stalking the stage at the Mosesian Center for the Arts, he's a fit, pansexual ham with a thing for leather pants, stretching one-syllable words to three as he struts and preens.

It makes perfect sense that he's played by Paul Melendy. This is actually Melendy's second libidinous, rapid-fire horror sendup of the year, following Central Square Theater's production of "The Mystery of Irma Vep." Comedy of Terrors" is equally madcap, but its focus is tighter. Bram Stoker's 1897 Gothic novel is the source material, with a healthy drop of major movie adaptations (chiefly Tod Browning's 1931 "Dracula" and F.W. Murnau's 1922 "Nosferatu"). Melendy's Dracula — generally pronounced here as "Draculia" — is a flamboyant slice of Eurotrash, blissfully aware of his killer body but a little bored with this eternal life business. He wants a woman who challenges him a little and plays hard to get. He wants Lucy (Thalia Gerloff).

You could even say he ... loves Lucy. If you think that's a bad joke, please know that "Comedy of Terrors" actually uses it — though Melendy's continual, colorful utterance of the name will have you thinking of Ricky Ricardo well before that moment arrives. If this all sounds over the top, that's largely the point. Gordon Greenberg and Steve Rosen's relentless farce, which premiered as a radio play in 2020 before moving off-Broadway in 2023, is an exercise in gleeful excess with the gender-bending instincts of Monty Python and the carpetbombing gag approach of Mel Brooks (who made his own Dracula parody, the movie "Dracula: Dead and Loving It," in 1995).

As in the Brooks oeuvre, not all the jokes stick here; the '80s called and they want their joke about Margaret Thatcher's teeth back. But "Comedy of Terrors" is a volume operation, running at a speed of a few jokes per minute, and it doesn't take long before you realize that resistance is futile. (It helps that the show runs just over 90 minutes with no intermission, which means there's little time for the energy levels to flag.)

Those levels are quite high under the direction of Christopher V. Edwards, and the show's impact is felt more cumulatively than scene by scene. Everyone but Melendy plays multiple roles, and two of the five actors, Doug Lockwood and Bobbie Steinbach, are in a constant state of quick-change, with two prominent parts each. Lockwood matches Melendy's antic energy — no small feat — as Mina, Lucy's on-the-make spinster sister; and Dr. Van Helsing, now a sturdy, take-charge German lass accustomed to being underestimated due to her gender. He's a joy, with his bulky physical presence accentuating the humor of his drag turns.

The ever-versatile Steinbach also swaps gender for two roles: as Dr. Westfeldt, Lucy and Mina's stuffy father; and, riotously, as Renfield, Dracula's hunchbacked, insect-eating servant (although her version more closely resembles the jittery Knock, from Murnau's "Nosferatu," than the Renfeld immortalized by Dwight Frye in Browning's "Dracula").

The key to "Comedy of Terrors" isn't just that it's a campy, queered-up take on a Gothic horror classic, but that it also smartly recognizes such qualities in the original. Flowing capes, sharp fangs, buckets of blood, the eternal waltz of sex and death: "Dracula" is one freaky tale, and it deserves every freaky variation it inspires.

Put another way: Is it really that big a leap from Bela Lugosi's suave, seductive Count Dracula to the pink tights sported by Melendy (before he switches to black leather), or the euro-flavored EDM that sends the characters gyrating and, in the case of the freshly bitten Jonathan Harker (Nicholas Papayoanou), hitting the floor for some thrusting push-ups? If you can't see the potential for fabulousness in "Dracula," you're probably not looking hard enough.

As you may have inferred, Zoë Sundra's costume design is to die for. Sound designer Mackenzie Adamick earns as many laughs as some of the dialogue. But the lithe, elastic Melendy is unquestionably the straw that stirs this bloody drink; if you can appreciate what he brings, and brings, and brings, then "Comedy of Terrors" is for you. He has no off switch, which makes him a fine choice for a role and a production that goes big at every opportunity.

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INSIDE
Comics
Weather
TV Listings

Food

THE BOSTON GLOBE WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 14, 2026 | BOSTONGLOBE.COM/FOOD

Q&A

Erin French's relationship to hospitality is 'complex'

By Alexandra Hall
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Everyone loves a good comeback story, and Erin French is New England's culinary comeback queen. Her best-selling memoir, "Finding Freedom: A Cook's Story; Remaking a Life from Scratch," digs into the Maine native's beginnings as a cook at her family's small-town diner followed by a cascade of personal hardships — which then became the springboard for personal triumphs.

Those triumphs have been piling up ever since. At this point, French is no longer in comeback mode, but a bona fide gastronomic icon. (Not a 'celebrity chef,' mind you — she's repeatedly denied being a 'chef.') With three original television series on the Magnolia Network under her belt, she's taking time off from her restaurant — The Lost

ERIN FRENCH, Page G2



The Lost Kitchen's Erin French is on tour for her third cookbook.

Inside

GETTING SALTY
BEHIND THE BREAD
Before churning out award-winning sourdough, Breadboard Bakery's Daisy Chow was an engineer.
G4

RECIPES
IT'S APPLEPALOOZA
Overpick at the orchard? Put your harvest to work in everything from pork chops to apple pie bars.
G5

RESTAURANT REVIEW | ★★★★★



ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

The benne dosa, made with fermented rice and lentil batter, blistered in butter and stuffed with spiced potato, is pictured with chutneys at Aatma at Widowmaker in Brighton

Does this taproom serve the best Indian food in Boston?

Aatma at Widowmaker is unique, unlikely, and wildly delicious.



DEVRA FIRST

It's late afternoon on a Thursday, not yet dinnertime, and the line to order at Aatma at Widowmaker is already 10 people deep. On Thursdays, and only on Thursdays, the restaurant serves vada pav, a crisp potato fritter on a bun, topped with a whole grilled chile and various chutneys, sweet, sour, and spicy. It is quintessential Mumbai street food. The dish is "intensely laborious," says chef Keith Sarasin. "We make all of it from scratch, from the bread to the seasonings." It sells out each week, and those in the know come early.

On this particular Thursday, those in the know are mainly of Indian descent, from college students to older couples. A man eating vada pav at the bar is talking with a bartender: "I can't get it like this anywhere else in the country," he says in a tone both dreamy and urgent, as if he has been transported somewhere far away — Mumbai, perhaps — and is speaking from a distance.

One of Boston's best Indian restaurants — one of Boston's best restaurants — is located inside a Brighton taproom, the food made by "a white guy from New Hampshire," as Sarasin describes himself. Customers order at the bar. On the wall is a mural of the Hindu goddess Kali, awhirl in a garland of skulls.

The chef-owner grew up on a steady diet of chicken nuggets and mac and cheese, until one day an Indian friend made him a deal: If Sarasin lost their next game of Quake, he would have to try Indian food. "It was the best bet I

AATMA, Page G3

A look inside the new restaurant inside South Station Tower

By Kara Baskin
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

The Moseley brings fine dining to the long-awaited, 51-story South Station Tower (680 Atlantic Ave.).

Episcope Hospitality runs the restaurant. Chicago-based David Morton, a scion of the Morton's steakhouse family, leads the firm. Episcope's portfolio includes The Landing at New York City's PENN 1 tower and The Water Park development in Arlington, Va.

The ninth-floor restaurant spans nearly 10,000 square feet with seating for over 200 guests. It's open for lunch, dinner, and private events.

"If South Station is a welcome mat, we want to be the welcome hug," Morton says. "At the risk of trying to be something for everybody, we want to be something for everybody. ... Our hope is that it's a place you can come to a few times a week."

THE MOSELEY, Page G4



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

The Moseley restaurant at the South Station Tower is set to open with a commanding view from the ninth floor.

WHAT SHE'S HAVING

Everyone loves apple cider doughnuts

By Sheryl Julian
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

MILTON — Apple cider doughnuts are delicious little seasonal treats that you can smell before you even pull into an orchard in the fall. Even the bad ones taste good, and the lines to get them usually curve around the farm stand. They're all worth the wait.

These are cake doughnuts, which have a denser crumb than the puffy, airy yeast kind you get at local doughnut shops. Cake doughnuts, at least at farm stands, are rarely glazed and they're almost all served the same way: Either plain or tossed in sugar (sometimes mixed with cinnamon) and handed to customers while they're still warm.

When Suzanne Lombardi was a girl and went to stay summers with her grandmother in a rustic cabin on Long Pond on Maine's Mount Desert Island, she fell in love with small molasses cake doughnuts that her grandmother bought. "I've loved doughnuts since I was a kid," says Lombardi, a chef, baker, and former restaurateur, who is making doughnuts — practically without thinking — in her light-filled kitchen.

Early on Sunday mornings, Lombardi and her grandmother would set off for Higgins Market in the village of Somesville for molasses doughnuts. "Maine has a thing for doughnuts," says Lombardi. These were made by a woman who lived on Islesboro, a neighbor-

WHAT SHE'S HAVING, Page G5



SHERYL JULIAN FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Suzanne Lombardi's apple cider doughnuts tossed in sugar.

Insider

Eat hommus, support breast cancer research

As October turns the spotlight on breast cancer awareness, Cedar's Foods is doing its part. Since 2020, the Haverhill-based Mediterranean foods company has donated $50,000 annually to the Breast Cancer Research Foundation, and throughout the month its tubs of hommus (the "o" is the traditional spelling) wear BCRF's pink ribbon logo.

The 40-year-old company's generous contribution is inspired by team members who are breast cancer survivors and others currently in treatment. To directly acknowledge local caretakers this month, Cedar's is also delivering hommus snack packs to Merrimack Health locations in Haverhill, Lawrence, and Methuen.

"We think nationally but act locally," says Aimee Tsakirellis, Cedar's Foods executive vice president of marketing. "And do whatever we can to make a transitional difference for our employees and the community."

Giving back to the community has always been part of the recipe. The company donated thousands of pounds of hommus to local residents during the pandemic, and funded community events throughout the Merrimack Valley as well as New England. "It's a pillar of who we are," says Tsakirellis.



Cedar's is a family-run business in its third generation, launched in the 1970s by Abe and Layla Hanna after the couple emigrated from Lebanon to the Merrimack Valley and started selling Layla's hommus in the refrigerated case of a local DeMoulas Market. When America's appetite for the chickpea dip took off in the 1990s, Cedar's rode the wave. Today, the company is the largest producer of hommus in the United States, churning out nearly 150 million pounds each year. Its products are sold at 15,000-plus retailers nationwide.

Cedar's The Original Hommus, $2.99-$3.99 for 8 oz. at retailers nationwide. For more information, visit cedarsfoods.com.

ANN TRIEGER KURLAND

Cocktail napkins that double as conversation starters

If birds can build nests, then they can make hats!"

This is artist Vicki Sawyer's tagline, and anyone familiar with her whimsical paintings knows she takes this idea to heart — and canvas. After designing dolls and composing hundreds of murals around New York City, she pivoted to painting striking images of the natural world — namely, birds and animals in elaborate headwear made from fruits, vegetables, flowers, and greenery.

These days, her work is easily enjoyed at the dining room table. Her paper napkins (both cocktail- and luncheon-size) and placemats feature a menagerie of delightfully decorated characters. Harold the Hedgehog poses among a fanciful cluster of mushrooms. Squirrels Sam and Kris wear a strawberry and a flower as crowns. The birds of Entourage sport extravagant floral headdresses, as though they're on their way to a fancy brunch.

It's the sort of millinery that would turn heads at any party, but the inspiration is rooted in the natural world. Sawyer grew up on a farm in Pennsylvania, where her grandfather taught her to identify plants and birds.


VICKI SAWYER

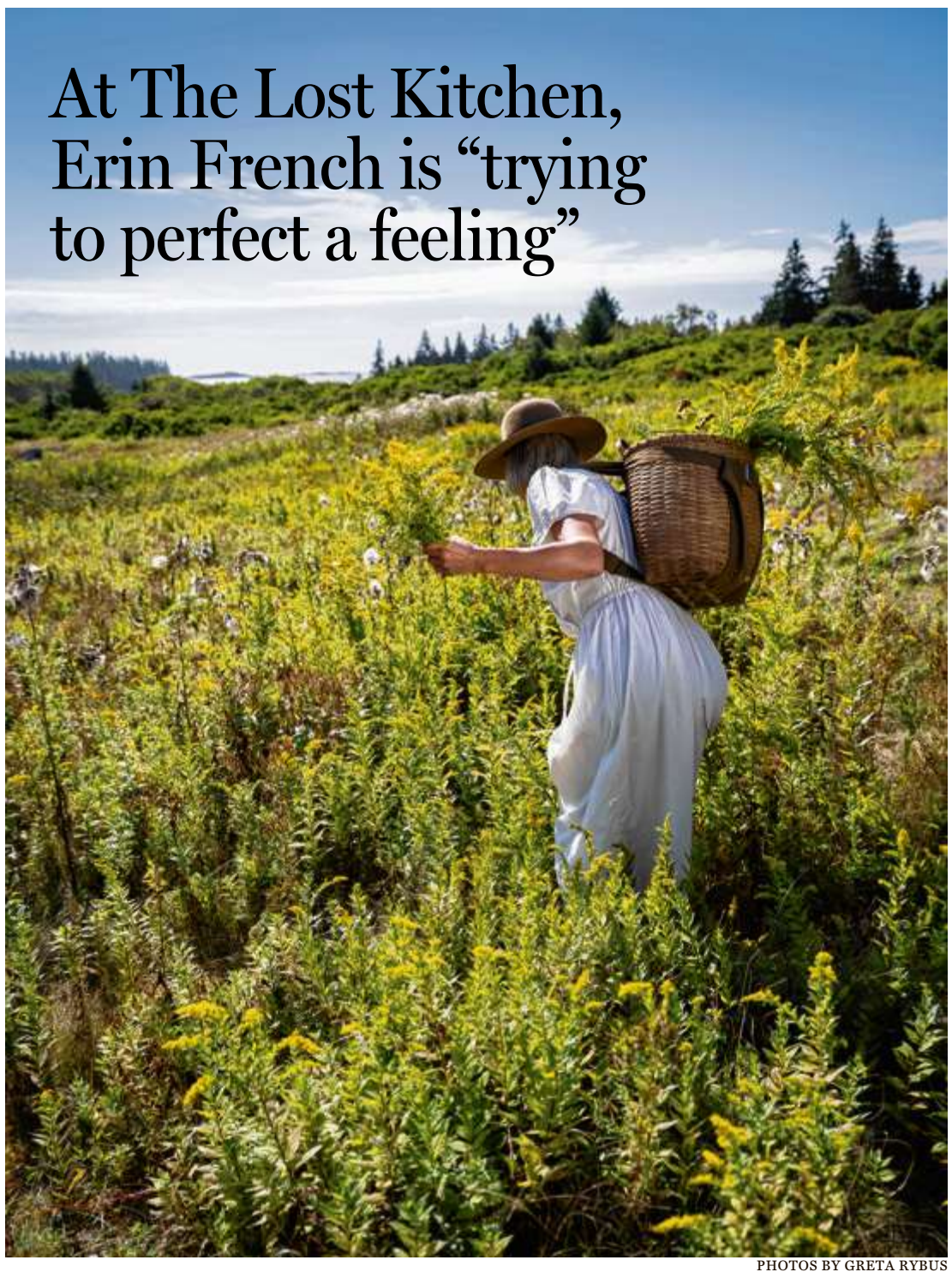
The three-ply napkins are made from oxygen-bleached tissue, printed with water-based colors, and sold in packs of 20: $6 for the 5-inch-square beverage size and $7 for the 6½-inch-square luncheon size.

Placed beneath a martini or passed alongside cheesy hors d'oeuvres, these napkins start the conversation before anyone has to ask, "So how do you know the hosts?"

Vicki Sawyer napkins are available at Greentail Table, 343 Watertown St., Newton, 617-244-3510; Mount Auburn Hospital Gift Shop, 330 Mt. Auburn St., Cambridge, 617-492-3500; Westcott Mercantile, 63 Leonard St., Belmont, 617-484-0093; Russell's Garden Center, 397 Boston Post Road, Wayland; Idylwilde Farm, 366 Central St., Acton, 978-263-5943; and Mass Audubon Shop, 208 South Great Road, Lincoln, 781-259-2214.

ANN TRIEGER KURLAND

At The Lost Kitchen, Erin French is "trying to perfect a feeling"


PHOTOS BY GRETA RYBUS

▶ERIN FRENCH
Continued from Page G1

Kitchen in Freedom, Maine — for a national tour touting her third cookbook, "The Lost Kitchen Volume 3: Seize the Supper," which publishes on Tuesday, Oct. 13. In advance of her speaking event for the book at The Wilbur on Wednesday, Oct. 14, we chatted with her about everything from the evolution of her cookbooks and clapping back on dinner-check naysayers to what hospitality means right now.

In the new cookbook, you write that creating the feeling of a meal at The Lost Kitchen is: "... taking into account the time of year, the weather, the ingredients that are at their best, the mood, and the sense of place and then putting it all together with the desire to savor something that we know is fleeting." What's the genesis of that feeling at the restaurant? Did it come together organically, or was it by design?

It's actually been experimental — trying things and feeling them and [seeing] what works. And you follow your gut, knowing when something felt really delicious. I never went into this thinking I was going to open this restaurant. I think what surprised me is people's reactions, and then I just started making changes and decisions off of those reactions, and slowly navigating off the page. That's how we got to dinners [as] we're serving them today, and it was just answering the call of how people were responding. It's all just kind of like a lesson in psychology — you feed people and see the response, and let it guide you.

Has the process of writing cookbooks changed for you?

Yeah. I didn't have the confidence that I have now when I wrote that first book, because as a first-time author, I had a lot to prove and a lot of people asking questions. And now being through that process a couple of times, I've proven my weight, and I'm able to have freedom with this book. I was able to be a thousand percent myself and make the executive decisions to say, 'No, I understand the process now deeply, and this is exactly how I want it to go, and these are exactly how I want the order of the pictures,' and not be afraid to kind of push back on these larger publishing houses who are telling you a lot of their feelings. So this book felt supremely, confidently me.

Meanwhile, right now we see authenticity and being yourself is also what culture is craving so much — whether it's in our political leaders, or our celebrities, or our food.

Yeah. Even looking at everything on social media and all of these things, it's like everyone's just trying to keep up and be the same, and it's so tiring. Tiring to spend all of your life's energy trying to be something else instead of just being uniquely exactly you.

Right now there's also this invigorating discussion in our culture being sparked by entertainment media, on shows like "The Bear," asking what food and hospitality really mean to us in our relationships, and arguing that feeding people is — at its best — about caring for people. So in that context, what does hospitality mean to you right now?

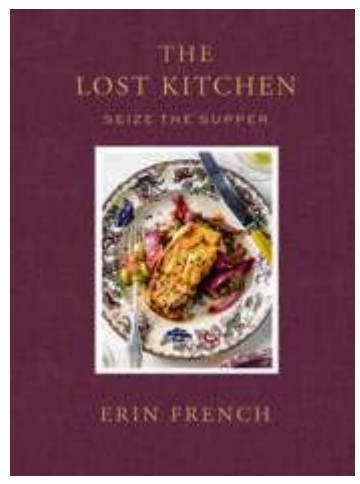
I'm glad you're asking this because, you know, to be honest, I've been digging deep on this this summer. I've tried multiple different things with our restaurant and this has all been a learning curve for me. Thirteen years now at this restaurant has been an educational experience. And my thoughts and opinions on hospitality have been ever-evolving ... And for me it's putting yourself in absolute control over the people that are coming into your world and letting them think that they are in control the entire time. But the truth is that you're guiding them because you want them to feel comfortable. It's about letting them feel that they're in control when actually you're making decisions for them all night long, so they don't have to make a single decision. That, to me, is the utmost hospitality.

Which can be a very big orchestration.

It absolutely is. It's production. You know, to be honest. I've learned ... maybe I would have been a good producer in another life because there are so many other layers to it. And it's rough. I have a complex relationship with it and have gone from feeling beaten up, battered, and abused by it to having it be the most insanely addictive love affair I've ever been in my life. And I think that is the honest truth of it — that it rides both of those lines.

When you say beaten up by it, is that because of your own expectations? What's causing that?

I think there's a mix of things. I will say, customers can be difficult, and the expectations can be sometimes unheard of, unruly, and completely challenging. And the other thing about this line of work is that it can become a very



Plates of pork roast with apricots and olives, over soft polenta with honey and ricotta (bottom left) feature in Erin French's "The Lost Kitchen Volume 3: Seize the Supper."

easy place to put all of your self-worth into. And if you're putting all of your self-worth into a dish, and you're putting it on a plate, it can feel like your entire heart and soul are on that plate. And you can give that to someone who can go and then either devour it or break your heart. It's a very intimate process, caring for people, feeding people, and walking them into your space and giving them something deeply personal.

And with affordability being on everyone's mind these days, what's your response to some who've said The Lost Kitchen is too costly? [Dinners have a base price of $295 per person, not including tax, gratuity, or alcohol.]

I think it's a matter of what people want to spend money on. If you think about it, you could go to Applebee's three times, and that's how much it would cost you for one dinner at my place that would change your life — as opposed to just fill your stomach a couple of times. So I think it's all about priorities for people. I will say, I don't think we value food enough. Or the work that goes into it. One thing that drives me crazy endlessly is [that] people expect a free bread course and I'm like, 'Do you know how much it costs to make a really good loaf of bread?" It's $15 for a very well-made loaf of bread, and the fact that you think that we should give these things for free? That's on top of what goes into the evening itself. It's a performance. It's like we're putting on a show. You think of what people spend on concerts, but you're getting a concert and we're also feeding you 15 courses on top of it.

Until recently in history, chefs and cooks who got the most attention were all men, while the vast majority of cooking all over the world was being done by women. At the moment, you're one of relatively few public-facing chefs who are female, and being celebrated for it. Talk about what that means for you — especially since you also have an all-female staff.

I would imagine that our kitchen runs quite differently from some other kitchens. I think also, women cook from a different place. We're cooking from a place of wanting to provide care and nourishment for their families, to care for their homes, and the people and their lives. We don't cook from a place where we want to win or to make a dish that's the best dish in the world.

I'm trying to perfect a feeling. I'm cooking for the people who are sitting around the table and have them be my biggest judges and not judging for like, was it perfect, you know? It's just like you're just trying to evoke a feeling from them. I don't think women cook competitively. I mean, unless they're trying to, because we feel like we have to keep up or prove something, but that's not the natural place where we cook from.

The new book is structured seasonally, and so often when cookbooks do that, they start with spring. But this one begins with winter. Was there a reason for that order?

I know it should be spring, [with a] fresh beginning, but that's not the way it rolls here. I feel like spring never tastes so sweet until you've been through winter. And so, you start with the hardest part and then you end with the sweetest part, which actually is fall. So I just felt like that was more of an honest progression — start hard and end with the good stuff.

Tickets to see Erin French's book launch at The Wilbur can be found at https://thewilbur.com/artist/erin-french/



PHOTOS BY ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

Customers dine beneath a colorful mural at Aatma at Widowmaker, inside Widowmaker Brewing in Brighton.

At Aatma, traditions are skillfully bent and broken

▶AATMA
Continued from Page G1

ever lost," Sarasin says. "It was like Neo seeing the Matrix."

So launched an almost 20-year journey that took him to India, immersed him in the country's regional cuisines, taught him Hindi, and introduced him to some of the world's top Indian chefs, all as his work life revolved around farm-inspired New American cuisine at New Hampshire restaurant Greenleaf and events company The Farmers Dinner. Eventually mentors convinced him he had a calling, and Sarasin launched Aatma, first as a popup, then at Widowmaker Brewing late last year.

The restaurant's name means "soul" in Hindi.

Approaching its Brighton corner, one can smell the spices from half a block away. These are the backbone of Aatma's cuisine. Sarasin goes to India each year to seek them out. Spice blends are all toasted and ground in house.

In one bite of Better Butter Chicken, the difference is clear. The food tastes alive, as if the kitchen sharpened the focus and added filters for depth and contrast. It isn't just the spices that make the butter chicken better. Instead of cream, Sarasin and his team use cashews, a traditional thickener that makes the dish rich but not heavy.

The benne dosa, a specialty of the southern city of Davangere, is a buttery, crisp, golden crepe, anointed with Kashmiri chile oil and gunpowder spice mix (curry leaves, sesame seeds, urad and chana dal, and Kashmiri chiles), folded around spiced potatoes. It's one of the best things I've eaten all year — a year in which I also ate the famed gunpowder dosa at Michelin-starred Semma in New York. (Chef Vijay Kumar and Sarasin are friends, and Kumar ate at Aatma earlier this year.)

But what most sets Aatma at Widowmaker apart is its proudly untraditional approach. "NOT AUTHENTIC," declares a card placed on the table. "We don't copy. We contribute." Food is an evolution, authenticity an ongoing conversation. Aatma has something to add, brash but couched in deep respect for cuisine and culture.

The clearest example of this is the smash burger. (Aatma has become known for the dish, which helped contribute to long lines and long waits, alleviated since the restaurant added reservations.) Inspired by Pashtun chapli kebabs, it is made with masala-spiced beef patties, achari pickled onions, and India's iconic processed Amul cheese, slathered in smoky, sweet, savory Aatma sauce — as if McDonald's Tangy BBQ went to the subcontinent for vacation and decided not to come back. On the side: Chaat-er Tots, tots tossed in chaat masala.

It is in your face. It is a playful joke on a plate. And it is delicious, one of the best burgers in town. (A vegan version is coming soon.) It is also spicy, although the menu makes no mention of this. Same with many of the dishes here. It feels intentional: This is Aatma. Take it or leave it. "Too many cuisines apologize for who they are," Sarasin says.

Other twists are subtler. Steaming clay-pot biryani is made, unusually, with tender, rich lamb belly, buttery meat against buttery grains. The rice, stained saffron, tastes and smells of perfume and barn, flavored with rosewater-adjacent kewra (screw-pine). It's heady and wonderful. And now it's gone. Aatma's menu changes every few months, and starting Oct. 14 the biryani is made with mushrooms instead. (The menu is divided evenly between veg and non-veg; all of the meat is halal.)



The vada pav, made with Kufri Pukhraj potatoes, mustard seed, garlic chutney, khatta meetha, and buttered pav.

Reflecting the season, this new menu — which includes kale chaat with smoked sweet potatoes and cranberries, and squash pakora with apple chutney and dried sage — underscores that Aatma is a restaurant informed by place, and that includes New England as well as India.

Patra Ni Machi is a Parsi dish in which fish is coated with green coconut chutney, wrapped in banana leaf, and steamed. Sarasin makes it with local haddock, which he grills to add smokiness, then unwraps it, dunks it in a spiced batter of chickpea and rice flour, and fries it. It's served with Chaat-er Tots, grilled lime halves, and ranch dressing. It's fish and chips, Aatma style.

The fish is leaving the menu, but New England-influenced gulab jamun remains, the cozy dessert dumplings soaking in maple syrup. The textures and flavors are reminiscent of brown bread steamed in a can. A new dessert arrival — Nu England Parsi custard — is "a tale of two mothers": Sarasin's own, who loved Grape-Nut pudding, and his friend and mentor Kurush Dalal's, who was a famed Mumbai caterer and cookbook author. Many of the dishes here are based around moments, memories, and people from Sarasin's life.

Aatma's food is poetry and punk rock, and it goes perfectly with beer. (There's also mango lassi, chai, and India's Thums Up cola.) The partnership with Widowmaker Brewing isn't incidental; there's an affinity of temperament between the teams. Order the Queenfisher, a premium lager from Widowmaker that's an homage to India's Kingfisher beer.

After work, the taproom hosts beer geeks thirsty for pours of Blue Comet and Sludge Factory. Come evening, the space fills with a youthful crowd, here to eat: queer couples with incredible fashion sense, college students accompanied by hip moms, groups of 20- and 30-something friends, many of them Indian. "It's a 2½-hour wait," the host tells new arrivals apologetically.

It's a vibrant scene that feels more like Brooklyn or San Francisco. But it's here, on a Brighton corner scented with spices. Aatma at Widowmaker presents a point of view, knowledge of and respect for culinary tradition, and the skill to bend or break it in new and delicious ways. In a casual setting that puts on zero airs, it is serving some of the most exciting food we've got going right now.

AATMA AT WIDOWMAKER ★★★★★
190 N. Beacon St., Brighton, 617-390-0660, www.aatmacurryhouse.com
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★★★★★ Extraordinary | ★★★★ Excellent | ★★★ Very good | ★★ Good | ★ Fair | (No stars) Poor

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KEN MCGAGH FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Chef Keith Sarasin (right) serves Indian delicacies like patra ni machi, New England haddock marinated with banana leaf-smoked coconut and chili chutney and fried in besan batter with chaat-er tots at Aatma at Widowmaker Brewing.

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GETTING SALTY



PAT GREENHOUSE/GLOBE STAFF

Daisy Chow divides and shapes sourdough and seeded sourdough loaves at Breadboard Bakery.

Before opening a bakery, Arlington's Daisy Chow was a math whiz and an engineer

By Kara Baskin
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Arlington's Daisy Chow, 48, owns Arlington's Breadboard Bakery, where she's renowned for breads, croissants, and kolaches. She paid her dues: After quitting an engineering job, she built her baking skills at Maison Robert and Clear Flour, and hosted pop-ups at Cutty's before striking out on her own seven years ago.

Earlier this year, she got her second win at Le Grand Prix Elmendorf du Pain, a professional and amateur baking contest and food extravaganza run by Cambridge's Elmendorf Baking Supplies.

Chow talks about growing up as a math student in Texas, a baker's erratic sleep schedule, her bakery's signature croissants and kolaches, and her favorite local restaurants.

How did you come to start Breadboard? Walk me through the history.

I always go backward when I do this. This November, I will have been here seven years. Before this, I was doing bakery pop-ups at Cutty's in Brookline for maybe close to five years, which sounds ridiculous. I was doing that for five years mostly because I was looking for a bakery location that fit my budget that had the power requirements for my equipment.

While I was doing that, I was still working at Clear Flour. I'd been there for 15 years.

You developed such a loyal following through Cutty's. Did you just approach them and say: "Hello! Might I pop up in your sandwich shop?" How does that work?

Mary [Ting Hyatt] from Bagelsaurus was working there before, and she's friends with [Cutty's] Rachel Kelsey. And it turns out I went to college with Rachel. I went to the Columbia Engineering School, and she was at Barnard, which was the women's school across the street.

I was a rower. She was on the soccer team, but we never crossed paths. So then it turned out we both were in food in Boston, and our connecting person was Mary. They basically said, "Do you want to work on your business plan and practice having your own mini bakery here at Cutty's?" And I said yes.

How does one go from Columbia Engineering to becoming a baker?

My parents had a Chinese restaurant in Texas, so I was used to being in kitchens. I was always the nerdy kid in school. I loved math. I decided to apply to the best schools I could possibly get into, and the school that felt the most well-rounded and the most fun was Columbia. While I was at Columbia, I delved back into food and started writing for the school paper and did restaurant reviews.

But then I got an engineering job with an MIT startup when I graduated, which was in Somerville. And about a year into it, I just wasn't feeling it. I started thinking: "Here's my quarter-life crisis. Am I going back to grad school? What do I do next?"

I had read "Kitchen Confidential" the summer before. It was cool to be in a kitchen, and also a little rough. Anyway, I applied to work at Maison Robert.

I quickly realized that to work in the kitchen, especially in pastry, all you need is a brain and to be able to follow directions. You can pick up the other skills. It's not rocket science. It's easy to get fast and skilled at things if you just repeat them over and over again. That's how I hire people now: The best people can follow instructions, and have a good personality.

So I have no formal experience. My food background is based on [Maison Robert], which was French pastry, which is the basis of most baking.

How did you manage this?

I quit my engineering job, and in order to afford my rent, I also had to take another part-time job. So I ended up working at Formaggio Kitchen. I worked part-time in their bakery and behind their retail counter.

What was that like?

Really fun. I met some very interesting people there, and I got to taste a lot of cheeses.

[Later], I applied twice to Clear Flour. Eventually, I got in. I think the first time the timing wasn't right, and the second time it stuck. I was there for like 15 years. I never thought I'd be there that long.

When you apply to be a baker at a place like Clear Flour, do you go in and audition with your greatest hits? What happens?

Basically, you stage. You spend a day or a few hours working in the back, and you know ideally they're not trying to make you do anything impossible. They want to see what skills you have, what potential you might have. Maybe you'll be handling dough, watching someone shape something or use a piece of machinery, and then you copy that.

A lot of things aren't natural for baking, like tension: How much tension do you need to put into shaping? A lot of times dough is sticky, and so: How much flour do you use? Not too much, but not too little. [You need] just the right amount, so you can have a nonstick sort of texture on your hands. It's just a matter of experience. When hiring somebody, you want to see the potential that maybe this person could improve over three loaves, if they're listening to what you're saying.

There are people who will just be like: "Yeah, I got it," and then make the same mistake over and over again. You need someone who will watch, pay attention, and then have the set of hand skills to brain skills, that sort of connection. Potters and ceramicists are very good.

I think I was good at it because I really wanted to see all the details and really focus. I wasn't going to jump in and say, "Yeah, I have this skill!" I'm very humble. It doesn't sound humble to say you're humble! I just wanted to make sure I did a good job.

I get it. Tell me something. Why did you choose Arlington for Breadboard?

I think it was a bunch of practical things, like [the space] had the power I needed for my oven. The price point, the rent, was very reasonable. It was already a food establishment. It had a restaurant footprint, gas, electricity, bathrooms in place. It was basically more or less ready to go for making food and selling it.

What are you known for?

Well, bread. Bread is our main focus here. We love bread. We love making it. We love eating it. We're not bread snobs. We do a lot of sourdough, but we also have a lot of things that are commercially yeasted like baguettes and challah. We do like to have fun with sourdough.

We try to use as many local ingredients as possible. Our flour is from Western Mass., from Ground Up Grain, and also from Elmendorf in Cambridge. We also use King Arthur standard whitebread flour.

I love our croissants. They're 30 percent whole wheat. I like to make everything just a little bit different and jam in some whole grain goodness. And then we have other things like kolaches, a Czech Texan pastry.

What time do you have to wake up?

We're open every other day, and we bake three days a week. On baking days, I'll get up at 2 a.m. because I live in the neighborhood. I can just walk over, so I will start working at 2:30. On other days, I might sleep in a little bit, until like 6. If I can sleep in more, I will. But it's not easy doing a very early morning and then sleeping in. The sleep schedule is very erratic. I'm here until 3 p.m.

Where do you go after work? Home to crash?

I take a quick one-hour nap before dinner, and then maybe another one before brushing my teeth and going to sleep. I'm so tired all the time.

Where do you love to eat when you're not working (or napping)? Do you have any favorite local haunts?

Oh my gosh, BoonNoon.

I love them. They're the nicest. What do you order?

Crispy chive cakes, and panang curry if they have it. And the lemon tofu appetizer is very good. It tastes weirdly like fish sticks.

What closed restaurant do you really miss?

I have several. Let's see; the first one that comes to mind because we moved to Arlington from Allston is Blue Asia Cafe, a Taiwanese restaurant. The nicest sisters ran the place. It felt a little like a blue plate special: meat over rice and two side veggies.

And I found an old jean jacket the other day and I saw a Hungry Mother button on it. [I miss] Hungry Mother.

What do you think that the Boston food scene excels at, and where could we improve?

Good question. My bakers and I were having this conversation about how some places just don't live up to the hype. You go and then maybe service is not great, or it's more expensive than what you would think. You know, Boston's just not necessarily friendly to starting businesses because real estate is so expensive. Rent is so high. Maybe that's something that could be better.

What's good about the Boston food scene? There seems to be an uptick of Asian-owned places when I feel like there weren't so many. Rubato is the number-one example for me. Even Boon Noon. My friend Nancy, who owns Silver Whisk Baking. She does wedding cakes in Waltham. I'm seeing more Asian representation in food ... people branching out and doing new things because they can. I think that's cool.

I [wish we had more] mid-range food, like really well-executed burgers, sandwiches. More places like Cutty's and Bagelsaurus. Really, I would be happy with more great diners or places that you would frequent more regularly.

Is there any food that you will never eat, or an ingredient that you hate?

I don't want to alienate you. I might say caraway seeds. Or anything that's overly sweet or overly frosted — like cupcakes with as much frosting as the cake part itself, or a frosted brownie.

Interview was edited and condensed. Kara Baskin can be reached at kara.baskin@globe.com. Follow her @kcbaskin.

Stately, not stuffy vibes at South Station Tower restaurant

▶THE MOSELEY
Continued from Page G1

Chef Tindaro Losurdo was previously the vice president of culinary operations at Rosa Mexicano Restaurants and executive chef at Abe & Louie's in the Back Bay.

Morton describes the menu as casual fine dining, and dishes are straightforward: pan-roasted chicken, filet mignon, cavatelli Bolognese, miso black cod. Morton is especially fond of the tuna hamachi poke bowl.

As for the atmosphere: Think stately, but not stuffy.

"It can look and feel maybe almost more hotel-esque, but with a lot of warmth, care, friendliness, and professionalism, in a casual format. If you just want to pop in with jeans and a T-shirt, great. Or you could host a spectacular 200-person event," he says.

Mainly, Morton hopes that this is a comforting standby for a busy transportation hub.

"We really hope to be that day-to-day option. To me, in 2026, success looks like: 'Let's just go to the Moseley because it's always good. It's always predictable. They know us; we know them. And, if it's full, we know they can get us in.'"

The Moseley is open from 11:30 a.m. to 9 p.m. on weekdays and on Saturdays from 5 p.m. to 9 p.m.

Kara Baskin can be reached at kara.baskin@globe.com. Follow her @kcbaskin.



PHOTOS BY JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

Bartender Shay Carrick serves a proper spritz made with sari, vela butterfly vodka, prosecco, and lime.



The tuna hamachi poke bowl with sushi rice, wasabi peas, pickled Fresno pepper, avocado, radish, and soy-lime vinaigrette.



The dining room at The Moseley.



The charred heirloom cauliflower.

APPLE RECIPES

WHAT TO COOK THIS WEEK



SHERYL JULIAN FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Baked Apples with Walnuts

Serves 4

Whole baked apples are a wonderful dessert, but when you go to serve them, no one wants a gigantic apple at the end of the meal, so you have to cut them in half. At least this happens often to me. Why not begin with halves? They cook faster and there are fewer apples to core. The halves don't look quite as regal as whole apples, but they've got all the same, winsome qualities: tender flesh, the scent of cinnamon, toasty walnuts, and buttery, brown sugar pan juices. Serve with ice cream, whipped cream, or yogurt.

Butter (for the baking dish)
2 large baking apples (Cortland, Golden Delicious, Rome Beauty, Baldwin, Mutsu, Jonagold)
2 tablespoons dark brown sugar
2 tablespoons walnuts, coarsely chopped
½ teaspoon ground cinnamon
1 tablespoon butter, cut into 4 pieces
2 tablespoons orange juice

1. Set the oven at 350 degrees. Generously butter an 8-inch baking dish, or another dish large enough to hold the 4 apple halves in one layer.
2. Halve the apples through their cores. Carefully, using the tip of a paring knife, remove the cores, taking care not to split the apple. Remove small pieces of core at the bottom of the halves. Leave any stems intact. Arrange the apples, cut sides up, in the dish. It's OK if they're touching.
3. In a bowl, combine the brown sugar, walnuts, and cinnamon. With a small spoon, divide the filling among the apples. Add a piece of butter to each one. Carefully spoon enough orange juice over each one to moisten them without disturbing the butter.
4. Tent a piece of foil over the dish so it doesn't touch the top of the apples.
5. Bake the apples for 20 minutes. Lift off the foil and baste the apples with the pan juices. Continue baking, uncovered, for 10 to 15 minutes, or until the apples are tender when pierced with a skewer. If the bottom of the pan seems dry during cooking, add a few spoons of water. (Total baking time is 30 to 35 minutes.)
6. Serve in shallow bowls with the pan juices spooned over them.

Sheryl Julian

Pork Chops with Apples and Potatoes

Serves 4

Thick, center-cut, boneless pork loin chops star in this comforting, homestyle dish, which becomes slightly smoky with a couple strips of bacon. The chops are browned first, then set on a bed of onions, apples, and small golden potatoes to finish in the oven. Cook the potatoes first so they're nice and tender before they go into the pot. Use any apples you like. Some will break down in the sauce. If you want to see apple slices in the finished dish, use a baking apple such as Cortland or Jonagold, which will hold their shape better.

Salt and pepper, to taste
16 baby golden potatoes (sometimes labeled "creamer potatoes")
2 thick slices of bacon, cut into matchsticks
1 tablespoon canola or vegetable oil
4 thick center-cut boneless pork loin chops
1 large onion, coarsely chopped
2 medium apples, peeled, cored, and thickly sliced
1¼ cups chicken stock
Handful fresh thyme, leaves removed from stems

1. Set the oven at 400 degrees.



SHERYL JULIAN FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

2. Bring a large saucepan of salted water to a boil. Add the potatoes and return the water to a boil. Lower the heat, cover the pan, and simmer for 10 to 15 minutes, or until the potatoes are tender when pierced with a skewer, but not falling apart. Drain into a colander.
3. Meanwhile, in a large, deep skillet or Dutch oven over medium heat, cook the bacon, stirring often, for 5 minutes, or until it is golden brown and has rendered all its fat. With a slotted spoon, remove it from the pan.
4. Sprinkle the pork chops on both sides with salt and pepper. Add the vegetable or canola oil to the pan (if there's a lot of bacon fat, you may not need extra oil) and heat over medium-high heat. When it is hot, add the chops. Brown for 4 minutes. Turn and brown the undersides for 4 minutes more. Remove from the pan.
5. Add the onion to the pan with a pinch each of salt and pepper. Lower the heat to medium. Cook, stirring, for 10 minutes, or until the onion softens completely. Add the apples to the pan and cook, stirring gently, for 3 minutes, or until they start to soften.
6. Add the potatoes to the pan. Return the chops to the pan, setting them on the vegetables in one layer. Pour in the chicken stock. Sprinkle the chops with half the thyme. Bring to a boil.
7. Transfer the pan to the oven. Cook, uncovered, for 10 to 15 minutes, or until a meat thermometer inserted into the thickest part of the pork registers 145 degrees. Remove the pan from the oven. Let it sit in a warm place for 5 minutes.
8. Transfer the pork chops to a cutting board. Cut them into thick slices. Taste the vegetable mixture for seasoning and add more salt and pepper, if you like. Spoon the vegetables and cooking juices onto 4 shallow plates. Add a sliced pork chop to each. Garnish with the remaining thyme.

Sheryl Julian



SHERYL JULIAN FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Apple Pie Bars

Makes 9

Thinly sliced apples layered between a buttery crust and a crumble topping make a casual version of a pie without having to get out a rolling pin. Use a food processor for the bottom crust, stopping just short of turning the mixture into a dough. Press it firmly into a parchment-lined square pan and bake until lightly browned. Meanwhile, partially cook sliced apples in a skillet to soften them slightly. Spread them in the crust and cover with the crumble topping. The bars are a cross between apple pie and apple crisp, made into portable portions for each eager eater.

CRUST

Butter (for the pan)
1½ cups flour
2 tablespoons light brown sugar
½ teaspoon salt
½ cup (1 stick), cold unsalted butter, cut into small cubes
1 egg yolk

1. Butter a 9-inch square pan. Cut a piece of parchment paper that is 9 inches wide and about 17 inches long. Line the bottom and two sides of the pan with the parchment, leaving a 2-inch overhang on each side to form a sling.
2. In a food processor, combine the flour, brown sugar, salt, butter, and egg yolk. Pulse until the mixture starts to clump together and forms large crumbs. Don't let it form a dough.
3. Spread the crumbs on the bottom of the pan and press them firmly. To smooth the crumbs, line the outside of a dry measuring cup with plastic wrap and glide it over the dough, pressing to smooth it. With a fork, prick the dough in several places. Set the food processor aside (don't wash it) to make the topping.
4. Bake for 20 minutes, or until lightly browned. Set on a wire rack to cool.

TOPPING

⅔ cup flour
¼ cup light brown sugar
⅛ teaspoon salt
1 teaspoon cinnamon
6 tablespoons cold unsalted butter, cut into small cubes
⅓ cup old-fashioned rolled oats (not quick-cooking or steel-cut)

1. In the food processor, combine the flour, brown sugar, salt, cinnamon, and butter. Pulse the mixture until it turns slightly darker in color and forms pea-size crumbs.
2. Add the oats and pulse briefly to blend them in.

APPLES

6 large apples (Honeycrisp, Granny Smith, Cortland), peeled, cored, and halved through the stem
¼ cup light brown sugar
Juice of ½ lemon
1 tablespoon ground cinnamon
2 teaspoons cornstarch

1. Place the apple halves cut sides down on a cutting board. Slice them thinly. Transfer them to a large bowl. Toss them with the brown sugar, lemon juice, cinnamon, and cornstarch.
2. In a large skillet over medium-high heat, melt the butter. Add the apples and cook, stirring often, for 8 to 10 minutes, or until the apples soften. If the apple juices evaporate before the apples soften, add water, 1 tablespoon at a time. Remove the pan from the heat and leave until no longer hot.
3. Set the oven at 350 degrees.
4. With a large spoon, spread the apples and their juices in the crust, taking care to layer the slices so they are flat. Sprinkle the topping evenly over the apples.
5. Bake the pan for 35 to 40 minutes, or until the topping is golden brown.
6. Set the pan on a wire rack and leave to cool completely. Run a thin knife around the edge of the pan. Use the parchment paper to lift out the bars in one piece and set them on a cutting board. With a large knife, make 2 evenly spaced cuts in each direction to form 9 squares.

Sally Pasley Vargas

For fruity, not-too-sweet doughnuts, make a double-apple syrup

▶WHAT SHE'S HAVING
Continued from Page G1

ing island, who sent over dozens of her sought-after, freshly made rounds on the mail boat in the morning. "The whole thing was so special," she says.

Lombardi developed her own recipe for apple cider doughnuts and wanted a hint of molasses to remind her of the ones from her girlhood. She was looking for a subtler flavor, so instead of adding molasses, she mixes her dough with dark brown sugar, which has a molasses note, but is less intense.

She also wanted a big hit of the spices and a clear taste of fruit. "I use both applesauce and cider," she says. One 4-ounce container of Mott's unsweetened applesauce is the perfect size for a batch of dough, which makes one dozen (on lucky days for her family, a baker's dozen). She adds spices to the dry ingredients and to the liquids, which she simmers into a syrupy mixture.

Into a bowl of flour, baking powder, baking soda, cinnamon, nutmeg, and salt, she pours a hot, reduced syrupy mixture she calls an "apple slurry," simmered with fresh apple cider, unsweetened applesauce, both granulated and dark brown sugar, butter, cinnamon, nutmeg, allspice, and salt.

She adds eggs, buttermilk, and vanilla to form a wet dough that looks a little like firm cake batter. Lombardi sets the dough on plastic wrap, shapes it into a flat rectangle, wraps it tightly, and refrigerates it for an hour.

Lombardi was a food stylist for the Globe after graduating from MassArt. She went on to cofound Dancing Deer Baking Co., named for her grandmother's antique shop in Bar Harbor, Maine, which became famous for its cookies. (This is the doughnut grandmother.) Later, Lombardi's candy business, Tiny Trapeze Confections, was acquired by Whole Foods.

Her most recent enterprise was The Plate in Milton Marketplace, which she closed in 2024 because she wouldn't commit to the Marketplace owners to be open seven days a week from breakfast through dinner. Many mornings, Lombardi arrived at her breakfast and lunch spot at 4:15 a.m.

Sundays at The Plate were doughnut days, she says, as she's rolling the dough, stamping out rounds, and frying them the same way you see it done at the orchards.

As I watch, she's working on a pastry mat sprinkled with flour and often dips a 3-inch double-circle doughnut cutter into flour as she stamps. She rerolls the scraps, and even though there's some dough left, she stops cutting doughnuts. "I'm not going to keep rolling," she says, "they'll be too tough." The excess dough doesn't go to waste. She uses a small 1-inch round cutter to stamp out tiny rounds that will be fried later with the doughnut holes.

She readies a fat bath in a big Le Creuset Dutch oven. "You need high sides," she says. She clips a deep-fat thermometer to the side of the pan and scoops in Crisco vegetable shortening along with soybean oil. "I don't like canola oil," she says. Like many cooks, she finds it tastes fishy.

When the fat reaches 350 degrees on the thermometer, she drops in the rounds with her hands. Don't try this at home. Instead, slide them off a wide metal spatula dipped first into the oil.

Only four doughnuts cook at a time, for exactly 1 minute per side. They're dark golden brown when she transfers them with a spider (basket spoon) to a wire rack to cool briefly.

The kitchen has that familiar, heady, fragrant, fall-in-the-orchard smell.

When the doughnuts cool slightly, Lombardi drops them into a bowl of organic cane sugar, which is faintly brown because it, too, contains some molasses.

Last into the pot are the tiny rounds. At The Plate, making doughnuts on Sundays at dawn, she handed off the small golden holes to a grateful overnight worker. "I used to give them to my night baker," she says. "He was always so happy."

In her kitchen, we taste the warm doughnuts and I'm bowled over. They're crusty and sugary on the surface, not too sweet with a pronounced, delicious apple taste, and tender, cake-y interior.

And because this isn't a farm stand, and we can do what we want, we scoop up the doughnut holes and eat them like popcorn.

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Apple Cider Doughnuts

Makes 12 or 13 doughnuts, plus 24 holes

Milton baker Suzanne Lombardi, who has founded several business in the area (Dancing Deer Baking Co., Tiny Trapeze Confections, and The Plate in Milton Marketplace) created a recipe for doughnuts that reminded her of the little rounds she had as a girl with her grandmother in the village of Somesville on Mount Desert Island in Maine. Lombardi boils an intense apple syrup with fresh apple cider and unsweetened applesauce to stir into a bowl of flour to form the dough, along with eggs and buttermilk. The dough needs to rest for an hour before you roll it. If you don't have a doughnut cutter, use a 3-inch plain round cutter and a 1-inch cutter for the center holes. Lombardi fries all the holes, which you should, too. If you think apple cider doughnuts at an orchard are incredibly good, fresh homemade doughnuts will knock you out.

APPLE SYRUP

¾ cup fresh apple cider
½ cup unsweetened apple sauce (one 4-ounce individual container)
¾ cup granulated sugar
½ teaspoon ground cinnamon
¼ teaspoon ground allspice
¼ teaspoon ground nutmeg
½ teaspoon salt
6 tablespoons unsalted butter, cut into 6 slices
¼ cup dark brown sugar

1. In a small saucepan, combine the apple cider, applesauce, granulated sugar, cinnamon, allspice, nutmeg, and salt.
2. Bring to a boil over medium-high heat. Lower the heat to medium and let the mixture bubble steadily, uncovered, stirring every 5 minutes, for 18 to 20 minutes, or until the mixture darkens and thickens. The bubbles on the surface will slow down as it thickens.
3. When the mixture is dark and syrupy, pour it into a 2-cup heatproof glass measuring cup. You should have ¾ cup. If you reduced it too much, add more apple cider to bring the level up to ¾ cup. Immediately, whisk in the butter until it melts. Whisk in the brown sugar until it melts.

DOUGH

Extra flour (for sprinkling)
1 cup granulated sugar (for tossing doughnuts)
3¾ cups flour
2 teaspoons baking powder
½ teaspoon baking soda
1 teaspoon kosher salt
1½ teaspoons ground cinnamon
½ teaspoon ground nutmeg
2 eggs
⅓ cup cold buttermilk (well shaken)
1 teaspoon vanilla extract
2 quarts solid vegetable shortening mixed with vegetable or soybean oil (for frying)

1. Have on hand 2 rimmed baking sheets. Set a wire rack on one. Dust the other lightly with flour. Put the sugar into a wide shallow bowl. You also need a clip-on deep-fat thermometer and a 3-inch round doughnut cutter or 3-inch and 1-inch round cutters.
2. Meanwhile, in a bowl, combine the 3¾ cups flour, baking powder, baking soda, salt, cinnamon, and nutmeg.
3. Make a well in the center of the flour mixture. Scrape the apple syrup into the well. Lightly beat the eggs into the cold buttermilk. Add the egg mixture and vanilla to the well. Stir with a rubber spatula to form a sticky dough; do not over mix.
4. Spread a sheet of plastic wrap on the counter. Set the dough on the wrap. Fold up the sides. Lightly press the dough into a flattened rectangle. Refrigerate for 1 hour.
5. Fill a Dutch oven or deep, heavy-bottomed pot with 2 quarts of solid vegetable shortening mixed with vegetable or soybean oil. Once the shortening melts, you need at least 1½ inches of fat in the pot. Clip the deep-fat thermometer to the side of the pot. Heat the oil over medium-high heat until it reaches 350 degrees.
6. On a lightly floured counter or pastry mat, roll the dough to a ½-inch thickness. Dipping the cutter often in flour and stamping as close together as possible, stamp out doughnuts. The dough may be a little sticky, and it's OK to twist the cutters as you push them in to get a clean cut. Gather the scraps and gently form them into a ball; pat or roll out again to a ½-inch thickness. Cut more doughnuts. You will get 12 or 13 rounds. Don't collect the scraps a second time because the doughnuts will be tough. With floured fingers, pat out any scraps and stamp out doughnut holes using a 1-inch cutter. Transfer the donuts and donut holes to the lightly floured baking sheet.
7. Dip a wide metal spatula into the oil. Set a doughnut on the spatula and ease it into the hot fat. Add 4 total to the pot. Fry for 1 minute exactly, turn, and fry 1 minute more, or until puffed and golden brown. Use a spider or large slotted metal spoon to gently remove the doughnuts from the hot oil. Hold them over the pot for a few seconds to drain off the excess oil. Transfer to the wire rack. Keep an eye on the thermometer and adjust your heat to maintain 350 degrees (the temperature can rise quickly).
8. Let the doughnuts sit on the rack for 1 minute. Then place them one at a time into the bowl of sugar. Toss until well coated, sprinkling some of the sugar over the doughnuts and making sure the sides are coated. Return to the wire rack. Fry and sugar the remaining doughnuts and holes in the same way. The holes will cook faster; check after 30 seconds in the hot fat.
9. Serve the doughnuts as soon as possible.

Sheryl Julian. Adapted from Suzanne Lombardi

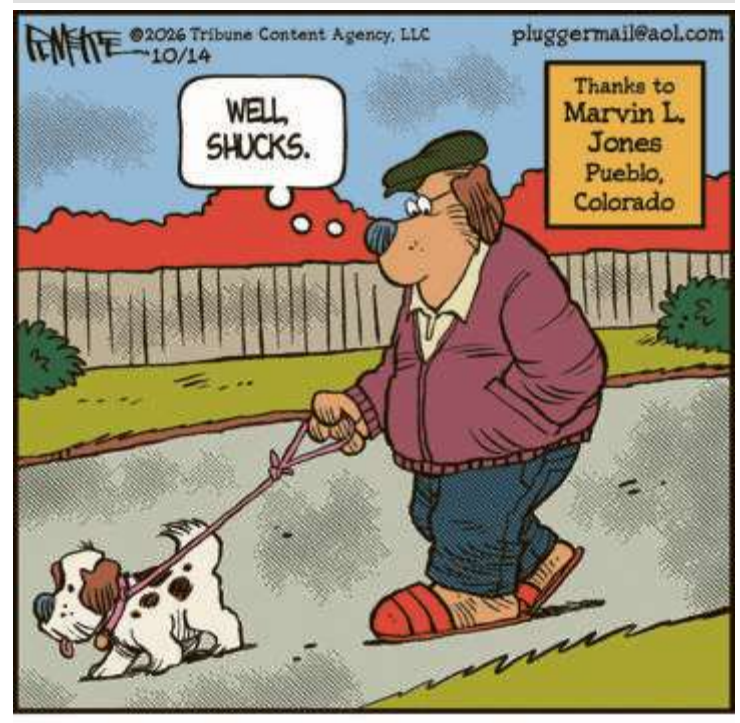
CRABGRASS by Tauhid Bondia



ZITS by Jerry Scott & Jim Borgman



PLUGGERS by Rick McKee



You're a plugger when you're halfway down the driveway and realize that you still have your slippers on.

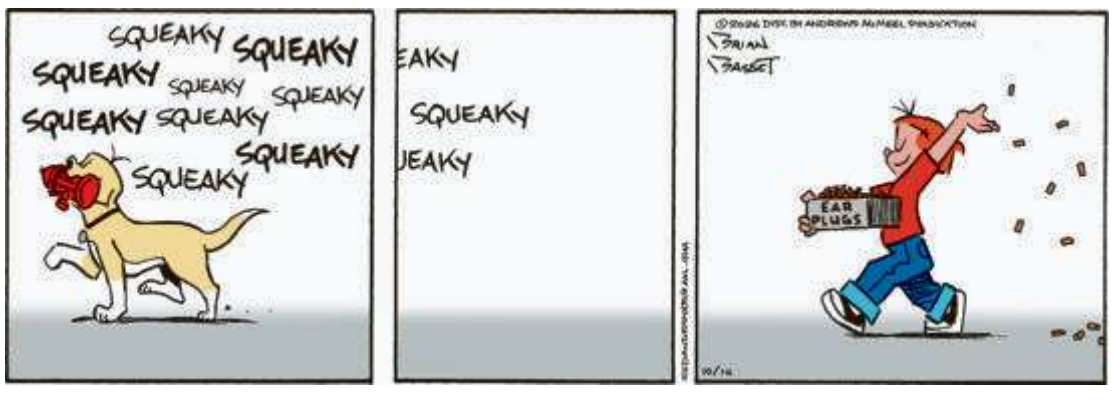
DOONESBURY by Garry Trudeau



DUSTIN by Steve Kelley & Jeff Parker



RED & ROVER by Brian Basset



ARCTIC CIRCLE by Alex Hallatt



FOR BETTER OR FOR WORSE by Lynn Johnston



CURTIS by Ray Billingsley



RHYMES WITH ORANGE by Hilary Price



ARLO & JANIS by Jimmy Johnson



UNIVERSAL CROSSWORD PUZZLE

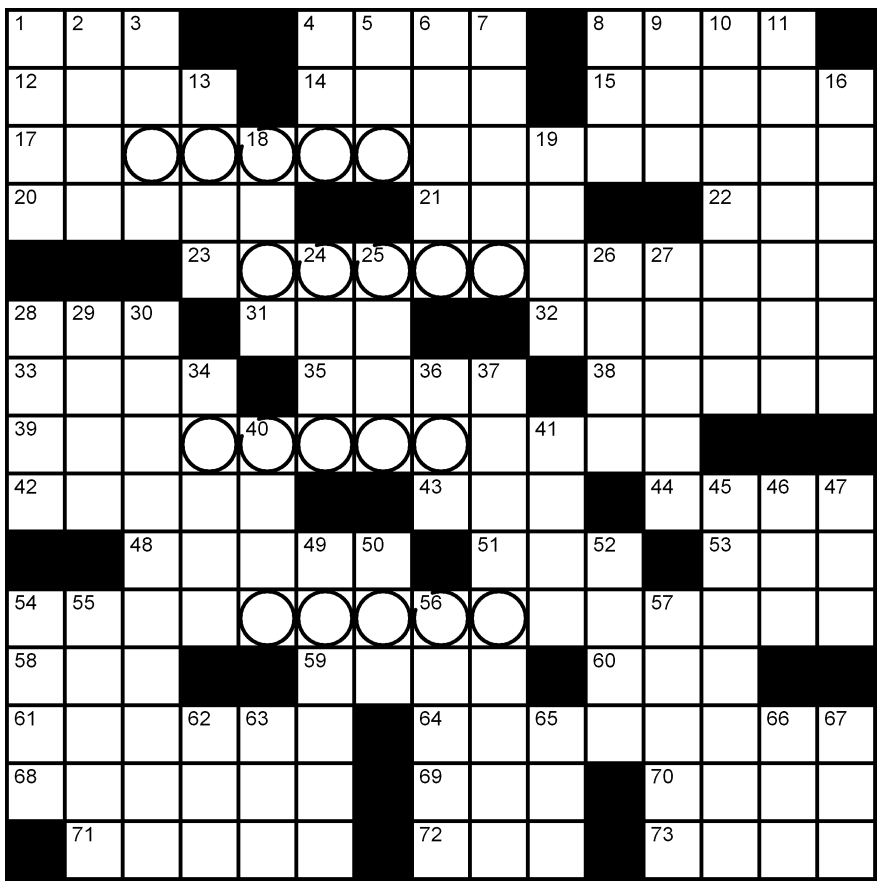
SOMETHING'S BREWING BY DREW SCHMENNER | EDITED BY DAVID STEINBERG

ACROSS

1 Liven (up)
4 Sounds of amazement
8 Acquire
12 Tries to win the heart of
14 "Wheel of Fortune" turn
15 System of beliefs
17 "Finally ..." (In this answer, note letters 3-7)
20 Incredible bargain
21 Twosome
22 Compete (for)
23 "You gotta be kidding me!" (... letters 2-6)
28 Mai ___
31 Labradoodle, e.g.
32 So-o-o happy
33 ___ and for all
35 Faucet issue
38 Fruits used in 46-Down
39 Debates ferociously, say (... letters 4-8)
42 Rita's "West Side Story" role
43 World Cup cheer
44 Mind-centering discipline
48 Conspiratorial group
51 (Throw me a bone!)
53 Wrestler's goal
54 Competition with knights and queens (... letters 5-9)
58 O'Hare, for United
59 Future tulip
60 Charged particle
61 Ancient Greek prophet
64 Low-alcohol brew ... or what's found in 17-, 23-, 39- and 54-Across? (Bonus: Note what the changed letters spell!)
68 New Orleans sandwiches
69 Sound of contentment
70 It eliminates wrinkles
71 Queens ballplayer, for short
72 ___ Lankan rupee
73 Singer Del Rey

DOWN

1 Leather punches
2 Castle defense
3 Get ready for a selfie
4 Buckeyes' sch.
5 Decide
6 Diwali celebrant
7 Pig's schnoz
8 Goop at a salon
9 Grabbed a bite
10 "There's no alternative for me"
11 "Not gonna happen"
13 Male deer
16 Knights' rides
18 Needed a Band-Aid, say
19 Eco-conscious bag
24 Big commotion
25 Fairy-tale monster
26 In addition
27 "Roots" writer Alex
28 Roman garment
29 Unknown commenter, for short
30 Coolest rap song from 1990?

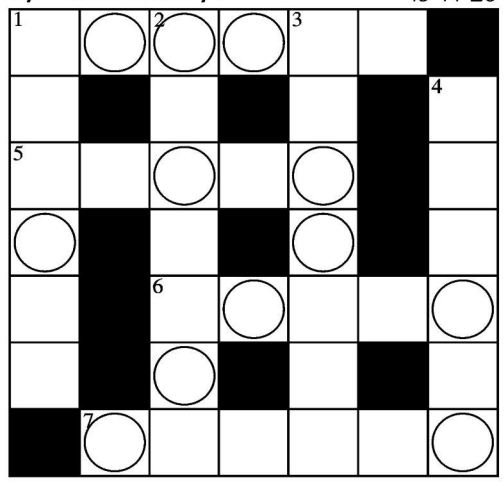


34 "Como ___?"
36 "Am ___ believe ..."
37 Seal predator in Arctic lands
40 Browser subwindows
41 Gull's relative
45 Tennis period beginning in '68
46 Martini booze
47 Queen of the hill, perhaps
49 If nothing goes wrong
50 Rock icon Reed
52 Impartial
54 Karate strike
55 Lake touching Michigan's "thumb"
56 Forearm bones
57 It merged with Exxon in '99
62 Frequent URL ending
63 Harsh cleaning agent
65 Fish whose name is Hawaiian for "fire"
66 Lo-o-ng time
67 Cellular messenger

JUMBLE® CROSSWORDS™

by David L. Hoyt

10-14-26



ACROSS

CLUE	ANSWER
1. Annul	LNECAC
5. Swiss ___	NARCF
6. Go inside	ETRNE
7. Music ___	USIOTD

DOWN

CLUE	ANSWER
1. ___ cup	FEEOCF
2. Tidiest	STTENEA
3. Thrilled	EITCEDX
4. Music system	RTEESO

CLUE: The first coin-operated phonograph, a forerunner of the jukebox, debuted in ___ ___ in 1889.

BONUS

How to play

Complete the crossword puzzle by looking at the clues and unscrambling the answers. When the puzzle is complete, unscramble the circled letters to solve the BONUS.

ANSWERS: 1A-Cancel 5A-Franc 6A-Enter 7A-Studio 1D-Coffee 2D-Neatest 3D-Excited 4D-Stereo 8-San Francisco

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Send comments to DLHoyt@HoytInteractiveMedia.com

Boston's forecast

AccuWeather. Superior Accuracy™ for Better Decisions. Get the AccuWeather app

TODAY 6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.

HIGH **76-81** LOW **51-56** | Intervals of clouds and sunshine. Winds W 10-20 mph. Partly cloudy tonight. Winds NW 8-16 mph.

THURSDAY 6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.

HIGH **60-65** LOW **47-52** | Mostly sunny and cooler. Winds NNW 8-16 mph. Increasing clouds at night with occasional rain and drizzle late. Winds SE 6-12 mph.

FRIDAY 6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.

HIGH **64-69** LOW **43-48** | Breezy with rain at times. Winds S 12-25 mph. Cloudy most of the time at night; a steady breeze. Winds WNW 12-25 mph.

SATURDAY 6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.

HIGH **50-55** LOW **36-41** | Mostly sunny and windy. Winds WNW 15-25 mph. Clear at night; freezing temperatures in the normally colder spots. Winds W 8-16 mph.

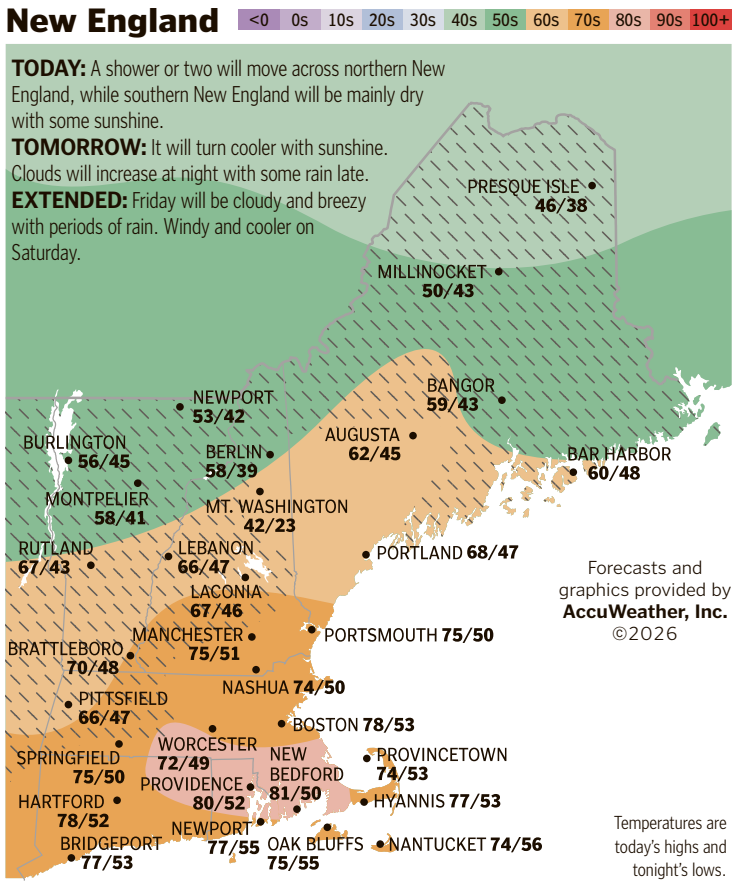
SUNDAY 6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.

HIGH **53-58** LOW **42-47** | Mostly sunny. Winds W 8-16 mph. Partly cloudy at night. Winds SW 6-12 mph.

New England

<0 0s 10s 20s 30s 40s 50s 60s 70s 80s 90s 100+

TODAY: A shower or two will move across northern New England, while southern New England will be mainly dry with some sunshine.
TOMORROW: It will turn cooler with sunshine. Clouds will increase at night with some rain late.
EXTENDED: Friday will be cloudy and breezy with periods of rain. Windy and cooler on Saturday.



Forecasts and graphics provided by AccuWeather, Inc. ©2026

Temperatures are today's highs and tonight's lows.

Almanac

Yesterday's high/low	61°/53°
Sunrise today	6:56 a.m.
Sunset today	6:04 p.m.
Moonrise today	11:17 a.m.

Mount Washington (5 p.m. yesterday)

Weather	Freezing rain
Visibility	1/16 of a mile
Wind	south at 37 m.p.h.
High/low temperature	38/29
Snow depth at 5 p.m.	0.0"

Allergies Source: Asthma & Allergy Affiliates, Inc.

Trees	Weeds	Grass	Mold
Absent	Absent	Absent	N.A.

Yesterday's mold and spore rating.

Eastern Massachusetts air quality

GOOD MOD. UNHEALTHY VERY UNHEALTHY

41 (50 100 150 200 300)

For more information on today's conditions, call the state hotline at (800) 882-1497 or Massachusetts Department of Environmental Protection web site www.state.ma.us/DEP

24 Hr. Precipitation (valid at 5 p.m. yesterday)

Yesterday	0.05"	Month to date	1.59"	Year to date	24.53"
Precip days in October	6	Norm. month to date	1.66"	Norm. year to date	33.26"

Climate data are compiled from National Weather Service records and are subject to change or correction.

Tides

	A.M.	P.M.
Boston high	2:12	2:16
Height	9.2	10.0
Boston low	8:07	8:41
Height	1.3	0.5
High tides		
Old Orchard ME	2:01	2:03
Hampton Beach NH	2:15	2:17
Plum Island	2:19	2:28
Ipswich	2:00	2:04

High tides	A.M.	P.M.
Gloucester	2:09	2:14
Marblehead	2:12	2:16
Lynn	2:18	2:25
Scituate	2:11	2:18
Plymouth	2:13	2:23
Cape Cod Canal East	1:58	2:05
Cape Cod Canal West	12:59	
Falmouth	1:56	2:00

High tides	A.M.	P.M.
Hyannis Port	3:30	3:22
Chatham	3:18	3:09
Wellfleet	2:26	2:30
Provincetown	2:19	2:27
Nantucket Harbor	3:25	3:16
Oak Bluffs	2:30	2:50
New Bedford	11:03	11:22
Newport RI	10:51	11:14

New England marine forecast

● Small craft advisory ● Gale warning ● Storm warning

	Wind	Seas	Temp
Boston Harbor	W 6-12 kts.	1 ft.	77/52
East Cape Cod Canal	W 6-12 kts.	1 ft.	78/53
Buzzards Bay	SW 7-14 kts.	2-3 ft.	77/53
Martha's Vineyard	SW 8-16 kts.	3-4 ft.	73/51
● Nantucket	SW 10-20 kts.	4-5 ft.	70/53
Provincetown	W 7-14 kts.	2-3 ft.	73/53

For current Charles River Basin water quality, call (781) 788-0007 or go to http://www.charlesriver.org.

Cities

Forecast high and low temperatures and conditions

● Travel delays possible, **C** Clouds, **F** Fog, **H** Haze, **I** Ice, **Pc** Partly Cloudy, **R** Rain, **Sh** Showers, **S** Sun, **Sn** Snow, **Fl** Flurries, **T** Thunderstorms, **W** Windy

	Today		Tomorrow	
Atlanta	89/64	S	89/65	S
Atlantic City	85/57	Pc	65/57	Pc
Charlotte	88/61	S	87/65	Pc
Chicago	66/58	C	62/49	R
● Dallas	90/71	T	88/61	Pc
● Denver	48/40	R	50/32	Pc
Detroit	69/51	Pc	61/54	R
Fort Myers	90/73	S	91/74	T
Los Angeles	84/61	S	93/66	S
● Miami	89/79	T	90/77	T
New Orleans	88/69	S	88/73	S
● New York City	79/56	Pc	64/56	S
● Philadelphia	84/59	T	67/59	Pc
Phoenix	78/60	S	89/70	S
Salt Lake City	56/41	Sh	64/40	Pc
San Francisco	73/52	S	80/57	S
Seattle	65/49	Pc	72/50	S
● Washington	89/62	T	64/60	R
Beijing	72/46	Pc	81/48	Pc
Cancun	89/75	T	86/77	R
Mexico City	76/55	Pc	76/56	Pc
● Montreal	55/40	Sh	55/44	S
● Toronto	62/45	Sh	55/51	Pc
Vancouver	59/47	C	62/47	S
Jerusalem	81/64	Pc	75/61	Pc
London	67/57	Pc	71/53	Pc
● Moscow	48/44	R	50/47	R
Paris	69/49	S	74/55	C
Rome	76/53	C	76/52	S
● San Juan	89/79	R	89/78	R
Stockholm	49/35	R	51/48	Pc
● Tokyo	81/65	T	71/63	S

HOROSCOPES

HAPPY BIRTHDAY for Wednesday, Oct. 14, 2026: You're adventurous, imaginative, and curious. You're also independent minded and a keen traveler. Make time for reflection this year to renew your spiritual or religious beliefs. Explore philosophies that will give you better self-awareness and get you closer to the true meaning of your life.

ARIES *(March 21-April 19)*
This is a fantastic day to travel and do anything to expand your world! Sports events, kids' activities, the theater, and the arts will be exciting choices. You'll also feel sympathetic to people in other countries. You might even act on this feeling in a practical way. Tonight: Learn something.

TAURUS *(April 20-May 20)*
You are the financial wizard of the zodiac, and today is an excellent day for financial negotiations and discussions about shared property, mortgages, taxes, debt, and inheritances. You'll be sympathetic but practical. Tonight: Check your finances.

GEMINI *(May 21-June 20)*
Today you might attract someone very interesting to you. This person might be logical, informed, and sensitive. They might have bright ideas that they express very directly. In turn, you'll feel revved up by these conversations and perhaps will come forth with your own clever suggestions. Tonight: Listen to someone.

CANCER *(June 21-July 22)*
Today you might be in a position to help someone or put the needs of someone else before your own. You might be financially generous or see ways to encourage others to be helpful. Whatever you do will likely earn the respect of some. (Hey, good press is always nice.) Tonight: Work.

LEO *(July 23-Aug. 22)*
This is a high-energy, playful day! Enjoy schmoozing with friends. Sports events, fun activities with kids, the entertainment world, and spending time with others will be great choices. Do something that pleases you today. Romance with someone of an age difference might happen. Tonight: Socialize.

VIRGO *(Aug. 23-Sept. 22)*
You might make some home improvements today or pay bills and secure your home in a better way. Instead of home improvements, this could translate into helping a family member as well. Stock the fridge, because your home routine might change. Tonight: Relax at home.

LIBRA *(Sept. 23-Oct. 22)*
You will negotiate strongly on your behalf, or for anything that you want to do today. You might represent a group or a friend. Not only will you be persuasive and charming, you'll also be practical and sensible. Whatever you do today, you will do with a keen balance. Tonight: An interesting discussion.

SCORPIO *(Oct. 23-Nov. 21)*
Financial discussions will go well today. You might see ways to boost your income. At work you will persevere and won't overlook details because your mind is focused and ready to create order out of chaos. People will listen to you. Tonight: Check your possessions.

SAGITTARIUS *(Nov. 22-Dec. 21)*
You're in the driver's seat today because the Moon is in your sign dancing beautifully with Mars, Saturn, and Neptune. You know what you want to achieve and you will do so, even if you're interrupted by someone unusual and unexpected. Tonight: You're in charge.

CAPRICORN *(Dec. 22-Jan. 19)*
Today you might use the resources of someone else, perhaps a partner, to help someone in need. This person who is in need might be a family member, or they could be someone far way in a distant land. Lately, you are involved with creative, younger people, perhaps from your past. Tonight: Enjoy solitude.

AQUARIUS *(Jan. 20-Feb. 18)*
You might attract someone a bit aggressive to you today. However, this person might help you deal with friends and groups to get things done, especially if you want to help someone in need. This isn't surprising, because you hope to make the world a better place. Tonight: Be friendly.

PISCES *(Feb. 19-March 20)*
You're high-viz, which means people notice you today. They see you as sympathetic, strong, and proactive, which is a good thing. This puts you in a position to convince others to listen to your ideas and perhaps jump on your bandwagon and fight for a worthy cause. Tonight: Be modest.

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SUDOKU

3	7			4		5		
						1	2	
					9			
	3		7	9				8
	8	9				7	6	
6				8	2		1	
			6					
	9	4						
		2		1			7	4

Fill in the grid so that every row, every column, and every 3X3 box contains the digits 1 through 9. Puzzle difficulty levels: Easy on Monday and Tuesday, more difficult on Wednesday and Thursday, most difficult on Friday and Saturday. Tips and computer program at www.sudoku.com.

DAILY BRIDGE CLUB

BY FRANK STEWART

South dealer — N-S vulnerable

North
♠ A J 5
♡ 8 6 4
♢ A Q J 4
♣ A Q 10

West
♠ Q 10 6
♡ A 10 3 2
♢ 10 9 8
♣ J 5 2

East
♠ 9 8 4 2
♡ 7 5
♢ 6 5 2
♣ 8 7 4 3

South
♠ K 7 3
♡ K Q J 9
♢ K 7 3
♣ K 9 6

South	West	North	East
1 NT	Pass	6 NT	All Pass

Opening lead — ♢ 10

Cy the Cynic says that as you go through life, you should take time to think about the other fellow: He may be plotting something.

In my club's penny game, Cy was South, and he and North bid easily to 6NT with their 33 points. West led the ten of diamonds, and Cy won in dummy and led a heart. East played the five, and the Cynic offered his king.

Unfortunately for Cy, West was Ed, my club's best player. Ed played low smoothly. Cy led a club to dummy and returned a second heart to his queen, and Ed played low again.

Cy then led another club to dummy and a third heart. He was dismayed when East showed out, and Ed took the ace and ten for down one. Cy would make the slam if he finessed with dummy's jack of spades, but for all he knew, East had the queen of spades and the ace of hearts.

Ed defended well. Since he had seven points, he knew Cy held every missing point. To duck the first two heart leads couldn't lose and might (and did) induce Cy to go wrong.

DAILY QUESTION You hold: ♠ Q 10 6 ♡ A 10 3 2 ♢ 10 9 8 ♣ J 5 2. The dealer, at your left, opens one diamond. Your partner doubles, you respond ("advance") one heart and he bids two hearts. What do you say?

ANSWER: Partner has a strong hand. He couldn't afford to raise with a minimum hand since you might have had no points and four ragged hearts. Since you have seven useful points, game is possible. If you trust partner, bid three hearts. He might hold A J 9 4, K Q 8 4, 3, A Q 4 3.

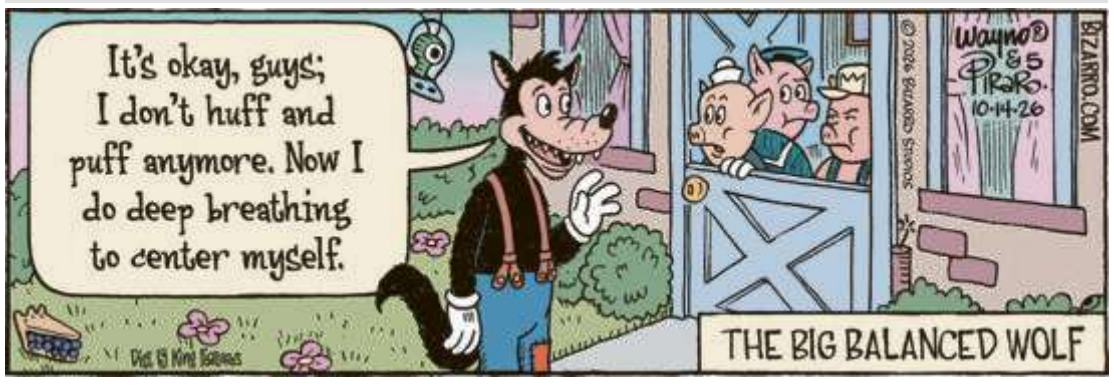
ZIPPY "Quote Slam" by Bill Griffith



ADAM@HOME by Rob Harrell



BIZARRO by Wayno & Piraro



ROSE IS ROSE by Pat Brady & Don Wimmer



MOTHER GOOSE & GRIMM by Mike Peters



Today's Crossword Solution

A	N	L		I	R	S		T	E	M	Y	N		
N	O	I		H	A	A		S	Y	O	B	O	P	
O	R	B	E	E	R	N		L	E	C	A	R	O	
H	U	B			N	O	I		B	U	L	B		
C	H	E	S	S	T	O	U	R	N	A	M	E	N	T
		C	A	B	A	L		A	R	F		P	I	N
A	N	I	T	A			O	L	E		Y	O	G	A
G	O	E	S	T	O	E	T	O	T	O	E			
O	N	C	E		D	O	R	I	P		S	L	O	E
T	A	I		D	O	G			E	L	A	T	E	D
			G	E	T	O	U	T	T	A	H	E	R	E
S	T	E	A	L			D	U	O		V	I	E	
L	A	S	T	B	U	T	N	O	T	L	E	A	S	T
W	O	O	S		S	P	I	N		E	T	H	O	S
A	M	P			O	O	H	S		G	A	I	N	

Today's Sudoku Solution

3	7	6	2	4	1	5	8	9
9	4	8	3	5	7	1	2	6
1	2	5	8	6	9	3	4	7
2	3	1	7	9	6	4	5	8
4	8	9	1	3	5	7	6	2
6	5	7	4	8	2	9	1	3
8	1	3	6	7	4	2	9	5
7	9	4	5	2	8	6	3	1
5	6	2	9	1	3	8	7	4

TV CRITIC'S CORNER

BY DON AUCOIN



AMC

From left: Bryan Cranston, Anna Gunn, and RJ Mitte as the White family in "Breaking Bad."

As those around him broke bad, RJ Mitte's Walt Jr. remained innocent

This contains spoilers about "Breaking Bad."

Within the dangerous, ever-shifting world of "Breaking Bad" (2008-13), the character I always worried about the most was Walter White Jr. Surrounded by guilty or compromised adults, Walt Jr. was the one true innocent.

Played by RJ Mitte, who died by suicide Monday at age 34, he was the teenage son of Bryan Cranston's Walter White, chemistry teacher turned meth manufacturer and general drug kingpin. His mother, Skyler (the underrated Anna Gunn), was eventually drawn into Walt Sr.'s activities, opening a car wash to launder her husband's piles of narcotics money.

To say Walt Jr. had a turbulent adolescence would be a massive understatement.

But he was a resilient kid from the start of the series. As he navigated high school, he refused to be constrained or defined by his cerebral palsy. (In this, the character mirrored the actor who played him: Mitte had cerebral palsy, and became a committed advocate for the rights of performers with disabilities.)

Early on Walt Jr. insisted he be called "Flynn," as a declaration of independence from a father from whom he was beginning to feel alienated. But he was, again, a kid. And I was always a bit apprehensive that Walt Jr. had been placed in harm's way as his Jekyll-turned-Hyde dad plunged deeper and deeper into a maelstrom of criminality.

As I enter into the these-people-are-real suspension of disbelief TV series and all dramatic art require, I often feel an edge of anxiety while watching dark dramas that feature children of criminals as a prominent part of the story line. With "The Sopranos," I fretted that one of Tony's mob rivals would target Meadow and A.J. (Thank heaven that final "Don't Stop Believin'" scene in the diner left their fate unclear.)

Not till late in "Breaking Bad" did Walt Jr. learn what his father had turned into. But all along, he had a surrogate father of sorts. Throughout the series, it was poignantly evident that there was a close bond — built on banter — between Walt Jr. and his uncle, Hank Schrader (Dean Norris), a DEA agent.

Walt Sr. seethed at that bond; he could see himself being displaced, and the paternal rivalry, so to speak, between the two men was a constant undercurrent. After Hank discovers that Walt Sr. is the notorious "Heisenberg" he's been hunting for so long, the intensity of "Breaking Bad" ratchets up even further.

In the series finale, a fugitive Walt Sr. calls Walt Jr. from New Hampshire and tries to arrange a way to funnel around $100,000 to him, his mother, and his baby sister. Walt Sr.'s love for his son is one of the only remnants of his onetime decency.

But Walt Jr. wants no part of his father's last-minute bid for some kind of redemption, shouting incredulously into the phone: "You want to send money? You killed Uncle Hank! You killed him! No, what you did to Mom, you [expletive]! You killed Uncle Hank! ... I don't want anything from you!" Before hanging up, Walt Jr. says these damning words to his father: "Why are you still alive? Why don't you just, just die already? Just, just, die!"

It's one of the most shattering scenes in one of the greatest series in TV history. And it owes much of its emotional power to RJ Mitte, gone far too soon.

Don Aucoin can be reached at donald.aucoin@globe.com.

ASKING ERIC

Veteran teacher traumatized by students' crises

Q. I have been a teacher for 19 years. I have seen a lot. As a mandated reporter I have had to make the call to the authorities with some frequency. I have also had other children who had prior abuse and I was always a shoulder to cry on when needed. I have felt intense sadness at times, as when a student's sibling was murdered. I tried my best to comfort him.

I never let these instances interfere with my attitude on life or my job. I was always able to move on and not let it get me down. I always seemed to be able to see the silver lining and think this is a hard thing they are going through, but these kids are going to get through and at the end of this trial be stronger and able to help others through.

However, this last year broke me. I don't know any other way to describe it. Those rose-colored glasses I managed to keep on through 19 years of hearing horror stories and teaching some very traumatized kids just shattered to pieces.

This past year I had two second-grade students that changed everything. Their stories are horrific and heartbreaking, but I am not sure why these two boys affected me more than all the others I've taught.

I am angry and sad. I keep finding myself not wanting to ever go back to teaching. I feel like I am still mourning a loss that was never my loss. When I try to talk to my husband, he gets irritated, telling me to get over it and to let it go. I realize I am being irrational, but I can't seem to shake this off.

NO MORE ROSE-COLORED GLASSES

A. You're not being irrational, and your husband's irritation is inappropriate.

You're dealing with incredibly traumatic things and, as a teacher and mandatory reporter, you're often having to receive distressing information while immediately pivoting to care and action.

It doesn't sound like your school system is providing you with the time and resources to adequately process what you're hearing. You may have been able to compartmentalize for years, but the feelings you're dealing with have to go somewhere.

It's said that a good therapist always has a therapist, and although you're not a therapist, as a teacher you have been called on to step into a similar role at times. There is a cost to that. Please consider talking to a trained professional about your experience and the feelings it has brought up. You may consider taking a leave of absence from teaching, to give yourself time to heal and regroup.

There is nothing wrong with taking a step back to care for yourself. One can't pour from an empty cup. You do incredibly important, vital work. You owe it to yourself to take time to recover.

Q. I bought a friend tickets to a concert she had mentioned wanting to go to. I didn't ask her about it because I wanted it to be a surprise. I gave her the tickets for her birthday, and she looked surprised and annoyed. I said, "What?" She told me her boyfriend already gave her tickets to the concert.

Well, I got mad about that. I don't really like her boyfriend, first off. Second, she and I had talked about the concert. Now she's saying that she'd actually asked her boyfriend to get the tickets for her.

I'm really annoyed about the whole thing. I get that she likes this guy, even though I don't see why. But I went out of my way to make a nice plan for us and it's not like the tickets were cheap. Should I insist she go with me instead?

CONCERT CONFLICT

A. Insisting of any kind, about anything, is just going to add more tension to this situation. And it doesn't seem like the situation actually warrants tension.

Sure, you don't like your friend's boyfriend, but his intentions seem good, as were yours, so you're not really in conflict.

You did a nice thing for your friend. And it's unfortunate that that nice thing coincided with a nice thing her boyfriend did for her, at her request. But the best thing to do is defer to her wishes. If she wants to go with her boyfriend, it's not a knock against you.

There will be other opportunities to celebrate with your friend. And in a case like this it really is the thought that counts.

Consider inviting another friend to join you at the concert. This friend could even pay for their ticket, so you wouldn't be out so much money. Or, if the ticketing service's policies allow it, you can list the tickets for resale.

R. Eric Thomas can be reached at eric@askingeric.com.

Wednesday October 14, 2026

Movies Sports News Specials

		7 pm	7:30	8 pm	8:30	9 pm	9:30	10 pm	10:30	11 pm	11:30
2	WGBH PBS	BBC News The	R. Steves	Nature (N) (SP)		NOVA "Evolution: Brain Power" (N)		Secrets "Africa's Golden City" (N)		Amanpour and Company (N)	
4	WBZ CBS	Wheel (N)	Jeopardy! (N)	Survivor (N)			The Amazing Race (N)			News (N)	(:35) Comics
5	WCVB ABC	News (N)	Chronicle	Scrubs (N)	Abbott (N)	Million Billy Porter, Leslie Odom Jr. (N)		Shark Tank (N)		NewsCenter 5 (N)	(:35) J. Kimmel
6	WLNE ABC	Videos		Whose	Whose	Whose	Whose	Saturday Night Live		Saturday Night Live	
7	WHDH	Inside (N)	Extra (N)	Family Feud (N)	Family Feud (N)	7 News at 9PM (N)		7 News at 10PM (N)		7 News at 11PM (N)	(:35) Inside
9	WMUR ABC	Chronicle	News (N)	Scrubs	Abbott	Million (N)		Shark Tank (N)		News (N)	J.Kimmel
10	NBC Boston	NBC 10 Boston News at 7pm (N)		Chicago Med "Third Rails" (N)		Chicago Fire "Rattle the Cage" (N)		Chicago P.D. "Don't Blink" (N)		Boston News (N)	(:35) J. Fallon (N)
10	WJAR NBC	News (N) (Live)	Extra (N)	Chicago Med "Third Rails" (N)		Chicago Fire "Rattle the Cage" (N)		Chicago P.D. "Don't Blink" (N)		News (N) (Live)	(:35) J. Fallon (N)
11	WENH PBS	Weekends	Windows	Nature (N) (SP)		NOVA "Evolution: Brain Power" (N)		Secrets "Africa's Golden City" (N)		Amanpour and Company (N)	
12	WPRI CBS	Wheel (N)	Jeopardy! (N)	Survivor (N)			The Amazing Race (N)			12 News at 11 (N)	(:35) Comics
25	WFXT FOX	ET (N)	TMZ (N)	The Floor "The Quiet Achiever" (N)		99 to Beat (N)		Boston 25 News at 10PM (N) (Live)		News (N) (Live)	(:35) News (N)
27	WUNI	Rosa "Un extraño amor"		Sabor a ti, entre hi "Desinterés" (N)		Tierra de "De padre a hija" (N)		Corazón "Amor a segunda vista" (N)		Noticias Univisión	SaborDe/ (:35) Noti..
36	WSBE PBS	Milk Street TV	Mexican	Tim Janis: Our Natural World -- Returning to Earth			Visions of Italy, Southern Style			PBS News Hour	
38	WSBK	Big Bang	Big Bang	WBZ News 8p (N)		Patriots 1st Down	Jeopardy!	Perfect (N)	Perfect	Flip Side (N)	Flip Side
44	WGBX PBS	Test Kitchen	Antiques	Whitstable Pearl "To Those We Love"		The Outlaws		Sisi: Austrian Empress		PBS News Hour (N)	
50	WWJE	Murder USA		Heartland Homicide		Killer Cases		Crime Stories		The FBI Files	
56	WLVI CW	Young Sheldon	Young Sheldon	Police 24/7 "It's Not a Good Day Today"		Crime Nation		7 News at 10PM on CW56 (N)		Modern Family	Modern Family
64	WNAC FOX	Family Feud (N)	Family Feud (N)	The Floor "The Quiet Achiever" (N)		99 to Beat (N)		12 News on Fox Pr (N)		Seinfeld	Seinfeld
68	WBPX ION	Blue Bloods "Under the Gun"		Blue Bloods "Sins of the Father"		Blue Bloods "Baggage"		Blue Bloods "Home Sweet Home"		Blue Bloods "Love Stories"	
PREMIUM CABLE											
Cinemax		(6:20) ★★ Robin Hood ('10) Cate Blanchett, Russell Crowe.		(:40) ★★ Tomb Raider ('18) Dominic West, Walton Goggins, Alicia Vikander.				(:40) ★★ Beetlejuice Beetlejuice ('24)			
Flix		(6:15) ★★ Faster ('10)		★★ The Mechanic ('11) Ben Foster, Jason Statham.		(:35) ★★ Paycheck ('03) Aaron Eckhart, Uma Thurman, Ben Affleck.				(:35) Stepford...	
HBO		(:55) Last Week To.	(:40) The Pet Cemeter		(:25) Youth	★★ The Housemaid ('25) Amanda Seyfried, Sydney Sweeney.				(:15) War "It's Done"	
HBO 2		(:20) ★★ The Craft ('96) Fairuza Balk, Neve Campbell, Robin Tunney.				NFL Film	(:45) Youth	(:15) The Pet Cemeter		(:05) ★★ Mission: Impossible ('96)	
Paramount-Sho		(5:45) ★★★ Se7en ('95) Brad Pitt.		★★★ V for Vendetta ('06) Hugo Weaving, Stephen Rea, Natalie Portman.				(:15) ★★★ Patriot Games ('92) Anne Archer, Patrick Bergin, Harrison Ford.			
Showtime 2		(5:35) ★★★ Noah ('14) Russell Crowe.		★★ The Return ('24) Juliette Binoche, Charlie Plummer, Ralph Fiennes.				★★★ Troy ('04) Eric Bana, Orlando Bloom, Brad Pitt.			
Starz!		(:20) ★★ In the Grey ('26) Henry Cavill, Eiza González, Jake Gyllenhaal.				Alarum ('25) Sylvester Stallone, Scott Eastwood.				(:40) ★★ Jennifer's Body ('09) Amanda Seyfried, Megan Fox.	
TMC		(6:30) ★★★ Best in Show		★★★ Planes, Trains and Automobiles ('87)				(:35) ★★★ Airplane! ('80) Julie Hagerty, Robert Hays.		(:05) ★★ Airplane II: The Sequel ('82)	
SPORTS											
CBSSN		Inside College Football		NWSL Soccer				PWBA Bowling			
ESPN		SportCtr (N) (Live)	Countdown (N)	WNBA Basketball (N) (Live)				SportsCenter (N) (Live)		SportsCenter (N) (Live)	
ESPN2		International Dance League Los Angeles		College Football Western Kentucky at Sam Houston State All the action from college football. (N) (Live)						NFL Live Marcus Spears	
Fox Sports 1		MLB on FS1 Pregame (N) (Live)		MLB Baseball Championship Series: Teams TBA All the latest action from Major League Baseball. (N) (Live)						MLB on FS1 Postgame (N) (Live)	
Golf		(5:00) College Golf		College Golf St. Andrews Links Collegiate, Final Round						LPGA Tour Golf	
NBA		(6:30) Ba..	Coaches	NBA Basketball						NBA Basketball	
NBC Sports		Celtics (N) (Live)		NBA Basketball Charlotte Hornets at Boston Celtics From TD Garden in Boston. (N) (Live)				Celtics (N) (Live)	Celtics (N) (Live)	Boston Sports (N) (Live)	
NESN		Wm. Hockey Merrimack at Boston College (N)					Fame	Chat (N)		The Varsity	
FAMILY											
Cartoon		Burgers	Burgers	Burgers	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	RickMorty	RickMorty
Disney		Big City Greens	Big City Greens	Phineas and Ferb	Phineas and Ferb	Place	Phineas and Ferb	Phineas and Ferb	Kiff	Ladybug	Ladybug
Encore Family		(:10) Lena and Snowball ('21)			(:40) Oddball ('15) Alan Tudyk.			(:15) A Dog and Pony Show ('18)			
Nickelodeon		★★ Hotel Transylvania 2 ('15)				Friends	Friends	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang
Nick Jr.		PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	DORA (N)	DORA (N)	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig

		7 pm	7:30	8 pm	8:30	9 pm	9:30	10 pm	10:30	11 pm	11:30
BASIC CABLE											
A&E		Alaska-Trooper "Burglars & Bears"		Alaska-Trooper "Bloody Warrior"		Troopers "Armed & Squatting"		Alaska State Troopers		(:05) Troopers "Trail of Blood"	
AMC		(6:00) Halloween		★★ Christine ('83) Keith Gordon.				★★★ It ('17) Jaeden Martell.			
Animal Planet		Naked and Afraid "Not Today, Satan"		Naked and Afraid "Mayan Blood Sacrifice"				Naked and Afraid "Enter the Queen" (N)			
BBC America		(5:30) House of Wax		★ Thirteen Ghosts ('01) Tony Shalhoub.				★★★ Trick 'r Treat ('07) Anna Paquin.			
BET		Celebrity Sandra Lee, Lea Thompson		Celebrity Jennie Garth, Kyle Massey		Sistas "Long Row To Hoe" (N)		Her Baby (N)	Zatima (N)	Her Baby	Sistas
Bravo		Real SLC "Fortune and Misfortune"		Housewives SLC "Hypocrisy and Bull..." (N)			Line of Fire (N)		Housewives/NYC		Housewives SLC
CMT		Mama's	Mama's	Reba	Reba	Reba	Reba	Reba	Reba	Gold Girls	Gold Girls
CNN		AC360 (N) (Live)		James Talarico (N) (Live)			The Source (N)		CNN NewsNight (N) (Live)		
Comedy Central		South Park	South Park	South Park	South Park	South Park	South Park	South Park (N)	Mike (N)	Mike (N)	South Park
CSPAN		(6:00) Public Affairs		C-SPAN Primetime				C-SPAN Primetime			
CSPAN2		(6:35) Public Affairs		(:20) Public Affairs Events				(:10) Public Affairs Events			
Dest. America		Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea
Discovery		Expedition		Expedition		Expedition		Ghost Adv (N)		Ghost Adventures	
Discovery Life		Hoard-Buried		Buried Al. "Ronda"		Buried Alive "Susie"		Buried Al. "Shelley"		Buried Alive	
E!		How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met
Encore		(6:35) ★★★ The Talented Mr. Ripley ('99)				★★ The Longest Yard ('05)				Goon: Last of the En...	
Food		Guy's Grocery Games		Grocery "Three Course Couples"		Grocery "Extreme Express Lane"		Grocery "All-Star Pizza"		Guy's Grocery Games	
Fox News		Ingraham (N) (Live)		Jesse (N) (Live)		Hannity (N) (Live)		Gutfeld! (N)		Fox News (N) (Live)	
Freeform		(6:50) ★★ The Addams Family ('91)				(:55) ★★ Addams Family Values ('93)				The 700 Club	
FUSE		Cher: Life in the Spotlight			Stevie Nicks: Wild at Heart			The Women		Cheaters	Cheaters
FX		(6:30) ★ Gone in 60 Seconds				Lowdown (N) (SP)		The Lowdown (N)		Gone in 60 Seconds	
FXM		(5:20) ★★★★ Aliens		(:10) ★★ Alien 3 ('92) Sigourney Weaver.					★★ Alien Resurrection ('97)		
Hallmark		(6:00) Reluctant Royal		The Spirit of Halloween ('26)				Gold Girls	Gold Girls	Gold Girls	Gold Girls
Hallmark Myst.		(6:00) Hannah		Hannah Swensen Mysteries				Murder, She Wrote		Murder, She Wrote	
HGTV		House Hunters	House Hunters	House Hunters	House Hunters	Sin City Rehab (N)		Botched Homes (N)		House Hunters	House Hunters
History		Pawn Stars		Pawn Stars (N)		Mountain Men (N)		(:05) Pawn Stars		(:05) Pawn Stars "Pawnanza"	
HLN		Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic
HSN		Tarte Cos (N) (Live)		C. Wonder Fashions		Holiday (N) (Live)		Holiday (N) (Live)		Perlier (N) (Live)	
ID		American Monster "The Last Dance"		Serial Killer "Till Death Do Us Part"		Serial Killer "Behind Closed Doors" (N)		Body- Baseme. "Her Last Steps" (N)		Serial Killer "Till Death Do Us Part"	
IFC		Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men
Lifetime		Rizzoli & Isles (N)		Rizzoli & Isles (N)		Rizzoli & Isles		(:05) Rizzoli & Isles		(:05) Rizzoli & Isles	
LMN		(6:00) Girl in Room 13		Girl in the Shed: Kidnapping of Abby Herna...				Big Lies in a Small Town ('22)			
MAGN		Fixer Upper		Maine "Ballard"		Maine		Maine "Roberts"		Maine	
MSNBC		The Weeknight (N)		All in With Chr. (N)		Briefing (N) (Live)		Last Word (N) (Live)		The 11th (N) (Live)	
MTV		Office	Office	Office	Office	Office	Office	Office	Office	Office	Office
National Geographic		To Catch "Cocaine Cocktail"		To Catch "Pills and Powder"		Contraband Capture (N)		Contraband "Rookie On Board" (N)		To Catch "Cocaine Connection"	
NatGeoWild		Secrets-Zoo		Secrets-Zoo		Baby (N)		Secrets-Zoo		Secrets	VetDetec
NECN		Your News (N)		Your News (N)		Your News (N)		Your News (N)		Your News (N)	
NewsNation		Vargas Report (N)		Cuomo (N)		On Balance (N)		Katie Pavlich (N)		Jesse Web (N)	
Ovation		Hudson & Rex		Hudson & Rex		Blue Skies		Hudson & Rex		Hudson "Pet Sitter"	
OWN		DreamH..	DreamH..	DreamH..	DreamH..	DreamH..	DreamH..	DreamH..	DreamH..	DreamH..	DreamH..
Oxygen		Dateline: Secrets		Dateline: Secrets "A Shot in the Dark"				Unknown Ser		Dateline: Secrets	
Paramount		(6:00) ★★★★ Forrest Gump ('94) Tom Hanks.					★★★ Ocean's Eleven ('01) George Clooney.				
QVC		Kevin O' (N) (Live)		Kitchen (N) (Live)		Holiday Fun with Rick & Jane (N) (Live)					
Science		Catastrophes		Catastrophes		Catastrophes		Catastrophes		Catastrophes	
Sundance		Law & Order "Hubris"		Law & Order		Law "Sunday in the Park With Jorge"		Law "Teenage Wasteland"		Law & Order "Phobia"	
SyFy		Movie	★★ Halloween ('18) Judy Greer, Jamie Lee Curtis.					The Ark (N) (SF)		The Last Exorcism	
TBS		Big Bang	Big Bang	All Elite Wrestling: Dynamite (N) (Live)				Collision (N) (Live)		Collision	Jokers
TCM		(5:45) 49th Parallel		★★★ Monty Python and the Holy Grail				★★★ Monty Python's Life of Brian ('79)			
TLC		Stories of E.R.		E.R. "End Zone"		Stories of E.R. (N)		Save My Skin (N)		1000-lb Roomies	
TNT		(6:00) Little Fockers		NHL on T..	NHL Hockey Dallas Stars at Colorado Avalanche (N) (Live)						Post-Ga..
Travel		Paranormal Cam.		Paranormal Cam.		Paranormal Cam.		Paranormal Cam.		Paranormal Cam.	
TruTV		(5:30) ★★★ Rudy		NHL on T..	NHL Hockey Dallas Stars at Colorado Avalanche (N) (Live)						Post-Ga..
TV Land		Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	(:20) Raymond		Raymond	Raymond	King	King
TV One		CosbySh..	CosbySh..	Jeffersons	Jeffersons	Jeffersons	Jeffersons	Jeffersons	Jeffersons	Jeffersons	Jeffersons
USA		9-1-1 "The Searchers"		9-1-1 "Triggers"		9-1-1 "Rage"		9-1-1 "Monsters"		9-1-1 "Athena Begins"	
VH-1		Chris	Chris	★★ Escape Room ('19) Logan Miller, Taylor Russell.				★★★ Adventureland ('09)			
WE		NCIS "Lost at Sea"		NCIS		NCIS		NCIS		NCIS "Gone"	

Content Ratings: **TV-Y** Appropriate for all children; **TV-Y7** For children age 7 and older; **TV-G** General audience; **TV-PG** Parental guidance suggested; **TV-14** May be unsuitable for children under 14; **TV-MA** Mature audience only **Additional symbols:** **D** Suggestive dialogue; **FV** Fantasy violence; **L** Strong language; **S** Sexual activity; **V** Violence; **HD** High-Definition; **(CC)** Close-Captioned